

Title: Im worried about men's mental health. Men, who do you confide in 100%?

Post Text: This week there was a post about lies men are told about women, and one of the comments said that women don't care about men's feelings. Im a woman, but that aside, who in your life do you open up to 100%? Dad, brother, friend?

EDIT: I did NOT expect to get this many responses but im really happy that it got a large discussion going. I think this topic is very important and extremely undervalued by our society. I AM young and naive, but thanks to your answers I feel I understand a man's world a bit better now.

As a woman who genuinely cares about men's mental health, and would love for my partner/ male friends to be able to lean on me...this discussion has shown me that i belong in a small minority. That most women don't want to see men as fallible humans with vulnerable emotions. This angers me as much as it saddens me and I see now that this is a HUGE problem within interpersonal relationships. We as women need to do better in this department!!!!!! Now i ask myself the question, "where do men get their strength from?"

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- No one. My Dad was that person. I learned quickly after he passed that it would be no one from then on, and that piled on to the grief and stress I felt at the time.
- Honestly? Reddit. I tell my wife everything as well, but seeing she is 7mo along with twins. Something's stress her out. So I'll dump them here just to vent them.

I listen a lot to people who need help and offer advice. I'm generally my collective groups sounding board most of the time. But like all therapists. I need a sounding board too, and well Reddit seems to be the most reliable for brutal reality.

- Crisis Intervention guy, counselor and first responder here. The state of men's mental health is truly concerning. There is an epidemic of loneliness and an overall effort to reduce 'toxic masculinity' that has reached wayyy too deeply into many men.
- No one. Tried confiding in my wife, she effectively told me to be a man and not a child. No one else -wouldn't trust to confide in. Basically it's keep it all inside until I can't stand it and then spend \$thousands on therapy.
- The best statement on this was stated by /u/TheBananaKing to quote.

Yeah, you think you can handle it, but honestly you probably can't.

In my experience, and in the experience of a whole lot of men, you very likely aren't prepared to see your husband ugly-cry, curl up in the foetal position and shake, express feelings of helplessness and worthlessness, or otherwise 'let it all out'.

Men generally aren't permitted outlets for vulnerability or negative emotions in our society. They're valued for what they can do, and since vulnerability is unreliability, demonstrating it completely destroys their worth in the eyes of everyone around them.

Inside Out is only true for girls. If boys break down crying, they get shamed and spat on and ostracized - and that's only by their own family.

Most of us have made the mistake, once, of letting the mask slip, and showing the person closest to us what it's really like in there. And we've seen the love and admiration in their eyes turn to contempt and disgust. And that never really comes back, certainly not all the way.

It's like seeing them learn that the house they just bought has termites and is of dubious structural soundness. Yay it's their home... but. And there will always be a but. And you can patch it up, make repairs, but what they wanted was a symbol of strength and safety and a reliable shelter that would always hold them up... and it will never quite be that ever again. That sense of betrayal that they put their trust in what turned out to be a lemon... that never goes away. Not at the subliminal, emotional level that defines what things really mean to you.

My strongest advice to you is not to look. You can know intellectually, that's fine - but don't force him to show you. You think you're above all the shitty gender-role programming that's been pushed on everyone for millennia, and of course you want to be - but chances are you're just not, not enough.

Even worse, partners feeling excluded and rejected when we don't 'open up' can push and push and finally force us to create a second mask, to simulate being just a little bit sad; occasionally letting out one single manly tear like Grey Worm. This is of course twice as much work and stress to maintain, on top of all the stress that's causing you to ask in the first place.

Very likely the best thing you can do for your husband is not to refer to signs of not-OK-ness leaking out. Act oblivious, or at least give him plausible deniability. And also with plausible deniability, offer up some unspoken comfort and support; little tokens of affection and appreciation that say 'I've got your back' without actually saying you know he needs it.

All of this sucks giant purple donkey dick, and none of it is your fault. Of course you want to help the person you love. Of course you know you'll be there for them. But the pressures we are raised with are often a lot stronger than we like to acknowledge, and ain't that a kick in the teeth?

And the very best thing you can do for the wider problem underlying it is to lessen the pressures that your child will be raised with. Be loud about it being OK for boys to be vulnerable. Use your incoming mama-bear powers to eviscerate and maul anyone trying to gender-police people, and let your kid see you do it. Teach that it's not a boys job to be a stoic protector 24/7/365, and that it's not a girl's job to be a fragile flower that needs that protection. Everyone needs healthy coping skills to tank moderate amounts of stress without cracking, and the option to be vulnerable and ask for help when they need it, regardless of their personal plumbing. Be part of the change you want to see, and pay it forward to the next generation.

- Well this sub doesn't do any good . We are concerned about men's mental health but we are quick to one up each other
- No one. I tried to open up once to hear and she got angry at me. I even went to therapy for a while I could tell he didn't give two shits. The only thing he wanted to do is put me on drugs.

It is now dark sense of humor and bottle it back up.

Title: "Mental health won't impact your career"

..is just shoddy. The above study shows that trans youth are 3-4 times more likely to complete suicide than comparable controls, but then, bizarrely, tries to explain this away by saying this is explainable by increased psychiatric contact (when really it just means that trans youth have increased psychiatric contact..and those that do are more likely to complete suicide).

The question then is, why do trans youth struggle more with mental health problems?

Thankfully there's plenty of studies that show that trans ppl generally get more discrimination, more crime, more bullied, more isolated etc etc and that acceptance is generally associated with better MH outcomes.

Again, I can't comment on the substance of this review as they haven't publish the data it's based on, but as I've said eleventy squillion times before, trans interventions are to deal with gender dysphoria not suicide..or depression..or anxiety or any other mental health problem.

The relationship between GD and functional MH problems is far more complex.

Title: does any of you guys have mental disorders(question) and how you guys felth about the toh characters having some disorders fells representative(question)

Post Text: i know my last question was about if have a lot of neurodivergent here

i think i will make a more large question

does any of you guys have mental disorders(question) and how you that have the disorder that are on toh being represented in toh(question)

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I didn't know I had anxiety and depression until I got counseling for TOH.

Much of what Luz does and feels I can relate to, especially feeling the world on your shoulders. I had a similar incident in my life, the stress from which left me blind in one eye.

Most everything related to mental health clicks with me, and I'm grateful beyond words that kids have a show that can be a positive example for relationships and also a positive example for mental health and talking about issues that are stuck in your mind.

- Definitely felt for Gus's struggle with anxiety and the illusions getting to a point where you have trouble centering yourself back on reality. My therapist gave me some tips regarding that "derealization" but Gus's simple counting on the fingers is something so straightforward I can do

it even when I can't think straight, and it helps me align enough to do the other methods people talk about like counting x number of things you can touch/see/smell/etc.

Post Text: Now we can't go on TDY/deployment for just seeing the mental health clinic? No matter the severity...

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Oh boy, this is my soapbox. *taps mic*

Let's be real for a moment. This may come off as harsh, and it's not necessarily directed at OP but to anybody who needs a reality check. I think it's important to frame it this way. I'll say it as many times as needs to be said.

If you are in this situation, first: there is a volunteer block right there that you have checked: yes, I want to do this (which, by the way, props to you. Seriously, it's so important). second: this profile is being created because it is believed that *your health and welfare are at risk.* it is exactly the same as a physical profile: certain things you should not be doing, written out on paper by a qualified doctor, stating that those restricted actions could injure you further or affect your recovery.

****Mental health is a silent killer****, and you as an individual are worth far more than your career. People put far too much stake in how much it will affect their enlistment when they don't realize it's their health and safety on the line.

I was in for 12 years as a flyer with a TS. I saw MH once a month, sometimes more often, my entire career and never once had a single issue. Eventually I was medically retired for a mental health diagnosis. I volunteered for the MEB because I didn't know what the hell was wrong with me. Ended up with the most amazing team and treatment I could've asked for that changed the course of my entire life up until now, and I never would've been able to do that if I hadn't released my death grip on my career. It hurt, but the relief was overwhelming when I could actually get the treatment I had needed for *years*.

That is to say, my life is 100 times better now that I'm not hiding my illness for the sake of keeping my job, which ironically was driving me toward losing *everything* if I hadn't gotten it treated. I "lost" (gave up) a job, but I gained far more. If I'd let it go, I'd have lost not only my job, my marriage, and my house, but probably my life too.

Happily, most people will not be required to make the choice I did. This profile is temporary, but I still want to commend you and anybody else seeking mental health treatment. Be honest with your friends if you can manage it. Encourage them to get help too. Talking about your experience openly helps reduce the stigma of getting help.

TL;DR: Better a DD214 than dead.

- We're not working at Pizza Hut. Seeking care shouldn't unnecessarily impact the career but at the same time you can't expect someone with a serious mental health condition to be green lighted for arming and deployment.

- The way I'm reading it: GOING to mental health doesn't have a negative impact. If you're DIAGNOSED with a mental health disorder that impacts job or interpersonal relationships you'll be placed on a profile that is there to help/protect you and others.

I would think that if your behaviors are impacting your job and relationships, that would have a far larger negative impact on your career than a profile for a bit

- ??? I saw Mental Health as a flyer, got put on meds, did my 6 month ground testing and now I'm back to being full up....definitely depends on diagnosis but imo they are doing the best they can under the circumstances. Profile for TDY/Deployment is preferred over a casket dude.

- >I wish to continue treatment in Specialty Mental Health

I mean this shit is pretty strongly implying that something is actually mentally wrong with you if you need specialty care. You shouldn't be deploying or going TDY if you're possibly mentally unstable.

- Let's be straight about this: yes, going to Mental Health absolutely can impact your career. And that's ok.

There's more to life than the Air Force. If your mental health is being adversely affected by your career, then that career needs to be impacted. Yes, it will suck, but your sanity is more important than making the next rank or getting your #1 assignment choice.

- Hi! As someone who works in mental health. It's a new DHA guidance. It's not something that we want. My clinic finds it to be dumb because now people aren't going to want to see us when there are other options like the chaplains or MFLCs. Originally the only time you would be put on a profile is if you are prescribed medication, suicidal or homicidal ideation, or if you are in ADAPT.

- Do you really want to deploy while having mental health problems?

Get better first, worry about the rest later. I don't understand why people think they should be 100% green-lighted despite struggling with Mental health currently. That all can wait until you are good again.

- Mental health absolutely impacts your career in the same way a physical injury does. You cant deploy or do certain jobs with a broken leg so why is it surprising that you might be duty limited when you have a mental health issue?

Remember you are not alone and god speed on your recovery friend.

- OP, they are prioritizing your mental health so that your treatment is not interrupted.

Deployments/TDYs can often be a stressful environment for any military member. They are insuring you are taken care of and not pushed deeper into stress/anxiety filled situations.

- Isn't this a good thing? Wouldn't a 6 month deployment make it difficult to get the mental health services you may need?

- This post is dumb as hell. Like many others have said, undiagnosed mental health issues are a medical condition and will generally result in a profile until treated. Nobody is trying to blackball you, foh
- Going to mental health won't affect your career. However, a diagnosis might. You've misinterpreted what you've been told.
- What is needed is more transparency about the type of mental health issues that have no impact, temporary or permanent impact, or may be disqualifying.
- A profile isn't a big impact to your career, though. No different than spraining your ankle and getting put on a profile for running.

My question is where are you stationed that you actually managed to get to the treatment stage with mental health?

- Would this include marriage counseling? My husband is saying no to counseling because he thinks it will affect his security clearance and job
- Reducing Mental Health Stigma in the Military

Military service is one of the most challenging careers globally, demanding physical fitness and mental health. However, post-war psychological disorders, which may originate from combat or be a result of stress in military service, are still largely unacceptable. This stigma reduces the willingness of service members to seek modes of healthcare they may require, making them less healthy and ready for duty. To be able to achieve a culture that is supportive of people within the armed forces, there is a need to fight against mental health stigma.

****Understanding the Stigma****

The prejudice of mental illness in our military stems from cultural beliefs that strength is the absence of weakness or vulnerability. Military personnel may think they will be scorned as cowards or considered unfit for duties and responsibilities. As stated by Greene-Shortridge et al. (2007), this is due to the stigma that enables people to deny having a mental condition, not to mention to look for treatment. Even as awareness rises, far too many of them still bring to themselves the notion that mental health issues are the individual's shortcomings.

****The Role of Leadership****

Key leaders are responsible for altering people's perceptions about issues related to mental health. It is empowering when leaders talk about mental health and are comfortable talking about who can get help. Managers can ensure that they develop programs that explain the existence of Battle mind training, which, according to Adler et al. (2009), helps manage resilience and has no trace of stigma. With such actions from leaders in society, issues to do with mental health are camouflaged in the same way readiness is done, thereby advocating for ready mental health in society.

****Barriers to Care****

Stigma reduction is still an essential step despite the continued presence of other barriers to care access. Such barriers include restricted private mental health care availability and a scarcity of resources within operational environments (Hoge et al., 2004). These barriers worsen the treatment of other related counter-illnesses like PTSD, anxiety, and depression that affect many of the returning veterans. All these difficulties can be solved only on a systemic level, for instance, by implementing mental health support programs directly into military workflows.

****Moving Toward Solutions****

They are improving mental health services in the military and concluding that creating a tolerant environment towards mental health requires a complex approach. Training military personnel through training sessions or awareness creation through peer discussions or workshops goes a long way in creating awareness for those servicemen and women. Providing ways for people to get access to private care motivates people to seek help so as not to face humiliation or get penalized at the workplace. Self-help support programs, where fellow client ex-service personnel are involved in the support, help develop rapport and respect for each other. Moreover, including joint mental health assessments in customary physical annual and clinical examinations removes the stigma and allows checking for problems for possible further treatment.

Eliminating stigma around mental health in the military is not simply the right thing to do; it is critical to the military's mission. Those who have expressed that they can get support in cases of mental health problems are more capable of meeting their responsibilities. By changing the mental health culture, improving access to care, and using leadership to drive change, the military can be the pioneers of breaking the mental health stigma.

- JFC. Yes, it can impact certain careers. The fact of the matter is, if you need a specialist to treat something, you should probably stay put so it can get treated. Same shit happens if you go on a medication or need a change in dosage of a med. Literally any illness, regardless of whether it's physical or mental, that does not improve with treatment within 365 days warrants an AMRO referral. If you require MH treatment or any treatment beyond that time frame, then you should not be in the military. No one should be in treatment for years for the same problem. Any provider that keeps you in therapy for that long is stealing your money or you don't have the motivation to change and that's on you. I'm not even sorry. I'm so fucking tired of these posts. Light the fire under your ass to get better. We're not going to fix it for you.
- This is not the norm. I have never seen this, I've been seeing MH for two years now for major anxiety disorder, depression, and adjustment disorder. Never been placed on a profile. I take my Zoloft, Wellbutrin, and I stfu and get back to work.
- People like OP irritate me. It's to ensure you don't harm yourself and others.

Is your TDY/deployment really going to help your mental health? For most if not, no. Get the help you need man.

- 85% of all deployment cockblocks was mental health at the last second when I was a UDM.
- Yeah. Watched a guy get separated due to his mental health issues.
- My permanent profile for physical issues was interrupted and turned into temporary ones...because mental health got pissed that I'm paying out of pocket for a counselor. According to them, I've been seeing her too long. Their fix? Profiling me for anxiety, and not telling me 😞
- You can select the other option and see what's out there that doesn't result in a profile. I went to mental health. They then referred me to a vet center
- AFRICOM has a 7 year time ban if you see mental health
- I was still able to go to SERE training after seeing mental health. U just have to get their permission before u go. Not a big deal.
- Honestly talking to military mental health is the scariest. You want to be truthful but when they start your treatment they tell you your safe... But.... If they feel like it's something they will tell you command. Unlike physical pain or injuries your life is put in someone's hands and what they think is going on in your head. There is zero you can do to prove them wrong because they will label you as an unreliable reporter and stop listening to you. Have you ever tried to explain that you're not crazy to somebody? It's impossible to do without sound crazy
- Fun fact for those that need it. You can see a VA mental health counselor (even as active duty) and your unit will be none the wiser. I can't speak for any inpatient facilities

Title: Apparently r/justiceserved and its newest bot thinks we're all terrorists with mental health issues.

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Self defense now is a mental health issue. Lol
- "We need a mental health reform."

Title: Has suffering from anxiety made you a bitter and resentful person?

Post Text: Hello, long story short I've been suffering from severe anxiety for about 8 months now. I'm on medication and have been doing consistent counselling but it's not enough. Anyways, this daily suffering has led me to become a more bitter and resentful person. I'm wondering if other people have experienced this as well.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- People and rejection have made me bitter. Anxiety is just the symptom of my underlying depression.
- Most definitely. I am envious of others who are simply going through life healthy and thriving. Or even the ones who are experiencing anxiety about the election. At least they have an end in sight.
- What medications are you taking? I have been pretty angry and bitter these past few years because of how terrible my anxiety is.

- Absolutely. I have CPTSD, was diagnosed 3/4yrs ago but have had symptoms from 8yo. Living with this chronic and debilitating anxiety for 2/3rds of my life has turned me utterly resentful and bitter. I hate it but with it causing me depression it's very hard for me to want to fix it. I've done trauma therapy, DBT and other talk therapies and it just seems to have gotten worse in the last year

- Yes, most definitely! I also am more compassionate to people with mental health issues too, but can't help but be jealous of people who get to live normally.

- It's weird.

I'm naturally an empath. I just understand others pain. But I am also kinda bitter and jaded with the world. Does this mean my anxiety becomes worse? Probably, but I can't help it.

I don't use pharma. Never did. I'm an alcoholic, but don't drink. I used alcohol for anxiety for decades. It's not nearly as bad as it used to, but it's still there.

I'm sorry you're feeling this way. The world isn't that bad even though there's evil everywhere. Just try to keep your perspective focused.

- I'm having social anxiety for many years now, it's hard to not snap at people who are close to you when you can't live your social life like everyone else does. (especially if people around don't really know what you're feeling) You can't be happy all the time, no one can, and being in constant anxiety around the people outside and even online is not helping being less bitter. I never took any medicine, never got to therapists, so I think my mental health is giving me a sign through my bitterness that I should consider it xD's

- Yes i think it has for me. To make myself feel better when I feel inferior and insecure (I have social anxiety), I try and make myself believe I'm better than others and try to act cold and reserved. This backfires and then I just start being a bitter person. It's very stupid but I'm trying to fix it and to try and start being a happier person.

- Sort of. On one hand I'm definitely bitter towards enjoying things since it's always dampened by a constant state of anxiety and nausea. I can't enjoy what I eat outside of needing it to fuel me so I make do with watching cooking videos.

I also get fairly annoyed when people tell me to relax more now. What do you mean relax? You think I haven't tried to for the past year? The more present my anxiety is the more impatient I am with dealing with people who don't know any better, of which I don't blame them for either.

However, it's also made me more empathetic to strangers and general events. I don't get so upset at things that used to make me upset since my internal state is preoccupied. Similarly I'm learning to enjoy the small things.

- It's certainly made me annoyed at times but not bitter! Working each day to better myself helps a lot! What techniques do you use to help your anxiety?

- The key is to stop thinking it's just you and no one will understand I was angry thinking I was alone in this until I realized this is pretty much everyone some are just good at hiding it better we are a lonely generation understand what your feeling is normal but it's not normal to

stay that way forever Resentments creates more anxiety it's a terrible cycle chose forgiveness!
But you have to forgive yourself first
- It might be that you just don't have the capacity at the moment.

It takes so much energy just to get through life when your mental health is suffering to the extreme.

I think once you find the right treatments for yourself you will feel you have more capacity for others and more patience.

I feel like anxiety is so often our nervous systems completely overloaded so anything extra can just push you over the edge.

I'm sure you aren't a bitter person deep down, you're just going through a hard time right now.

Take care of yourself. Find whatever you can to get some decent down time, as good sleep as possible, relaxing diverting activities that make you feel good and be systematic about treatments for your anxiety, whether it's trying a block of CBT, doing a regular relaxation app, speaking to the doctor about medication.

Hope you feel better soon. Life is not easy 🧡

- As the other have said it has made me more compassionate but also very bitter and resentful. I highly resent people without anxiety and it's complicated to fight this feeling

- Good question. I was meditated heavily for 25 years. So I'm feeling major anxiety. I have less patience. But I am trying to be patient it's hard. I'm trying. ❤️

Title: 24 F, career focused or am I delusional about reality.

Post Text: 2018

I have joined in institute can't tell name here but that provided me BA degree and upsc coaching upto to no sense of myself I have joined yet not much helpful for me .

2019

lockdown online classes my monkey mind got a honey that is phone 📱 literal distortion of life strated

Instant instagram,snapchat, everything that attracted monkey mind and fallen trap into final lap dating . Suffering from validity syndrom (I discovery myself)

2021 August

done with degree . I was involved in online stranger dating because only thing that was giving me happiness. Feb was in home (as was in delsuion i was studying I wanted to do upsc was super excited with delusional about to take coaching and moving close to my online

Still coming from conservative family they send me to the city stayed in pg. where I decided to take coaching it was around 18 March 2022.

Regret Regret dumbness at 700

Hardly went to classes because felt hard cant able to do daily answer writing cant able to make friends, many excused here introverted jealous dumb women i was. And also busy enjoying life and as I said money mind found so much freedom first time in life she was doing all kind of shitty nasty man hunting destroyed her relationship and herself.

2023 may D-Day prelims upsc zero preparation failed came back to home.

June 2023- June 2024

Online search strategies ,planning ,planning overwhelmed can't able to single work out of anxiety

June prelims 2024 failed .

Did I learnt any lesson in life and exam. With regard to still immature in 2024 being 24f in my homes costing my life parents are on run to find a match to marry me soon my dad sister son was easy one stop Solution to my they live in Kuwait i have to move in i fought did drama all I told one last attempt in 2024 this happend in October.

Since June I joined a mentorship they were good but you know me it was hard with this overthinking dumb mind can't able to do single plan by myself not able to recognize my own pattern of study not myself . It was becoming overwhelming with that mentorship with so much targets yet not in mind even single thing I read so much anxiety pushed to me away from our mentorship group.

I choose to join other mentorship dumb ass shortcut may be I was trying they assured to cover prelims syllabus by teaching all material of prelims subjects thought I though omg !!!!!!! I am going to pass prelims finally 🙌😂
I have joined

Just one subjected i have completed when geography started i understood there teaching was simple yet same problem now

1. I had no plan how am going to cover this vidoes watching and remembering as I have joined late 1 month.

So somehow one subject I have complted but got stuck with geography bcs my 2nd thoughts kicked in i was looking for more clarity of concepts over youtube i was in loop here simply concept Simplify concept was just name over analysis yet not moving ahead

Septembe - October - November stuck in loop with geography

Now here I am lost confused overwhelmed anxious can't able to complete single chapter reading.

May be you never came across this much dumbness in your life.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- ## r/AskIndia is looking for new moderators, [please apply here if you are interested.](https://www.reddit.com/r/AskIndia/comments/1gx5qiw/mod_we_are_looking_for_new_moderators_for/)

I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit](/message/compose/?to=/r/AskIndia) if you have any questions or concerns.

- So are u going to prepare for pre 2025 ?

- What exactly do you want (to do in life)?

- you're marrying your bua ka Idka!? first cousin!?

Title: Suffering from terrible Anxiety and it has affected me in all aspects of my life.. looking for solutions or things to help with this stress.. cheers in advance

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Hi. I'm 4 years anxiety-free. My anxiety was so bad that I couldn't work for 4 months. I was paralyzed by it and lost almost 20 lbs. I white-knuckled through it without medication or seeing a therapist. That worked for me but isn't for everyone and I am not against anti-anxiety medication and I love therapists who help people with anxiety. Here are the resources that helped me the most:

****Media:****

[The Panic Pod podcast.](<https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/the-panic-pod/id1489050218>)

[Cognitive Behavioral Therapy for Dummies](<https://www.dummies.com/article/body-mind-spirit/emotional-health-psychology/psychology/cognitive-behavioral-therapy/what-is-cognitive-behavioural-therapy-267176/>)

Edit to add [Michael Sealey YouTube channel](<https://youtube.com/c/MichaelSealey>). It's all guided relaxation, guided meditation, and nearly half of it is focused on calming an anxious or fearful mind. They are long and have very mellow ambient music in the background. His voice is soothing.

Edit to add [The Tara Brach podcast](<https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/tara-brach/id265264862>). Just wonderful and supportive and calming Buddhist talks that speak to a lot of the sources of fear and anxiety.

****Habit Changes:****

No caffeine.

No alcohol.

Focus on deep triangle breathing, and avoid shallow breathing.

Kept daily CBT journal using the prompts laid out in the Dummies book linked above.

Physical exercise to near exhaustion every day. When my body was exhausted, there was less energy for my brain to use to ruminate in fear spirals, and I would sleep better. I would walk for 90 minutes at a time just listening to The Panic Pod and Eckhart Tolle talks. Yoga and Pilates, as well as weights. That was appropriate for me. What's best for your body may be different.

The anxiety subsided gradually, rather than going away quickly. Learning how and why my brain became anxious, and learning the cognitive tools to stop future fear spirals, was the key to being anxiety free. Knowing that my awareness is separate from the 'mechanics' of my reactive mind was my biggest and most useful breakthrough. That was the key for me but may not be for you.

You can get to the other side of this period of anxiety, I just know you can.

EDIT: Thank you so much for the awards. I wish I could take the anxiety away from everyone who has it!

- Feeling your feelings is a discipline. Go out of your way to truly feel all your feelings as much as possible. Breathe through it. It really helps.

- Check out Huberman Lab neuroscience podcasts. Lots of good stuff for anxiety.
- Dr. Harry Barry on youtube. Gave me a new perspective.
- Sorry to hear you're having terrible anxiety, it's never an easy thing to deal with. I'd recommend looking into Acceptance and Commitment Therapy (ACT) as it incorporates mindfulness with other psychological processes and is rooted in hard science/evidence based. Personally it has helped me significantly with anxiety and panic attacks. I wish you all the best with your journey!
- You have a lot of great advice here for lifestyle/therapy options! These are some crisis type tools I use when it's bad

1) when I'm repeating thoughts and worries over and over, I actually sit quietly and take time to analyze them. The series of questions my therapist has taught me goes something like "is this thought/worry true? Is it 100%, without any doubt, absolutely true? How do I feel when I believe it is true? who would you be without this belief? Is it possible, even slightly, that the opposite could be true? And then are you able to flip the statement."

So, for example, "everyone thinks I'm an idiot". Is it true? At that moment I might say yes, but then the 100% follow up, my scientific brain says that no, I don't know if it's that true. Is it possible not everyone thinks I'm an idiot? Yes. It's possible. I feel terribly about myself when I believe it. If I couldn't believe it at all, even a little, I would feel so much more free to be me. Could I flip the sentence in my head to something more positive (or less negative)?..even if I get to "my friends and family think I'm capable and have good qualities", it's an improvement.

The series of questions also helps me see when I'm "in someone else's business". Think along the lines of "what others think of you is none of your business." I can't control what others do and think or how they feel. I can't protect my family from feeling bad or from hurting each other's feelings. I need to stay in my feelings and in my actions.

2) if the worry is still nagging I try to make sure I'm not judging myself for worrying (there is a part of you that is genuinely concerned and that part is valid and, while it may not feel helpful, that part is trying it's best to protect you) And then I ask myself "what is the worst that can happen?" (Insert brain's catastrophic response here) followed by "can I be willing for that to happen?" The answer has pretty much always been yes because, in the end, the thing I am worried about is likely out of my control. So even if I don't want to deal with the worst possible outcome, when it comes down to it, if that's what happens, then that's what happens. I have pretty much always determined that, yes, ultimately, I'm willing for that to be an outcome and I'm willing to respond to that outcome. If I'm not, then it usually means I need to reevaluate my plan or actions. (Eg. Im worried about something at work and that I'll lose my job and that will mean my husband will want to leave me and and and and and and). And yep, all of it could possibly turn out that way. But if it does, I will go from there. Is it also possible that it could turn out ok? Yep.

I have also found that if the bad thing I'm worried about does happen, it usually isn't as bad as I worried. At the very least, it's never been worse than I worried. The build up on my brain is always infinitely more stressful than the actual event and I feel more ok because I've already

examined what I think is every possible outcome and determined all of them are possible and I'm willing to experience it.

3) when I feel myself starting to panic, someone on Reddit taught me about identifying 5 things you can see, 4 things you can hear 3 things you can feel, 2 things you can smell, and one thing you can taste. If I can't make it through that, then I go simpler and count the blue objects in the room. It can help physically ground you back to where you are in the present moment.

4) box breathing - breathe in for 4, hold for 4, out for 4, hold for 4, in for 4, hold, out, hold. Or sometimes I do breathe in for 4, out for 8, in 4, out 8.

5) when I can't manage to breathe or count things, I need to break it down to "right now, in this moment (not a moment or millisecond from now, not a minute or hour or day) at this very exact moment, am I safe?" Again the answer has always been yes. Because if I wasn't, I wouldn't be able to consciously ask myself that. This one was a struggle for me because I kept spiralling into all the potential dangers of the world and how anything could happen to anyone at any time. I had to really work with my therapist to understand the single moment.

As others have mentioned, I also try to keep healthy things going as close to daily as I can (journal, meditate, walk, exercise - I horseback ride, do yoga, and dance -, shower, tidy up, etc.) and work on a bedtime routine and sleep hygiene. I also don't beat myself up if I miss a day. My family and close friends know about my mental health and I am fortunate to have an understanding boss who also tries to support and accommodate when I'm struggling. I am also taking Wellbutrin for depression (which can actually make anxiety worse, so I don't believe it is typically recommended as an anxiety specific treatment) and a small dose of what I believe is an antipsychotic except it's used as a supplement to the Wellbutrin to help me sleep better, the dose isn't high enough to work as an antipsychotic, if that makes any sense. I am grateful I get to see my therapist regularly and am able to adjust frequency when I need to. Sometimes we just talk, but he specializes in EMDR (was helpful for my cPTSD) and Internal Family Systems.

If you get a lot of back and forth in your head, I really recommend looking up IFS. It sounds really... hokey? at first. And it's hard not to feel cheesy doing it at first. But omg it has been so extremely helpful to me and my anxiety and overall self.

Edited to add a bit to point 1...

And edited again to say thank you for the award!

- I'm a trauma-informed holistic practitioner, psych/neuroscience student, and have dealt with anxiety myself. I overcame it naturally. Know that you are not your stress. You are not your anxiety. You are not your thoughts. Someone/some experience planted them there and it became hardwired in your brain. It's been scientifically proven that your thoughts create who you become and that you are the only person that can change that. It's like you literally have to convince yourself with positive thoughts. But you have to get to the root of why you experience

anxiety. And be ok with discomfort, exploring your emotions because they need to be processed, and be ok with change (the unknown) anxiety is based on perceived fear.

I got myself out of anxiety with heart breath meditation and asking myself in the moment “is this real or perceived fear?” And it’s always perceived based on what we’ve been programmed with in our experiences. If you are not faced with an obvious imminent threat, take a deep breath, hug your heart, and tell yourself the threat is perceived. Cognitive Behavioral Therapy, Emotional Freedom Technique, massage, meditation & breathwork all beneficial and scientifically backed to help improve symptoms.

Check out the works of Dr. Joe Dispenza.

- Quit drinking coffee and alcohol.

- Cognitive behavioral therapy, Etsy has downloadable workbook/planner’s you can print and do yourself. Listening to music and driving help me the most; or doing something that makes me happy- truly happy. I love animals so I like volunteering at the local shelter (it’s impossible for me to be sad surrounded by dogs/cats) ❤️❤️❤️ I also found quite a few ADHD/CPTSD life coaches on Tik Tok; watching their stuff helps me tremendously.🤗 It reminds me I am not alone in this (even though I feel like it,) we have a chemical imbalance we didn’t ask for this. I try to focus on what’s most important at that moment to help ground myself. BREATHE, YOU GOT THIS ❤️ HUGS 🤗

-

<https://medium.com/publishous/fixing-your-brain-a-guide-to-balancing-neurotransmitters-72649aab40b1>

- I personally have had relatively crippling anxiety my whole life and I’ve learned recently that it was because I have complex ptsd, or complex trauma so you may want to look into that and see if it resonates :) also nervous system dysregulation. The holistic psychologist (Nicole LePera) has some good resources on those topics.

- See a counselor. You don’t have to do this alone. Plus treatment works - but you have to start the right treatment that has been shown to work. I’m a therapist - and I’ve met young people and older people with anxiety and depression. The only difference is--the older ones waited 20 or 40 years to get help, and suffered unnecessarily. It’s up to you to get help. Please don’t let another year go by.

- I could talk to you all day & night about what i’ve been through and what i’ve tried but i’ll keep it short ... lol

I don’t know what’s going on in your life but my anxiety was off the charts bad a couple of times and what helped me 100% was getting rid of the negative things and people in my life. It’s way easier said than done, change is hard, especially if you have severe anxiety or depression but sometimes it’s necessary in order to heal. It’s hard when your life is intertwined with someone who brings you down. For example, I was in a relationship where i was so stressed over what was going on when i was away (for good reason) that i made myself sick with panic attack after panic attack. Once it was over i felt like the world was lifted off of my shoulders and i was

myself again, for the most part. I'm not sure what your reasons are or if they're coming out of nowhere (which i know happens) but that helped me.

Sorry if it's not your situation at all.

I wish i had a cure because would give it to you! I know how it feels and your not alone in feeling this way. It's the worst and it's debilitating for me too sometimes.

Good luck!

Also

I slowed down use of my facebook then i got rid of my facebook and most social media besides this and it's helped me tremendously as well.

- ​

<https://thework.com/> this is good and Eckhart Tolle's has others have mentioned.

getting into nature as often as you can will help a lot too.

- I've had anxiety for roughly 3/4 years now. For the longest time I would just battle myself. I would eventually get over what was bothering me but it kept coming back.

Eventually it got so bad that I talked to love ones on what I should do as I didn't want to keep battling with myself. Talking about it I found out that I wasn't alone.

I then seeked help by going to a counsellor and that really helped.

In combination with that I seeked out and got a family physician. We talked about what I was going through and I took a questionnaire test. Through that we talked about medication and I've been on medication for over a year now and it's absolutely changed my life for the better.

That said maybe you don't need anything of that. I just want you to know that your not alone in this and we're all here to help(someone probably has better ways).

The number one thing is you want to improve your well-being and that's the first step needed.

- [deleted]

- I would do very hot showers. I would sweat in these showers for at least 40 minutes drinking lots of water and electrolytes. The water would be so hot that I would have to move all the time or it would feel like it is burning me up. My heart rate would get into cardio range. After that long sweat I would put on a thick robe and sweat some more. It was very relaxing.

- I started Body therapy for trauma. See if there is a Holistic Center in your area. Acupuncture for trauma is another option.

- This may not be popular, but honestly? Citalopram (celexa in the US?). Gives me the breathing space for CBT and mindfulness to work.

- First you need to do full medical tests including hormones (thyroid, cortisol, etc). Any hormonal imbalance will cause anxiety, depression. This is very important

If your anxiety is trauma base then you need EMDR therapy with a qualified EMDR professional.

Read this too:

<https://medium.com/publishous/fixing-your-brain-a-guide-to-balancing-neurotransmitters-72649a-ab40b1>

Progress will take time up to 3-6 months

Healthy diet rich in healthy fat (brain/hormones need cholesterol- this is documented online)
Exercise minimum 3 times a week, 45min each (balanced not aggressive exercise) - bike, running, swimming, yoga (anything that will increase blood flow in the brain) - this is all online you can medical studies that explain process etc

During the day:

Vitamin supplement in the morning, omega 3

Slow Diaphragmatic breathing 10 times a day, 10 breaths each time (stop if you get tired and go slow in the beginning)

Vitamin D or sun exposure

Strong probiotics

Aware of the present moment, find joy in the small things, going for a walk in nature

L theanine (matcha tea has lots but it has caffeine, is better to go with supplement form)

At night:

Magnesium at night before sleep

In bed before sleep progressive muscle relaxation (lots of free YouTube video)

Last thought before you close your eyes, a happy memory from your past as vivid as possible.

Good luck

- cut out masturbation

- [deleted]

- I promise it will get better.

Things that have worked for me (and I've been THROUGH IT): mindfulness meditation (I got hooked into it via the Calm app, but you can find free guided meditation through YouTube), Buspar medication, CBT AND talk therapies, and the book The Wisdom of Anxiety.

Anxiety is very treatable and it will get better.

- Look up ACT Therapy, and read the book "A Liberated Mind" (cheesy name), really helped me a lot.

- My solution for my anxiety was more mindfulness.

- Do you have any problems with hearing? I found I had a strange hearing loss that my brain was subconsciously freaking out about and a hearing aid has really helped my brain calm down

- Do this everyday preferably twice a day everyday

[intro](https://youtu.be/K4hCvdDn7Zc)

And [practice](https://youtu.be/EwQkfoKxRvo)

- Try this. Everytime you are anxious, immediately ask "who is it that feels anxious?" When you do this, FEEL into it. Who?

The key is to feel and sense it. Don't think. The moment you start thinking, you ask "Who is thinking?" Then go back to feeling/sensing this. Then just remain there. When you do it right, it's almost as if a significant chunk of weight falls away from you.

- Headspace to learn meditation, The Power of Now by Eckhart Tolle, solid gym routine and diet, good sleep & learning to not associate with your thoughts so much. Let them come and go, they are not you. They are not true. Godspeed friend

- Take deep breaths and write in a journal about whatever it is you're thinking

- I would try magnesium, I suffered from anxiety, depression, etc for years and finally found out I was living with several vitamin deficiencies that were causing debilitating anxiety. Magnesium for me was the most severe and I noticed an immediate effect at 400mg (within 10 minutes). I take vitamin A, C, B3, Zinc, and magnesium every day. Others once a week.

Edit: As others have said, I also would give up drugs, alcohol, and caffeine if that is something you partake in*.

- It might be drastic but try spending time with yourself... in public. Doing things you'd normally do with others (lunch, shopping, fun, etc.) - it will force you to rely on your own confidence and put you in an uncomfortable space but eventually you'll come out so much stronger. Best of luck to you

Title: If you have a friend suffering from suicidal thoughts/depression, what do you do?

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- If you ever need help, then please know that there are many qualified people who would like to help you.

https://www.iasp.info/resources/Crisis_Centres

<http://www.befrienders.org/>

<http://www.suicidepreventionlifeline.org/GetHelp/LifelineChat.aspx>

<http://www.samaritans.org/how-we-can-help-you> [UK]

<https://www.lifeline.org.au/Get-Help/> [AU]

There are crisis services worldwide that are trained to provide support. They are designed to give temporary relief from feelings that are overwhelming you and while they are unlikely to fix

any underlying problems, can help you get through a tough hour/night/week. Chat services are usually available on these sites. In the US, calling 211 or going to their website is a free referral source. They have providers who will see you regardless of your ability to pay. Just as you would see a doctor when you are sick, you deserve to take care of your mental health.

- So 8 years ago, my best friend of 18 years committed suicide. I never noticed anything was wrong until the day I found out he had passed. After that, hindsight was 20/20 and I couldn't believe I never noticed all the hints that were there all along. I spent a long time blaming myself...I noticed them now, why the hell didn't I notice them before? But, at the end, there was nothing I could do about it anymore. My friend was gone.

So, instead, once I quit blaming myself, I made a vow. From then on, I wouldn't let it happen again. Anytime somebody I knew was showing any of the signs I had come to recognize, I reached out to them. Even if it was somebody I didn't know super well. I've now done it three times...once for a former co-worker who had been laid off, once with a university classmate who was having trouble in her marriage, and once with a high school classmate who I noticed posting some very strange things on facebook (hadn't spoken to him in years, but we knew each other and he knew my friend who had died).

Here's the advice I would give:

1) Right off the top, most important, you gotta let them know you see them struggling and that you are on their side. Don't do it in a confrontational way, it can start with something as simple as "is everything alright?". Make sure they know you're not trying to intrude and insert yourself, but that you want to help. My go to line has always been "if you don't want to talk about it, you can tell me to butt out, but I wanted to make sure everything's okay". And then if they tell you to butt out, you damn well butt out, but end it with "if you ever need to talk to somebody, just know I'm always here".

2) If they do open up to you, just listen to them. Don't try to resolve their issues for them because, unless you're a trained psychologist, you're not equipped to do that. If they tell you, for example, that their girlfriend broke up with them, say "that's terrible, tell me what happened", not "that's terrible, what can I do to help". In certain cases, people just need to vent all their frustrations and they need a person who is just going to listen to them. Not make all their shit go away, but listen and truly feel sympathetic to them. Just knowing somebody cares enough to ACTUALLY listen to you is a very reassuring thing.

3) If they start telling you things that are causing their depression, under absolutely no circumstances whatsoever should you tell another living soul about it. Even if the person that is causing them to have suicidal thoughts is somebody you know. Even if you think that person would be reasonable about it. Even if you think you can resolve the issue by telling somebody else. Don't do it. They opened up to you and only you. If they wanted somebody else to know, they would have told them.

4) Encourage them to get some help if at all possible. One of the biggest issues is that they think getting help makes them weak. The stigma is starting to lift, but it is definitely still there. If you think they're a very serious threat to themselves, then try everything you can to break down that stigma and convince them to get some help.

Those are my four points. I hope they are helpful. These are the steps I have followed and I like to think have been somewhat successful to varying degrees over the past 8 years.

I know it can seem daunting to put yourself out and offer to help your friend in need, but I promise you that it's worth it and a lot better than the alternative. Also, make sure to look after yourself in this process...being there for a depressed and/or suicidal person is not easy. Once they start opening up, you might hear some things that are very dark and that you may not have wanted to hear. And hearing those things can bring some darkness into your own life too. So always make sure you are looking after yourself too.

If you need any other advice or want help writing a message or something to your friend, you can always DM me. I'm always happy to help, even if it's a complete stranger.

- People who are depressed often become silent. They'll stop texting, calling, and using social media. That's when you need to reach out and pull them back into your circle and hug them tighter.

There's usually a reason why. Finding out may be tough, but you might just save a life if you sit down and listen to them.

Edit: I appreciate all your responses and awards! Great dialogue going on here. I want to add- approaching a friend whose a bit isolated, be gentle, non judgmental, and ready to listen without commenting unless they ask.

Here's an example. "Hey man, I care about you a lot. You know that right? I'm worried you might be sad and going through this on your own, do you want to talk about whats going on? If not that's totally cool, let's do something fun instead. If so, gently ask about depression. Ask SIG E CAP (sleep, loss of interest, guilt, energy, concentration, pleasure) and if they are depressed, encourage them to see a doctor ASAP. And after that, be the best friend you are to them, or best neighbor you can be to them, or best classmate, whatever role you play in their life.

- do the best thing someone can do

be there for them and listen to what they say, don't offer some shit advice to them or tell them it gets better, but instead give them someone to lean on in their times of trouble, and I can say this for sure having been someone who was helped out of depression and suicide by just someone who stood there, listened to what I had to say and god damn it felt so much better

- Acknowledge the fact that they're depressed. Tell them that you're there for them if they feel like going out again. Offer help with practical stuff if they need any.

Don't force them to do fun things, don't tell them to cheer up.

Only worry when they appear suddenly at peace with the world and depression seems totally gone. It's not uncommon for suicidal people to have a short tranquil phase when they have decided to end it all and are at peace.

- First of all, I think it's important to keep in mind that it's not your job to cure them. Take that burden off your shoulders, and focus on being there as a friend. It will help both of you in the long run. As the saying goes "Don't set yourself on fire to keep others warm."

Second, if they decide to open up to you, listen and acknowledge. I know we all have an urge to help, and it's easy to throw out quick fixes like "have you tried X", but a lot of the time validation can be more helpful.

Third, don't give up on them. Depression can last a long time. Keep inviting them to stuff even if they decline/don't answer/bail again and gain. It's very easy to stop inviting someone when they don't show interest, but in the long run it could be very helpful in their recovery.

Best of luck to you and your friend, these things are hard. Hope you can work through it.
- I'm depressed-

my biggest advice is to not take their symptoms personally. Depression is exhausting, meaning we often don't have the energy to even open and respond to messages. A lot of people take this as us not wanting to talk to them so in response they don't talk to us either. By doing this, you're just isolating us further. We want to chat with you, but sometimes we can't. Often times, when we are the most silent is when we need the most help

- I spent most of yesterday morning on a suicide hotline. With the exception of maybe two people, those who know me would be surprised by that, and many would dismiss it. Based on my longtime struggles:

* Acknowledge their pain, and that it is real and valid. Don't tell them "You're lucky, you have ____." Don't, for the love of fuck, tell them that kids with cancer/POC/trans youth/you or someone you know have it worse, or remind them of their privileges. Don't make references elsewhere about how selfish or self-centered they are for their mental health struggles

* Ask them what they need, right now, and be prepared to give that to them. It might be a hug, just time to vent, assurance that you're not going to stop caring about them, or quiet company and distraction so we don't feel alone in our heads

* Don't ask "Why haven't you _____" or "Why don't you just _____?" What seems obvious or simple to you is probably something that we've already tried, countless times, and it's not working. 99.9% of the time, we don't want advice. We just want comfort, safety, love

* Don't word-police them. This is not the time to remind them that some people/you consider "crazy" or "insane" problematic. We are already struggling to explain these feelings, and yes, it's going to be imperfect and even include ugly words

* Leave inspirational rhetoric out of it. This is not the time to talk about how much Jesus comforts you. We don't need to hear "that which does not kill you-" or "put on a happy face!" or "Have you tried working out more?"

* HOWEVER, it is okay to share your own perspective, just a bit. I know this has come under troubling scrutiny, but responding with "I've felt like that too, after I lost my job in 2012, I understand" makes most of us feel less alone. As long as you don't take over, or make it about your own struggles, letting someone know that "Ugh, I've been there, too, and it sucks" = connection and empathy, which is desperately needed

* Be prepared to set boundaries and even walk away if it's too much. Most of us don't want to be burdens. No, you don't have to take middle-of-the-night phone calls, or spend all week with them. It's okay to say "I love you and want to help, but I can't do the heavy lifting on this one. Can I call someone for you? Want me to see if Friend or Family Member can come over?" It's even okay to call for outside help from a crisis center, or ask them if they want to go to the hospital

* Remind them of the things you value about them. Let them know the ways in which your world is better because they are in it. Don't guilt them -- "I would be heartbroken if you weren't here!" -- but remind them of how they matter to you. "I've always been grateful for your friendship. Remember that time we went to the zoo? That's one of my happiest experiences with you. You've given so much."

* Remember this is an ongoing struggle, one step forward and two steps back, for a lot of us. You can't magically fix us. There ARE no magical fixes, otherwise, we'd've already fixed things.

* Thank you. Even if we forget to say it in the moment, we're so grateful that you gave a shit and took time. Thank you

- **Two of my best friends tried to commit suicide. Please listen closely, I literally beg you.**

The other comments cover the basics. I'm gonna give the unusual advice that I wish I had been told.

At some point, you need to let go emotionally. **You cannot be someone's full-time ventilator.** You WILL crumble. "Even if I'm scared they will die?" Even if you're scared they will die. "But they matter more!" Don't. Do. It. Alone. Get them help. Because if you're saving a drowning person, as strong as you are, they will try to drown you too in their panic. Either that or the current will tire you out and you will sink. YOU WILL BOTH DROWN.

The first time I missed the signs until it was too late and got their call from the hospital. We were only 16. "It'll never happen again," I told myself. "Next time, I'll stop it, no matter what it takes." The next time, I was 18. I held to my word. I went in the trenches and tried to pull them out before it was too late. A month passed. Two. Three. Six....

I still suffer from Complex Post Traumatic Stress disorder, a panic disorder, and post traumatic seizures.

I might be on medication for the rest of my life because of the trauma I suffered keeping a suicidal person alive. And in the end, they turned against me when I threatened to call them an ambulance, because I was being "selfish". And for a while I believed it.

****TL;DR:** Whatever you do, no matter who it is, be a helper, not a hero. Heroes don't exist. Draw boundaries or pay the price. And the price is heavier than you might think. You are worth saving too.**

- When I was in my severe depression and had thoughts of suicide I explained to my friend I couldn't be there to support her in her day to day as I could barely support myself. She continued to reach out almost daily. It honestly ended our friendship for 6 months because I didn't feel heard when I said "let me be"

I handle my bouts of depression by isolating and doing what I have to do - work, care for myself (shower, make my bed, eat), and care for my dog. That is my bare minimum

Listen to your friends!

- I suffer from depression and am occasionally suicidal. What would help me out most if people just reached out to ask "hey, how are you doing today?" It would help make me feel seen. It's so simple, but something that rarely happens.

- Sometimes people don't want help. Seeking therapy and the other suggestions offered all require an interest in self preservation that may not exist. For some people this is the right choice. And those left behind have to live with it.

- OP you are amazing. I have ppl on the internet(VRchat) who help me during my depression and my down phase. They comfort me with just listening or just do some deeptalk with me. as said above dont offer solutions just listen it works best.

You are such an amazing person if you reach out to know how to help your friends i wish you the best :)

- Won't specifically comment on suicidal thoughts situations, but depression in general.

As a base: Be there, but don't expect anything. They might not text/call back (or even read your text), agree to any activity or show up when agreed. Do not take this personally. I think calling is a good thing, even if it's just a small talk.

As to the frequency and intensity... It probably depends on the other person, but I'd say calling daily is fine (if they're a really close friend) and just chat for a bit. You won't be able to solve their problem, I think most of what counts is to remind them that there's someone out there who is thinking of them and cares about them. You can ask them out for an activity (like, going for a walk), and, depending on the person, be at least a little persistent about it (sometimes people need that little extra push), but doing so light-heartedly without pressuring them.

They should seek professional help and if they don't, you may offer to help them look for a therapist or help them set up a call.

- Being someone who's been on both sides of the coin the biggest thing I do is something I learned from my dad and it's simply being present with them. I never force them to talk about what is going on before they're ready, I just choose to be present with them.

My dad and I still do this as depression is an ongoing struggle for me even though a few years ago he moved to Georgia. Sometimes we will just sit on FaceTime for hours doing our own things (me gaming, him usually a project or a movie) but still just being there and being present for the other person. Mostly we chat about life and what the last week has brought us and what we look forward to, and sometimes we don't say anything. Sometimes we play Xbox games together which is nice and sometimes we both have deep conversations about what is happening but we never force the other person to bring it up before they're ready.

I know it sounds odd, but even something as simple as knowing someone else is there and wants to be there with you even if nothing gets said has been something I've found wonderfully helpful and has had a much bigger impact than I could've imagined not just for me, but for my closest friends I've been able to help with it.

Something else that I find helpful is just helping them put it out of their mind. Whether we hangout, play video games, grab food, my main focus is just to allow them to be in a headspace they feel safe and comfortable, but also one that allows them to be free from what is holding them back and helps build that trust and relationship with them so that if they do feel like opening up there is no concern from them that you'll use it against them or share their business.

Also remember that the quality of friends in your life is much more important than the quantity of friends. Be someone of quality that has a genuine interest in those you care for but it is never your job to please everyone. My biggest times of depression are when I feel surrounded by friends I know but feeling like I don't really know them. Invest in a few solid people and continue to do that as you feel more comfortable but don't feel like you need to be over invested in everyone's life.

I know plenty of people, but it's more important to genuinely know a few people than it is to know who a lot of people are if that makes sense.

- Suffer from suicidal thoughts and depression.

- Tell them that you are always going to be there for them. Anything that crosses their mind they can talk to you about.

When I suffered BIG time with depression I always wanted that ONE person to keep pushing me.. to work their way inside and finally get me to crack. I wanted that ONE person to show me they cared.

Offer reassurance and tell them when they are ready you'll help them take the next step to getting help.

There is only so much you can do and everything a professional can do.

It's really hard at first. But finally you get to a point where you either snap and give up or snap and finally realize you need help.

That's a huge burden to carry when having a depressed or suicidal friend.

With friendships like this it's usually like 80\20 type of friendships. It'll feel you're doing SO much and they're doing so little. But to them they are doing the best and the most they could possible.

Trust me, once they get the help they need they'll never forget.

And your friendship can flourish.

- As that friend, I really wish more people pushed me to get therapy. It's so hard to get the motivation to help yourself. Just need a little nudge.
- I'd keep checking on them. I do have a friend who is struggling with depression. I try to check on them when I have the Time.
- As somebody who is just human and not a mental health professional the best one can do is validate the friend's feelings and encourage them that getting help isn't being weak its being strong.
- Be there. That's all you can really do. Some people will respond to "tough love", but many with depression won't.
- Recognise your limitations.

Help them find professional help, offer to accompany them to appointments or even just phone them up on the morning to encourage them to go.

Show them they are loved - spend quality time with them, buy them a little gift that would be special to them, cook them dinner and leave a few portions in the freezer, write a poster they can look at that says all their wonderful traits, give them a hug!

Persist in friendship, and don't make every encounter a focus on their depression. They won't find everything easy, but go for a walk even in the silence, watch a silly film together that you don't like, send them funny memes even if they don't text back.

- In my experience, spend time with them and remind them about what they enjoy and that you care. Don't bring up suicide or depression often. Get their thoughts off it and help them realize what they want to live for, even if your company is the only thing keeping them alive.
- I have/had two friends like this, and an older sibling with this.

To make this easier:

Friend 1 = 1

Friend 2 = 2

Older Sibling = OS

1 was really violent. He was trans male and self harmed, and weren't doing too well (has a homophobic family). I didn't know what to do with him, so I tried my best not to annoy him

(which was really difficult bc im generally pretty annoying to most people. i don't try to be, but i guess i just am. i don't really know when to shut up). He ended up punching 2 in the face because he thought she was laughing at him. 2 started crying, not because of the punch but because people started to crowd around her after that. He ended up getting expelled, and I haven't talked to him since, but I really hope he's doing alright. I wasn't much help to him here. But, even though he found me annoying, he was still a friend of mine. He didn't really like talking about his problems, so I decided to keep quiet and to not ask him about anything he didn't want to talk about.

2, on the other hand, is turning out much better. She's my best friend right now. She used to self-harm, but she's managed to get over 100 days without it. When that day came, OS and I got her some chocolates and cookies as a celebration for her. I'd like to think she's doing much better, but on the way home from school, OS and her still like to talk about mental health stuff (they both have some mental disorders and like to talk to each other about it, so i usually keep quiet there). I generally try to make her laugh and stay quiet if she's not doing so good, and offer comfort and support where I can.

OS? They're not doing the best, but they're doing alright. They're still suffering from these thoughts, and we suspect they might have depression, but it doesn't really come up too much. I just try my best to not annoy them if they're in one of these moods. But, they also do love this milkshake I make, and they like talking about Genshin a lot, so if they're in a bad mood I offer to let them rant to me about a new character coming out or something while I make them a milkshake, and that usually gets them in a better mood.

TL;DR I try to offer support and comfort where I can but don't force them if they don't wanna talk. OS and 2 talking to each other about mental disorders and their problems in general also help, so it's good for them to have someone that understands how they feel.

- Someone who went through severe depression a couple years back here. All I ever wanted was someone to be there for me. I just wanted someone to be my friend and to accept me for who I was. Even if I didn't want to talk, it would have been nice to have someone let me know they were there for me. You can't pressure someone with depression to open up or to get help. A lot of the time, all you can really do is let them know you're there for them. Check in on them, at least try to make them smile, that kind of stuff. But most importantly, listen to them. If they want to talk, listen. Sometimes ranting can make someone feel at least a little better

- I lost my daughter in August. She took her own life. My advice would be to not be afraid to take big steps to get them help, be prepared for them to be mad at you.

My daughter needed inpatient treatment. My ex refused to go along with it despite my begging because he didn't want her to hate him. I'd rather her hate me and still be here. Sometimes depression causes them to not accept the help they need. It takes others to push them toward help. Sometimes, even when you do everything right, you can't stop them. I can say it's the absolutely most devastating thing I've gone through. I'd give anything to have been able to get her the help she needed.

Look up resources are available in your area. Speak to other loved ones. Encourage the depressed person to always practice good hygiene, get some exercise, journal or another activity that helps channel their focus, and get them out of the house. Remind them how loved they are. Let them know you'll never give up. Suicide ends their pain but spreads it to all their loved ones.

- Uh i'm no physiologist, which is whom I would recommend your friend speak to if possible, but I went to therapy for over a year when I was depressed/suicidal and learned CBT techniques. I took to it very well as it made alot of sense to me but others may not take to it as well. The problem stems from genuinely how he thinks and he needs to learn ways of thinking differently.

Stoicism was another concept I leaned into heavily during therapy. There is alot in the world to be grateful for, especially if you are lucky enough to be born in a first world country.

- I wouldn't tell even my closest friends that I've had/have thoughts of suicide. I don't think it's fair for me to put that much on them. Not sure if that's right or not but it's how I handle it.

I've taken the steps of therapy though. That is the right thing to do for sure.

I have had a friend reach out to me with their issues regarding the topic, and I just tried to be a good listener without judging. It's a tough topic for sure.

- don't have them call a suicide hotline. that hotline just reads everyone the same prompt that says, "you have so much to live for, yadda yadda," and it'll help no one. instead, tell them to seek help. they need to see a psychiatrist to get a professional diagnosis so that they can figure out what medications will work best. also therapy might help, though it's not for everyone. if you're with the person, and they are feeling down, or crying, hug them, comfort them, and listen to them vent if they need to. it's very hard to console someone who is suicidal because you may not understand what they're going through, and that's why you must support them getting help.

- Obviously not an option for everyone but invite them to live with you and help them rebuild.

Basic non-med cures for depression:

1. Mindfulness
2. Social interaction
3. Physical exertion
4. Planning for the future

Moving is physical work, living with someone forces you to notice your environment, pushes you to talk to someone. Rebuilding your life pushes you to think about your life.

- probably do a bunch of fun stuff with him/her and pretend i forgot they had depression so they think i just care about them.

- Try to be the first one getting the bad news that are directed to them, and be with them every time to avoid them doing something crazy, I do this since both my mom and my older sister

attempted to end themselves more than one time, it always scares me that if I died before them, they couldn't handle the sadness and you know... It is really stressing some times, my sister has tourette, anxiety and depression, and my mother has depression and is a little bit of an alcoholic, the worst part is that she lives at 150 kilometers away and I can only visit her once a month, at least I have my little sister, some times it feels like she is the only one who cares about my mental health

- If you are not a mental health professional, any intervention may do more harm than help. If this person is unwilling to seek professional help, ask yourself a question. "Do I care more about this person than they care about their own self?"

If the answer is yes, maybe just observe and report.

- Tell them to get help and if they don't want to do that themselves then offer to make that call for them and even follow them there for support. There's nothing you can do or say to make them feel better. Depression is irrational and they can't help how they feel and most of the time there's no real reason why they feel that way. That's why they need professional help.

- The girl I'm dating has been struggling with deep depression and she isn't entirely aware it. She has now pushed me and all of her friends out of her life after talking about how lonely she is and that no one wants to be around her. She wants it all to end.

I had hopes when she admitted it might be time to consider therapy, but she never got help..

She blocked and and I'm afraid for her :(

- I am a social worker. Other people have posted excellent links to help, but I'd like to give my two cents as well even if you may not read it.

One of the most important things is to keep a neutral composure as they tell you what's going on in their lives. If you show expressions of shock, anger, sadness, etc, it discourages them from sharing because they know you're having a negative emotional response to it. Ask them if they have been making any plans to kill themselves, and what those plans are. Take note of whatever methods they bring up (overdose, hanging, cutting, etc) to accommodate dangerous items like that once you come to an agreement.

Consider sitting down with your friend and writing up a suicide contract where the friend writes down the things they promise not to do for X period of time. After all, if they're so intent on killing themselves, what difference does another week make compared to all of eternity? It can be enough time for a person to cool down from initial suicidal ideation, however, and that's extremely important.

Make sure that this individual doesn't have any dangerous weapons in their possession. If they have guns, see if they're willing to turn them over to you or another trusted loved one for an indeterminant amount of time until the friend is in a safer space. If you live with this person, consider locking the kitchen knives and other sharp instruments in your bedroom to "check out" as needed. Yes this can be annoying, but it saves lives.

Tell your friend that you are there for them if an emergency does happen. Set your phone so the ringer goes off for this individual no matter what time of day or night. Make it clear that this is to be used for emergencies only, and in an emergency you'll drop everything to help them.

Look at what insurance they have and what financial accommodations they may qualify for. There are many therapists in real life and online that are willing to make accommodations for individuals that struggle to afford individual therapy. Also, if you come to a therapist and express you are currently having a suicidal crisis, it is their job to take the time to talk to you. Keep in mind if you do this however you'll more than likely be sent to the hospital for testing and observation. On the flip side if this happens, the hospital can recommend treatments within your area and get you started on an antidepressant.

- Firstly, talk to them. Ask them how they are feeling, ask how you can support them if they want that. A really great way to be supportive is to not just jump in and try and help but to ask what you can do to be supportive. If they don't know then maybe offer to cook or walk a dog so that they don't have to worry about that. Don't be pushy, you will likely find that there is not much that you can really do beyond being a listener. To be a good listener, try and ask lots of open-ended questions, ask to follow up questions on things they have said and don't be afraid to go back and summarise what you are hearing from them.

Secondly, maybe suggest some people that they could talk to. I'm not sure where you live and so I can't recommend who to reach out to. There should be some sort of lifeline or suicide hotline that they could contact to receive basic support and information about other forms or more long term support. If you are at high school then there might be a nurse you could start with for example.

Thirdly, if you ever have any reason to believe that they are in imminent danger then do not hesitate to ring the relevant emergency number eg 999. Even if you think you might be wrong then still call. Police would rather attend 10 calls where they are not needed than non attend where they really were needed.

I do a bit of work in mental health support at the college level and this is the best advice I can give. Also, look after yourself in the process because supporting someone who wants to take their own life is very draining.

- One day decided I needed help...hospital said unless u harm urself first....byebye....thank youbeen trying to get help since...everybody too booked...Pittsburgh, where physical help is great n mental health screw it...getting crazier everyday....sad

- This might be considered controversial but in this situation, seek this person professional help.

A counsellor, a doctor, therapy of some sort.

I have been severely depressed in my life. And when friends used to come to me I wanted to help them so badly. But I have realised I am not equipped to do anything for them. I can of

course be an ear and a friendly face. However, there are professionals trained to help your friend.

I remember the first time I found a good counsellor, I instantly felt better. Because that's her job- to be my support system. And she is trained to do that.

Definitely help your friend, but I highly recommend getting some professional help here too. I know your friend won't want help- it's all part of the depression I have been there. But you can't take no for an answer here.

Sending love- you are a great friend

Title: If you're suffering from depression, what the hell do you do?

Post Text: My depression is always there. It reduces in intensity. Feeling strong at the gym? Not incessantly thinking about my prior failings.

I'm going to therapy, but it all feels pointless when enacting any change to your overall mental health feels impossible. I'm utterly powerless, trapped in a life I don't have any power over. I'm just drifting along.

How are you supposed to not wither away like this?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- After suffering 15 years with depression, I finally beat it. This is what helped me personally; but bare in mind that everyone is different- what worked for me, may not work for others.

1. Getting your dopamine fixes. Exercise and sunshine should never be looked over. Running especially gets you a good runners high.
2. Halt those negative thoughts. Negative thoughts become a bad habit. You'll find yourself naturally drifting towards them without even realising. The moment you notice you're doing it, stop. Immediately change your mindset to something positive. Doesn't matter what it is; it could be thinking of your beloved pet, or perhaps how good your hair looks. It takes a while to get over negative thinking; bad habits are a long process to crack.
3. Plan your future and set yourself goals. Perhaps you want to reach your running to 10k. Or finish that book you have always been meaning to read. Keeping goals set so that you have something to work towards, will stop the "what's the point" thoughts. Make sure the goals are within your means. Don't make your goals difficult to accomplish, or you'll set yourself back. Little goals to begin with, and bigger goals later.
4. Find a GOOD therapist. One that actually suits your needs. I went through a few therapists before i found a dude who truly helped me. Every therapist works with their clients differently. If you find your therapy isn't helping, consider getting someone else.
5. Groom yourself! Get a good skin care routine, clothes that make you look good. They don't have to be brand new or expensive. Looking good makes you feel good.
6. Clean environment. Nothing more depressing than being surrounded by clutter and dirt.

7. Curing depression is never a quick fix. Nobody can say a magic word to take it away. It's a slow process, but so worth the work! Take one day at a time, and cherish every positive step in the right direction.

8. There will always be bad days. Depression is like waves crashing on the beach. You're trying to tame that ocean, but you're always going to get that big wave. Ride it out. And get right back to taming it once it ebbs away, giving you a breather. Don't give up because you had some bad days; this is perfectly normal to experience on your road to recovery.

9. Don't be afraid to tell people you trust that your depression is giving you a bad time atm. You will be surprised how many people will check in on you. They most likely won't be able to offer any sound advice; just notice the little things they are doing to help and cherish it. Don't bother telling people who do nothing; and don't hate them either. Some people are afraid of depression and afraid of making it worse. They think them continuing as normal is helping. Nobody is trained to deal with depression, so don't hold it against them. Depression has a horrible habit of getting angry unnecessarily at others.

I don't know if any of this is new information for you. But, there is light at the end of the tunnel. Don't ever give up.

- One thing that helps me and may or may not help others is what I eat. Most of my life has been a diet of junk food and soda. I stopped drinking anything besides water, milk, coffee. I limited my food to meat, fruit, and vegetables. After about a week I could feel my mind clearing up and my body rejuvenating. Like I suddenly wanted to work out. My patience grew. My anxiety lessened. While I still never really feel happy, I feel like there might be a path to happiness that my diet was blocking. I now see sugar and boxed foods with 100 ingredients and poison and most likely a big reason so many people these days suffer with mental illness

- Combination of prozac, therapy, and prioritizing relationships with people who treat me well, and self care: diet, exercise, hydration, and sleep. Also, try a vitamin D supplement. Most people have a deficiency and don't know it.

Hobbies: Strum my guitar, read novels, practice languages on duo lingo, work on home improvement projects.

I also foster dogs. It's amazing how much less alone you can feel with a pet relying on you and forcing you into keeping a regular schedule.

- Mail order ketamine therapy is literally saving me from myself at the moment, and this is coming from someone who's dealt with severe medically resistant depression for 18 years. I've even been declared "disabled" in the past it's gotten so damn bad. I'm already getting my groove back just 4 days in and boy does it feel good.

- Are you open to ideas that are "spiritual"? I've dealt with depression on and off for almost 30 years and the things that have made the most impact have involved looking at the world through more something other than the modern materialistic perspective. If you're open to that I have some tools I've learned. If you're not I totally respect that.

- Your therapy is not working. The idea of therapy is to give you tools to overcome your depression. If it's not doing that, you need to either a) talk to a psychiatrist as you may need an adjustment to your meds, or try different ones, or b) find a therapist you gel with better to give

you those tools. You have to be willing to participate in the therapy, too. Some people think they go talk to a therapist and all their troubles go away. It doesn't work that way. You have to be an active participant. Or it won't work.

- I found the hack after seeing my friend do it and seeing unreal changes. It sounds totally bonkers and I only tried because I saw these crazy mental changes.

I started a elimination diet

Red grasfed meat, butter, water/sparkling water/ butter. I did this for 2 weeks

I then added after 2 weeks some high fat dairy products like double cream, cheese, Greek yogurt and had no side effects.

I was 50% better by this time.

I started to test products

Carbs: Anxiety, depression

Avocado: Sad

Chicken: depression.

Cucumber was okay, the little bit of nuts was okay, a few berries were okay.

It's not easy to start, you need a lot of determination.

It's been 4 weeks and I am a changed person. I lived a life of depression for the last 10 years and did some medication but I got chronic pain from then so i had to stop. So much clarity had been living a painful life and my diet did this, my body can't handle carbs. I'm awake and I feel good, I'm also more emotional, the carbs, gluten etc were just messing with my gut which is connected to the brain and now I can work on childhood trauma that caused it. I stopped dopamine chasing. I still have chronic pain but I heard people got rid of that too.

Everyone has different diet intolerance. But I urge everyone to try this.

Also look up Mikhaila Peterson she did the same thing and then got her father on the same diet with same results

- Find the causes of depression. My depression was caused by my shitty job. I switched jobs and I suddenly don't want to kill myself. I was recently feeling depressed because I felt like my life was groundhog day. I went on a vacation to Italy and got to do and see alot of cool things.

Now I feel infinitely better. Sure depression doesn't just go away but there are things you can do to minimize it..

- I truly understand your feelings. It is possible to live a good life and feel empowered. Get on the right meds, therapy, educated about yourself and go from there.

- I am under employed I'd say, and I am trying to get a different job. With people. So far, I stay at home so much due to my anxiety I developed a phobia of highway driving. I can do backroads. To deal with my depression and anxiety, my wife asked me to walk 25 minutes a day before I do anything like play games I use to escape. I also do a thankful journal that my wife asked me to do. I am trying, and I have done some better help, but that doesn't work for me. But I did try. Not a lot is helping. Life has gone downhill ever since covid, but thats for everyone. I permanently live a 1984 reality, annnd it's been interesting. I cycle through depression, anger, sadness, and I get a daily energy allowance of between 15 cents to a dollar, in a world where there is no dollar menu. 39.... I don't know if I have the energy or positive outlook to last the marathon, but I have to just keep moving on who knows what is around the corner. Most likely more of the same... but just maybe. Like Tom hanks says, you never know what the tide may bring. I have to feel it starts with some level of forgiveness but in the end it doesn't matter. My depression will have no impact, a certain amount of life and time needs to be a waste, why not mine.

- I don't know the answer to this. My depression has gotten worse as an adult and I feel it largely has to do with social isolation. I wish I was the kind of person who thrives being alone all the time. Instead, I sit alone with my thoughts too much. I feel getting out of the house as much as possible helps me feel a little better.

- Exercise and fix the issue that's causing your depression. Helps if you spend time with family/friends and going out and doing something. Eat healthy, because there's no cure for depression.

- It's a constant cycle of feeling ok and then not. I take meds, go to therapy weekly, and walk dogs everyday. Some days are good, some days I want to quit. Some days I do see I have control and have joy in my life.

- For me a sort of fake it till you make behavioral modification strategy worked. I went to therapy and read about CBT, and incorporated some of the strategies given. Focused less on circumstances and more on possible actions, actively stopped and tried to drown out the negative internal voice with forced positive thoughts, went out in nature and excercised more, ate better, slept better, and biggest of all cut out 90% of social media and all forms of posting personal info. One step snowballs and makes the next easier. Before I knew it I was genuinely a different person.

- There's not one singular thing that will cure depression. It's the accumulation of lots of small habits and changes that make it easier to manage. Good diet, daily movement, and consistent sleep are a great foundation. It's harder to be happy when those 3 basics aren't being met.

Regularly spending time with family and friends is another good component to maintain. Maybe a standing weekly dinner or game night. If they aren't readily available, look for weekly meetings for your hobbies, volunteering opportunities, or even support groups. Having consistent interactions with the same people helps you feel a part of a community.

Mindfulness and meditation can be powerful tools for learning to manage the chaos in your mind. Just because you have a thought doesn't necessarily mean it's true or accurate. You have to learn how to not believe the lies and negativity that we can sometimes tell ourselves.

Once again, it's not any one thing that will break you out of it, and it probably won't happen overnight. It's developing your skills with the various tools necessary to build a well-rounded life. Keep trying until you find what works for you. Depression may not ever go away, but it can be conditioned and contained so that it doesn't take over your whole life.

Show yourself lots of patience and love. Learn to talk to yourself like you would a small child. Be gentle with yourself as much as possible, and keep chipping away.

- For me, medication has been consistently helpful, there's hit/miss. I also had seasonal depression that part vanished when I moved south

I still battle some depression but it's manageable atm. Depression snowballs, but so does recovery. I think for most people, disengagement from doomer content works best. My personality/faith makes that impossible 🙄 so I try and convert the doomers (bashing the odious ones)

Whether you fight or ignore them it's important to realize that doomerism is not entirely organic. Overseas operatives are in play

- If traditional therapy and medication don't work for you, look into TMS Therapy. It's typically approved for people with recurring, medically resistant depression. I'm starting the approval process with my therapist when I talk to her in a few weeks.

I've tried Lord only knows how many medications and been in and out of therapy for 35 years with a few IOP and inpatient stints. TMS was recommended recently and I'm hoping it helps.

- Work out daily, eat better, get off the internet, give back to your community, help others, stop scrolling, and stop comparing yourself to others. Start going to sleep earlier and waking up early. Get more sunlight, especially first thing in the morning, and start a yoga practice. Your depression will be eclipsed by an increased sense of well-being in a few months.

- I've been on all the meds. I'm currently in therapy and taking Wellbutrin and Cymbalta. At almost 38, they feel it's a safe bet to try something different. I'm a veteran, so I'm fortunate not to have to pay for the trial and error of mental health treatment, however; I'm at the point where nothing is working. I'm starting TMS treatment next week. I'm hopeful, cause worse case scenario, I'm still depressed, but at least I tried.

- I'm always depressed. The thing I have to watch out for is if I get too low. If I get to that point it's normally a doctor or worst-case scenario ER visit. I also have bipolar disorder and it's just something I've learned to live with. Therapy and medication can help but it might not fully get rid of it. There's not magic wand that can just make it poof away. I wish there was.

- Citalopram works wonders for some people.

Meditation is also fantastic.

Or try hypnotherapy. You can find some videos for depression on YouTube. Lookup Michael Sealy.

- Meds and therapy helped me. Low dose of Sertraline was night and day.
- Therapy. Hobbies. Intense exercise. Prioritizing sleep. Clean eating. And staying away from all alcohol. I'm definitely not perfect and have my down days but it's not all consuming anymore.
- Besides the usual therapy and medication, try finding a hobby. I've recently picked up making candles. It's gotten my mind off of a lot of mental blocks, and I've made a few friends in the process.
- TMS changed everything for me. The process kind of sucks and it's hard to get approved, but it was a serious game changer. Nearly a decade of undefeated depression got turned around. It didn't make me happy, but it removed the barriers that were making it impossible for me to really make progress by myself.
- By ignoring the people that cause you depression. Have you ever thought it's because of your environment?
- First, im sorry that you're going through this. Severe depression can be debilitating. It's hard to talk about this with friends and family.

For me, I know when I'm at my healthiest when I'm happy and in "autopilot" mode. I'm not trying to be better in a conscious sense. I have a sense of purpose every day, and I just stick to a routine. For me, the combination that works is being active (in any sense), talking to a friend/coworker, and doing one thing I look forward to that day.

Although a lot of these suggestions are great, I would take baby steps. I'm not sure what your situation is, but see if you can go on one walk a day (15 min tops), maybe listen to a podcast or call someone and ask how their day is to catch up. Sometimes reaching out and being interested makes you feel worthy even for that small part of the day. Plan one fun thing that week - maybe you're not feeling that anything is fun. A new recipe, but get the ingredients in person at a grocery store just to get out of the house. Is there someone that would be glad if they received a small "thinking of you" card? Sometimes just making a connection is purpose enough.

Just baby steps. You don't need to run a half marathon. You don't need to eat healthy all the time. But try and add little bits of purpose in your life, when you have the bandwidth (ideally bits that get you up off of your feet away from the screen, and bonus points if you make a human connection).

- One thing I kept from my therapy sessions is that life is like horse races. There are options out there but betting on the same horse every time, will get you up to some point but not necessarily always win after a certain amount. In a similar way, I should not apply and follow what I'm used to. I must try new things that help me, improve my lifestyle and more.
- Have you considered antidepressants? Talk to your doctor about it. I'm my experience, antidepressants + therapy really helped—antidepressants made it feel easier for me to actually implement the stuff I was working on in therapy, and eventually I was able to get off them after about a year and a half. If you feel like therapy isn't working, try to find a new therapist. But stick with it! In my experience therapy is like exercise—after a single session sometimes I wonder if it's even worth it. But I can look back at the last year or so and see that I've made progress.

Outside of medication, I have my “depression protocol” which consists of 3 main things: 1) getting good sleep, 2) exercise, and 3) eating healthy. Optional 4) socialization. When I’m not doing these things I find it much easier to succumb to my depression—depression has a way of getting you to STAY depressed. When I have no energy or motivation, small steps like trying to get to bed earlier, taking walks or doing easy yoga, and throwing some frozen veggies in while my ramen is boiling all help me build up energy to do more.

And honestly, I know it sounds cheesy, but gratitude helps. I like to take a moment when I’m eating to feel thankful that I’m able to afford to eat a delicious meal, or that I get to work outside on a nice spring day, or that I have a cozy bed to sleep in at night.

Ultimately we are different people and what worked for me may not work for you. But by doing these things for myself, I feel like I DO have some power over my situation. I am optimistic about my future.

- I think it’s situational. I’m 24 and still feel the last 6 years of my life have been pissed away. No personal advancement. 6 years of battling stomach and anxiety issues, making me lose jobs, not be able to eat regular food (or any for a time). Now I sit here with my check coming Friday and no gas to get to work the rest of the week. None of my friends or family will loan me the much needed \$30 to hold me over till my check. It makes me upset, I know how well off people are, and I need \$30 to survive. I’m so sick of fighting this fight

- Meds, I know that’s not the answer for everyone. I also did TMS therapy for MDD. Definitely changed my life though i can only speak from my experience.

- Here’s the thing, there’s really not one thing that you do. Sometimes you go to lunch with a friend, sometimes sometimes you curl up in a blanket burrito. Some days you go to the gym, some days you sleep through your alarm, some days you’re really present and kicking ass at work, other days you’re scrolling TikTok for five hours and avoiding deadlines. But eventually, if you consistently connect with things that feel fulfilling and engaging for you, and couple that with actual inner work like therapy and or medication, you start to have more good days than bad. It kind of never stops feeling like work for a while, but you really do see the effect with consistency of taking care of yourself and connecting with things that feel fulfilling, meaningful, and enjoyable.

- Getting off gluten and dairy did WONDERS for my depression and anxiety. Seriously -- give it a try. It’s been incredible.

I’ve also tried a couple different anti-depressants. Currently on a low dose (50mg) of Zoloft. Life has been good lately.

- I have had my depression under control for a long time but it’s always lurking. I have found my environment has a big factor. Are you surrounded by good people? Psychedelic mushrooms made me feel like I was getting a much needed hug and feeling of worthiness from the universe. I would do a lot of research before taking anti depressants. I enjoy taking care of myself- eating well, taking long walks, sleeping, calling a friend. I think you have to figure out what works for you. A BIG thing that helps me is having responsibilities: a job where I’m important and people need me, a dog that relies on me to keep them in a routine and take them on walks, people in my life that I show I care for them. Believe me, I’ve been rock bottom depressed (practically

bedridden for months at peak) and it just took experience to say never again so I fight that shit off every day and I'm glad to say I'm a fighter who wants to continue to slay it. Getting away from my family also helped immensely.

Edit: you may need a change, if you could change your identity and start anew, would that feel good and what would you do?

Edit#2: a lot of what is keeping us down is our subconscious and therapy is not good at bringing that out unless you are REALLY ready to see it because your ego wants to tuck it away and forget about it forever, likely no one is ready to confront it without I would argue psychedelic assistance

- Imagine saying all of this thing trapped in a third world country earning jack shit a month. Wanting to leave but unable to ...

As me.

I just feel like that everyday, I just train like a mad man and run like crazy everyday to keep myself sane and off my mind.

I dont go to therapy because money, I dont take meds because money, I just train, try to play videogames, chess, read, sleep, (work to death) repeat.

Forever

No breaks, just running.

Petting my cats makes me feel a normal human being.

- Diet. Lots of healthy fats from proteins like eggs, meat and raw milk. Magnesium is crucial.

Getting exercise and sunlight on your skin and in your eyes. A connection to nature. Having a passion, a purpose each day. Finding god helped my depression a lot.

- You need a hand to get out. Everybody says go to therapy, but your subconscious knows this person wouldn't be there for you if it wasn't for the money.

You need some humanity, not therapy.

You're in a hole that you can't get out of alone. Society has deteriorated to such a degree that nobody gives a fuck about anybody or anything unless there is money involved.

I hope you become the change you want to see in the world.

My advice? Find somebody in the hole with you and put your backs together to get out.

- I was in your shoes too while in therapy. I was assigned to journal, but a good amount of the times I wanted to write negative things. I spoke with my therapist about it, and we'd agreed that it was fine. It seems you have a similar mind like me where trying feels like going nowhere.

You're kind of right now in fight with your brain, but you still need to help your body and the world around you. My best advice is do the things you need to do, and journal any self hatred down. It is weird, but it helped me out for some time. Year later, I still do it. Since family members and friends could struggle with hearing those thoughts, the journaling helped me out as a way to vent out my anger against myself and the world.

- Try psychedelics. Mushroom microdosing. Use it as an adjunct to therapy.

- Depends on what type. Some types are brain induced. Otherwise some people get depression when they cant to their goals and their dreams are no longer there. Its always a choice to take action and make ur life happy. U are sad and loney? Go to a sports game. Staying in bed? Get up and work out? Not motivated to study? Go and take a class where u will make friends and just talk to people. Whatever u do, u have a choice to take action. Lonely go to socials and stick there and talk to people for 2-3 hours. Dont talk to the same people ectera

- Therapy helps, but only if you find the right person. Don't hesitate to switch it up if you don't match well with the therapist. Also consider medication, therapy and medication together can work wonders. And balancing your life is key. Try to exercise, try to get enough sleep (and if you show signs of sleep apnea *see a sleep specialist!*), avoid over indulgence especially with alcohol. But don't beat yourself up either if you can't do all that.

Like my optimization professor used to say, once you've spent 4 hours on Facebook, you don't need to spend another hour beating yourself up, or another 4 hours on Facebook trying to hide from your problems. The most optimal thing you can do is the best thing you can do *now*, not what you should have done yesterday.

- You can get psychedelic therapy there's this one online its ketamine and yeah u can look it up if ya like but with doing psychedelic therapy u should take great caution and check to see if u have a family history of schizophrenia, or any mental illnesses or if u already are prone to schizophrenia or any mental illnesses and you are doing psychedelics or smoking cannabis it could lead to mental illnesses if not for sure lead to mental illness so I would definitely go get checked out by a doctor if u would think this is something y wanna do . I suggest you do ur own research and homework on this as psychedelics can have a really positive effect or really negative and the ones that are positive can lead to change CAN, it's not going to take ur problems away and solve them for u that's not something anyone or any substance or anything whatsoever can do besides your self but it can help u open ur mind up to a new perspective to help facilitate positive change and growth . If u would like to talk more about this I would be happy to . If you're wondering I have experienced psychedelics before and I've had like 1-2 experiences that helped me in some way . So yeah um I would definitely research as much as you can if u consider doing it, psychedelics ARE NOT A TOY I would go as far to say if y use them as a toy it's going to use u as a toy best way I can describe it , it's jus going to be something ur not going to like they must be taken with respect or u will have a bad experience

there's the right way to do them and the wrong way and I recommend taking them only the right way , I've had experiences where I felt like I went insane forever that there was no going back from only because of the way I was acting thinking talking behaving constantly behaving and my destiny was at the moment it was just all insane I wasn't a good person I only really cared about me and what I could get out of something just not in a good head space at all , I'm a strong believer in that so please do as much research as you can they can be very intense or very gentle so yeah hoped this helped much love

- I feel you 200%. To be honest I haven't felt fully happy for over a decade. Therapy and medicine doesn't do much for me either. It was like I was set up for failure the moment I was born. I hope you find your happiness soon.

- You take it a day at a time. It's not gonna go away, and it comes back. Best thing to do is force a positive outlook on everything, and go to therapy to help learn some coping skills.

- 15 years of depression here. I think I've overcome it.

I started to focus a lot on my physical health and nutrition. Focused on making more money even though I think the US financial system/federal reserve is rigged entirely. I started grooming myself more and cleaning up around the house.

If you hate your job, change jobs until you find something you like. Do not waste time anywhere, your mental health is at stake.

- Depression is mostly how you see things.

Half full/ half empty deal.

You're not special if you suffer Depression.

You're just another one of hundreds if millions on this earth that suffer too..

That's the 1st thing you need to realize.

Once you truly understand that,

You can start learning how to modify your outlook on the world.

A little at a time.

Look for the good, sunshine, a flower, maybe a bird or even a bug, don't forget little children and how they look at the world!.

I've lost several friends to Depression thru medication.

One script at a time, that's all they needed..

I can't sleep- take this

I have anxiety- here take that

But not one of them ever approached Depression from the point of view of what isn't depressing.

Lots of triggers for Depression.

But saying what's on your mind to others

Saying how you feel

Changing your routine

Definitely change news channels to off and most social media honestly.

There are good happy times for everyone if you put yourself out there to find your place.

- For me each depression is like starting in a brand new maze that I have to find my way out of.

Sometimes it's a sunny day that gets me out. Sometimes it's time with family, or with my cat. It's never the same thing.

This weekend it was microdosing weed.

Today was a really good day. Hoping these will last a few days.

- I mostly drink not like Jim beam, jack daniels, Jose, or that shit! The good stuff like Don Roberto tequila, still Austin bourbon, Armagnac, gin like greenhouse, green all, and siesta key rum. Therapy won't help in my opinion I could've been a therapist listen to people that's what I'm good at been a good listener ever since

- Hit gym and start setting personal goals and venture out into other things like cycling, swimming, yoga, martial arts and make those your lifetime hobbies to stay in peak health and you will be happy. Most depression today has its roots in smart phones, screens, video games, porn, social media, etc. We are hardwired to want to exercise and receive endorphins and dopamine through physical activity. This is what killed my depression dead in the water and I was alcoholic loser for 6 years.

Edit: if you are bipolar or schizophrenic exercise still helps massively.

- I'm still figuring it out. But things that have helped are

Emdr therapy, cutting sugar, doing whatever i have to to get better sleep. Walk 20 mins a day minimum.

Also consider listening to the master key system audiobook if it's still up on YouTube.

- If it's normal depression. Find a rock. Cling to it and use it to hell lift you into a better place.

If it's something more medically inclined aka, you have potentially some other issue as an underlying factor, go to a doctor, see if you can either find medicine, therapy, or something else that works for you.

If will all feel like it's useless and won't help most likely. Push through that and find something that works for you. The medical staff you may work with want you to feel and get better. Take their advice more than ours on reddit.

I understand that last part is a lil contradicting as I type this out, but we mean well, for the most part at least and hope you get better and push through this dark patch.

- Hey first of all, congrats on making it through every single day until now.

I know how you feel, I spent 7 years in clinical depression and it took over my whole life.

I ended up getting a bachelor of science in psychology to figure out what the fuck was actually happening in my brain and then used published science papers to try new things that had decreased depressive symptoms for their participants.

The biggest tools i used to get me through (other than talk therapy to figure out my shit and antidepressants, was learning to journal effectively, and training the mind to actually relieve proper rest (look into iRest yoganidra meditation, it's essentially sleep yoga and is so fucking

restorative) along with remembering your depression brain is being a dick when it tells you you'll feel like this forever.

I'm working on a project called MyLatibule that puts all the info and tools in one online hub, check it out if you need some help.

The premise is to learn share and shop through depression, so learn what's going on in your brain using psych and neuroscience, share your story and read others to feel less alone, then shop for tools to help manage your mood.

Feel free to message me there if you have any questions or want some freebies ❤️

Keep going, I'm proud of you for staying alive

Love Bren

Xx

- r/KetamineTherapy magic mushrooms or psychiatrist for ADHD testing & stimulant drugs.

There seems to be online services for the latter now.

- Here's what no one will tell you. Quit coffee and caffeine. Number one anxiety inducer and sleep killer, even if you have it in the morning. Bad sleep = sad.

No alcohol. Alcohol = bad sleep.

Do this for oneweek and go to bed on time every night. Let me know how you feel. You'll be tired from no coffee at first if you drink it already.

- I take Wellbutrin... but... it's not working. Still find myself having waves of intense depression and anxiety about the future - especially my kids wellbeing - since I am the only financial provider or caretaker physically and mentally capable of managing them.

I think what pulls me out of the "oh shit... this is crippling weight" moments is finding things that are beautiful or priceless around me and practicing being grateful for those things. Whether it's looking at my child's face for a few minutes, or just appreciating I have a roof over my head and central heat and air... really thinking about those things and how lucky/blessed I am makes me feel a little better

- I have it too,

Some days are hard still, but generally it's all about perspective, hard work, and having goals to work towards.

Will everyday be perfect? No, will you always be happy? Hell no, but it is WORTH pushing through to get to those perfect days, happy moments.

Work hard, remember that while yes, depression makes the world seem small. The world is actually huge and you are NOT limited.

Do what you want to do, pursue your passions, enjoy your hobbies, be grateful for the things you do have, meet new people and hear their stories. See how not alone you really are,

You'll be okay, as long as you tell yourself you'll be okay. Life is a journey with bumpy roads, mountains and rivers, cross them at your own pace and be proud of every single day. You got this,

- I've gone through bouts of depression for majority of my life which turns into suicidal ideation. I've never actually contemplated suicide but my brain imagines myself hanging similar to the scene of the old man in Shawshank Redemption. After nearly 20 years of the same image, I finally pinned down that it gets triggered when I feel that I have no control of myself and that suicide is always an option for control.

With that, I've found success in talking to myself in the mirror. Loud and proud if home alone, whispers if my wife and son are home. I tell myself I've been through much worse than what's going on now, if 10 year old me saw my life now it would put a smile on my face, my wife and son need me and I'm a net positive in their lives.

This relieves the pressure of never feeling good enough and working myself into the ground for an ounce of recognition I never received growing up.

- I'm bipolar, diagnosed 15 years ago. Manic-depression so I understand the depression aspect. Therapy, meds and cutting ties with people that weren't supportive of me (meds meant less drinking, therapy/meds making me happier) and just wanted me to stay down with them. Also determination.

Therapy took a couple years to work, I did CBT. It's been 6 years since I started and I still go. Meds are tough because not all meds work for everyone, everyone needs a different dose and some people need a booster or other medications because they also have adhd, or anxiety, etc. Rarely does the first one you try work and you have to give them at least 6 weeks before trying something else, which means you may just be on a rotation of not feeling any better but also dealing with rough side effects.

It gets worse before it gets better, but the better is so worth the fight. You have to put in the work and that looks different for everyone. If depression isn't situational then it can be a little trickier but it's possible to overcome. Something my therapist & psych told me early on: therapy and meds teach you the tools and aren't meant to make life sunshine and rainbows. They're meant to bring you to a neutral state of mental stability rather than make you *happy*. The happy part is what you do once the clouds clear and you can breathe again.

- I live with an older man while I'm trying to get back on my feet... doing therapy and on medication.

- Try fasting or limiting SAD (standard American diet). Took me out of a depression. If possible only eat organic.

- Ketamine therapy changed my life

- Medication helped me and therapy. Keep talking. Write what's in your mind on paper. It gets the pain out. Try and meditate for 5 mins a day. And be kind to yourself. It will get easier. Hugs to you.
- The thing about depression is that it takes as long to dig yourself out of as it took you to get in. You have to start with small things.. eating something healthy, going for a walk, talking to someone new, eventually moving to bigger things like switching jobs or living situations or moving cities. These make up the day to day fabric of your life and you have to work like hell to create a life that brings you joy. Even if you don't know what those things are yet. Some of us are more susceptible to depression and aren't going to be happy just anywhere. So you have to start exploring and uncovering some of the things that will make your life feel less shitty. But's not going to change overnight. If you want more info I can PM you my story but I struggled for a decade and have been happy and undepressed for 4 years now.
- Mushroom therapy with a trained and caring guide. Best remission rate for depression by far. Nothing else even comes close.
- Medication does the heavy lifting of my depression. Exercise is also helpful as well as a social life and support system.
- I did years of therapy. Very helpful. Recently, though I've been playing around with a theory about depression -- I believe it stems from a feeling of powerlessness. Standing up for yourself, and overall treating yourself well is probably the best cure for depression that I've found for myself personally. Fight for a life that you don't have to be depressed in all the time.

Also connection is super important. I joined a club where I see the same people every week. Incredibly helpful.

- this is a legit answer but xtc ...I have really bad depression and got my hands on a few pills and the pills made me feel so full ..the after effect can lead you feeling really down but that's where microdosing can come in..
- Therapy. Self-acceptance, self-love and mindfulness. Engage in hobbies and interests. Stand tall, take full control. You get what you give in life. Perseverance will absolutely pay off.
- Pills helped me a huge amount. Therapy and zoloft worked a miracle for me. Doesn't work for everyone but I had textbook severe depression for over a decade before medication got me out of it.
- Faking it till I make it, stuck with therapy even when every fibre of my being wanted to just bed rot
- Welbutrin saved my ass. Literally the medicine is there for a reason speak to a doctor, there is no shame in needing some help the only shame is potential loss from not making the choice to choose yourself earlier. Wish you the best my friend, if you have a headache you will take an asprine if you have a flu you will take theraflu, if you have an infection you will take antibiotics. Depression is a illness where your hormones are producing an imbalance of chemicals that regulate your mood. Take the antidote (with doctor supervision like you would other severe sickness) and get back in the game homie.
- Go to a Psychiatrist Dr MD, because they can prescribe meds and order intensive medical testing or a clinic that has a Psychiatrist and a Psychologist on staff to help with long term depression.

- Find a good psychiatrist and get on a med...unless you think you can exercise the depression away. I've met a few of those before (very few), but more power to them. If you're scared and need help, keep going to therapy and go to a Psych.
- Cognitive Behavioral Therapy works wonders
- Surprisingly, hydro therapy helped me quite a bit. I'll take a moment to really stretch after waking up in the morning before taking a really hot shower. After a bit, I'll switch to as cold as it'll go, and once I'm good and frozen, I'll switch back to hot, then repeat, ending on a cold shower. It's done wonders for me and took about 3-6 months of doing this to notice a difference with the depression.
- This is not for everyone, but it has really helped me balance out my mental health and ultimately enabled me to live off of antidepressants for over a year and a half. I also understand my body more than I initially did.

Backstory: I didn't realise I suffered from depression until I went through a severe depressive episode after a heartbreak at the age of 24. I left that relationship very broken. A couple of months prior to the end of the relationship, I was overshadowed by a darkness, felt like my world ended, and all the willpower to try again just fled my body. This was unusual because I could usually pull myself out of these depressive episodes, but this one was different. This was after I'd found out my partner in that failing relationship was already on dating sites and happy to choose themselves in all ways regardless of how that would scar me. I stopped working out, quit my job after multiple sick calls, isolated from family, dropped out of uni, and spent my days withering away getting high on weed and playing games in between dropping and picking her up from work. She later came to me saying she developed a wandering eye that we needed to fix, and we split up a week or so later. I knew I needed help and found a therapist to help me navigate these feelings. She put me on antidepressants after suicidal ideation caught me with my pants down.

Current strategy: I now see depression and anxiety as the body trying to communicate some kind of shortcoming in your life, or in my case, whatever I placed my self-worth in. At the time, this was showing up as a good partner. So, my solution was to address these perceived shortcomings, address my insecurities, accept my vices, and fix my heart. Naturally, fixing those core issues I was facing was, in turn, fixing smaller issues I didn't know I had. I got back in the gym, and naturally, I felt more confident and sexy (self-esteem improved), not forgetting that being active was helping me gain clarity when I wasn't escaping my depression by getting high. I got jacked and started enjoying styling myself. Everything just fit me better and looked better on me despite being a regular piece of clothing everyone wears (by product). I reconnected with family and gained fulfilment from feeling like I belonged somewhere where I was desired. This led to me working on a family business, which came with huge financial benefits and put me further than I was pre break up depression (by product). Due to this, I could now begin building my mother's retirement home as I've always dreamt of ... I remembered who I was and some of my core dreams again (feeling more like myself again). I adopted daily meditation to cleanse my mind and reprogram my mindset. Suddenly, I didn't view myself as a victim. I saw myself as the main character of my life again, took ownership of the story this main character told, the setting and crowd surrounding this character.

This journey just feels right again. Kinda like how being in love made me feel. The only difference is this time I'm in love with myself. If you're going to learn something from my story, let it be that. I needed to experience that bad episode to truly know what I lacked within myself and the type of heart I need to look for in my future partner/ partners 🧑🏾💕. Unfortunately, my heartbreak was the collateral damage. The way I see it, my capacity to love has greatly improved now that I love and value myself without being tied to anyone. I'm glad I sought help when I needed it, or else I wouldn't be where I'm at today. This approach might not work for you, find something that does, when it's all said and done it's just you against the darkness, that shit sucks, you can either let it consume you or you can be the badass staring you're always meant to be. Goodluck

- Other comments have great advice, let me add mine (all of this I initially found somewhere on the web, and it works).

If something makes you sad, avoid it. If looking at rain makes you sad, close the shades and don't look at it. I've cut off music completely. Feeling numb is better than feeling sad.

Have a document ready on your phone or on paper with important stuff in case of an episode. Have the following sections there:

1. When I'm feeling down, it helps to...

(Have something listed here to do, to watch, etc. I have unopened Lego and Hot Wheels around just in case.)

2. If I'm feeling down, I can talk to...

3. When I have intrusive thoughts, I should remember that...

(Reminders of things you know for a fact, but it's hard to keep them in mind when feeling depressed, like "A lot of people find me attractive and smart" and "I don't think actually about X when I'm feeling okay")

4. I'm excited to wait for...

(A game release you're hyped about, a sports event, your niece's first words etc.)

5. When nothing helps, I should...

(Specific course of action made with smallest steps, like "wear shoes, look at weather, wear street clothes, go out, head to park, walk 30 minutes". Washing dishes or taking a shower can help.)

If you have a close friend, maybe they can be more supportive but just don't know it--let them know you don't assume good things by default and need reinforcement. Some people keep gratitude journals, I haven't tried, but it might help. I know depression doesn't let you recall your achievements and good memories that easily.

- Have you tried running? Long runs like 10k or more on a bi-daily basis?

I'm a very positive person so I can't say I understand depression. But when I run, I feel a little happier. Hope this helps you take up running.

- I try an extreme restriction/elimination diet. I can't feel any worse, might as well try to fine-tune my eating habits and health internally lol. Also tend to shed excess water weight and get rid of bloating in this period of time.

I notice when I eliminate sugar and white flour from my diet, and start taking a methylated B-Complex supplement, my depression lifts significantly and the feel good lasts a while, too.

- Depression can be associated with an imbalance of neurotransmitters in the brain, such as serotonin, norepinephrine, and dopamine. These chemicals play crucial roles in regulating mood, sleep, and overall emotional well-being. Medication, prescribed by a psychiatrist, can help restore balance to these neurotransmitters, thereby alleviating symptoms of depression.

- I have a Major Depressive Disorder. Highly functioning. It doesn't leave. It never leaves. Meds. Therapy. Meditation. Finding joy and living in that moment. Giving yourself grace. Helping others really helps me a lot. Kindness to strangers. Yes. I'm depressed. Beyond depressed. I'm thankful for the people who stick by me.

My advice is find your joy and find ways to build in that into everyday life. It's not easy. DM if you need to chat.

- I've had depression for a while, lots of suicidal thoughts. The main reason is definitely my environment. The people around me, where I lived, all were the main factors. I moved, met new people, did new things, and boom, it's just gone like it was never there. Depression is a giant alarm from your brain that the way you're living is not good. If you can't move, do new activities, get hobbies where you're around different kinds of people. You have to change your habits

- Y'all think happiness just comes to you, no you have to go out and strive everyday to remain happy and content, this is what dealt with my depression, that and my mom killed herself lol.

- Honestly a genuine trusting relationship is the only thing I can think of for me personally. Not a dating relationship, but someone who really and truly cares about you and will do whatever it takes to keep you in their lives, and who you can be there for and give the same energy to. It's hard finding genuinely good people out there, but once you find someone like that, it seems to help lessen the feeling of hopelessness. The keywords here are genuine and trustworthy. The fear of someone hurting you is what oftentimes holds people back, but sometimes you need someone to pull you out. Self love and therapy and meds don't help when you have no one to share your accomplishments with, someone to check in on you, someone to cry to at 3am. Humans are made to be social, and it's hard to get better when you are burdened by loneliness.

- Please also make sure to take your vitamin D (check with your doctor of course, and/or get your vitamin D levels checked). I was low on it and it made my depression worse.

- Medication and a good diet. Watch "Hack your Health" on Netflix.

Depression is more than "thinking positive" and "just exercise more". Sometimes these efforts don't work.

Find what works for you.

- I've taken any number of medications over the years which help for a while, but then I basically get so used to them that they don't work very well anymore. I end up stopping them and feeling even worse than before which causes me to get back on them again - the cycle continues. My situation is made even worse because I'm in my 50s, have little to no money, and know I will never be able to retire. I'm about to start yet another new job next week and I'm already having anxiety and panic attacks over it since I'm starting over again for the hundredth time.

- Cognitive behavioural therapy is something that has helped me with this a lot. I would recommend picking up a copy of Dr Burns' Feeling Good: The New Mood Therapy.

To give you a taster of this book, the main idea is that your thoughts influence your emotions. Of course you will always live under a cloud of grey if your thoughts are always grey. The good news is that you are in full control of your thoughts.

Some practical tips:

1. You mentioned incessantly thinking about prior failings. I would recommend you count each negative thought that goes through your mind in a single day. You will probably notice how this really adds up. You might want to do this for a few days to see how frequent these thoughts are and just how much you put yourself down. I used an app to do this on my watch, and it was really eye opening.

2. Recognise cognitive distortions. For instance, when you're thinking about prior failings you might tell yourself "I ALWAYS fail. There's no point in trying when I will always be a failure." This statement is distorted by a generalisation (ALWAYS failing), fortune telling (I will always be a failure), and labelling (calling yourself a failure). When your perspective is coloured by these distortions, you're at risk of making yourself more depressed. These distortions are outlined in the book, but I'm sure you could also find a list online.

3. Learn to talk back to these distortions. E.g. You might say, "I didn't manage to complete this task but it doesn't mean that I am a failure or that I will always be a failure. It does mean that I need more practice." This is when you are looking at things objectively. I would absolutely recommend writing these down as opposed to doing the whole exercise in your head as it helps you to better see the faults in your thinking.

These are just a few tips I have learnt but they have really, really helped me. I used to think that it's better to be harsh on myself because it is more *realistic* but I didn't realise this was fueled by low self-esteem and distorted thinking.

- I was depressed for years because of what happened to my family. I cut off talking to my friends. I used to stay in my bedroom for months. I started with my medication, somehow the antidepressant works on me but still there are times that depression and anxiety hits me. I tried to come out of my comfort zone to finally go outside for a walk every morning, talk to my close few friends and motivational books. I also clean the house when depression hits me. I remembered seeing myself wash the dishes while crying but it helps me to clean my mind. I hope it helps.

- Depression is like a Black Homeless dog that just keeps following you.....

We have Valid Reasons to be Depressed.

This world and all the suffering and corruption.

Our foods are not Nutritional enough.

We work and no rest or play.

🔪 I had to come to the End of myself and seek the One who is much higher than me.

I discovered Apart from Knowing OUR CREATOR GOD-Life will never make sense....

Nor can it.

I pray and seek GOD and read the Bible. Life and Eternal instructions are in the BIBLE.

Also, Depression can come from Chemical Imbalances and Over medicated or lack of medication.

- >Not incessantly thinking about my prior failings.

This is how my depression looks like if i could describe it in a single line. My partner keeps saying to just get over it. He is like surprised how i can be so hung onto my past for monthsss instead of just moving on. I really don't know how my brain works. As long as i keep myself really busy and plan my future weeks ahead in a way to keep myself fully engaged leaving no space for overthinking, i am fine. But negative thoughts creep back in at night.

- Depression sucks, no way around it. But you've got to keep fighting it, my friend. First thing, get those positive vibes going - exercise, hang out with your pet, anything that lifts your spirits even a little bit. Shut down those negative thoughts as soon as they start, doesn't matter how.

Next, set yourself some goals to work towards, but keep them manageable at first. Small wins build confidence. And seriously, get a good therapist who you click with. Had to go through a couple duds myself before finding the right fit.

Self-care is huge too - treat yourself to looking and feeling fresh. New skincare routine, haircut, whatever works for you. And keep your surroundings clean and clutter-free. Cluttered space, cluttered mind.

The bad days will still come, that's normal. But keep pushing forward on the good days. Lean on your people when you need it. Most importantly, don't give up.

- Find the things that give you dopamine overloads. For me it was agriculture. Farming and gardening quite literally saved my life. It's the only thing that quiets the demons and, on the bad days, makes me feel like I can make it through another day.

I worked corporate for 7 years and had to find a way to fit farming/gardening into my life (volunteering, gardening at my parents, reading, etc). I quit corporate 3 years ago and now work as a farmer full-time. The depression is always there, but it doesn't scare me and is way easier to manage.

- I'm sorry to hear you're depressed.

All I can say is that therapy and antidepressants have been a huge help for me, once the side effects were over after two weeks.

- Accept the depression and just keep moving. The parts of you that are sad are just as important as the parts of you that are happy, there's nothing wrong with it. Humanity has to embrace the yin and yang push and pull of life.

- I can't say I fully beat Depression because in weak moments I notice how it wants to get a piece of me, but I am on top of it now, after 18 years of struggling hard with several visits to clinics, therapists, being locked away for my own safety, and at times not being able to leave the house for days, despite really having to, no matter the financial etc consequence.

My mind definitely matured over the years but it definitely needs some work.

I still look for purpose but it's okay now, really. Life is mostly good now, instead of years of not wanting to be alive at all.

This is what helped me control what controlled me for over half my life if not longer.

1. A good therapy/therapists. I made the biggest progress at clinics away from everything. But they were known to be one of the best clinics in my country and boy was it a difference. Bad clinics with bad therapists made me feel worse.

2. Social contacts. If you can't be social outside your home, try to invite someone, or be social online.

Talking in voice over discord or whatever can help massively. It's not good to be alone in your depressive head 24/7

3. Being outside, walking and sunlight is important.

If you don't want to go alone, see if you can maybe walk a friendly dog for a neighbor.

Energy with nowhere to go is destructive.

4. Stop telling yourself that you're shit, not worth living, wasting air, that you will never be happy, that you're a failure.

It made a gigantic difference in my life. You can be your biggest ally. Just Stop insulting yourself is so important for your mental health.

5. Eat good and check what you're eating.

Good, none processed food is important.

A car needs fuel, cooling fluid etc to run, your body can't run on nothing. The body needs nutrition to even produce the hormones that can make you happy. For me realizing that my Omega 3 and Vitamin B12 levels had hit rock bottom gave me a massive push. It's actually impressive how much it boosted me when I started to compensate the lack and how tiny my anxieties suddenly became.

6. Set boundaries and protect them.

I had difficult family relations and I had to learn to Set boundaries In order to not constantly feel like shit.

I got rid of my toxic Ex BF, who did nothing but control and talk down on me.
I cut out another family member after they ignored my boundary and I felt finally good and like I could start over.

Boundaries can be good, they can heal relationships if they are being respected. People who care will respect them. It heals because you are not angry at yourself/them anymore.

7. Groom yourself

Don't skip that shower, you need it.

8. If you notice you have an interest in something, then make room for it in your mind and life, it will take away room for bad thoughts.

9. Try to keep your home in a decent state, clutter and dirt in your home is never good.

I motivate myself by watching Auriikatarina on Youtube. She also Talks about mental health and it always gives me a bit motivation.

Of course that's not the recipe to be happy for everyone and it doesn't explain what exactly needed to be done, or when it needed to be done.

I just always knew that being massively depressed with no will to live was not normal which means I had a Chance to fix that.

It wasn't easy. I don't know if it's gone.

There are other methods I would have tried next otherwise, like lionmane, the gut health/wrong bacterias, maybe Microdosis of pff LSD or shrooms? , meditation, maybe even surgery.

It's a big world, with many problems and just as many ways to try to fix it

- I go to therapy, take meds, and find hobbies or work that helps me

- All of the lifestyle change advice is very very good advice, but I do want to say, if you still need more help, don't be scared or ashamed to talk to a doctor about medication. There's always going to be people who say it's the worst thing they've done. It took me too long to get past the fear of other people's negative experiences becoming mine. That doesn't make up the majority. I have bipolar disorder and specifically experienced deep heart aching depression/sadness for long periods of time. Medication has given me so much of my life back. I was a nervous wreck for months before I finally gave in. I've also had medications that did not work for me. There are many people like me who feel that medication gave them their life back. I don't recommend, however, just using medication and making zero lifestyle changes. Meds and healthy lifestyle is a team effort 🤝 hope you find relief soon 💖

- Meds, therapy, think of what you wanna do in life work towards it slowly, slowly get your shit together so you live your life how you wanna be happy do the things that make you happy

- Medication. It's an illness and medicine is a totally valid option that works for many, many people. I take it for mine because I know that my depressive state of mind is not logical, but I can't control it. I can't link it to adverse events in my life, everything is going great for me. That's how I know therapy won't help me. I know deep down there is no external reason for me to feel this way, there is just a problem with my brain.

- Therapy and medication. Eventually you leave the meds behind. The trick is to change your outlook on life.

- God cured my depression, sadness, anxiety, and suicidal thoughts. No longer am I medicated for that stuff because I formed a strong bond with God, go to church and be with an amazing community, and read the bible. God truly opened my eyes with a lot of things. Thank you God for healing me and helping others in this cruel world <3

- Seriously, if you figure it out, please let me know. I've been struggling with depression since I was 8 years old. The cause was the intense bullying I was suffering at school. Then in the middle school years, it wasn't just at school anymore but online too. Then I lost my dad when I was 16, and then I became enraged and even more depressed. Long story short, I've been to over two dozen therapists, a handful of psychiatrists, on a laundry list of different medications, tried to change my diet (which nearly killed me), exercise more, become more socially outgoing, and honestly, everything everyone can recommend and I still was crying to my mom on Friday about how much I want to die. I am a firm believer that there are some people who are just not meant to be here and I am one of them. Part of my depression stems from losing my dad, it's been 14 years and I am still filled with as much rage as I was the day he died. Part of it stems from the fact that I have no friends and really no family, outside of my mom (my siblings hate me and want nothing to do with me because they're ashamed of me). And part of it stems from the fact that I am 31 and can't financially take care of myself, despite the fact that I am working a full time job. I have a college degree and masters degree taking up space that I can't use, so I imagine that is part of it too. I would have killed myself by now if it weren't for my mom, lord knows, I've tried.

- I got into martial arts specifically to combat depression. The mind body connection was great. Keeping my mind busy learning the techniques and gaining belts was good for me. Eventually I essentially rewired my brain to be positive and not negative. I haven't had a serious episode of depression since.

- i think society gives medication a bad rep. i did talk therapy for 5 years until i was referred to a psychiatrist. within 1 month of being on very low dose of mood stabilizer, i was able to get my head out of the fog and started to see my life clearly. i made some huge life decisions, ones that looking back should have been no brainer but when you're so deep in the hole you just don't really have the ability to do anything. for people who have never suffered from depression, it's impossible to understand that when you are depressed, you know logically what you are "supposed" to do (sleep 8 hours, exercise, get sunshine, have happy thoughts, etc) but you may have a chemical imbalance that impacts your ability to function. it's like telling someone who has poor eyesight to drive down the same road at the same speed as you without getting glasses — they may never get there. am now off the medication, sleeping a normal amount (before i was taking 60mg of melatonin just to fall asleep for a few hours), and happier than ever! know that just because you start medication doesn't mean you will be on it forever. i dont think i would have been able to kickstart my life back up without it.

find a GOOD psychiatrist who will properly diagnose you and stay with you on your journey. it's worth the money to find someone who is invested in helping you get better.

- You tell me and we'll both know... 😊

But seriously, I'm right there with ya. Some say "stay busy" but what if the fact that you're always busy, always on a schedule, always pushed to do more, IS THE PROBLEM!!!!???

I've done the God thing! And I'll never do that again!

Counseling? What are they gonna say to make me feel better? What is anyone gonna say to make me feel better? FLUFF! That's all it is! People will say ANYTHING to try to make you feel better. But it's all just FLUFF designed to make you feel better with NO SUBSTANCE! Sure! I might feel better for a few minutes, maybe a whole day! But what about tomorrow? And most of that fluff isn't real anyhow!

You'll get through it... 🤔! Yes! The last several years have shown me that it will some day end... With me in the ground!

Taking advice from people who don't even know what real depression is, is like going to church for a tooth ache!

Live for... (so and so) spouse? Kids? Friends? I've found out the hard way that you CAN NOT put your hopes and dreams for the future onto someone else. They'll let you down EVERY TIME!

So, I honestly don't know. After years and years of living a life I no longer find ANY enjoyment in? Faking being happy so that no one knows just how bad I feel ALL THE TIME! When smiling becomes painful and feels dishonest? When laughing is something you wish you still knew how to do?

I don't know.

- You gotta realize that the stuff that goes on in your head all day is a symptom of it. You need to actively tell your inner monologue to shut up because it's feeding you a line of crap. Getting out of a depression means intervening with the ways you operate by default. Number one thing is this: imagine you're a 3 year old child and no one else in the world is responsible for you except for you. You would never deny a 3 year old the care they need from you- so stop doing it to yourself! Love is a verb, to love yourself means to act on your own behalf, constantly. It all feels pointless and helpless now- that's the bullshit depression talking. Tell it to shut up, tell it you're in control. Tell it you want to change and are gonna make it change. Start small, build momentum. I clean my kitchen every night and while I do, I think about how happy I'll be in the morning to walk into this clean organized space and make my coffee. This is how you reset your brain, do work for yourself and feel the benefits
- Dialectical Behavior Therapy. You really can retrain your brain.
- I got hit HARD during the ol' rona days.

Hit what I felt was my absolute rock bottom.

Started going to Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (drinking was a MAJOR issue), through that I found meditation, which led to Stoic philosophy. Within 3 months of starting the process my mind was wired completely differently.

Learning about serotonin and dopamine was also huge for me.

Overall, for me: exercise (even if it's just a few thousand steps per day, but my goal is 10,000), LOTS of laughter, dopamine/serotonin supplements/probiotics, daily sunlight, and keeping a relatively tidy living space does a lot for me.

I really learned to hack around my habits, for instance I never drink water, so I put a case of bottled water under my work desk. Not a huge fan of cleaning, so I bought a Roomba and have it run every day while I'm at the office.

I would suggest not focusing on everything at once, leading to being overwhelmed. Start with small things you can do every morning (even just making your bed and feeling accomplished).

Listening to audiobooks while I'm falling asleep has been great, too. Highly recommend 7 Habits, Man's Search for Meaning, The Enchiridion by Epictetus, and Meditations by Marcus Aurelius.

You got this, the world needs you!

- Goes to gym to get rid of depression....works out with near consistency for three years.... now just depressed and shredded but at least it's an outlet! I think having outlets is the only real thing places to place the feelings.

- I was in your shoes... had been suffering with severe depression, with many other mental health disorders, all my life, 39M. I reached out, went therapy, got medicine, seen a psychologist. None of it ever really changed the "problem". Or got rid of what was causing my issues... I didn't think I was ever going to get out of where I was at... I ended up have some reactions from a surgery, some damages happened, and some reactions in my brain happened. The hospital refused to address the medical issue's they caused, because that would be admitting fault, and they used my mental state as an escape goat and said it was all in my head and I just needed to see my psychologist.... not to mention worded several other things that made me sound like a terrible dirty horrible person on my personal chat for everyone to read... well that sent me over the edge and I decided to kill myself.... I am not in no way telling you, this is the answer! I have no ideal why this happened to me. I am still gathering answers... After I was talked down from doing it, I finally fell asleep at 4 am and woke up a 6 am and everything was gone in my mind. All of it... I had been noticing stuff in my brain had been, deleting... but I couldn't explain it to anyone... but that is what happened... for the best that I can tell, I went through a personality change. And since I was the extreme, I reversed... to what would be... semi "normal".... I wish I had answers for you brother... I hate that you are suffering.... I know how it is.... it was terrible... my best advice i can find now, is I have come to realize I have trigger points, that I couldn't notice or control before, but now in this frame of mind, I can see them and feel them coming on. I can stop the situation and walk away if something is happening and I feel that is going to cause me to react or do something. My emotions are also muted right now, and I have requested to be put on anti depressants that help to keep them that way as I dont want to relapse. Find your triggers. Find ways to work through them. Do breathing exercises. Meditation.

Helping people seemed to help me a lot, but don't let people get to using you... because people will get to doing that too. Write in a journal. Your thoughts. Your goals. Your feelings. What happened to you and how it made you feel. Do it every day. Every few days, go back and re-read some of your passages and see if you still feel the same. Explain why. See if you can find a way to help you feel better or find a solution. And talking with a close close friend who gets you and totally understands you and doesn't judge you, really helps when you just need to vent and blow off some steam. I hope you can find peace brother. I know its hard. But don't give up. Just because you haven't found your solution yet, doesn't mean it isn't out there.

- What worked out for me is that I stopped trying to "fix" myself. For me, depression was never meant to be fixed but to be felt through and understood. I adopted the idea of embracing the shadow self kinda like how Naruto embraces his dark self in order to find peace within himself. Yes you want to do practical things to help you cope. What helped me out in the end is an extreme practice of mindfulness and letting go of the need to fix fix fix.

I understand that this is more of the philosophical/purely psychological way of going about this.

- Gotta create tiny moments of joy for yourself. Buy a postcard and send a total stranger from the Whitepages a card. Leave a compliment in a library book. Buy yourself a little treat. Randomly text a friend "hey I just wanna say thanks for being in my life - it's better with you in it."

I've been dysthymic since I was 8 years old - depression & suicidal ideation has been and will always be there waiting for me. Learning Self-Soothing, Mindfulness, meditation videos, random acts of kindness, Gratitude, constantly trying new things, and lots of DBT skills have helped me to create reasons to be glad to be alive even though I have a brain that tries to unalive me constantly. I've trained myself to wake up and think about what I'm grateful for or what I have to look forward to, even if it's just that hot shower before work (yay clean water!) and the good coffee from the shop around the corner once in awhile (yay occasional breakfast sandwich) or the 20 minutes of vidya gaming I allow myself before bed.

Therapy has helped with depression, as well as meds but what really helped was internalizing the fact that depression & anxiety are actually reasonable reactions and conditions to have in response to *gestures at everything*. Focus on what's in your Circle of Control & it'll help you figure out what your next best steps are.

- I beat depression once upon a time. For me it started with getting medicated to help fight the feelings of hopelessness, sadness, and lack of care to do anything. Zoloft for me didn't cure my depression but it did get me the motivation to begin trying and not feel quite as down

From there I became proactive with myself about reflecting on what was making me depressed (in my case it was simply coming to terms with being gay as a teen and hating myself and feeling like I'll never find/have love or people that like me for me).

I then used that knowledge to form a plan to better my health mentally and physically. Being active, forcing myself to be social to make and be with friends, getting a job, achieving in school, etc. Every time I felt that feeling creep back in the med helped it a bit stay away and I reminded myself why I'm doing what I'm doing. With months and months I began to build up self esteem

both physically and mentally, the relationships I built made me feel like I can be loved and cared for no matter what, and I eventually came out and not a soul was bothered in my life. I later began dating men and it was great and life has proceeded since

- After a severe TBI in '14 (it's a blessing from God I even survived), I sought out EMDR therapy during recovery and decided to stop living in my past and work towards a better future. Problem: Solved.

- Psychotherapy that works for you specifically, change of attitude, narratives and mindset. Also meditation, stretching... and if still needed psilocybin or pharmacotherapy. Get to know your mind instead of trying to fight it. Learn to be in the body, how to express emotions and regulate your nervous system. Breathing techniques could also help. It's a struggle until you find what works for you but it actually CAN GET BETTER!

- Take a long walk, write out your thoughts for 30 minutes, get counseling. It's been many many many many years and I'm still drowning but after that routine I get enough clarity to push on forward

- Therapy and weed

- Therapy, medication, transcranial magnetic stimulation

- ketamine therapy! it actually saved my life. i feel like a new person! i'd definitely give it a try

- This sounds like my anxiety (my depression is more seasonal, but my anxiety is constant.) I've never tried meds or found therapy even remotely helpful. At this point, I've just accepted it's never going to go away completely, so I just try squashing it down enough where I can actually function. So if things like exercise, sunlight etc help to keep it at bay then it's about trying to keep consistent with them. And then "getting back on the horse" if you get out of routine and start to slip into a stronger depression. It's a fucking exhausting life. I sometimes feel like I spend all of my time trying to keep my anxiety at bay (and my depression during winter,) to try and be "high functioning."

ETA: with my seasonal depression, I find walking outside to get some sunlight and taking vitamin D supplements to be very helpful. Because mine is seasonal, I know the issue comes from the lack of daylight during the winter where I live so trying to counteract that helps. Sadly if your depression is constant then it's hard to figure out the "cause" (assuming there even is one.) But I do recommend trying to get more walks outside in the daytime. It's worth trying, I think.

- For me, really good cognitive behavioral therapy changed my life for the better. I got sick of therapists that gave me the, "how does that make you feel?" crap just so I could come back week after week to say, "it feels awful." I just wanted it fixed. Once I got to the point of kind of accepting that large parts of life are going to feel terrible and that the feeling is largely irrelevant and doesn't have to dictate what I do, I started getting more consistent with habits. I started forcing myself to go to my church's young adults groups almost every day. I stopped drinking. Then I started eating better. Then I started working out. And I genuinely started looking forward to doing things again.

- My depression turned out to be childhood PTSD. I suspect that's the cause of a lot of depression, anxiety, and unresolved rage. Just finding out made me feel immensely better, but there is treatment for it (EMDR). Ask your therapist if you might have it.

- Your diet & exercise should be healing your depression. Or at least give you moments of relief. The first line of treatment for depressed individuals is to take a walk outside.

What does your diet look like? It's actually quite easy to be undernourished, which will keep your mental health in disaster. I thought I was eating healthy until I actually started eating the proper amount of protein, carbs, electrolytes and calories, and my anxiety & stress completely diminished. I felt like a new person. Sometimes I still get anxiety but I give myself time to process it & self soothe instead of running away with it and letting it take over every moment.

After you've got that straightened out, you can give meds a shot! Good luck!

- I started to take Escitalopram, which is a SSRI antidepressant three years ago and it helps me to give me more energy throughout the day. Depression is still here, but now it's very low key. Additionally, to that I started therapy again. Life doesn't seem as pointless any more, but that's just me. I don't know what will work for you best.

- Depression is a chemical imbalance. Medication can help restore balance. See a PSYCHIATRIST not a therapist and get evaluated and prescribed. I'm sitting right now in a swank restaurant on a resort island with my beautiful wife and I look like a poet/killer I'm told. Those pills saved me and continue to see me through to new adventures. I'd be in some basement apartment smoking roaches if I hadn't seen that first shrink. Good luck!

ICYDK, avoiding help is a symptom of depression. Overcome it and act today.

- I tried prescription therapy for 6 years. Didn't help at all. I got off all pills and did psilocybin therapy, I've been depression free for 3 years.

- See a Psychiatrist about adding medication to your treatment plan. Therapy isn't enough.

- Do a thought experiment. For a week, you will tell yourself that depression isn't real.

This alone helped me so much. I'm very rarely depressed anymore.

- Here's a long shot, but are you vitamin D deficient?

I found out I was and had a bit of depression before I started taking cod liver oil. A few days in and my mood started to improve.

Depression, mood swings and anxiety are one of the main symptoms of vitamin D deficiency.

- Step 1: Don't be a Democrat

Step 2: Depression cured.

Step 3: Get actual Depression

Step 4: Seek help.

- I will provide the solution but doubt anyone does it lol.

All psychological suffering comes from mistaken identity. That what you are is a mind and a body.

If you investigate what you truly are, honestly, to the end. The conclusion will free you permanently from all suffering.

Look up "who am I" if you need guidance on the subject.

But yes no drug or therapy will provide permanent solution, just a plaster.

Title: A question about suffering vs clinical depression

Post Text: And I understand that depression is suffering, but that isn't quite what I mean.

I'm reading Buddhism for Beginners: A Practical Guide to Spiritual Enlightenment by Tai Morello. Pretty early on in the book they say "it is we, ourselves, who are the causes of our own suffering because of the nature of our own minds – which are inherently undisciplined. Such undisciplined minds create delusions which lead to pre-conditioned responses that intern cause suffering."

Is this to say that depression is looked at as a manifestation of our own undisciplined minds in Buddhism? Because scientifically speaking, that shouldn't be the case - It's a result of brains not producing the right chemicals to keep us happy. Even the Dalai Lama has said that Buddhism should alter itself if science presents evidence for something.

Or am I misunderstanding this entirely?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- The brain is an organ that malfunctions just as the thyroid, or the pancreas, etc. Genetic factors, developmental issues, chemical imbalances, etc, can all contribute to clinical depression or other brain disorders.

We can't discipline ourselves out of hypothyroidism or diabetes, why would we think the same of clinical depression, or adhd, or schizophrenia, etc?

But combined with medical treatment, therapy, the buddhist teachings can help us lead more fulfilling lives and help. The buddha even had his own doctors.

Ordinary suffering and clinical depression are not an equal equivalent. A more disciplined mind can help manage many aspects of depression that cause us more suffering. But it is not a replacement for medical help.

If not for medication and therapy I would not be the buddhist I am today. I do not see buddhism as invalidating mental illness or implying that it's because we lack discipline. It seems like the author is making a very broad generalization and not taking those kinds of nuances into account

(for a beginners book I could see why they might so that). But I would not interpret it so mean that our mental illness is our own fault.

- I wouldn't say that statment captures the whole picture and may be poorly worded.

Depression and anxiety of which I have had

are often the result of conditioned states. Trauma, inflammation, poor diet, poor thought patterns picked up by adults ect.

You can meditate all day but if your brain isn't healthy and producing enough of the necessary neurochemicals you will still be miserable. Just like any other organ that is sick will result in a particular unhealthy outcome.

It is true that an undisciplined mind can lead us to unskilled actions and thought patterns which increase misery, but this doesn't mean it's entirely the result of that.

I want also note that depression has been linked to repressed anger as well as self-hatred. Buddhism provides strategies for working with these unwholesome states of mind if they are in fact present.

- The 'Chemical Imbalance' theory have long been proven false. It's a clever way for Pharmaceutical companies to continue promoting this concept to make more sales. The underlying cause to depression or mental illness isn't fully understood since it involves various other components that can contribute to it. There are also publications on Antidepressants and it's ineffectiveness. Most studies indicate that these pills are just as effective as placebos. Psychiatry in general is a developing field.

If you want to further research this topic, you can always use Google scholar or related credible sources. Most searched website on Google aren't credible.

- I think there is a strong argument for depression and anxiety to be born by our thinking patterns. There are exceptions of course but many people find themselves depressed due to longstanding patterns. I am one such example of someone that has suffered deeply from both anxiety and depression in this way.

- I have been practicing Buddhism for decades. It has not cured my clinical depression. Depression is a brain disease. Meditation practice reduces symptoms of Depression. Buddha taught that illness is a characteristic of being human. Developing compassion for ones self is important but difficult..

- from a medical perspective I read this recently:

<https://theconversation.com/depression-is-probably-not-caused-by-a-chemical-imbalance-in-the-brain-new-study-186672>

- No. I don't believe Buddha thought the genuine suffering of the mentally disordered was their own fault for lack of discipline. MDD is a real condition. It should be treated medically. MDD is not caused by low serotonin but it is caused by many real epigenetic and genetic vulnerabilities. It is not something caused by the individual.

That being said the suffering caused by MDD can be helped by following the Buddhist teachings. Long term meditation has been shown to make changes to the brain. Learning to cope well with stress and find a balanced mindset are key to learning to live with a mental disorder, however it will never cure it.

I believe Thich Nhat Hanh spoke on the subject and did not indicate that mental disorder was a fault of poor discipline. He sought only to help relieve the suffering of that person and their loved ones through the teaching of mindfulness.

- Hi KimchiAndMayo,

Very briefly, suffering, (or suffering from a depressed mind (a mind with certain chemical balance)) versus having a brain that is said to have unbalanced chemical balance are two different things.

Buddhism does not say physical/chemical state are bad, nor do they deal with these states. For instance, certain electrical signal/chemical balance that creates desire for sex, is different from being consumed by the desire of sex. Having certain electrical signal/chemical balance that creates desire for food is different from being consumed by the desire of food. Body wanting sleep is different from wanting sleep.

If one does not know how to see the mind ('undisciplined') and the you are completely consumed by the mind as its desires arise, then there is suffering.

If you look at the post, there are words like "suffering" and "happiness"

>"it is we, ourselves, who are the causes of our own suffering because of the nature of our own minds – which are inherently undisciplined. Such undisciplined minds create ***delusions*** which lead to pre-conditioned responses that intern cause ***suffering***."

Is this to say that depression is looked at as a manifestation of our own undisciplined minds in Buddhism? Because scientifically speaking, that shouldn't be the case - It's a result of brains not producing the right chemicals to keep us ***happy***.

These (what is bold and italicized) are what Buddhism deals with.

I suppose we can summarize, within the context of this post is that, in the undisciplined mind, the mind has the tendency to think thoughts like the following: "I am hungry, therefore I want to eat and I can't stop eating; what's wrong with wanting to eat? Am I a bad person for wanting to eat?" and/or "I am a good person and those people/country/religion that says I am not are the bad people; they need to be changed/they need to be educated/they need a reformation of government/they need to have better values"

In either of these cases, the subject believes that the reason they feel the way they feel is external (i.e. chemicals in their brain (and not their own mind) or people in other countries/religions (and not their own mind)).

Whether certain chemicals exist or not, and whether other people exist or not, is not the determiner of whether you are happy or suffering, according to Buddhism.

In today's world, we believe that the happiness or suffering is based on what our environment (either in our brain or in the external world) is like. So, we think: "as long as we can fix that, or manipulate that, or change that ("that" being anything but the 'self' and is some non-self thing), then, surely, I will be happy and not suffer".

So, we buy things ('as long as I have things in my environment, I will be happy'), kill insects ('as long as they are not on the plants or in my house, then I will be happy'), gain knowledge ('as long as I have more facts in my brain, then I will be happy'), kill people ('as long as those freaks are dead, then I will be happy'), etc. We keep wanting to change the world thinking that that will make us happy; but no amount of manipulating the world (or chemical balance in our brain, or amount of facts accumulated in our minds) makes us any happier.

​

Again, this is just a brief intro. If further information is desired, feel free to ask and I will try to provide as much information as I know regarding the matter for your own reference.

- Depression is a giant blanket category that has very little clinical specificity. There have been multiple studies of our current classification system that have found that they are not clinically meaningful in the way that other diagnostic criteria are. The evidence that it's caused by "brains not producing the right chemicals to keep us happy" is lacking - mixed at best.

So, that's worth understanding. It is a giant blanket category loosely related symptoms - not diagnostically meaningful condition in of itself. Which makes it very difficult to talk about in contexts like this.

There are symptoms that might be classified as depression that arise from physical ailments. I am trying to get my hypothyroidism properly diagnosed - a key symptom of which is lowered mood. And it's important to receive treatment for that.

There are symptoms that might be classified as depression that result from our own wrong view and wrong intent. There are symptoms that might be classified as depression that result from our own wrong speech, wrong action, and wrong livelihood.

That's kind of the issue with with it as a diagnostic "condition". Condition is supposed to denote the cause but there are so many causes of "depression" it's unhelpful in dialogs like this.

The thing is though - and this is me speaking as someone with a condition that causes depressive symptoms so this is not abstract to me - the author is right regardless of the cause. Whether it arises from physical factors or our own actions - our ideas that we shouldn't have experience bad things and should only get the nice things is what give rise to suffering.

I think too often people read passages like that and think "Oh well then they're saying that if I was in pain and I was enlightened then I'd be happy - that's ridiculous." No, you'd have equanimity - no one experience would be preferable to any other. You might still experience lowered mood or physical pain but you wouldn't suffer from the conditioned belief that things should be any other way. It would be within your ability to tolerate and you could abide with it.

If you're new to Buddhism, I really would recommend taking an open minded and investigative approach to these ideas - to test them. If you're looking for a religion that already aligns with your present beliefs, there's a good chance Buddhism won't be it. I didn't understand many many concepts that I heard monastics and lay leaders talk about or a very long time. But I saw they were worth at least considering. It took me, no lie, 8 years of reading and going to services pretty regularly to understand karma.

If this idea, that we cause our suffering, is difficult right now - that's okay. Just abide with it for a while.

- depression is what? You don't feel good. Why don't you feel good? For all the fucking reasons in the world. First, you have to take care of your conventional self. Whatever way you fucking need to. Second, on the edges of wanting to feel good, say, I'd rather feel real than feel good. There, that's a start. It won't make you rich, but it will give you decent sleep. Which is what anyone needs.

- There have been news reports in just the past week to the effect that no one has ever actually found evidence for the claim of chemical imbalance. And in fact, if you take something like an SRI it's likely to stop working after awhile and result in difficult withdrawal. Why? Because the brain adapts to what it detects as a serotonin malfunction and reduces serotonin sensitivity.

Long story short, the neurotransmitter imbalance theory was a handy way to make people feel less guilty about their own depression, it was an appealingly simple theory of human experience, and it was a great way to sell a lot of pills. As I recall, Prozac has raked in over \$30 billion.

I think you need to recognize that scientific materialism (the source of these brain chemistry theories) and Buddhism are also two fundamentally different world views. In Buddhist point of view, suffering is mainly generated due to attachment to a belief in an existing self. We're constantly trying to confirm our own existence in relation to "other". I have a relationship with other, therefore I exist. You really need to practice meditation to understand this. Meditation will show you your own mind experientially.

So there's the samsaric experience of constantly trying to confirm self existence, but never being able to because all such confirmations are relative. Experience is not ultimately graspable

as a thing. You can feel alive when you desire a lover or hate a driver who cut you off in traffic, but it's holding onto that drama that gives you a sense of solid world.

Depression, then, would be a case of getting stuck. When we feel threatened in our "solidity", we amp up klesha, or toxic emotions. We lust after someone. We get angry or competitive. Those things make us feel alive. If you inspect depression you can see the same thing. No one thinks they want to be depressed, yet there's tremendous resistance to letting go of that mental state. As with all klesha obsession, there's no sense of humor and it feels extremely solid. That sense of solidity is the appeal of depression. The idea to just cheer up would feel very threatening.

If you think you're interested in this, I'd suggest that you look into real Buddhist teachings and not books by "meditation geek entrepreneurs". You might also consider doing an intensive group meditation retreat, for a weekend, a week, or more. That will give you a grounding in the practice and a better sense of what it's about. Buddhist teachings are practical guidance for meditation practice on the path of enlightenment. They are ****not**** philosophy or theory.

- Your characterization of the cause of depression is (or was) a popular misconception, but is currently debunked. The mechanistic view of mental pathology in general is quite biased and dumbed-down, as it arises originally from a deluded, avoidant, severely materialist outlook. Biased minds may confuse correlation with causation.

Even if depression were dumbed down to a mere chemical origin, the question still lingers: what causes you to encounter this chemical pattern where others don't? Besides the clinical inquiries (which are important to follow up on), the **underlying** point according to Buddhадharma is that you cause such patterns to take hold by wielding your mind and actions in certain ways.

There are quite a number of potential causes and conditioning factors that cause or constitute depression; it can be a complex network of interactions between thought patterns, core beliefs, relationships, environmental factors, lifestyle factors, physiology, and brain chemistry.

But at a deeper level, these patterns take hold due to the underlying delusion: one presumes a separately existing self, and one perceives a supposed world of external objects to be desired or shunned.

>"Mind is the forerunner of all states. They are led by mind, all mind-created." (Dhammapada v.1)

**Once you presume a self and a world of separate beings and objects*, then yes, there are many things that seem to just happen to you regardless of your hopes and activities. But when you begin to perceive things at a deeper level, you see the interconnectedness of everything, and how the subtle movements of your own karma sets the suffering world in motion.*

Your own karma -- your own actions and intentions -- create the views that you take for reality and the repercussions that visit you, sometimes long after the cause for them has faded from awareness.

Get proper Dharma teaching; don't just speculate and guess, and don't take anonymous online hobbyists for teachers. Go to an authentic teacher and learn these most important issues the right way.

Study karma with a living teacher, then train properly in meditation with a teacher so you can begin to perceive your own habitual karmic patterns.

When you meditate with stillness and clarity, you can see the ways your mind moves, the directions it turns toward, the objects it clings to or rejects or ignores. Thus you can witness *in your own experience, beyond what anyone says about it* how karma unfolds. Then the teachings and your experience can merge and illuminate each other. That becomes your *wisdom*, which is of a completely different nature than mere speculative philosophizing.

If you are interested in further study, the text *The Wheel of Sharp Weapons* gets into the specifics of how various categories of thought and action result in specific kinds of suffering. The text is available in a number of translations; the commentary by Thubten Chodron in her book [*Good Karma*](<https://thubtenchodron.org/books/wheel-of-sharp-weapons/>) is quite good.

For an accessible discussion on the environmental and relational origins (among others) of depression, see Johann Hari's work. For starters:

* <https://youtu.be/0y7cBicUg3w>

* <https://youtu.be/Hfl3Yh7fS4g>

* <https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/34921573-lost-connections>

See also the Buddhist teachings on interbeing/interdependent causation, *pratityasamutpada*, and mind as the 'forerunner of all things'.

^Edit: ^typo

- >It's a result of brains not producing the right chemicals to keep us happy.

Side note: Depression is not caused by brain chemical imbalance as announced this week by recent findings. This is not related to your point or question and I don't mean to alter your question. I'm just presenting this as a piece of side news.

- The author of the book is correct in a way, but remember that the book is called 'Buddhism for Beginners' so it gently introduces the concepts of what Buddha taught in a way that the reader can relate to. However, this can also introduce misunderstanding, as in this case.

To fully understand what he meant when he said '...the causes of our own suffering because of the nature of our own minds', I would suggest you go to the actual text of the Buddha's teaching on the topic of the Four Noble Truths. I will list the first 2 here:

1. The Noble Truth of Suffering

Birth is suffering, old age is suffering, disease is suffering, death is suffering, sorrow, lamentation, pain, grief and distress are suffering, association with the unpleasant is suffering, disassociation from the pleasant is suffering, not to get what one desires is suffering; in short, attachment to the five aggregates is suffering.

2. The Noble Truth of the Cause of Suffering

It is this craving that causes rebirth and is bound up with pleasure and lust and finds delight now here, now there. That is, the craving for sensual pleasures, the craving for repeated rebirth and the craving for annihilation.

Taking these two into consideration, the cause of our suffering indeed lies in our mind, and it is this craving. Craving to pleasant things and situations that you desire and when pleasant things don't happen and unpleasant things keep on happening, or you keep being associated with unwanted situations and being disassociated with wanted situations, you feel miserable.

Our craving is not just limited to material and tangible things, but also to intangible things like ideas, beliefs, religions and so on and when someone says anything unpleasant towards your ideas, beliefs of religion you get so agitated and upset.

This is what the author meant by 'suffering caused by the nature of our own minds'.

I hope this clears up a little of your misunderstanding.

Lastly, when Buddha gave his discourses he always talked about 'mind' and 'body' and never once referred to the brain itself, since it is the mind that matters, and the brain is simply the container in which the mind operates.

- It seems depression can have a reactive base (per Tai Morello) or a biological base.

Reactive depression Buddhism would call a 'mental disease'.

Biological depression Buddhism would call a 'physical disease'.

- Buddhism is not a substitute for science or doctors.

If you are truly suffering from diagnosable depression you need to be properly treated by an expert in the field. There is no ability to out think imbalance of chemicals in the brain.

Way too many people come here thinking buddhism is some secret cure to all their troubles in life. In truth truly following the path is infinitely more difficult than actually dealing with their own problems.

- The paradigm of neurochemistry in psychopathology is but only one point of view in understanding disorders and dysfunction. One of the brain's properties is something called neuroplasticity which, in laymans terms, means that it "changes" itself according to how you think or what you do as evidenced by larger brain regions (taxi drivers in London have larger areas of their brains devoted to memory or people who speak with more than one language have observable differences) and by neural connections (learning, thought patterns, and the like).

Believing solely in the neurochemical perspective in understanding clinical depression (MDD) is extremely wrong in clinical practice because the following have also to be considered: genetics, cognitive patterns, life experiences (predispositions and preceptations), and dynamics.

Title: I have a friend suffering from depression, how do I help?

Post Text: I have a friend who went through a divorce 2 years ago and she can't seem to pull herself up. I try to be supportive, but maybe I'm not doing the right things to help? It might seem obvious to some, but I'm struggling to find the words to say or the actions that make her feel supported. Can anyone give advice on what things they feel might be most helpful?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

Title: Been suffering from PTSD and severe depression for 8 months from a previous relationship, need some positivity

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Depression isn't exclusive to those who don't care about their looks. (Not to OP, to commenters in disbelief.) I really hope you are having a great day, and don't let a bad relationship get you down. Hang in there! You are a handsome guy and I'm sure you will find a beautiful relationship soon.

- Ok but I can't join your high profile case.

Or

Please don't audit me.

I'd 100% have coffee with you if you hit me up in the wild because you look like someone easy to relate to and a pretty gd sharp dresser too.

Depression is such a pain in the ass. I've suffered on and off my whole life. I'm sorry you're in the middle of it and I hope you find relief soon.

- Warm hugs aren't a global panacea, and obviously therapy/professional help is needed for the issues you are having. Just wanted to say that there are plenty of kind, non abusive humans out there who would jump at the chance to offer you a warm hug. Hang in there.

- Ok Boss... what do you mean by severe depression and PTSD? I've been hospitalized for severe depression quite a few times throughout my life. So, one person's severe depression may be very different from another's. Previous relationships "CAN" (not WILL), be congruent to death. It's a grieving process, which is never easy. The positive takeaway is that every day that goes by is one day closer to being "pain free." You'll always remember that you suffered... but the pain won't be there anymore. Try to keep your mind occupied at night, before sleep... to avoid ruminating about the issue. When trying to sleep, listen to natural sounds I, like a rain storm, or stream flowing (Via youtube), etc. To keep your mind clear and relaxed.

- I hate to hear that you're struggling. I understand very well how hard it is to cope with severe depression and ptsd. I love that you reached out looking for some kindness and positivity! You deserve kindness, from others and from yourself. It's so hard, but things will get better. Keep remembering that you deserve kindness. Sending love!! (Ps-what a handsome fella you are!)

- I'm so sorry your anxiety and panic attacks have been so bad. Will you think about seeing a psychiatrist and therapist? Maybe you can get some help

- You have a very handsome look, and you seem like the kind of person who'd be wonderful to just sit and talk with about whatever comes up.

And as someone who's in therapy because of trauma and CPTSD, I just want to let you know that healing? Isn't linear. You can come a long way and experience a setback. But the thing that matters is doing your best on the path to healing. Let yourself feel what you need to feel. Don't bottle things up or push them aside, I promise you that doesn't help at all. Look into talking to a professional who's trauma-focused for therapy. I can't tell you how much of a difference that makes. And above all, *do not blame yourself for what your ex put you through*. You aren't at fault. You got dealt a bad hand, and you didn't deserve whatever she put you through. Keep your head high, and stay strong. It can take a while, but I can tell you with absolute certainty that you can heal from all of it.

- You seriously look like a movie star! For depression and PTSD, I highly recommend speaking to a trauma informed therapist. I also have PTSD and going to a trauma informed therapist has helped my PTSD a lot. There's also EMDR Therapy that's helpful for PTSD. I also recommend going to a psychiatrist for depression and PTSD.

- At first glance I legit thought this was an AMA with a movie star.

I'm so sorry you've been struggling. I've had depression for most of my life and when I get waves of severe depression it can be almost unbearable. I've never had PTSD, but I have anxiety and get panic attacks and it is rough.

It is absolutely her loss though and while it may be difficult, it is your gain if that relationship caused you such suffering. You are strong, probably physically, you've got a strong jawline, and most certainly mental & emotional strength (and intelligence since you're no longer with this person). Someone will recognize this strength, emotional intelligence, and everything wonderful about you and will appreciate you for the amazing person you are. In the meantime, I hope you're able to see and recognize that in yourself ❤️

Until next time, Mr. Bond. Or should I call you James?

- I hope you are getting support with the PTSD and depression. I'm so sorry about what you've been experiencing. I see a lot of pain in your eyes, but I see a spark of determination there too. Hmm; maybe also a tiny bit of mischief!! The pain tells me you are kind (because kindness is only possible when someone is willing to experience the pain of being human). The determination and the lil bit of mischief tell me that you have some tools and resources and guts to work through this like the strong gentle person you are.

Okay hope that's not too much!! Also you are very handsome, of course, but that never protected anyone from heartbreak, did it. I'm sorry, brother. Big hugs to you. We got you.

- Max Pain with Depression

- I toast to you, your future and healing journey. To the smile that will come back as you find yourself again. To the pain leaving your eyes and to the things you will enjoy.

As you heal consider taking up something new or something you'd like to get better at. Build your confidence and don't worry about the dating. Focus on you and your overall wellbeing.

- damn she lost one handsome guy that's crazy!!! also just know you aren't alone in feeling this way. depression has a way of tricking you into thinking you are alone in this and that you will always feel this way but please know it's not true.

- Yeah, your looks get you a lot of compliments, but I also know looks only tell some of the story. I'm sorry you're going through this trauma. I know what it's like to deal with post-breakup stress when I had to call the cops on my "ex" (was only together for a few months, but I left a relationship of almost 11 years to be with this woman) a few months ago. And at that time I just shut down. I lost my mojo, my drive, my desire to be happy. I didn't want to watch sitcoms or funny movies, didn't want to listen to music or anything to get me going.

Have you talked to a professional about this? There won't be an instant cure and some wounds simply take time to heal. But there are still little things you can do in your daily routine to at least try and get you out of the doldrums, Eat out by yourself on occasion. Splurge a bit by buying two sandwiches, then bringing the spare to work and reheating it in your own little air fryer for better texture. Spread the love you should be getting by bringing in donuts for coworkers. Remember who you were before you got attached to your ex, and how someone else can see you with that same positivity and drive. You don't have to project it, only because it's not the real you right now. Just don't forget it's there and that there are plenty of women who will appreciate it when you do make your move to prove yourself.

- Keep going man! Get therapy and/or surround yourself with positive people and help! You'll make it and find the one for you!

- As someone who left an abusive marriage five years ago, it does get better. It hurts like fucking hell, the only way out is through (your feelings, thoughts and experiences) you will feel better in time. That doesn't mean everything will be perfect but the anxiety will lessen. Therapy helped me so much, I highly recommend starting if you haven't. You are brave and have so much ahead of you. It takes an average of seven times to leave an abusive relationship, you have crossed one of the hardest hurdles. You got this ❤️
- Try EMDR therapy.... Find a good trauma therapist, not a psychologist and deal with the trauma. The longer you leave it, the harder it becomes. It will remain with you until you deal with those demons
- I gutted that shit out for 63 years. Diagnosed with PTSD from childhood, major depression and major anxiety. Going to therapy helped, but coping with it daily is still hard. Get help, you'll be glad that you did.
- Not only are you hot as fuck, your eyes show a lot. It's strange because normally I can only see this in person but your eyes show a lot of character. You seem awesome. Your hair is super thick, too! The jawline, is jawlining honey! & prayers for you, nobody deserves to go through depression. Feel better, you super handsome guy! I hope you get sent an amazing person when the time is right!
- People who suffer from depression are typically some of the coolest people I know. Not trying to glorify depression but it's true in my opinion.
- Hey man, firstly well done on reaching out for help, the fact you put on a suit for this shows me you're absolutely trying your best to support yourself. I hope the large wave of compliments you've received is a sign you can have a bright future once you can overcome your mental issues.

Regarding what you've been through, you don't deserve to have gone through so much pain, whatever happened in the past it's not your fault, but unfortunately you've been left with a mess to sort out.

I'd like to help you, but I'm trying to understand the situation you're in better first. You mentioned in another comment that you quit a job 3 days ago because it was triggering, and you mentioned that you've had PTSD and severe depression for 8 months. Can you describe the feeling you had after you left the job? Was it a feeling of relief?

- You look very distinguished, and your eyes have a nice look to them. Also, I don't have depression, but I have a slew of other mental health issues. Best of luck to you, and remember that life is a dialectic. Good and bad things can be true at the same time.

- You are, dare I say...a beautiful man.

The cleft chin, piercing eyes, the hair...just gorgeous.

I'm going to assume you're just as handsome on the inside!

Doing good deeds for others is one way to help with the depression, at least for me.

Take it from someone who also struggles with soul crushing depression: things do get better.

You're going to reach that light at the end of the tunnel!

- Sorry, buddy. Hate to see you are having such a hard time. Ptsd sucks, friend. Please take this time to focus on you. Last year at this time, I was down and out, too. I had a constant feeling of

panic, anxiety, and depression that affected my physical health so badly that the doctors thought I had cancer. I weighed under 100 lbs. Once everything physically was ruled out, I sought out a doctor for my mental health. I was diagnosed with mild PTSD, an anxiety disorder, and depression. Once I got acclimated to the meds, I realized how unwell I was. I'm still a work in progress, but all that to say, you aren't alone. You're worth it. You are a good person who had a crappy hand dealt to them, but your PTSD does not define you! Keep fighting. It'll get easier. It won't be overnight, but it'll happen. Hang in there, friend. The right one is out there for you. You deserve to feel loved and cherished!

Let's not forget to mention... you are a smoke show, and any person would be lucky to have you! 🔥🔥 I love my husband, but man, it would be awesome if he had your fashion sense! The only time he will put on a suit is for weddings and funerals!! He considers a nice pair of jeans and a sweater "dressed up" 🤔

I wish you the best. Show that PTSD who's boss! If I can get through it, so can you. You've got this.

- I'm so sorry to hear that :(I've been struggling the past 8 months too but anxiety depression and somatic OCD, it really sucks but you're not alone and if you need a friend to talk to I'm here. Take care of yourself the best you can, one day at a time. Sometimes we take steps forward and steps backward but as long as we try to be kind to ourselves even if sometimes we can't. I hope things start looking up for us all.

- You look more like the younger version of my stepdad. Which is a good thing. I can't even roast you, man. You look way too good. Hopefully, your depression in PTSD goes away soon, and feel free to text me if u like

- First, go get your mental health checkup. And afterward, life is too short to be depressed about the past. That's why it is called the past. Your future and what you make it is what counts. #mentalhealth#livelife#loveyourself# Bewell

Title: Those who suffered anxiety/depression, what are your experiences and what might one expect?

Post Text: Did meditation alone make everything fall into place?

Did it bring confidence and clarity on what you want to do?

Are everyday tasks and learning just as draining as before or is there purpose now?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Meditation played a huge part in overcoming anxiety. But I did have therapy before it and without the therapy I likely would not have dared to face my fears or it might have made it worse. What happened was that every time I meditated, I would have a panic attack. I still did it though, and by facing it and accepting it, I started to see through it, and I learned that it isn't something to be scared of, even though it feels scary.

If you are suffering from anxiety and depression to the point where it is affecting your life in a major way I recommend therapy. Meditation can then help you gain clarity once you have the framework and the tools to deal with your dysfunctional thoughts.

Title: Suffering from Anxiety/Panic Attacks. was told getting into shape would help?

Post Text: Hey so I don't know what I'm doing in the gym and I've been getting panic attacks where I can't breathe randomly... I was told by a doctor it might be panic attacks or exposure to a chemical at work causing respiratory issues

So let's assume it's panic attacks... I'm a dude who doesn't have any friends and doesn't know what he's doing in the gym... which gym and what sort of strength training/lifting program would you guys recommend? 35

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I've suffered from anxiety/depression with panic attacks for years. Doctors always told me to get some exercise and that it would help. I tried sporadically for years, but I wasn't consistent. About two years ago, I did a couch to 5k program. About a month into it, I started to notice my symptoms were improving. I've maintained a running program since, with a little time off, because I did too much too fast and had some minor injuries, and my mental health is so, so much better.

That would be a great place to start and has a very low barrier to entry. Just get a decent pair of running shoes. And give it time. It's not like a line of coke that makes you feel better right away. It takes time, but once you start to experience it, you'll be a changed person. (It also had the side benefit of causing me to think more about my diet, and I started a basic strength program to support my running.)

- [removed]

- Following

- The first thing you should do is the easy exercises like bicep curls or dumbbell benchpress:

* <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ykJmrZ5v0Oo>

* <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MciZvX7gHvY>

Also about 90% of the machines are very simple to use, even if you've never seen that machine before in your life. Just use low weights the first 2-3 visits on each machine until you feel absolutely confident in your ability to add a high amount of weight.

The most important goal is to familiarize yourself with the equipment machines. For the free-weights and bars and benches and stuff, I stick to youtube for how to do those things since they typically include important yet non-obvious info, such as pulling your shoulders together during certain chest exercises!

- I have the same issue. I don't know about getting in shape because I have reached there yet but definitely spending time at the gym, pushing my limits, and seeing small progress over time has helped immensely. Exercising can definitely help with Anxiety.

- Start with a program that focuses on doing compound lifts, they're good bang for your buck timewise and will strengthen your whole body. That said, Stronglifts 5x5 is a good beginner program that does this but there are others (look up beginner compound lift programs). It's nice because it focuses on doing 3-4 exercises per workout, which keeps it simple and lets you focus on good technique. Boostcamp is a great app for workout programs, the wiki linked by the bot is another great place to start: <https://thefitness.wiki/getting-started-with-fitness/>
- m43 it is the only REAL answer/cure



- It will actually help
- Any physical activity is helpful. Start as slowly as you have to, even if it means just going for a walk and doing some stretching and a few pushups. This has been shown in countless studies on mental health, I wish you the best
- Welcome to /r/BeginnerFitness and thank you for sharing your post! If you haven't done so already, please subscribe to this subreddit and [join our Discord](<https://discord.gg/9kajGUEDGd>). Many beginner fitness questions have already been answered in [The Fitness Wiki](<https://thefitness.wiki/>), so go give that a read as well!

I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit](/message/compose/?to=/r/beginnerfitness) if you have any questions or concerns.
 Title: I've suffered from anxiety/panic disorder my whole life and I feel like I'm constantly getting new physical symptoms. It makes me think I'm developing other problems besides anxiety.
 Does anyone else deal with this?

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Absolutely! I struggled with chest pain a lot when I got really anxious. What helped me was going to the doctor to check up on my heart to see if there was something ACTUALLY going on separate to my anxiety. I would highly recommend checking it out if you are able just for the peace of mind!!
- Honestly I wonder if my anxiety is sentient as every time I get a good grasp of a terrifying symptom it evolves and it effects me in a newly terrifying way
- Yes, and half the time I don't know if it's the anxiety (fear of pain) or actual pain. Then I feel like a hypochondriac when I get tests done and they don't find any reason for my aching. Really frustrating.
- Yuuuuup. I have fairly severe anxiety, especially centered around working, which isn't something I can stop doing at the moment. Despite medication and therapy I still have a lot of physical side effects. I'm nauseous every morning before work, leading to vomiting semi-frequently, my period will get out of sync when my anxiety gets particularly bad, and of course high heart rate. I will say that after a while of a near constant resting heart rate over 90, my psychiatrist prescribed me a blood pressure medication which has alleviated some of the stress thinking I'm about to die lol

- Absolutely. I had the worst anxiety attack of my life (so far) a couple months ago, and I genuinely thought I was going to die. Felt super dizzy/lightheaded, got really flushed and hot. My pulse was in the 150's for at least 30 minutes. I had my husband call 911 and by the time I actually got to the hospital, my symptoms were fading. Felt like an idiot but I had never had that feeling before.

- As someone else who has experience with panic disorder, I think I understand. I had BAD hypochondria for around a year because my anxiety symptoms were so bad that I didn't believe they were from anxiety. Even to this day, every once in a while I start to experience a newish symptom and worry about it, but eventually just accept it and move on. My most recent "new symptom" is a faint buzzing-feeling in my toes when I'm really anxious. That being said, I'm almost positive there is nothing wrong with me physically, as I'm in good shape, eat healthy, exercise daily, etc.

Im sorry you're dealing with this. The worst part about severe anxiety can often be not being convinced that anxiety is actually the problem. It took me a long time, but I'm finally to the point where I've accepted that anxiety symptoms can come in any form or severity, no matter how unrelated it may feel to the anxiety. I hope you find relief

- Anxiety sufferer for 20+ years here. All kinds of symptoms! And yes they shifted many many times. Once you get used to them, they go away but then reappear in another form. This kept happening until I addressed my underlying traumas and beliefs.

- Yes! My anxiety is getting better and I can even work out and run but when I had bad anxiety I had trouble breathing, chest pain, all kinds of stomach problems. And when I started thinking "something dangerous" is going on in my stomach it hurt more. I didn't have to go to the army because of the breathing trouble. It's like when I thought about my breathing it changed to manual

- Yep. Psychosomatic problems for the last 3 years. My therapist told me to repeat to my mind that anxiety is not showing me the reality and that my reality is way easier than my anxiety's view. It's very simple as an advice, but it helped me. Also use cold water a lot on your body

- I used to get pains in my chest/heart. When I was very young I was walking home from school which was close and one day I could barely get home due to the pain. Or heart would skip a beat. My doctor would say there was nothing wrong then in high school I managed to get an ECG which came back normal. Which would be because I wasn't having symptoms then.

I only found out recently I have anxiety and likely have always had it but was put down when little as shyness. I feel like I thought anxiety was normal life so it has been quite a revelation because it is so evident.

I tend to get a rash notably on my chest and my hands can shake.

- For years and years I thought there was something else wrong with me, and was told the whole time that it's just the anxiety talking.

Fuck no it wasn't. It was multiple sclerosis wreaking havoc on my brain. That they never bothered to scan despite going from zero to twenty panic attacks a day when I was 19.

If you truly think there is something new, insist that the doctors check. They are often blinded by diagnosis.

- yes, my anxiety physically manifests as shaking and gagging (yes, i get so anxious i just dry heave. it's humiliating).

- I also have this issue and it's turned me into quite a hypochondriac. I've gotten eczema, stomach ulcers, heart palpitations, and hair loss just from anxiety. I monitor any and every symptom I have because I'm afraid that I'm developing something. I have to dig myself out of the rabbit hole sometimes... all the time... but I just remind myself that the symptoms are only a physical manifestation of my anxiety. And they were confirmed by a doctor :)

- I have other health issues, chief among them is Chronic Migraine Disorder, making my three major diagnoses General Anxiety Disorder, Clinical Depression and Chronic Migraine Disorder.

Sometimes I wake up with a rash on half my face, sometimes my hands tremor so badly I can't brush my teeth without making a mess, sometimes I feel like I can't catch my breath, sometimes I feel super low energy and sometimes I feel almost manic (I'm not just feels that way). Some days I see the doctor and my BP is insane, some days I visit and everything is normal.

All of this to say, every body (literally like the physical thing) is different. Who's to say if my random face rash is from my migraine meds or maybe it's an autoimmune disorder or a hormonal thing, literally there's just no 100% fool proof way of determining exactly what is happening and why inside of you. That's stressful as fuck, especially to anyone with GAD who needs information to control their brain from spiraling out...

Maybe the best advice I ever got from a doctor, kind of a gruff neurologist, when I asked why he thought I was having these symptoms said "Who cares why, no one knows why, that's why you're here. If it was easy your other doctors would have told you but now you're here, and I'm telling you you may not ever know, but you can know how to move forward with it." - At first I was frustrated by him but soon came to realize just how right he actually was & is.

If the body were as simple as $X+Y=Z$ then we wouldn't need doctors and specialists. Sometimes your body just does things and it's not like on a TV show where some eidetic genius is going to find some crazy underlying cause. Sometimes we just have weird shit happening and it's best to note it, acknowledge it, then figure out how to move around it.

Probably not the answer you were hoping for but it's really the truth.

- Body pains do manifest from anxiety and stress. 3 parts of anxiety is

1) intolerance to uncertainty (feeling the need to get physical hence problems check JUST INCASE somethings wrong)

2) perfectionism (makes you think you're developing other problems and that your not perfect; when actually you're human and everyone who experiences severe anxiety gets these physical symptoms at times)

3) over responsibility (wanting to always deal with everything that comes up instead of focusing what we can actually control (diet, nutrition, exercise, mindfulness practices, being in nature) everything that makes your anxiety less.

I've been speaking to a psychologist who helped me with techniques to stay present and work through anxiety issues; and after I also went to get my heart checked and confirmed that I have no heart issues; the psychologist sessions have helped me eliminate chest pains .

At one point I almost went for a carpal tunnel syndrome operation due to pains in my wrists and fingers being so sore I could hardly use them. after a diagnosis confirmed I couldn't have arthritis. I wasn't happy with the carpal tunnel diagnosis I asked for an alternative.

Went to physiotherapist who specialised in pain management who confirmed the pain was caused by neurological issues. Basically my nerves were "shot" due to stress buildup and anxiety. I needed a massage to release a knot in my shoulders caused by anxiety and stress that had manifested into a knot. Body pains, wrist pains and all pains were gone within a month. Physio specialised in pain management and was able to tell me that I needed to speak to a psychologist about past anxiety because my nerves were tense.

Since understanding how anxiety can manifest in physical pain and learning nerve stretches from a physio, I have no physical pains anymore.

Knowing my physical body is fine, it's actually just my nerves that are being overly tense due to stress and anxiety means my "monkey mind" can't hijack me anymore and make think that something bigger is wrong.

A really helpful book that helped me understand this is DONT FEED THE MONKEY MIND.

Now I can spot when it's my Monkey mind creating the anxiety and hijacking's my thoughts and feelings; and that allows me to say "thanks Monkey mind, but I'm safe don't worry" and then I can be present and play with my dogs or daughter and be in the moment again.

Hope this helps you OP

(Edit: I've also eliminated caffeine from my diet and changed diet to focus on Gut health (more yogurt, oats, fish in my diet etc). Mind gut connection plays a role with Anxiety too. That seems to help as well. You will see that people in tropical regions who eat more fish and unprocessed fruits and veg have less anxiety and depression. Junk food can sometimes give immediate comfort but push anxiety higher in the long run)

- Absolutely. For the last 6 months I've been obsessing over thinking that I may actually have ADHD. I feel like I have many of the symptoms. I've been diagnosed with general anxiety and long term mild depression and I know that ADHD is often misdiagnosed early as anxiety and depression. I hyperfixate on hobbies/ideas/beliefs for a few weeks or months and then move onto the next thing. I try to organise my daily life with journals and to do lists but as soon as they are out of sight I immediately forget about them. I get overwhelmed very easily. I get socially exhausted after a few hours and need a few peaceful days to recover. I rewatch tv shows I like again and again because I feel comforted knowing how it's going to end. I'm a teacher so I need

to have my daily and monthly plan on my desk in clear view otherwise I get an overwhelming sense of panic that I don't know what's going on. I can't sit still through a film or something, I often twiddle my hair or chew my fingers. I did those stupid online tests that all say I've likely got ADHD... I tick most boxes until I read that in the DSM5 (the diagnostic manual), ADHD will only be diagnosed if several symptoms were present before age 12. I can only remember being depressed between ages 10 and 12 and was not diagnosed with anything at that age. Anyway, after all that for six months I came to realise that it was just another hyperfixation and it is likely caused by my anxiety. I wonder what else anxiety will convince me is wrong with me?

- 1000%. When I first developed panic disorder I became essentially non-functional in a matter of weeks. I couldn't believe all of those symptoms could stem from a mental disorder, and I had been dealing with depression for well over a decade at that point. Tunnel vision, racing heart rate, tingling and sweating hands and feet, shaking - and that's just the stuff during the active panic attacks. The rest of the time I had extreme fatigue, muscle weakness, insomnia, had to pee all the time, dry mouth, you name it.

The worst part is that it builds on itself, so if I feel shitty due to my anxiety it will only cause the anxiety to spike and trigger more symptoms. It's a vicious cycle, but it can be broken!

- I struggle with chest tightness everyday other than anxiety i have nose allergies and it really sucks i got so anxious when i go outside you need to try reducing drinks contain caffeine and white sugar to reduce the anxiety

- Mistrust in the body and perceived physical symptoms can be a sign of agoraphobia (however I'm sure it's comorbid with other phobias as well). I have agoraphobia and I used to panic a lot that I'm having a heart attack. There were a lot of unnecessary ER visits. Instead of indulging in physical checkups, which can worsen your phobias, I'd recommend behavioural therapy. Helped me a ton.

- Yes I used to suffer from this significantly but have learned how to manage it over time. It still flares up on occasion. I used to get real physical pains and issues that were 100% caused by mind. They seemed as real as day and my logical brain refused to believe it was in my mind.

Unfortunately there's no quick fix to this issue but speaking to a therapist is definitely your best option long term as they can teach you coping mechanisms and how to manage it. It was a therapist I saw that got me passed it.

If you're struggling right now I suggest trying to identifying some invisible triggers that make it worse, notably googling symptoms was my trigger. I'd get a symptom, Google it, read some horrible illness and my brain would start recreating those triggers and you end up in a cycle.

It's very difficult but if you find yourself doing something that you notice adds to your anxiety then try and cut it out for at least one week, ideally longer and see if it improves your anxiety.

Best of luck

- I guess the best course of action would be to go to a doctor/therapist. Any mental health situation that is the best call

- I've dealt with this for two years, for me it's all anxiety. What helps me is just continue to live and once you continue to do that all of sudden the symptoms go away. Lots of self care and going on walks helped me.
- What's your caffeine intake like? How about your chocolate consumption? It sounds stupid as fuck, but if I have any caffeine or chocolate, it makes my physical symptoms from anxiety significantly worse. And I mean *significantly.* It sucks balls though. I'm a chocolate hound and I love a cup of coffee every now and then. But it just isn't worth it.
- 90% of my week I live with chronic shortness of breath in which fluctuates my brain fog and other mental symptoms of my anxiety.
- I second this. When I'm anxious I can't eat anything. I, then, have to survive on liquids. Yesterday I shifted to Mumbai from Delhi for my pg course and will be living alone for the next 10 months. Food is such a big problem in this city and my anxiety is at all time high. I've already had episodes where I was unable to eat and just wanted to puke but I had my dad with me. What will I do once he leaves for Delhi? I have no idea. Wish me luck!
- I had the shingles about a decade ago from relentless GAD...I didn't even know it but extreme stress "awakens" the shingles virus that stays dormant at your nerve endings (if you've had chicken pox)
- I just wanted to drop a comment to let you know you are not alone! I too feel this exact same way and reading all of these replies calms me down a bit knowing I'm not the only one aha. I have gotten multiple tests, scans, you name it. Every single time it all comes back clear but I still can't help but fear somethings wrong when a new symptom randomly pops up. It's a difficult and long road ahead but as long as you push through it and reassure yourself you're fine, you'll come to realize it really is just anxiety after all. Even if you feel like anxiety can't cause these symptoms, they do. If you're really in doubt get them checked out but everytime I get tests done I'm shocked at how it turns out to be nothing more than anxiety. Best wishes !
- Anxiety is commonly associated with gut issues. :(
- this sucks so much I can relate so much with you lately i've been getting numbness on my left side of face and left arm 🙄 I don't want to go to er because I know I was told anxiety and my heart is fine i'm just so afraid of heart attack
- Yes. Anxiety can cause physical symptoms to appear as it's so powerful. It can keep you from sleeping, eating, and even just living your life at times and it can make you physically ill. I get nauseous and start shatting myself if anxious for a long time with no break at all.

Also I had heart stuff like chest pain and felt like I was having a heart attack. Went and got an EKG and NOTHING showed up. I also get regular palpitations.

- Yup. Health anxiety

- Yes I've had headaches, chest pain, "asthma", and severe IBS. My anxiety manifests in very physical ways

Title: Anyone suffering with long term anxiety physical symptoms?

Post Text: Anyone that has generally got their anxiety under control but still continue to Feel the physical effects of anxiety? And what have those symptoms been like?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Off dizzy sensation when walking. Feels almost like I'm buzzed. Doesn't occur when I'm sitting or laying. Got tested for everything. It's anxiety. Spikes either I go through anxious periods. Calms when I'm not thinking about it.
- Dizziness, DPDR, feel like I'm going crazy, memory issues, shakiness, chest pressure, shortness of breath, etc etc. slowly improving and I know in my head that it's anxiety but it sucks none the less.
- Yes but I still refute anxiety is the cause.

I suffer from dizziness and vertigo daily, been diagnosed with vestibular migraine but told the anxiety is largely my main cause of my dizziness.

I refute this, IMO the dizzy feeling comes first then the anxiety kicks in. The professionals claim the anxiety largely causes the dizziness. Which I refute.

I mean I lost my job over these symptoms and the symptoms persisted despite being on an SSRI

- I feel like I'm working towards having my anxiety under control not as much googling, not as much worrying and accepting that I have anxiety in the moment when it comes on. But I still have chest pains, and dizziness when it's bad plus a lack of energy
- You're going to hear 1001 different symptoms. It affects everyone differently and when you suffer long term they all rotate depending on which symptoms you focus on and pay attention to. Good news is the faster you realize they are harmless and allow them to happen without fear of them the faster they will leave and your anxiety will go away. I suffered for 26 years and then one day I woke up and said fck you anxiety do your worst! "Oh I feel dizzy make it worse anxiety make me fall over". "Oh my stomach feels upset cmon anxiety really make me throw up all over the place (preferably near that guy at work here that I hate) that would be funny to see him gag at watching me puke. After I decided to become the hunter not the hunted a few months later I woke up and it was gone
- I was dizzy, heavy breathing, ringing ears, heavy heart beating, tired and depressed, muscle spasms, eye twitching and more. About every day 24/7 for 5 years until I started zoloft. 4 months on zoloft and all physical symptoms went away.

Been 3 months off zoloft now and still fine. Occasional anxiety spikes but a few puffs of weed takes it away immediately. Not advocating drug use but weed is fantastic for anxiety in my case.

- Constant yawning, teeth grinding/jaw clenching, jaw cramps, teeth pain (cleared by dentist) neck cramps, shooting pain down my arms, rib pain and chest pain from tension and always hyperventilating (cleared by xray), tingling limbs, itchy skin, sores and lesions from always picking my skin, seasonal allergy's worsened, acid reflux, stomach pains, on and off diarrhea and constipation, throat tightness, tickle in throat, sensation of something stuck in throat, sensation of my tongue swelling (it's not really), visual snow, heart palpitations, there's so much anxiety symptoms that I probably haven't even listed them all.

I was prescribed lexapro but my health anxiety is so bad that I'm scared to take it for fear of side effects. I tried one pill but I'm terrified to commit.

- I have anxiety that comes and goes as "seasons," I call them. I'll go long stretches of time where it's very manageable and other stretches where I become less functional. Even during the manageable times, I always find myself dealing with random dizziness.

Title: Do you think empaths in general suffer/have more anxiety by nature of being an empath?

Post Text: Because I had to learn the emotions around me growing up at all times in order to survive it has made/forced me into empath. However, it's pretty much the main reason I suffer with anxiety, I'm picking up on so many people's anger, anxiety, stress, emotions, and I sometimes make up with wild scenarios in my head which turn out to be true or idk if they are true but they could be - something like my coworkers walks in mad and I remember I did sometime that might of annoyed them and instantly I am like crap it's from my email and they aren't quiet because of me. Etc. and I'll go on for hours days night thinking and overthinking this - sometimes I'm right and sometimes I'll never know.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Yes!

Here is my take: Many empaths have roots in CPTSD and hyper vigilance. Which came first? Who knows? I hypothesize that hypersensitivity puts an empath at elevated risk of CPTSD and there's some research from Harvard that supports the notion of a 'trauma' gene.

Now take that highly sensitive person and pair them with someone that's got autism or a personality disorder where all of the micro-expressions or lack-there-of send constant conflicting messages to the empath. It fries our nervous system....

That said, if you are around other empaths or emotionally safe people, then there's far less reason for anxiousness. I definitely lean anxiously all the time but with a good trusting partner that's consistent and expressive, my anxiety is greatly reduced.

- I think most of mine is external. I do feel very calm in calm spaces when not surrounded by people who seem stressed out.

I usually wondered if I was in an empty island, would I feel stressed? Probably not. I'm normally really care-free - even about my own things

- Every empath I've met seem to have anxiety issues, I put it down to our profound ability to sense others emotions deeply which does affect us, also picking up on others energies including environment energies, it can/does get overwhelming at times, anxiety alone can teach us about situations if we reflect long enough on it..

- Hey! I know exactly what you mean. I was telling someone else about this and I've only recently discovered it. I really hate upsetting people it really, really effects me, conflict with anyone BECAUSE of me causes me intense anxiety. So I often end up taking 100% responsibility and convincing myself it's all my fault when the reality is complex and just apologising profusely which can potentially lose you the respect of other people. We have to stand our ground, apologise and understand the things we did do wrong but also where it wasn't our fault. Particularly in relation to what you said, realise not everyone is mad at you because of

you, i definitely have that and think what have I done? People have all sorts of stuff going in their life and we can care about how they feel and as empaths, feel it but it doesn't mean we should assume it was us that caused them to be like that! Sending hugs to all who want them.

- No. I feel zero anxiety whatsoever. Every negative about me has flipped into a positive. Even my worst flaw, stubbornness, flipped to indomitability.

This should not make you feel worse in any way. Except perhaps at first, when that first debt comes due and you realize who you owe. That one hurts. From there? You make those things right and continue loudly ascending after.

- I definitely do and have dealt with it my whole life. Both my parents have anxiety and my dad numbs it with alcohol. I think sometimes it's written in our DNA...

Title: Health anxiety. Are you afraid of death or pain?

Post Text: I've struggled with health anxiety since I was a kid. I have always been very sensitive to sensations, symptoms in my body. And it's literally destroying my life

Now I'm in therapy and I've realized that I'm not afraid of death itself, but of suffering, pain, incurability, disability. That's why the methods of the acceptance of death don't work with me.

****I wonder if there are others like me here. What has helped you in such a case?***

Now my nervous system is exhausted to the point where I'm actually getting sick. I have persistent muscle twitching, digestive problems, all kinds of vague nerve symptoms, weight loss and depression. And I just can't get out of this cycle: I can't calm down to feel better... just can't.

Though I am quite aware of the reasons for my condition. From 6 to 16 y.o., I watched my grandmother die very slowly in my apartment. I saw the stroke, the consequences, the cancer, the gangrene, the incredible suffering of someone who could not be helped.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- health anxiety is such a burden some people don't understand how bad it really is. Everytime I get an ache, pain, sore. "Do i have a disease? Am I dying? Maybe i have a brain tumor/heart attack/illness". I'm afraid of death and i stand with you. You aren't alone♥
- Radical acceptance therapy. Not for everyone but it's helped me.
- I've got some chronic health issues that have led to a lot of health anxiety, so I totally sympathize with what you're going through. The worst is when your anxiety about the symptoms makes you hyperaware of those symptoms, and then it all just snowballs out of control.

I have had some success with radical acceptance techniques, specifically focusing on the idea that I don't need to "fix" what I'm experiencing to protect myself from something worse. A lot of my anxiety comes not from actual pain I'm experiencing, but from my fear that that pain will increase. I use a lot of positive self-talk to remind myself this isn't the case. "Okay, my stomach hurts. That's unpleasant, but I can handle it. I have felt worse than this before and had nothing bad come of it. I am probably not going to throw up. If I do throw up, that will suck, but I will

handle it. But probably that is not going to happen." I focus on staying calm and just riding through discomfort, rather than letting my brain run away catastrophizing.

- We see millions of people die everyday. Have you ever thought about how does the person feel while dying and the end of life suffering. This gives me depression because I was talking to someone and he raised a point that life is not like a laptop or a smartphone which you can power off or shutdown by pressing the power button. If it is it will give some relieve. He raised the point that some people die by accidents, drowned, cancer, heart attacks, burned and the list continues. Its always tragic and comes with pain...

so I was just stuck in that thought everyday just thinks about how painful it will be or which event will going to happen with me. which just give me pain in the present moment. Creating painful thoughts and stuff which just ruin the pleasure of life and changed my viewpoint on it..

- Honestly I feel the same. Lately for some reason I think something is wrong with me causing me to go into a complete panic. I've been to the ER 4 times and they tell me I'm fine and to follow up with a doctor. But I've been having so many panic attacks it's getting to the point where I'm afraid to fall asleep.

It always starts with me getting some weird pain. Then my anxiety kicks in causing me to feel other pains that probably are cause by anxiety. Then I start immediately thinking about dying. And that sends me in a spiral. I think about how I'm wasting my life. How pointless life is cause one day we just fall over dead and peoples lives will just move on. And then full panic mode sets in. I've always used smoking weed to help but I just turned 30 and smoking now just makes my panic attacks worse or even triggers them, which sucks cause I have ADHD, depression, and anxiety and weed was the 1 thing that helped.

I guess I'm posting this cause I feel like I'm not alone. Well... I hope I'm not alone. Panic attacks and disorders suck. And I wish there was an easy answer, but for me I have no insurance so I can't afford treatments or seeing specialists. But me reading this thread helps me get some type of clarity in knowing I'm not the only one that feels like this.

- To be very honest the person himself knows what he/she is fearing of which is death...

Anxiety = danger alert (and what's the most dangerous and scary thing can happen is death)

why people in health anxiety are in too much worry so something bad will not happen to them they will catch it early or if they fail all they have in mind is DEATH...

for all those who have health anxiety or GAD other than some phobias just have to accept that one day sooner or later they have to embrace it either they are in panic or not...

so let say if a person has 365 days left its your choice to either enjoy the 360 days and keep that worry for 5 days or keep that worry for all 356 days and have a miserable life. Because whatever will happen is surely gonna happen your anxiety and worry cant change it...

i know its easy to say that but it is what it is life is uncertain and mysterious

- I'm afraid of dying young and not living my life to the fullest. But with health anxiety or general anxiety, I feel like I am already cutting my life short. It's torture

- I have a very similar problem when it comes to having health anxieties. I am way too in tune with my body to the point that any slight discomfort or thing that seems off sends me into a panic. It's gotten worse since I had my first kid 6 months ago. My father also died 2 days after I had him so I think I'm just extra afraid to die. I'm too young.. & now I have so much to live for. I'm afraid to drive now too even though I do drive every day, it's just another added anxiety although I know that's kinda irrelevant. I just also fear dying in a car accident. My biggest fear is something happening in my brain or something unknowingly. Any headache or pain in my neck just makes me crazy. I try so hard to remind myself that the worry only makes it worse & everything is out of my control but it still sucks big time.

- I'm really going through it right now and I'm extremely afraid to die because I have a toddler. My health anxiety was bad before but now that I have a kid it's a million times worse. I just keep imagining myself dying and him growing up without a mother.

- That's very common for people with health anxiety. Worry and fear about your body supersedes all the other sources of anxiety in your life. It should be dealt with separately from ordinary anxiety. Avoid wrapping up your health anxiety with the other sources of grief and anxiety in your life. When people say anxiety they think both sources of anxiety are one in the same. Avoid doing that so as not to turn those into triggers. Your real anxiety is about your body. The other things that bother you are just triggers. I overcame health anxiety many years ago. Rest assured, you are safe. They did a huge long term study on people with panic disorder and not one had a heart attack, died, or even fainted. The trick is not to struggle with it, as hard as that is. Give yourself time and don't get too worked up about it. That's the secret right there. At least don't struggle with it the rest of the time when you aren't getting symptoms and it's easier. This is about symptoms, not life anxiety if you have health anxiety. It's not about your nervous system or your body, though you certainly activate it with your own what if thoughts. Don't struggle with those what if thoughts either. Let them fade on by. I had thousands of panic attacks starting in the late 80's and through the 90's. I'm still here at 66. All that worry for nothing. It's not going to go away overnight. It's become an automatic response for your mind and body. The way out is not to do anything to MAKE it go away, it's to gradually let go to LET it go away. Don't get frustrated if it comes back. Remember, it's hard wired into you, but it's not a real medical condition even though it has a very physical outcome. Therapy and taking care of your body are necessary but secondary. Don't get too wrapped in those two. You got this. By grasping this concept and sticking to your guns you will come out way stronger than any mere mortal. In my mind, those of us who have overcome health anxiety are an elite bunch. It'll all look totally different once you make it to the other side. Congratulations in advance.

- I don't want to die young... well youngish! I have a lot of things I'd like to do before I croak it.

It's the way I die that terrifies me, I saw my grandad pass from cancer almost 30 years ago. It stuck with me and that's what drives my health anxiety, I do not want to die like he did.

- I feel this. I hate even going to the doctor or dentist because of fear. I do it begrudgingly. I'm not sure how I'd deal with some terrible diagnosis, knowing that pain and unknown agony may be coming. They say that the actual dying part is peaceful, according to people who have lived through it. But, what is it like to waste away in a low income nursing home, or any nursing home? What does a terrible heart attack feel like? Would my anxiety end up killing me by making it worse? All of these things I've seen people close to me die from. My cousin had ALS.

I don't know what to say because I feel it too. I guess once the shoe finally drops, you know what you have to fight. You know what you have to concentrate on. But the unknown can eat you alive. My 12 step program has helped me deal with rumination on stuff like this. Ask your higher power, whatever that is, to help calm you. Meditation helps.

- I have severe anxiety(both health and general) depression, and ocd. Accepting death doesn't help. Letting go of any expectations helps a little. Trying to be easy on myself and steer through things. Have motivation to beat anxiety lets see where it goes.

- Afraid of both, but slightly more afraid of death. I, too, have had this anxiety for as long as I can remember. I can't even take a new medication without panicking that I'm going to have an anaphylactic reaction. I jump to worst-case-scenario every time I have an ache or "weird feeling". I also witnessed immediate family members suffer with significant/terminal health issues. The weight of everything I've witnessed/experienced/gone through and the constant daily anxiety is heavy and exhausting.

- I'm terrified of dying and never seeing my family ever again when I die. Also, it's a matter of how I die (Pain? Suffering? Will I get to say goodbye to those I love?) I'm well aware this is something I have absolutely no control over but it's overwhelming at times. I manage with medication, therapy, and doing things that bring me joy..

- I have health anxiety and its ruining my life, my family just don't understand, they just think I'm stupid....I'm so sad and unhappy but I don't know what to do

- The irony isn't lost on me. Here I am, a health nut who prioritizes kale smoothies and eight hours of sleep, constantly plagued by the fear of, well, everything being wrong with my health. It's not a fear of death itself, more like a terror of a slow, lingering illness that steals my vibrancy piece by piece.

It creeps in subtly. A dull ache in my shoulder morphs into a potential rotator cuff tear in my mind. A random bout of dizziness becomes a symptom of some obscure inner ear disorder I unearth on a late-night Wikipedia dive. It's a constant game of "what if," a mental pinball machine bouncing between worst-case scenarios.

The worst offender? The internet. It's both a blessing and a curse. A simple search for "fatigue" transforms into a rabbit hole of potential diagnoses, each one more terrifying than the last. Suddenly, every cough, every sneeze becomes a potential harbinger of doom.

Social life? It suffers. Invites to weekend hikes or crowded bars send shivers down my spine. The thought of being in close quarters with a petri dish of germs sends me scrambling for excuses. It's a lonely prison I've built around myself, all out of fear.

This constant state of hypervigilance is exhausting. I'm missing out on life, the good and the bad, while I'm busy freaking out about the maybe's. So, I'm fighting back.

It's a slow process, like chipping away at a stubborn rock. I'm replacing endless internet searches with actual doctor visits. Talking to a professional, someone who can separate fact from fiction, has been a game-changer. Health anxiety might always be a part of me, a nagging voice in the back of my head. But it doesn't have to control me. I'm learning to manage it, to

appreciate the strength and resilience of my body. Because hey, even a hypochondriac deserves to enjoy a damn kale smoothie without picturing the potential E. coli lurking within. Baby steps, right?

- I have the exact same issue, it's been awful for about a month or 2 and it made me incredibly depressed for about a week. My health anxiety was never bad but it just started getting worse after I had a bad reaction to something I ate. Thinking about it over the last month or 2 I'm not really afraid of death, I'm afraid of being in pain or some sort of discomfort and it just doesn't end, or doesn't seem to end. I'm also hyperaware of everything constantly, which never makes anything better.

Title: JYP Entertainment reveals that Mina is currently suffering from Anxiety Disorder + announces that Mina's participation in the September comeback will be decided by her and the members

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- >Hello, this is JYPE.

>

>This is an update on that status of Mina's health.

>

>Multiple professional medical institutions have diagnosed Mina's health condition as Anxiety Disorder.

>

>The main symptom of Anxiety Disorder is continuous or intermittent extreme anxiety, with levels of anxiety varying unexpectedly.

>

>Mina's participation in the schedule will be determined and decided by herself and the members based on this situation. In addition, as Mina's participation in the schedule is completely based on her objective health condition and her judgement, we ask for the fans' understanding.

>

>We will continue to do our best to help Mina recover. We ask all fans to please support and cheer her on.

Class move from JYP. I am really happy that the company is 1. letting the public know exactly what's going on and 2. letting Mina and the members decide if she will be healthy enough for this comeback. While it would definitely be sad if Mina ends up not promoting, all ONCES and non-ONCES alike should all respect her choice and cheer her on until she feels like she is ready to step onto the stage again.

- Poor girl. As a fellow anxiety victim, I am so glad she's not being forced to work when she's going through this. It's absolutely terrifying to have an anxiety attack. Nothing feels real. You question your existence and the meaning of life because you're so exhausted from being terrified of reality. It's so awful and she needs this time off.

- Well... if the only criteria for her participating is her and the rest of twice's words, then that seems like good news

They might be gauging reactions from onces, might influence their decision

edit: Does anyone else think she's probably experienced anxiety since the beginning? It's known Mina basically never leaves her bed/room on her own doing. Did we all just assume she was simply introverted and shy? :(she's just been strong for too long

edit 2: I say, and hopefully others say we should support her whether she participates or not. Just saying "we will wait" might sound like pressuring her until she is "cured" which doesn't happen. Understand if she wants to join or doesn't, support either option and don't nag at JYP to "IEt hEr rEst" if SHE wants to participate

- Won't play doctor here. I also have anxiety disorder and there are many times where I can't handle simple shit. I hope the best for her

- As someone who has had an anxiety disorder since I was a kid (I'm in my mid-twenties now), I feel for her so much. No amount of good things in your life can take away an anxiety disorder. This condition doesn't make sense unless you've experienced it because your body/mind acts as if you're in danger 24/7 and you never know when a panic attack could be triggered. I'm so grateful that medicine and therapy helped me learn how to better cope with my anxiety (I only experience like one or two panic attacks in a year), so I hope she's able to get the help that she deserves.

- Mad respect to JYP for actually addressing mental health and taking it seriously. Other companies take note

- This is definitely their way of saying that Mina likely filmed the MV + sang on all the tracks on the new album, but her participation in the promotion will be spotty. I suffer from mental health issues too, and you really can't know how you'll feel waking up each day. I hope she's focusing on herself, and am so glad that JYP respects the fans/Mina enough to tell the truth.

- honestly having anxiety disorder + being a celebrity is such a sad combination, she probably feels so conflicted about her job and her own health. I strongly wish the best for her

- poor Mina, it's awful that she has this. Anxiety disorder isn't something that can go away easily, especially since it's a mental health disorder, like there are people who have anxiety disorder their entire life and never really recover no matter if they take anti-anxiety pills or try to avoid the stimuli that causes them anxiety.

I hope Mina takes all the time she needs and doesn't feel any pressure, we ONCEs will welcome her with open arms whenever she feels ready to join her fellow members on stage again.

- I think a lot of us already suspected or knew that she was going through some sort of anxiety disorder, and this just cemented that. I'm glad she's getting care and treatment for her anxiety. Knetz are going to be brutal and hateful as ever because they're going to think it's a veiled excuse for her "leaving the group" (even though she's not).

- Thank you, JYP, for being transparent about Mina's condition and letting her decide for herself along with the help of the members if she is ready and willing to participate during their

comeback. Mental health is absolutely no joke and I'm glad that JYP is prioritizing her health above everything else. Whatever you decide Mina, please know that we love and will continue to support you no matter what!

- Props to JYPE for handling this professionally. Fortunately TWICE has 9 members so they can still deliver with 8 on a stage.

But it scares me to think that there are idols/groups out there with similar conditions who can't afford to have a member go on break. There must be idols out there where stress is grinding away at their insides, but there's enormous pressure to perform and put up a fake facade.

- JYP once again pioneering the way for being transparent and caring about the mental health of their artists, in a culture where transparency on the topic is frowned upon. What an outstanding company.

- The idol room MC used to have anxiety disorder. It took him 9 months or more of resting to be under control.

- It's surprising to see people giving JYPE props when Twice's ridiculous schedule probably contributed to her mental state. Obviously there's no details but burnout/exhaustion can lead to anxiety and I wouldn't be surprised if it was a big factor here.

- JYPE being a class-act, but it is a little weird that someone with a strong anxiety disorder would choose to go into an occupation like Stage Performers (even with her background in ballet). I guess there's the possibility that she might've overcome it through sheer exposure via kpop spotlight. Not what I would recommend though.

I hope for her recovery, and hope that ONCEs will not attack her over something as serious as Anxiety Disorder.

- Well all you can really do is echo what other people have said, JYPE are handling this really well, and you have to feel for Mina, anxiety is no joke.

When it first happened I saw a lot of people speculate that it was her leg injury that was causing her anxiety, but that was just those people showing their total misunderstanding of the condition - and maybe even some wishful thinking. A leg can be "fixed" but anxiety? She might have to bear the burden of it forever. With the right medication and coping strategies she can minimise the impact, but it will always be there.

- i just hope that if they have a comeback without her, people will stop pressuring mina by commenting "get well soon mina" on everything. i hate when fans refuse to acknowledge the negative effects their comments could have on idols' wellbeing by simply arguing that they're "real fans" or whatever.

one of the things that pisses me off the most is when people praise idols for "professionalism" after seeing them put their work before their own wellbeing. it makes me want to scream because these people are literally encouraging idols to suffer under the guise of being supportive. youtube recently recommended me an old video of mina at a fansign where a fan refused to walk away after his time was up, and the idea was that mina acted "professionally" by keeping a calm demeanor. the comments were all people praising her for not showing discomfort. that's exactly the kind of behavior that causes idols to neglect their wellbeing in

favor of their public persona and bottle up their suffering until it becomes too much to bear. it's absolutely horrible that so many people who consider themselves fans would say things like that, and the worst part is that if mina ever comes back, i imagine many people will quickly return to that pattern.

- Now that I'm seeing this confirmation of her anxiety disorder, I feel so bad for her when her Twice mates teased her and announced it to the whole world on broadcasting tv that she always locks herself in the room and refuses to go out when they invited her. Imagine how she felt at that point of time.

- Anxiety isn't fun. I didn't even know I had that shit and thought I legit had heart problems before the doctor was like "nah those are anxiety attacks"

- Anxiety disorder is very bad in the begining, she need a lot of time to understand it and accept it but once she does that the effects of the disorder will get smaller and smaller and everything will be under control.

- Anxiety is so horrible. I hope she knows fans will happily wait for her and she shouldn't rush herself if she doesn't feel ready.

- I admire how they left it up to her. Hope this sets a standard for other companies to deal with artists' mental health issues with similar patience as well.

- This isn't really a "good" or class move. It's a PR move and a power move to put the psychological pressure on Mina to come back despite the anxiety, to put all the onest on her if she decides not to comeback for September.

Now since it's "all up to her and members of Twice," she has the pressure of not wanting to let her members down knowing they are counting on her, of not wanting to let down JYP since this is what she wanted as a career and she's on top with the most popular group, of not wanting to lose popularity by being out of sight for too long, and of not wanting to let fans down or have fans turn on her.

But with the statement JYP can essentially say "we didn't force her to do anything, it was her choice" if something goes wrong or they can take credit if everything goes right. I know fans tend to look through a colored lens, but this is really just JYP covering their backside with very carefully chosen wording.

I may get downvoted but that's fine. Corporate is corporate and it helps to give a view through a corporate lens and not just a fan/bias lens.

- Im so glad JYP is putting their artists and mental health first, other companies should take notes so there will never be another situation like Jonghyun's again.

Title: At the age of 41, I have come to the realization that I have been suffering from near constant anxiety since I can remember. My gains in meditation have led me to this insight and I am just now starting to live an anxiety-free life.

Post Text: Can anyone relate? Do we have any late discoverers of their anxiety problems here? How are you getting by?

What are your thoughts?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Similar. I got to age 40. Had a major health scare, followed by a mental breakdown. Only then did I realize anxiety had been a background hum for years.

Now I'm 100% healed and calmer and happier than I have ever been in my life. I went the self-recovery route with Claire Weekes' and David Johnson's teachings after therapy failed me.

Highly recommend a mental breakdown; it gives you the chance to completely rebuild yourself so much better.

Title: To those suffering Mid-20's Depression & Anxiety: What does it feel like for you?

Post Text: Having just graduated college, I feel like I left an age of possibility and just entered an age of reality. I have this overwhelming sense that I'm not in control of my destiny. The adventure and thrill of youth are over. I'm now realizing that the rest of my life will be a constant struggle to maintain happiness.

****EDIT:**** Something to add. I can no longer bear to sign into Facebook because I hate seeing my college buddies who now have awesome lives -- great jobs, a hot girlfriend and a vibrant social life. And no, it's not that they're embellish their life on Facebook; I know for a fact that their lives are as awesome as they seem.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I would advise you to stop comparing your life to "Facebook lives", which aren't even real. Everyone's Facebook is an edited, carefully put together version of themselves with no real indication of how one's life really is, how they feel inside, what their relationships are like, etc.

I'm 24, now staring down 25 and for the first time I'm wondering where time went, feeling like everything is now just going too fast. Sometimes the weight of nostalgia for the past is too heavy to bear. Everything seems lighter, more free, back then. But I think it's important not to romanticize it too much. There are lots of things in adulthood that you couldn't have as a teen or very young adult... the ability to actually build your own life, the richness of adult relationships, money, freedom to travel, etc. I wonder if part of your concern is that you're no longer in the safe 'template' of youth (Go to school, do this, go there), and the openness of adulthood, the feeling of now being out on your own, is frightening. But that can be a good thing, too!

As for depression and anxiety specifically, people need help to deal with those. Therapists, help books, online tools...

- Your friends are doing well in certain departments because that's what they're prioritizing. You see one guy with an awesome job, another with a gorgeous wife, you think "my friends have great jobs and gorgeous wives". Well, your friend with the great job might be working 60-hours / week and not have time for anything else, and your friend with the great wife might have spent most of his free time working out, participating in clubs and other social events, in order to find someone like that, and now that they're married, you don't really know how happy they are. Your

Facebook friends aren't showing you the whole picture, because most people want to present the best image possible of themselves on Facebook -- like a high school reunion that never stops. Focus on what **you** want for yourself, and tune out all the distractions.

Also, not to say that you aren't suffering from depression and/or anxiety, but those aren't what you described. Depression is basically the absence of feeling -- your life feels flat and colorless, and you have no motivation to do anything, because nothing brings you any joy. When you're depressed, even sadness can feel like a blessing, because at least it's something other than ennui. Anxiety, at least for me, is actually more physical than "worrying". I had no idea I had anxiety until I started having shooting pains or numbness through my left arm and fingertips. Heart palpitations, back pain, headaches, nausea are also very common. Anxiety can be scary as hell, when you don't know what it is, because a person suffering from anxiety is prone to assume it's something else -- like a brain tumor, in my case -- and then the anxiety symptoms reinforce that assumption, which exacerbates the symptoms, etc. It sounds like you're having a quarter life crisis, which is perfectly normal. It happened to nearly everyone I know who graduated from college.

Finally, regarding Facebook specifically and the belief that everyone has more friends / is more successful than you are, [here](<http://www.psychologytoday.com/blog/the-scientific-fundamentalist/200911/why-your-friends-have-more-friends-you-do>) is a really interesting article published in Psychology Today from 2009. Definitely worth a read.

- Well, are we talking about depression/anxiety or bad circumstances? For me, they (it's hard to differentiate) physically feel like a pain in my stomach like I'm sick. I'm often tired, although not to the point that I can't function. Emotionally it makes it extremely hard for me to connect with people. I become very stressed about situations where I'll have to socialize "without a script," like at a bar or party. The inability to connect makes me feel very alone, which is also often boring. It makes me feel bad about the future as it's hard not to see this as continuing indefinitely in to the future. It makes me over think my interactions with other people, to feel unreasonably bad when things don't go the way I want--which is very often. It makes me want to avoid everybody and everything so I can just focus on trying not to feel so bad, which makes me miss all sorts of things, which makes me feel like I'm missing out.

Day to day it usually makes me not feel happy. Often I don't feel terrible, but I almost never feel good. It's hard to enjoy things. It's hard not to focus on the "unavoidable negatives," like friendships ending, people dying, even short term stuff like having to go to work when I don't want to. It also makes me take a very negative view of stuff like relationships, which my instinct says are doomed from the moment we start talking. That, along with almost never feeling any connection, make it very difficult to form new friendships. Again, if I don't know the "script" it's hard for me to behave in an engaging, attractive, interesting, fun way. So loneliness, if I haven't conveyed that already, is a major factor. The thought of being alone for the rest of my life is a factor.

Anyway, that's what it's like for me. [Hyperbole and a Half](<http://hyperboleandahalf.blogspot.com/2013/05/depression-part-two.html>) does, I think, a better job at explaining the sort of depression you typically hear about. More of that very, very deep depression that I don't really have.

I would recommend therapy, though, if you haven't tried it. There's a big stigma about "needing therapy," but the reality is that it's just having someone to talk to who will listen to you and try to help you figure out how to feel better. You don't have to be a total, complete mess to benefit from it. If you find you're really unhappy consider looking in to it. If money's a problem a lot of places can work with you to figure out what you can afford. I've seen it as low as \$5 a session (and free, but that's a little different).

Edit: Oh yeah, bad circumstances. In my experience bad circumstances can also add to the heap, so to speak. If you're already depressed having a friend blow you off is likely to make you feel really bad, unreasonably bad, but even if you were feeling great you'd probably be upset to have been blown off. That's a bad circumstance and it can be hard to tell if your feelings are unreasonable given the circumstances. In my case what it usually feels like is that I lack the resiliency to put myself out there. So I avoid situations I think would make me feel bad if (when, my instinct says) they went wrong, which makes me feel bad because I don't get the rewards of those things and it creates a bad situation that is depressing in and of itself.

- Hi. I know this is an AskMen thread (and the reason I come here is because I like to hear how men think and perceive their lives), but I wanted to add that mid-twenties funk is part of ~~being~~ becoming an adult, male or female. I definitely went through that around age 24-27, even though I hadn't gone to college.

I think my big let-down transformative event was the death of my father when I was 24. He and my mother were always very supportive of me, even to the point of bailing me out of situations I now realize I probably should have suffered on my own. Suddenly, all that was gone. My mother had cancer at the time, and so after the sudden death of my dad, I turned into a support system for my mother and siblings. I suddenly felt like life was bleak, hard, and would only get harder as I got older. I tried to imagine what it was like to be my mother, and it broke my heart. I grew up in a huge way, and tried to be the best daughter I could for her.

For me, at least, it got way better. Sure, it was a few dark years there, and I hastily made some choices that I thought were going to move me towards independence, but turned out just to set me back. But I learned. And I grew. And I'm at a place in my life now, at 32, where I realize that the awesomeness level of my life is determined entirely by my outlook and how I react to situations.

Yes, it *is* a constant struggle to maintain happiness. Happiness is not a permanent state of bliss that one receives if they punch in the right combination. It's a series of moments that you acknowledge in the course of your hum-drum life, and it's up to you to notice them as they pass.

In a class this year, I was shown a pretty neat documentary called ["Happy"](<http://www.imdb.com/title/tt1613092/>), and I recommend it to anyone interested in the sorts of research cognitive scientists are doing on that topic. For me, it crystallized a lot of what I already suspected about happiness.

****TL;DR**** **I'm a girl, and I think the mid-twenties depression is fairly common at that age, for anyone. Lots of changes happen in our twenties, from college to marriage to death of loved ones. After my horrible realization that life was hard and then you die, I learned that I was the author of my own happiness. It got better.**

- It feels like a weight constantly trying to pull me down and if I don't keep moving forward, it will.

Thanks to therapy I got my life in the direction that I want it to go. I still have rough patches but now I know that I have a very supportive therapist that I can talk to.

- Does 22 count?

I've been so empty and apathetic about life in general, I met a good girl, but we have a few problems, and my life is a pile of shit aside from this. But, I didn't realize I was depressed until I read that hyperbole and a half bit about depression, recently, and it hit me.

I'm a smart enough guy, decent looking, a bit out of shape, and I just hate everything. I don't know what to do, I don't know how to deal with my GF's and my problems, since we're shitty at talking about things. I don't know what to do with life.

Basically, I just don't have a fucking clue what to do. You ask what it feels like? It feels shitty. Reeeeeeeaaaaaally shitty. So, I just drink and smoke after most days, at least then life is interesting sometimes.

- Hi,

I went through this about 3 years ago. Oh wow, I didn't even realize I just passed my 3 year mark for graduation. All of my friends, and I really mean all of them, went through a depression after graduation.

For me, it felt like the world had gone dark and I was alone. I started... well... I partied harder than I had been in school. I tried to... at least but I was at a point where all my friends started to move away. Half of them were already gone by graduation and the rest left in the next year- moving all over the world- Santa Cruz especially. 0_o I even moved away (I still feel bad for my best friend stuck back home without me, I had to move for work though so... epic sigh)

The world is a terrible place. Half your paycheck goes to taxes for bullshit wars and spying on you. The cost of living keeps going up. You may be stuck living with your parents or a ton of roommates because everything is so expensive and it wouldn't really be practical to have your own place even if you could. There are murderers and rapists out there. People who will gladly steal your car or just smash in your window for your ipod and ruin an afternoon where now your

stuck on the phone with your anal insurance company. Parking tickets. Oh god. And dating... dating blows. Its so hard to find someone you like, who's pretty and smart and not totally fat and laughs at your jokes... its even harder to find someone who is all of these things and likes you back.

And even if you find her, it could turn into her cheating on you one day... or maybe she gets a job in Korea and has to leave. Or maybe she doesn't really want to be with you because you don't have a job yet...

My point is the world is a scary place. Its just you in this fight, whatever it is you're fighting. Now is the time to decide what you really want. Do you want to live in Iceland? Do you want to own your own business? Do you want to have kids in ten years? It can be daunting but the truth is that none of the choices you make right now will be set in stone. Your life will be changing constantly and you will adapt.

I wanted all of this to sound supportive but I feel like I'm talking in circles.

I support you. You will be ok. Just don't give up. You really are not alone. Say that to yourself until you believe it. You are not alone.

Furthermore, the adventure and thrill of youth probably won't be over until you're 30. And even then, at 30 you can still have adventures and thrills. I mean, do you really want your college years to be the best years of your life? or do you want to be 90 years old one day wondering which decade was best...

College was designed by other people for you. Now its up to you to design your own good times... go have fun and work hard.

- First of all; it's okay how you are feeling. There is nothing wrong with feeling the way you do. Embrace that you think about life in this way.

My next advice, being someone who deals with depression and anxiety and is 23, just out of college, is to seek out help. For me, seeing a therapist has literally changed my life. It has allowed me an outlet and also someone who actually helps me become the confident and amazing person that I am.

Her advice to me was to get out and find things to do. Think about things that interest you and go try them. Take some cooking classes, or improv or something. Don't be afraid to be alone; embrace the fact that you DO have control of some aspects of your life, including your happiness.

- I know exactly what you mean in your edit. It's sinking in more & more that I'm truly the runt of the litter.

I dropped out of college - depression left me practically unable to look after myself, to the point where I was starting to develop health problems from my rapidly declining weight. My position in

my class was also completely unworkable since I had given some offence in first year for which I was persona non grata & consequently had no help of any kind from my peers & was completely fucked if it ever came to group work (which was often).

Where I am now is that I have no possibility of ever getting regular work beyond stacking shelves & will likely be without a friend in the world by the time I'm 30 as old friends get on with things & all we have in common vanishes.

I was sad at a time (& still am from time to time) about having missed the one opportunity I had for getting any enjoyment out of life, but I become increasingly aware that there never was any opportunity at all.

- How my depression and anxiety issues feel: It's like the normal me is covered in a sticky black goo that is holding me down and darkening my life. The normal me is in here but I can't live normally. It's nice that the issues are periodic though and can take a break between bad periods.

However, I too just graduated college and have absolutely nothing lined up. No job. No place to live. No plans. I'm lucky enough to have parents that will support me for the time being. It helped me to realize that I don't need to make optimal decisions right now -- I only know what I know right now and can only make choices based on that. The jobs I apply for might not be the perfect life path but I'm just trying to do things that will make me happy and trying to not plan out further than six months or so. Just live life in the now, man :)

- I dealt with some anxiety a year and a half back. I've always had a degree of social anxiety, but I had never really suffered daily panic attacks or anything like that. I think what I really hated about it and still do look at with some disdain was how irrational it made me. After a little I realised the key to break to the cycle was to take control of my own life. I'd suggest take steps to calm yourself if you do suffer from anxiety, personally I just took a walk - cleared my mind of all troubles and just concentrated on taking in the area. As for taking control of your life - do small steps. Don't try to jump to the next floor, take the stairs.

- I am very anxious about little things, which lead me to be anxious about big things, which gets me down, which leads me to believe that I will never be free of my anxiety. Cue depression, then when I have a good day or two, something starts the anxiety and the cycle continues.

- I suffer from it from time to time. At my worst I don't take care of myself at all. Like so bad if something is not right with my body I just leave it. I become disconnected from this world. I start to think that i wouldnt care if I would die or i think all day about killing myself. I dont give myself any credit for anything. I cry myself to sleep. Have panic attacks when I wake up for work. I also dont talk much at work and struggle through the day and normally get stressed out easily. I look at myself in the mirror and look how skinny I am and really get disgusted at how I look.

Its horrible because I worry about the future so much and keep telling myself that I'm not a good enough person. I'm getting better now though, with the help of a therapist. Hopefully over time I get my self confidence back and maybe find a nice lady to spend my life with :)

- I just turned 23 and still have one more year of college to go. When I think about that it makes me feel like a loser but then when I think about how I'll be a lot better off than my friends

because I didn't choose a shitty major and work my ass off I feel a little bit better. Right now I feel like I'm on the brink of big changes. Next year I should be moving out and finally starting the bachelor stage of my life. Until then though it's like purgatory. Combine this with the fact that I've always had psychological issues and you start to get an even better picture. Good news is I've started exercising and I'll be seeing a therapist next month.

- I hit this pretty hard but I hit it early. I'm 23 and can say that (for now) I'm out of the woods. I went through it at the end of highschool, I was a straight A student and I basically went off the deep end, realizing that it had all just been this big push...do well in highschool so you can go to a good college so you can get a good job so you can make enough money so you can get a nice house so you can marry a nice person so you can have a nice family so you can live a nice life so you can be happy. I realized it was all someone else's dreams and I was tied on a treadmill running after them getting nowhere for ME. I took some time off, toured across the country with a band, had my first relationship, got my heart broken, learned a lot, changed my college and major a bunch of times until I found something I truly loved, stumbled into a tiny part time job where I met my amazing boss who is like Buddha, and I really broke out of that depression and mold I'd felt trapped in.

It was like I was looking at the other side of the moon. It had been there all along but I was so focused on the darkness on the shadow side that I completely overlooked the brilliance of the bright side of the moon. Before, I saw it as this suffocating world you had to fit into or be left behind. There were so many worries and complications like bills, insurance, taxes, retirement, doctors visits, health, exercise, hobbies, relationship drama, family drama, my god it is unending! You feel like you have to fight tooth and nail for every ounce of joy!

But my boss is this wisened old man who helped me realize life is insane, society is insane, people are often times insane, and the only way to find happiness is to throw your hands up and let the current take you. Learn to love the insanity. Find humor everywhere you look, find beauty in the smallest moments and most insignificant things. It's hard to put into words, and especially in only a few words, but I promise you the mid 20's depression is just the dark before dawn, and it's a sign that you're asking the questions whose answers you will use to define yourself, your outlook, and your life going forward. You're in a period of self discovery, and all I can say is that you should push yourself to do something new that pushes your boundaries. Doing the same thing every day is like being back on that treadmill, you feel busy and tired but you're going nowhere. Once you try something new, you're rolling the dice of possibility in your life and making room for new people, experiences, and opportunities that you couldn't have planned for but were out there waiting for you to reach for them. So much of my life and myself is a direct result of random, unplanned, whims and adventures that lead me to exactly what I needed at the time.

Be brave. Life is an adventure and you're an explorer. I still get overwhelmed, trust me. Life can be really, really complicated. But honestly just try to block it out and appreciate the little things like how good your in n out burger tastes, or how funny that gif was, or that cute girl at starbucks you see sometimes. I'm so not doing this justice right now, for all these lines I've written...but hang in there. Life doesn't change, but the way we see it does.

****TL;DR:** everyone i know is long since graduated with fancy shmancy jobs and I'm still in college because I changed my mind until I found my passion. But you have to step back and realize you're on the right track for YOU. You are exactly where you need to be, even if it seems like a shitty place from where you're standing, you WILL come out of it a stronger, better, wiser person. Don't worry about others; a lot of them are pursuing dreams other people convinced them to follow (beautiful wife, expensive car, ritzy house, high paying job) but plenty of them are trying to convince themselves they are happy. I know a lot of people who've made it to the top, and the higher up you go, the worse it gets. Be thankful for your simple life and revel in it's simple pleasures. You don't need a 100k/yr salary to live a rich life. Find out who YOU are and what YOU love and reach for it.**

- I've had depression for as long as I can remember. I have had maybe one month where I was honestly happy and hopeful about my own future.

It is just kinda miserable, plodding along in life. I have wanted to die repeatedly, but I normally just freeze up when that happens. Really, for the most part, I just feel like I have no motivation or ambition. Getting up and feeding myself is as tedious task that I don't bother with sometimes.

- I think things have changed dramatically in terms of how much promise college holds any more. When we were kids, there was actual promise behind getting a college education, which justified the cost and time to go through college. Now, the costs have skyrocketed, and you don't have a whole lot of options when you're fresh out of college unless you're in certain fields, and many of those are more related to the new "tech schools" that are out there.

Because of that, it creates an even greater level of uncertainty, when you thought that's what you were working to avoid by being in college. I haven't talked to anyone regarding that mid-20s depression and anxiety, but I really went through a heavy stint of it, especially when I was still dealing with terrible relationships on top of trying to find a good place to work.

I will definitely say the Facebook nonsense makes everything worse. NO ONE'S life is as good as they try to make it on Facebook, that's part of the issue.

I got that feeling that I will never catch up, and things kept going wrong. It's part of it, and you have to really push through and not quit. It is extremely difficult sometimes, and I was fortunate to have my wife to support and help me, but my family was a good support system as well.

Happiness should not be gauged based on how successful your life is compared to others. It should be gauged on how happy you are with YOUR life. If you aren't happy, you can always make adjustments and changes to make it what you want, you just have to be willing to put in the effort, and it's totally worth it. I know exercising (I play soccer and run with my wife) has actually helped me a lot more than I thought it would. Just having an outlet will do wonders for you. Find and keep a hobby you enjoy, are good at, and can afford. The little successes from those help you to build on for bigger things in your life.

- It feels just like my mid-teens depression and anxiety, but now I'm a lot more social.

- For those suffering mid-twenties depression - lighten the fuck up. I'm 54, I'd give anything and everything I have to be 24 again if it meant being broke, unemployed and homeless.

This is your one and only life, stop feeling sorry for yourself and get out there and enjoy it.

Title: r/unpopularopinion turns into a chaotic warzone when it is suggested to increase the legal age to star in porn to 21 from 18. "Sacred act of sex sponsored by al Qaeda", ethical porn is an oxymoron and many more.

Post Text: I kid you not when I say a shitstorm of such levels is exquisite, it sits at 44k upvotes with a 66% upvote ratio, and it is obviously from not following the rules of upvote which you disagree with and downvotes ones you agree it.

Nofap enjoyer*

Comments Related to Mental Health:

Title: Women are more likely to experience mental illness than men—where's our spotlight? Where's the posts and articles asking parents to pay more attention to their girls' mental health?

Post Text: I'm sure we've all seen posts that talk about how girls are more coddled and guided by their parents than boys, which leads boys to experience more mental illness. The post that I specifically saw said something like "when my nephew was younger, my sister said boys need less help than girls; now, my nephew is about to go into the psych ward. Please pay attention to male mental health". There are also numerous mainstream articles about the same topic.

The problem is that boys and men are less likely to experience mental illness than girls and women. 25.8% of American women have a mental illness, while 15.8% of men do. Women are twice as likely to have depression, more likely to have anxiety, more likely to self-harm, and more likely to attempt suicide. I understand men are less likely to seek help, but that doesn't explain the discrepancy.

I'm not trying to invalidate male mental health struggles. Men are more likely to experience psychosis and substance abuse. If you want to talk about a mental health crisis among boys and men, yes, absolutely, talk about how they are more likely to externalize their pain, to engage in antisocial behavior, and to struggle with substance abuse.

The problem I have is the way that a female mental health crisis is being ignored, and it's reflective of the way women's issues aren't treated as mainstream issues, while men's issues are. Women are much more prone to internalizing their emotions—why aren't there calls to teach girls coping skills? Female mental illness is often trivialized and written off as attention-seeking, while this exact characterization generally doesn't happen with male mental illness. So many women are struggling with mental illness, but general society doesn't seem to care.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I have only heard about how men have it so much worse re: mental health on Reddit and they frequently emphasise completed suicides and homelessness.

Meanwhile conditions like ADHD or autism continue to be under-diagnosed in women and girls. Eating disorders and disordered eating are also rampant. Anorexia nervosa has the highest mortality rate of mental illnesses and 90% of the sufferers are female.

- It really depends on the mental illness, for example some people are in denial that men can have EDs while others don't think women can have autism. Mens mental health is in general a bit more stigmatized, because they're taught not to cry and to bottle up emotions their unalive rates are also higher. On the other hand are disorders like ADHD and autism much rarer to be diagnosed in women, because of the stereotypes.

Title: Why are women with trauma or mental health issues considered "baggage"?

Post Text: I've just heard/read this sentiment too many times. When a woman has trauma, she's "too much", especially if she has sexual trauma. A lot of men avoid dating women who have never been treated right by past partners, it even used to be a meme at one point. Or if a woman has mental health issues, she's considered emotional baggage. Why are women constantly expected to be stable, perfect, always happy, always smiling, always cheerful, always pleasant?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- If a man has a lot of baggage, that's something I can't handle either. I think people in general are uncomfortable with mental health issues. (I find other people's mental health issues to be triggering for my own ones, so I find I start to spiral if I have to deal with it too much.)

- Especially when men with trauma/poor mental health/personality disorders are generally more of a threat to women than vice versa.

- It's not that they are considered baggage. The mental health issues and/or trauma is what people refer to as baggage. And usually people claim that someone has it or too much of it.

And that is the difference. People are usually not afraid to be with someone with baggage, but if they have too much then rightfully so. Because I have seen it quite a few times that someone with too much baggage starts to date someone and it slowly destroys their poor partner.

Because it is really tough to witness someone you love struggle so much when you can't do anything about it.

Hence why people will claim that someone has too much baggage or not. Obviously this doesn't mean that they will never find love. But it takes a certain type of person to withstand it. Or they need to get to a point where it doesn't effect them as much though the help of professionals.

- Hmm this is interesting. I have pretty severe CPTSD from childhood trauma (yeah, that kind) and I always refer to myself as having baggage. I'm actually super lucky to have an amazing husband who does NOT agree with me when I say that, or treat me like I have baggage when I break down, even if I break down because of something he unintentionally did. He never gets defensive, he just tries his best to understand and be what I need u til my head clears up again. Im not violent or anything but I get panic attacks, or strange anxiety/dissociative events (not like

DID, but times where it is hard for me to remain clear headed and everything gets super foggy and hard to think) I'm constantly apologizing and saying stuff like "do you wish you had a wife without baggage?" Somewhat facetiously...but I also wonder sometimes if he deserves a woman as mentally healthy as him (he had a wonderful life and as a result is the mentally healthiest person I have ever met!). His answer to my question is always, without fail "I just want to be married to you forever."

Like...I realize more and more that this man is a unicorn...but in some ways it makes me feel worse. Being married to him is wonderful...but being married to me sounds exhausting. And I hate being exhausting. I AM currently getting some intense therapy specifically for trauma and it IS making a difference. But there is SOOOO much to process and weed through. But I have all the support in the world so I know I could do it.

I wish the world was filled with men like my husband. You all deserve a man like him. But I'm not giving mine up!

- It's not a man and woman thing, imho. If I'm with a guy and he has unchecked, undiagnosed mental health issues that cause him to make me feel like shit? Or that become abusive toward me? There is no fucking way I am going to stay in that relationship because I think loving him enough will 'fix' him.

If it's a man who has a plan with medical/mental health professionals and works to help themselves in whatever way they can? That's different from someone refusing help, spiraling and taking me with them. And they never get a free pass to be an asshole to me. End stop.

It is also okay for someone to say, "I am incapable of enduring your mental health challenges..." (in a nicer way than I put, maybe), because you are incompatible with each other for that reason. And I will never again set myself on fire to keep someone else warm.

Now, a shit ton of people struggle with trauma and mental health issues. But pair me off with a narcissist or someone abusive and I will drown. Pair me off with someone genuinely trying to get support who is learning tools for management that don't involve lashing out at me or being abusive toward me? Or that don't involve trauma dumping onto me? Then that is not going to likely be the issue. Something else may pop up where we aren't compatible (that have nothing to do with trauma or mental health). Or something may not pop up.

I'm not always happy and smiling. I don't expect my partner to be either. But I don't want to become a punching bag for their issues or a receptacle for trauma dumping.

- If/when any guy I slept with learned anything about me, so quickly they'd tell anyone who'd listen that I was crazy & had daddy issues...odd thing is I never disclosed anything of my mental health or issues with rape & sexual assault to 98% of them. They'd just learn that I liked X band, or that I wanted to know if they knew my last name, or any other innocuous thing about me and THAT WAS TOO MUCH. Now, most of these pieces of shit were grown men, & I was a teen girl.

My husband (we first got together when I was 18, he was 20) was the first dude I slept with who cared about me, literally & in any conceivable measure. This including caring enough that I did disclose to him that I was raped as a child; since 1998 this dorky, nerd-tastic, role-playing sexy dude has encouraged me to do what the fuck ever it took/takes to find peace, & has never once called anything about me 'baggage'. He does however like to gently rip on me for how many boxes in bins, atop of bins in boxes, with little bins & boxes inside...

- Because having things that would require extra work or consideration IS baggage.

You can't pretend someone with mental health issues would be an easier match than someone who is mentally healthy. It's blatantly not true.

You need to look at this realistically. Baggage is tough stuff that a person has to carry with them and it has an impact on their lives and how they relate to the world. Trauma and mental illness are baggage.

That doesn't mean don't date us but it does mean it may be a more difficult experience.

- Respectfully, I think relationships are healthiest when people have "matching baggage". We all have baggage, we all have stuff in our life that we're dealing with. Mental health and trauma are common things people struggle with, but people also struggle with career, health problems, finding fulfillment, being a good parent, all sorts of stuff.

When two people who primarily struggle with their mental health or trauma get together, they can have a reciprocal loving relationship. I help you with your trauma, you help me get through my mental health struggles, it's a reciprocal relationship where you both take care of each other. But when you have one partner who is in a phase of life where they need a lot of help to get their mental health or trauma manageable, and another partner who has mostly managed that aspect of their life (either because they don't have them, or because they have got a plan that works with mental health professionals) what happens is that they take on a caregiver role for their partner. They drop what they're doing, to struggle with career, health, fulfillment, whatever, and they take care of their partner who needs mental health help. They can enable the partner's mental health and trauma to go untreated. They can feel resentful, like their partner is holding them back. They can get controlling of their partner, and infantilizing of their partner. Or when the partner does get better and gets better care for their mental health, they are so cemented as their role as "the caregiver" they can distrust and undermine that growth. It's not a healthy relationship dynamic, especially not when it comes on at the start.

Relationships are healthiest when both people are either independent and don't need help, or taking care of each other reciprocally. I think not wanting to date a person who is in a different place in their struggle with mental health is a very reasonable and healthy boundary to have.

- Idk it is baggage, baggage is just stuff that you carry into the relationship that makes the relationship more difficult. Men bring plenty of their own mental health baggage into relationships too and it's not weird to not want to deal with it. Anger issues, mommy issues, jealousy issues, undiagnosed bipolar, BPD, addiction issues, shit even just like a crazy ex who still doesn't leave them alone, all of them are things I'd want to avoid in someone I'm dating

because I don't feel any relationship is worth working through all that with someone. Everyone has traits that are desirable or undesirable that you use to decide if you want to date them long term and mental health issues are pretty undesirable in a partner for a lot of people regardless of gender identity.

- Lots of people with trauma like that have border line personality disorder and they do crazy stuff. its a horrible condition. They need huge amount of therapy to trust people and stop lashing out and they can't feel joy. Have been with 2 of them. Was hell.

- Can't relate. Trauma and mental health issues are baggage. Isn't anything that weighs heavy and hard to deal with baggage? Don't most humans have some sort of baggage?

Sometimes I talked about my mental health and trauma to try and deter men, it never worked. Not surprising because I wouldn't steer away from men with that type of baggage either. People get:

Savior complex

"I can fix them"

White knight

Heal together

"You can fix me"

- I'm bi so this goes for both men and women for me. I'm not looking to be part of your healing process. It is ok if you've had things happen but if your trauma and mental health issues are a big part of your identity we just won't mesh.

When you are in a relationship with someone their emotional state affects you and for me I don't want a partner that is going to emotionally drain me. It often means anything I'm going through is insignificant and you spend most the relationship being an emotional dumping ground and you have to walk on egg shells as to not trigger something.

I've had experience with it and I won't do it again. I will probably get downvoted on this but I will date a survivor of trauma I won't date a victim. It is a mind set difference. The survivor has come out stronger and while they have scars aren't fragile needing delicate care. It takes time and work to go from 1 to the other but it is possible.

- Calling Mental Health issues and Trauma "baggage" is wrong and undermines anyone who deals with real PTSD or other mental health issues.

It's an incredible amount of work and effort to be with someone who has serious trauma or mental health issues, it will often result in mental health issues for the partner as well. Not wanting to be with someone who suffers from a mental health disability hardly makes someone a bad person. At some point everybody has to do what's best for them, and often that's not being with someone who struggles daily with mental health. It's harsh reality but a reality nonetheless.

- This is important to understand. This question has so many layers and depending on the perspective of the individual, you will get different responses.

When people are in relationship with one another, they want to continue to be able to discover themselves while experiencing the other person, and hopefully understanding them. In many ways, the life experiences, the conditioning, the perceptions of an individual are developed from

what has happened before and their lives and what they have seen. If there was Trauma, which is very common, and individual who copes as a result, may do so in a responsible or irresponsible manner. This may occur from time to time. The person that they come to date, may not be equipped to navigate that.

With posts like that demonstrate that there is a significant misunderstanding and lack of understanding surrounding how peoples traumatic past can have an impact on themselves, the world, and others, is the exact same reason why someone would come to a relationship with an expectation for a person to be utterly perfect, perfectly behaved, even if they passed Had made them hurt and coping in someway.

Women are emotional, much better than men, and this is to be celebrated and embraced. At times, it can be difficult for a man to understand and navigated. The woman herself gets regular therapy and support and is working on herself so she is clear on when and if, she is feeling things arise. Who inquires about that can be doing so in order to understand her better, to relate with her better, to not take it at times.

My God, has the Internet, made this such a magnified polarization of how relating to one another should not be as insight to how to relate to one another. I can't imagine how difficult that is to get Clear.

& If there are any men here, potentially hurt any women at the expensive nurturing themselves or serving themselves, do not do it again. Get therapy now. Do not pass on your insecurities onto others.

Title: Why do people talk about men's loneliness and their mental health/suicide rates but not women's?

Post Text: I frequently hear about people talk about the loneliness epidemic in young men (often in the context that young men are having less sex/dating and getting married less than previous generations). But wouldn't this also be true for women? Women logically would also be having less sex/dating less if men are (unless they are lesbian).

Although men are more likely to die from suicide (because of the more effective methods they use, like firearms), women are more likely to attempt it and are more likely to suffer from mental illnesses such as depression, anxiety, eating disorders, and PTSD and be prescribed medication for it. How come I never see anyone bring this up? The focus seems to be mainly on men's loneliness and mental health struggles, although women arguably suffer from it more, statistically speaking (not that they aren't both important; this is purely from a statistical point of view).

Edit: I also read that women are more likely than men to request MAID (assisted suicide) for mental illness, so this might increase women's suicide rates where assisted suicide for mental illness is legal. (Canada hasn't approved MAID for mental illness yet, but they will implement it starting in 2027.)

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I feel like people don't "talk" about men's loneliness. They USE it as a way to deflect from women's issues. Because I always see it brought up in response to someone talking about women's issues, but i never see reasonable solutions being proposed, I never see men trying to validate each other, or help each other with emotions, or hold each other accountable, or provide GOOD comfort & community for each other, at least not when they're supposedly 'advocating' for men's issues. As a man this makes me frustrated because there are a great deal of steps we need to take to address our mental health and the health of our male friends & peers.

I think that's why we aren't hearing about the mental health struggles of women, because bringing up men's mental health facts is just a tool to shift attention away from women. This does a disservice to everyone, men, women, and beyond, because it makes a mockery of men's issues and women's issues.

- Some men believe that women have it "easier" — that even when women suffer, she always has people around her (often "orbiting men") to cater to her every need. Thus, even when women express the problems we face, they can't really be that bad.

This is, of course, absurd.

Some men believe that feminism is oppressive to men as patriarchy is to women. They see any discussion of feminist concerns as a *threat* to them and believe that the progress women have already made has led to a backslide for men. They may use male loneliness and men's mental health concerns as evidence for this theory.

This is, of course, absurd.

Some men are so immersed in their echo chambers that they *do not know* and/or *do not believe* the statistics about women's mental health issues. We had a man on this very sub within the last month or so talking about the male suicide rate as an issue that was important to him who didn't know and didn't initially believe that women attempt suicide at higher rates.

This is the patriarchy at work.

Some men believe the statistics about mental health are completely skewed and that women over-report mental health concerns and men under-report them because of patriarchal standards about men (who should be stoic and emotionless and strong etc etc).

Questioning women's self-reported mental health concerns is *wildly* harmful. Why in the world should we not believe women who say they are in pain? (For some of the men who question these statistics for women, the answer is that "women are attention seeking liars.") Dangerous. Absurd. Oppressive.

Of course, it is likely that there is some degree of underreporting when it comes to men facing mental health issues. We can and should acknowledge that, while also acknowledging that there would have to be a *whole lot* of underreporting to flip the statistics.

- There was recently a "You're Wrong About" podcast about this and I'd highly recommend. Essentially, there has been a social contingent in the United States decrying a "crisis of masculinity" for close to 100 years, although what this crisis is evolves over time. The first was about how moving from frontiers to settled life caused men to be less masculine in early America. Usually it's about men feeling like women's behaviors and advances are harming men. It's a convenient rhetorical tool which is often picked up by the center-right and center-left in male spaces.

There is a crisis of mental health among both men and women, and the fact that men are more successful at suicide, and women's suicide attempts are often survivable and more experimental/medical, is I would say still a mental health crisis and it is uniquely affecting men. We should be concerned about it. I don't think we should blame women's advances for it. It's one of the reasons I'd never own a gun-- although I did grow up rurally and believe in responsible hunting, I wouldn't risk it.

- Lots of it is pushed by male dominated industries, both to retain staff and trying to hide the fact they hurt a lot of men.

Here in Australia our mining industry revolves around the fly in, fly out model. This means mostly men travelling and living in remote locations for weeks at a time doing twelve hours days every day.

The money makes it seem like it's worthwhile but the grind can really take a toll on your mental health. There's a reason why they'll pay for your funerals even if you die off site

- Lack of interest in women's issues, maybe? Despite what MRA men act like, mainstream "feminist" discourse (in the U.S. at least) is mostly limited to reproductive rights, sexual assault, and the misogynistic comments of politicians. Sometimes other topics show up in articles now and then, but not that often.

Generally when I see discussions of the mental health/loneliness crisis, it's either not gendered and talking about everyone or about men. Which is useful and good, but I wish women's issues got as much discussion in the mainstream media.

- I'm not going to say that behind every woman with depression, anxiety, PTSD there is a man causing it...because it's not that simple, sometimes the older generations play into being accepted into the patriarchy or directly into religion, but yeah. And that does not mean that all men are toxic, but there are a lot of toxic men.

What I've seen many times is that the person who seeks psychiatric help is not really the person with the problem, but the person who is trying to "cope" with the person with the problem. And that has unbalanced them so much that they cannot "cope" anymore. And then the ethical dilemma of doing what that person asks for--more fuel to cope more--or first trying to make that person understand that there are limits to how much damage they can take.

So, and I know it's going to be unpopular here, but maybe it's not such a bad strategy to encourage men to seek psychiatric help and to demythologize this association with "female weakness". It does not feel like fair, i know.

- >Although men are more likely to die from suicide (because of the more effective methods they use, like firearms), women are more likely to attempt it and are more likely to suffer from mental illnesses such as depression, anxiety, eating disorders, and PTSD and be prescribed medication for it. How come I never see anyone bring this up? The focus seems to be mainly on men's loneliness and mental health struggles, although women arguably suffer from it more, statistically speaking (not that they aren't both important; this is purely from a statistical point of view).

It makes sense to try to look at the bigger picture, but I think you're missing the point when it comes to suicide specifically. Suicide attempts are generally fast and irrational. The decision is often made just minutes before the attempt and survivors don't reattempt most of the time.

It's bad when people die from suicide and men are dying at four times the rate that women are dying. It's a misconception that suicide is a semi-rational decision made when suffering exceeds a certain threshold, which is usually the reasoning behind the claim that women have it worse because they attempt more often.

In the face of this disparity, it makes sense that the social dynamics surrounding men and boys should have a place in discussing suicide the same way the social dynamics surrounding women and girls have a place in discussing sexual violence. It's not that suicide or SV only have victims of one gender, but that it's possible to generalize so hard you lose sight of an important aspect of the problem.

I want to reiterate that I'm only speaking about the suicide part of your post because I think suicide isn't well understood by most people. I agree that women's mental health should be discussed more.

- My mental health ebbs and flows, and I literally only have my boyfriend as a companion and I talk to a female friend once or twice a month, if we ever do. The loneliness is crushing, but I never talk about it. Not even with my mom or boyfriend. I feel like no one would really care.

- Many men think that women's problems are shallow and easily solved (if not outright women's own fault) and that only men ever really have deep, complex issues.

The conversation about loneliness and mental health in general is often gendered from the get-go, with men bringing up men's loneliness and mental health only in conversations about women, so show that "men actually have it harder".

It's not all for bad reasons though. Some men are finally starting to get away from toxic masculinity, which means being able to open conversations about mental health that they felt they couldn't have before. Because of this, some men are genuinely going out of their way to create those conversations, which is really good to see.

While it can be argued that women didn't have the same kind of stigma against mental health discussions before, that's not to say that women don't **still** face a certain kind of resistance when we try to start those conversations. Inevitably, a man will come in and try to start centering men, and calling women misandrists for wanting to have a female-centered (and by comparison male-excluding) conversation about mental health.

This presumably is stopping some of those conversations from happening at all, because "feminism bad" is a big problem. Women are expected to share their spaces, while men aren't so much.

- In my experience, I've only ever seen men bring up issues of male depression and suicide as a means to derail a conversation about women's mental health.

Essentially, they actually **don't care about men's mental health**. They only care about **stopping** conversations and movements that **help women**.

The sad part is, at the end of the day, **any** positive progress in expanding mental health "for women" would **also** benefit men struggling with it as well.

If you're a man reading this, and wondering what you **can** do to elicit change, start by complimenting your male friends just because. Ask them about their day, their job, their hobbies. One of the main factors towards depression in men, especially **widowed** men, is that men traditionally only have these conversations with their spouse or significant other.

Single men or men who have lost that significant other don't have an outlet for these feelings which makes them feel incredibly isolated. Change societal norms one heartfelt conversation at a time.

- > How come I never see anyone bring this up?

I think you may be inferring a level of cultural importance based on observations of what is being discussed in the public sphere, but there is a selection bias that might be worth considering: what you are seeing isn't necessarily representative of what people **in general** (and especially social scientists) believe. There is a vast movement of bigots pushing back against social change and equality, and one of their false talking points is that men have a way harder time; just yesterday a man told me that women get the cultural equivalent to training wheels while men have to endure without support, a transparently myopic and overtly inaccurate framing. So while there are large swathes of people that **sincerely** care about depression and loneliness in all people, regardless of gender (albeit their avenues of support may be structured to support gender commonalities), you are likely to hear a very vocal subset of people megaphone the idea that men are uniquely and primarily the victims of cultural systems and structures because it feeds an "anti-woke" narrative that they then will use (ironically) to prop up systems of oppression and inequality. Which isn't to say that there aren't some elements of the patriarchy that ***do*** primarily harm men, it's just that many of the people arguing that men are being left behind are being willfully disingenuous and self-servingly myopic

because they do not actually care about mens' health or mental wellbeing and, in fact, are *feeding* the problem. People like Jordan Peterson and Andrew Tare aren't in the business of helping men struggling with loneliness build healthy relationships, they are in the business of conditioning vulnerable men to further isolate themselves so they are more vulnerable to continued grifting.

- I don't know what you mean by "anybody" unless you mean certain factions of the media.

The new trend is to focus on men's loneliness I guess.

Women's suicide was talked about or at least articles were written and talk show episodes were made, in the 90s and 00s at least.

Media follow trends.

If you want real mental health research you need to look into the actual clinical research literature. Medical and psychological and social work journals and such. But if you look into that, you will get a sense on how suicide as a whole is being researched, as well as how different populations are being assessed.

- >Although men are more likely to die from suicide (because of the more effective methods they use, like firearms), women are more likely to attempt it and are more likely to suffer from mental illnesses such as depression, anxiety, eating disorders, and PTSD and be prescribed medication for it.

You are partially answering your own question here. People perceive a completed suicide as more grave, all things equal, than an attempted one or a simple mood disorder, for obvious reasons. People also die more from [suicide](<https://www.cdc.gov/suicide/facts/data.html>) than [E.D.](<https://bulimia.com/anorexia/statistics/mortality-rate/>), which includes anorexia, the most deadly psychopathology. It is normal that people care about deadly health issues more than others.

[Men are 2.5 times more likely to die of suicide](<https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s00038-018-1196-1>) and suicide directly affects mortality rate whereas all the other disorders have indirect relationships to death.

ED is the exception, but there is easy to find media coverage and unfair beauty standards and it's effect on women

<https://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2024/apr/29/eating-disorder-treatment-recovery>

<https://www.cnn.com/videos/tech/2021/10/09/instagram-eating-disorders-sidner-dnt-ac360-vpx.cnn>

edit: added one sentence

There is also the fact that a lot of the discourse about men's mental health is about how men are socialized not to talk about or recognize their feelings due to gender roles. This is part of the reason why it's not actually clear that more women suffer from those psychopathologies because women and men don't report issues or seek help in the same way even when they both face similar issues.

- >Women logically would also be having less sex/dating less if men are

Not necessarily. For example, you could have 1 man going on 5 dates with 5 different women in a week, and another man going on none. In fact overall less women report being interested in dating and in long term relationships than men.

Regardless of the statistics though theres also reporting issues. Women are less likely to be believed when they report mental health concerns (while men are less likely to report in the first place), as you stated men make less suicide attempts overall yet are more likely to actually pass away when they do attempt it, etc.

It SEEMS like there are also age related effects. For example younger men are more likely to experience loneliness, but for women its the older age group that seems to experience more loneliness.

It also seems like women are more likely to have support structures in place than men due to having greater levels of communication with family and friends.

As for how feminism informs the public discourse around this, in my opinion it probably goes back to the reporting issue. Women are less likely to be believed and more likely to be misdiagnosed or simply not diagnosed at all. It took far too long for postpartum depression to be acknowledged as a diagnosable condition and theres still taboos around this subject. I imagine a similar effect is happening with loneliness related mental health, combined with other factors.

- I think the reason men's mental health issues are brought up more than women's is because people are searching for reasons why men's issues are getting worse.

Generally speaking, although both men and women have struggles, women's issues are trending in the right direction while men's issues are trending in the wrong direction. People are trying to figure out why.

- It's hard to actually discuss this without resorting to conjecture, sweeping generalisations and stereotypes.

Maybe because men (stereotypically) don't discuss their feelings as much as women (stereotypically) do due to socialised toxic masculinity. So there is more of a public effort to change that gendered values and behaviours, and normalise men discussing mental health problems?

- Partly because women tend to have more intimate conceptions with their friends. They'll be more openly supportive and go out of their way for each other more, which makes a relationship less essential for intimacy and validation. It also means that while in a relationship, they're not as reliant on their partner. This may be partly why women are actually often more likely to be depressed while in a relationship, because they're spending less time with a more open and intimate group and more with someone who's more likely to be closed off.

Partly because the consequences are more 'outward' in that men are more likely to lash out in response, or get driven into right wing ideologies. This makes the issue more visible and attracts more attention. When there's a big rise in right wing voters or a school shooting, people want to know why and this is a thing they can point to, vs women's loneliness where the consequences aren't as obvious. The suicide rates are also higher for men, which again is a more obvious consequence, although I believe (this may need to be fact checked) women actually attempt suicide at a similar rate, but either aren't successful, or consciously or subconsciously don't go through with it as much. But attempts aren't considered as notable a statistic.

Partly because when discussing an issue that mainly affects one group, people often lose sight of the wider picture and neglect other people it affects. You see this with a lack of discussion and support for male victims of sexual abuse, or for women who were indoctrinated into street gangs. It makes sense that the discussion and support for groups be proportionate - men don't need as many rape shelters, and women don't need as many support groups for helping people to get out of gangs. But often the smaller groups are just forgotten completely in the discussion.

Partly because it's more acceptable for women to talk about mental health on an individual level (i.e. their own mental health), so there's less of a need for a broader discussion of women's mental health in general. Whereas it's less acceptable for men, so the conversation becomes an overarching one about the issue of men's mental health in society, rather than the mental health of individuals.

Partly because men are taught from a young age to repress their emotions, specifically because they're men. This makes the resulting mental health issues easily and very directly linked to gender expectations of them. This is less in the sense of an older man or father figure telling them 'don't show emotions it's weak' and more learning over time from the reactions they or peers get when they do show their emotions. Experiencing a lack of sympathy and empathy from a young age, which worsens as they grow older, and even often backlash or ridicule, of course trains them to bottle things up and present a 'masculine' front, on both a conscious and unconscious level.

This is also more a male-specific issue, whereas things like body image, which while far more prevalent among women due to insane body standards (which you can see in way higher cases of EDs in women), are way more common in men than I think men are aware of. But body dysmorphia with guys obsessively going to the gym and never being satisfied is praised and not really seen as an issue, but while it's not actively unhealthy physically the dysmorphia is impacting their mental health. Also while women have slightly more potential with makeup and fashion to

compensate for perceiving themselves as unattractive, there's a lot less options for guys. If someone is feeling shit about their looks and just wants cheap validation, it's harder for a guy to gonna slutty outfit to get that. I get that that's not a cure for depression, and men can learn to use some makeup, but men are more limited in how much they can elevate their looks.

Partly because people are more willing to help women. This is condescending to women in some ways, and often comes from a place of infantilisation, but of course is also nice too. Men are less likely to receive help, particularly from a strangers, if they're seen struggling or upset, and experiments have shown that people often view upset men first as a potential danger rather than underage jumping to help them, with the opposite big true for women. Of course these some legitimacy in having that concern, but for the men on the receiving end it's not great from a mental health perspective.

Women are more likely to receive compliments and general interaction from strangers. Again this is often a negative point in other contexts, since this interaction is usually unwanted and potentially threatening, but has the benefit of providing some validation, and also a sense of society being aware of your existence. Men will commonly state they can't remember the last time they received a compliment, or can vividly remember the one time it happened. Meanwhile the lack of more general interaction from strangers outside of necessitated things like talking to a cashier can make many men feel invisible to society.

There's also a kind of glamorisation of the dark brooding male with a traumatic past in media that I think is seen less in female characters, and idk if that could have some contribution.

Of course all of these things are very broad generalisations, but for talking about men and women as a whole it explains statistical differences. I think the biggest thing really much is a t the root of all of this is men generally experience huge lack of empathy and sympathy for a young age, and even a lack of sympathy to the fact that they experience a lack of it. In gender equality discussions men are generally viewed as the more advantaged and often as the aggressors, and when viewed in that light it's hard to be sympathetic. But ironically that's the one thing they need.

It's kind of completely fair enough people struggle to sympathise, given most women's (and a tbh most men's) experiences with men and the many advantages they DO have. Especially when so many react in a way that's harmful to other people - it's a bit shitty to then paint them as the victim when there are actual victims. But I genuinely think a huge amount of other issues for both men and women stem from this lack of empathy and sympathy.

- Maybe in online discourse? In health care reality men are [less likely to seek and receive care for mental health

issues](<https://www.aamc.org/news/men-and-mental-health-what-are-we-missing>) than women.

Title: i asked chatgpt about brain fogg and this was the answer.

Post Text: i have persistent fatigue and brain fogg and sometimes word finding problems and tiredness despite my cbc tes & thyroid tests & fasting blood sugar & liver & kidney functions &

cortisol tests all are normal except vitamin d which im deficient in (did not feel good after taking 10,000 daily for 1 month)what else should i try?

the answer

1. Neurological and Cognitive Health

* **Vitamin B12 Deficiency***: Low or borderline levels can cause brain fog, fatigue, and word-finding difficulties. Check B12 levels and consider supplementation (preferably methylcobalamin if levels are low).

* **Folate and Homocysteine***: Folate deficiency and elevated homocysteine can impact brain function. Test these to rule out issues related to methylation pathways.

* **Electrolyte Imbalances***: Magnesium, potassium, and calcium imbalances can affect both energy and cognition.

* **Rule out Neuroinflammatory Conditions***: Chronic inflammation in the brain can result from infections, toxins, or autoimmune responses.

2. Hormonal Health

* **Sex Hormones***: Low testosterone in men or imbalances in estrogen/progesterone in women can contribute to brain fog and fatigue. Testing might provide insights.

* **Adrenal Function***: A 24-hour salivary cortisol test or ACTH stimulation test may uncover subtler adrenal dysfunctions not apparent in single cortisol tests.

* **Thyroid Antibodies***: Even with normal thyroid function tests, conditions like Hashimoto's thyroiditis (elevated TPO or thyroglobulin antibodies) can cause symptoms.

3. Sleep Disorders

* **Sleep Apnea***: Brain fog and fatigue are hallmark symptoms. A sleep study (polysomnography) can rule this out.

* **Insomnia or Poor Sleep Quality***: Tracking sleep patterns with a wearable device or app can provide insight into disturbances affecting your energy and cognition.

4. Infections and Post-Infectious Syndromes

* **Chronic Viral Infections***: Reactivation of viruses like Epstein-Barr Virus (EBV) or Cytomegalovirus (CMV) can lead to chronic fatigue and brain fog.

* **Lyme Disease or Tick-Borne Illnesses***: These can mimic your symptoms and may require specialized testing.

5. Autoimmune and Inflammatory Conditions

* **Autoimmune Diseases***: Conditions like multiple sclerosis (MS), lupus, or mild autoimmune encephalitis can cause neurological symptoms and fatigue.

* **Markers of Inflammation***: Test CRP (C-reactive protein) and ESR (erythrocyte sedimentation rate) to check for systemic inflammation.

6. Nutritional and Metabolic Factors

* **Iron/Ferritin***: Even without anemia, low ferritin can cause fatigue and cognitive issues.

* **Omega-3 Fatty Acids***: Deficiency in omega-3s (DHA and EPA) can contribute to cognitive symptoms.

* **Thiamine (Vitamin B1)***: Insufficient levels can lead to fatigue and neurological symptoms.

7. Environmental and Toxin Exposure

* **Heavy Metal Toxicity***: Exposure to lead, mercury, or arsenic can cause cognitive impairment and fatigue. Hair, blood, or urine testing might help.

* **Mold Exposure***: Chronic mold exposure can cause neurological symptoms and fatigue. Testing for mold toxins in the body or inspecting your environment may be warranted.

8. Gut-Brain Connection

* **Gut Dysbiosis***: Imbalances in gut bacteria or conditions like small intestinal bacterial overgrowth (SIBO) can contribute to brain fog and fatigue. Stool analysis or a breath test can help diagnose these.

* **Food Sensitivities***: Gluten, dairy, or other food sensitivities can cause systemic inflammation and neurological symptoms. A trial elimination diet may help identify triggers.

9. Mental Health and Cognitive Function

* **Depression or Anxiety***: These conditions can cause fatigue and cognitive issues, even without significant emotional symptoms.

* **Cognitive Decline Screening***: For persistent word-finding problems, a neurological exam or cognitive screening (e.g., MoCA or MMSE) can help identify subtle impairments.

10. Consider Advanced Testing

* **Mitochondrial Function***: Mitochondrial dysfunction can lead to systemic energy deficits and brain fog. Specialized tests may be required.

* **Functional Medicine Approach***: Consider working with a functional medicine practitioner who may order tests like organic acid testing (OAT), which evaluates metabolic markers.

Title: My teen daughter has severe mental health issues.

Post Text: First of all. Let me say I am exhausted. My 15 year old daughter has severe mental health issues. She has been hospitalized over 7 times. We have done intensive inpatient,

outpatient and residential therapy. We have tried countless medications. I have myself gone to therapy. I've read every library book I can get. I've enrolled her in every program I can get my hands on including county family services and state services and an iep. She sees a fabulous psychiatrist and weekly therapist. She is a mess.

She has ruined my life. She is impossible. She often refuses to go to school, gets violent and is not rational half the time. Her dad has the same struggles so I'm pretty sure it's genetic. I have tried everything to help her and I'm exhausted. It is effecting my own health. Anyone I date takes off because she is over the top. I feel lost, frustrated and like I just want to leave and never tell anyone where I am. I just feel like giving up with her because.... What's the point? Hugest regret is having children. (Child)

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I know this isn't helpful, but if it's of any comfort at all...I was in the same boat as a teen that your daughter is. Lots of mental health issues and a war zone at home with my Mom. After I got proper diagnosis' and medicated it made a world of difference. If she's seeing a great therapist/psychiatrist it should hopefully help. It likely won't be a quick or linear fix, but moving forward is what matters. My heart truly goes out to you. I have such guilt to this day over the way I treated family/people as a teen.

- i feel for you. i'm not saying she necessarily is but FYI it's incredibly common for teen girls and women to be misdiagnosed a bunch of times before they figure out it's actually autism, ADHD, learning disabilities, or something else. it can also be other mental health issues on top of any combo of those things. Depression and anxiety can emerge as the result of the frustrating and shaming nature of what comes naturally to them. Autistic women are 9x more likely to die by suicide. Has she been evaluated?

- I'm so sorry. I was your teenage daughter. Not saying this is the case, but in my instance, I was misdiagnosed and incorrectly medicated. I ended up on 10 different medications at once because doctors were lazy and didn't want to do the work to find out what was actually going on and just kept feeding me more and more pills. I was diagnosed bipolar and BPD as a teenager — none of that was accurate. It was actually severe PTSD, anxiety, and depression. It wasn't until all the medications were thrown out and I got correct treatment that my life changed.

I recognize it was hell for my parents in the meantime. Hang in there. It's extremely difficult. I hear you, I see you, I support you.

- I was a kid like this. I know I caused issues. I needed therapy but I wouldn't talk even when I got it. The only thing that opened my eyes was having everyone abandon me. Only then did I realize my behavior was the culprit and it was no one's fault but mine. I had to see the truth in the mirror - I was my problem. I hope your daughter can chill before she lands herself in jail. Violence once she's 18 will be jailable offenses.

- Can you have her inpatient long term or a group home? I mean keep in contact with her, but at this rate it's better for both of you. You're going insane and she's having so many issues. With her being inpatient somewhere hopefully she'll get the tools and strict structure needed to make changes and possibly do better with her life later. I say this as a person with 9 mental health conditions and previously being hospitalized multiple times.

- Have you tried genetic testing for her? I recently took one specifically for mental health called Genomind. You need to find a provider to administer it and I think their website has a search function for that. It can pinpoint what disorders or gene mutations you may have and it can tell you what medications your body will process best.

Ever since I was a small child I was anxious, unfocused and had varying levels of insomnia. I'm now on low dose lithium + methyfolate supplements after taking the test, and it's amazing how much better I feel. I used to take Xanax for sleep or anxiety 1-2 times a week and now I rarely take it. Without the test I definitely don't think anyone would have thought to give me lithium since I'm not bipolar. It could be worth looking into for you all since other meds haven't worked. Hope this info is helpful for you! I'm sorry you're going through this.

- Idk if this helps, but I WAS that teen (not as severe but I relate), and I'm 30 now and a fully functioning healthy adult with a wonderful relationship with my mom. she got frustrated with me, our relationship wasn't good when I was a teen but she never gave up on me and was always there when I needed her. I owe her everything and I love her so much. Mental health issues run in my family also which worries me about having my own kids but just wanted to give u another perspective. I wish you all the best and I hope your daughter gets better and gets the help she needs

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Title: BBC insisting there has been no uptick in suicides due to the blocker ban

Post Text: BBC covering the government's cruel and ideological decision to ban puberty blockers, insisting they've caused no harm - take a read.

They've produced a report to contradict the suicide figures the community has quite rightly pointed out.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c9x8j5p0992o>

Edit: A redditor added a fantastic link to the suicide evidence presented by Jo Maugham (the good law project, currently challenging the blocker ban in court and based on the NHS' own data - this is the evidence which has caused the government to scramble to produce the false report)

<https://threadreaderapp.com/thread/1814364410720219323.html>

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- This is the actual review

<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/review-of-suicides-and-gender-dysphoria-at-the-tavistock-and-portman-nhs-foundation-trust/review-of-suicides-and-gender-dysphoria-at-the-tavistock-and-portman-nhs-foundation-trust-independent-report>

‘The data do not support the claim that there has been a large rise in suicide in young gender dysphoria patients at the Tavistock.’ ‘these figures do not include details of where in the care pathway the patients were when they died. Thirdly, they give no further information on the deaths described as being from other causes or “not confirmed as suicide” ‘

The specific claim made by Good Law Project was about the rise in deaths on waiting lists. Including probable but not confirmed suicides.

‘In the 3 years leading up to 2020-21, there were 5 suicides, compared to 7 in the 3 years after.’ But also ‘First, the figures are for “NHS years”, April to March, so the timing of the High Court judgment does not fall neatly between years.’

That looks important. Any deaths in first quarter of 2021 (after the Bell vs Tavi judgement) would be counted as part of the “5” that were “leading up to 2020-21”. Also the “7” in the years after would presumably not include any data after the transfer to the new clinics in 2023. So it looks like they were all bunched up in April 2021 to first half 2023. Given only confirmed suicides are included, the “7” will under-report numbers in the later period where a coroner’s inquest has not been completed.

Finally: 'References to gender distress in the NCMD cases occur more frequently in the most recent years, the highest single year figure being in 2021-22. It is not possible at this stage to link these cases to the GIDSaudit.'

- I can't comment on the substance of this review without the data underlying it, but I do have to say that the review poopooing all other evidence except one:

<https://mentalhealth.bmj.com/content/ebmental/27/1/e300940.full.pdf>

..is just shoddy. The above study shows that trans youth are 3-4 times more likely to complete suicide than comparable controls, but then, bizarrely, tries to explain this away by saying this is explainable by increased psychiatric contact (when really it just means that trans youth have increased psychiatric contact..and those that do are more likely to complete suicide).

The question then is, why do trans youth struggle more with mental health problems? Thankfully there's plenty of studies that show that trans ppl generally get more discrimination, more crime, more bullied, more isolated etc etc and that acceptance is generally associated with better MH outcomes.

Again, I can't comment on the substance of this review as they haven't publish the data it's based on, but as I've said eleventy squillion times before, trans interventions are to deal with gender dysphoria not suicide..or depression..or anxiety or any other mental health problem. The relationship between GD and functional MH problems is far more complex.

Title: does any of you guys have mental disorders(question) and how you guys felth about the toh characters having some disorders fells representative(question)

Post Text: i know my last question was about if have a lot of neurodivergent here

i think i will make a more large question

does any of you guys have mental disorders(question) and how you that have the disorder that are on toh being represented in toh(question)

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I didn't know I had anxiety and depression until I got counseling for TOH.

Much of what Luz does and feels I can relate to, especially feeling the world on your shoulders. I had a similar incident in my life, the stress from which left me blind in one eye.

Most everything related to mental health clicks with me, and I'm grateful beyond words that kids have a show that can be a positive example for relationships and also a positive example for mental health and talking about issues that are stuck in your mind.

- Definitely felt for Gus's struggle with anxiety and the illusions getting to a point where you have trouble centering yourself back on reality. My therapist gave me some tips regarding that "derealization" but Gus's simple counting on the fingers is something so straightforward I can do

it even when I can't think straight, and it helps me align enough to do the other methods people talk about like counting x number of things you can touch/see/smell/etc.

Title: Mental health c&p exam question?

Post Text: So tomorrow I'm slated to have my C&p exam by video call! I'm already rated 50 with severe depression an anxious tendencies! But things in life the past year have gone down hill for me, haveing to quite my job due to my other physical v.a disabilities an hand over the bread winning to my wife among other things,an started haveing thoughts of not being here anymore , my anxiety attacks have picked up an some upon waking up that lasted hours an some before trying to go to sleep an the random ones I get during the day! My question is will the C&P examiner have already looked over my last C&P exam an only focus on the new worsening symptoms or am I going to have to rehash relive through the entire exam again? Thank you all for reading an responding 🙏 God bless

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I think it just depends on the examiner, the last C&P I had for metal health; they went back through my history and asked me about the symptoms and how they we're currently affecting me. My best advice would be to prepare yourself for any and everything. Just be honest, tell them how life has changed for you recently due to the disabilities being claimed. Hell I'd even have your wife write a statement talking about how you've changed, you're circumstances have changed etc. You'll be fine fam 👍
- Just had mine a couple weeks or so ago, for an increase to my PTSD via video chat with VES doc. I was also very worried about the depths of the session as well, but it went alright.

Mine was for increase too, so she put me at ease right away that we were not going to dig through any stressor events from my time in Iraq and elsewhere. You might not be so lucky from what other's have cited -- but they shouldn't need to go backwards too much after your nexus and diagnosis have already been established. My doc said she already read through my entire file and cited a few things that seemed to indicate she did so -- and so we just talked about my situation over the past 5 years and curent state.

I hope you get the help you need.

Stay safe, and best of luck.

- I know that it sucks to relive and talk about traumatic events but I think you really should talk about it in the exam to show the doctor how it really affects you. It's going to be tough and you will probably be guarded and even cry. Just remember that you only see the examiner once and the outcome can potentially benefit you for the rest of your life so you might as well go in and open up completely or you will regret not doing so a year from now.
- If you have brain injuries from IED blasts I would suggest bringing notes. I've shit the bed with exams way too many times going into stress mode with memory problems. I brought notes this last time and had a way different experience. Oh and the most important box is total social and occupational impairment. The examiner can check every box but if they don't check total you will stay at 70%.

- Recently did one and I would say that the examiner will just talk about what's happening now and how it's getting worse.

Title: We're the Partners In Health Mental Health team, we're here to answer any questions you may have for mental health awareness month.

Post Text: Our teams operate in 12 locations around the world and we have been working with PIH to support mental health and improve access to care since 2009.

The team that will be conducting this AMA will be:

Bepi Raviola, MD, MPH - Child & Adolescent Psychiatrist and co-Director of PIH Mental Health

Stephanie Smith, MD - Consult Psychiatrist and co-Director of PIH Mental Health

Ksakrad Kelly, Psy. D. - Senior Psychotherapy Technical Advisor for PIH Mental Health

Father Eddy Eustache, MA - Priest and Psychologist, co-Director of PIH Staff Wellness

Together we have spent decades providing clinical care, mentorship, and expertise to promote and improve access to lifesaving mental health care in communities and facilities around the world, as well as fight stigma and advocate for the inclusion of mental health in the fight for universal health care. We have supported the rebuilding of communities after earthquakes and cyclones, and helped strengthen health systems ravaged by Ebola and other infectious diseases.

Drawing on our years of experience working in mental health across Latin America, Africa, and the Caribbean, we're here to answer any questions you may have for mental health awareness month.

Thank you all for asking your questions, we're hoping off but here are some resources if you have questions or want to learn more:

Learn more about work -

<https://storymaps.arcgis.com/stories/8dca051575aa4dd983e9fe1e21bcff6b>

If you have any questions to ask us - xsitementalhealth@pih.org

If you want to stay up to date on all of our work - <https://act.pih.org/soc-sign-up>

Proof: [Here's my proof](<https://imgur.com/a/Y5MjSeu>)!

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- For more AMAs on this topic, subscribe to [r/IAmA_Health](https://reddit.com/r/IAmA_Health), and check out our other topic-specific AMA subreddits

[here](https://reddit.com/r/IAmA/wiki/index#wiki_affiliate_topic-specific_subreddits).

- Hey I support PIH through John & Hank Green and their efforts to fund a maternal centre of excellence in Sierra Leone! Do you have plans for more mental health care in that country?

- In my state (WA), at minimum, there's maybe one assisted living facility for disabled who aren't seniors or have 'severe' developmental disorders. Its where I currently live, and despite having autism, I didn't qualify for other facilities because I'm literally too smart. The only other place we could go is *possibly* a group home, which wouldn't afford the same dignity.

IMO, us 'low care' mentally disabled who aren't seniors are an under-served, under-acknowledged demographic. We can't live on our own, or hold a job, but are too, ahem, 'high-functioning' and young to qualify for anywhere else. I suspect many like us are homeless in the streets, even.

Can I get your opinion on this?

- [deleted]

- Following natural (or manmade) disasters, what are the most effective mental health support strategies for children, teenagers, or young adults to minimize long-term effects?

We have so many events worldwide (war, political violence, earthquakes) and often talk about the physically injured, but I wonder what support we can/should advocate for to ensure survivors feel whole.

- What are your thoughts on self-screening and an apparent trend in self-diagnosing mental disorders? If someone is using a self-screening tool, what's the most realistic call to action beyond their results page?

I work in public health in Missouri, and we're kicking into high gear with mental health programming. I appreciate the time you're taking to do this! It's so important to talk about how we can increase access and decrease stigma!

- Are personality disorders (specifically cluster B's like sociopathy, narcissism, bpd) considered the same as a mental illness? How are treatments for said disorders similar/different from other common mental illnesses (like depression, bipolar, etc)?

- Are there any concerted efforts in the mental health field to help family members who may be living with and trying to help manage those suffering from mental illness?

In my experience, families often suffer tremendously when living with those with mental disorders, even when those with the disorder are receiving therapeutic interventions.

Counseling for family members might not only help family members to cope but ultimately, possibly by reducing stress and improving family interactions, help the member of their family directly disabled by mental health challenges.

- Do you have any advice for the parent of a 13 year old girl in these modern times? It seems like a desire for a diagnosis or ailment is ubiquitous amongst her friend group and many others. She likely does struggle with ADD and we are taking action on that front.

I just want to fix everything wrong with her and while she has started counselling, anything suggested she works on just feels like more work and stress. She's overwhelmed by school a lot of the time.

- Working across all these different locations, what is something your team has learned has been helpful in supporting mental health?
- Do you have any tips to support my mental health? Asking this more because sometimes life gets tough with work, bills and the news on TV.
- is there a link between ADHD and sleep/circadian rhythm disorders?
- What can one do to deal with extreme anxiety?
- How does PIH go about building comprehensive, community-based mental healthcare delivery systems? Do you start in one location (with more comprehensive services) and build out, or do you start distributed across a larger area (with less comprehensive services) and build up? I'm curious to hear what the process looks like, from initial planning stages to fully functioning mental healthcare systems. Thanks!
- How do you feel about Simon Sinek trying to reclassify mental health as mental fitness?
- Can you please share your thoughts on the permanence of telehealth as a mental health treatment modality going forward and what obstacles you see ahead?

Also, to what end will telehealth service communities across Latin America, Africa and the Caribbean?

Thank you for your time, thoughts and the work that you do.

- What are the biggest challenges you face in getting mental health care to people in places without strong healthcare systems? Stigma, funding, lack of HCPs? How much does your approach change by location?

Additionally, what can those of us in developed nations do to support your efforts?

Thanks for doing this AMA!

- Thank you all for asking your questions, we're hoping off but here are some resources if you want to learn more, have any questions, or want to stay up to date:

Learn more about work - [PIH Cross-Site Mental Health Program](<https://storymaps.arcgis.com/stories/8dca051575aa4dd983e9fe1e21bcff6b>)

If you have any questions to ask us - [Email us](mailto:xsitementalhealth@pih.org)

If you want to stay up to date on all of our work - [Sign up for updates](<https://act.pih.org/soc-sign-up>)

- I don't feel "anxious" or "stressed" ever

Could i just not know what those are?

- In what ways can a couple recover from infidelity?

How would a good couple's counselor help a couple determine if they want to continue the relationship or end it in the least mutually destructive way?

- What are we gonna name the plague?
- Is it normal for my psychiatrist to ask me what I want to do about problems that I'm having?

Since I got sober (one year) and lost a bunch of weight, I've been having more ADD symptoms. I was diagnosed in my 20s (44now), but spent years self medicating, as I'm also 16 years clean from meth. She makes me feel like I'm drug seeking. Idk what medication will help me. I also get a grant from the state that pays for these visits so switching doctors will be very, very hard. I'm on medication management only right now and really don't feel like I need to go back to therapy. For one their therapists are awful and I don't have the spoons to "train" a new one. I feel stuck. I had blood work done and all it showed was my high cholesterol and vitamin d was too high.

- What can Redditors do to help combat posts which try to frame political opposites or opponents as mentally ill, uncaring, dumb, or to otherwise dehumanize them? Ideally this would lead to increased empathy and compromise, though it would be a difficult, collective effort and would be resisted.

- Are people extra "crazy" today, or is mental health just more visible, so we can see the extent of it in a more holistic way? Is a goal of the Psychiatric industry to separate the infirm from the healthy? What is the best preventative measure a person can take (barring not having kids) to ensure they don't pass on their own trauma to their kids? What causes a person's own issues to be invisible to themselves?

- How can I make myself do more productive and useful things? I have no motivation to do anything that's not hedonistic.

- How to tackle with overthinking-related sleeplessness?(give easy tips)

- Mental Healthcare in Canada feels almost impossible to get when you are broke. I've had to cancel 2 counseling sessions I know I desperately need but can't piece in the \$90 a session.

Do you have any suggestions for resources in Canada? I've gone through the on calls, but everything always feeds into at least \$90 an hour.

Depression is absolutely killing me but no way to get help. Any suggestions are appreciated.

- what advice would you give cluster B individuals in the current societal space? mostly aspd, but also bpd and npd

- Should I inform my father, who has a severe case of Alzheimer's, about my mother's potential passing given her declining health, considering he is primarily cared for by her? She is really the only person he recognizes anymore.

- As a survivor and a haver of mental health issues and a teacher, how can I be an advocate and a supporter for students with mental health conditions in my school?

- I've been living in Japan for 4 years now. I've noticed there is a stigma when you have mental health issues like depression, anxiety, and general mental unwellness. Is your organization doing anything to change this?

- How hard is it to not diagnose yourself as a professional?

- Do you have any advice for treating Treatment Resistant Major Depressive Disorder. Over the course of years I've been on everyone of the 3 'types' of anti-depressants and none have ever worked, not even with adding boosters in. I've done Therapy and my Dr. even recommended trying medicinal marijuana to see if there would be any positive effects (unfortunately, for me personally, I hate the smell and taste and it makes me very paranoid).

I struggle so much and fluctuate between suicidal ideation, debilitating depression, and complete numbness. I don't know what normal even feels like as I've dealt with this my whole life and the thought of continuing this way is almost unbearable sometimes.

I know there have been some new treatments recently approved, like Eskatamine (I'm waiting to see if my insurance will cover it) and there are the psilocybin trials going on with micro-dosing but is there anything else in your experience that you have found to be meaningful impactful in people with similar diagnosis's? I understand you are not MY doctor and cannot speak as such but any advise or direction to look in would be extremely meaningful.

Thank you for all you do and all the people you help.

- why is it so difficult to gain access to an antidepressant if you've been prescribed them in the past many different times, for many years, and have had success with them?

edit: you have to find a doc that takes insurance, call and make an appointment, wait however many days or weeks to get in, then you have to have a screening before you see a doc. then you have to wait a day or two again. then you finally see a doc. if i could do all that, i wouldn't need one i the first place.

- Who can I call if I'm having a..let's say a severe moment, and just need a voice to listen? 988 either wants to hang up or call the cops so I don't hurt myself.

- Do you think mental health hotlines should be replaced by AI chatbots?

- Which World of Warcraft class would you choose based on the amount of stress alone?

- Which World of Warcraft class would you choose for the least amount of mental stress?

- Why doesn't this movement have flags and stuff plastered everywhere like next month will be? I'm fine with next month, they deserve their pride... but it's next month and it's already out!

Nobody I've asked even knows it's mental health awareness month.

(Meanwhile it's weeks btwn appointments to solve my ptsd problems I've had for decades, constantly getting the runaround from docs. No one seems to be advocating to make this easier for anyone. My meds are controlled strictly because other ppl can't be trusted to not abuse them making my mental health worse trying to get ahold of them.)

What awareness is happening and changes are being advocated for?

- How can I decide whether I need a psychologist or a psychiatrist? Thanks.

- How much time losses considered normal? Like I know I have adhd&ptsd but I often end up losing parts of my day, and only vaguely remembering them. Like I know what I did kind of it depends, but it felt like you know watching a movie or like watching somebody else do it. I know that I don't have a perfect memory and my friends and family say it's normal, but I'm pretty sure losing entire sections of your day is not normal. So is it?

Title: Hi! I'm a Mental Health professional, practicing clinical psych professional. If you have any questions related to mental health, you may freely ask it here :) I believe discussions about mental health can help raise more awareness and create a safe space for others.

Post Text: ASK ME ANYTHING!

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Is there anyway to forget your past traumas as a child?
- Self sabotage. How to get rid of it?
- Effective po ba ang dolomite?
- My mind always urge me to do random things because if I don't do it, something bad will happen, oftentimes I do it 5 times (or multiples of 5). For example po, I state a certain phrase in my mind 5 times tapos after nun mapapa-isip ako, "5 times ba talaga 'yun? Baka 4 lang" kaya uulit na naman ako hanggang sa sure na akong 5 times 'yun. I also do other things like check the under of my bed 5 times, kapag nadikit right knee ko sa pader dapat 'yung left knee rin madikit, etc. What do you think is this Doc?
- Totoo po ba na kapag hindi mo sineparate yung sleeping room mo sa study/work room mo(yung bed is literally beside lang ng study/work desk), yung utak mo maassociate na yung room na yun for study/work at mahihirapan ka na makatulog or magpahinga?
- May I ask you if a person who is mentally unwell can still pursue Psychiatry or Psychology in the future?
- Hi, yung mga sudden flashbacks ng memory ba ng embarrassing moments mo is still normal?
- How to forgive yourself and overcome regrets?
I know there are times I've been a bad person in the past. There are times that I remember those scenes and I regret my past actions.
- Yung mga taong tinatanong mo kung ok lang, ang sagot palagi. Im not well. Im not ok. And yet refuses to talk. What should one do for this person?
- I've been trying to cope up with stress and anxiety. Dinidistract ko sarili ko by binge-watching series or crocheting. Pero once na naging quiet na yung paligid ko tapos wala lang akong ginagawa, nagiging anxious ako agad, kung ano ano na naiisip ko. Sa sobrang anxious ko to the point na naaapektuhan na yung physical health ko. Are there more coping mechanisms that you can recommend? Di rin kasi gaano effective yung deep breathing sa akin.
- I want to report my ex therapist for unethical behavior. He said a lot of offhanded comments about my decision to be childfree. He told me things like "children cannot inherit autism from autistic parents" (I have autism) and "I have a female friend who used to be childfree, now she wants to give parenthood a try". He even tried to guilt trip me for being childfree after I told him my father supports me as CF. Considering how conservative our country is, do I have a case in reporting my ex-therapist to the PRC?
- I have a 14 year old brother who acts very immaturity. As far as I know, when he was six, the doctors said he had ADHD and his development was two years behind. That was the last visit. Our parents don't really care much about mental health.

Here are the things I've noticed about him:

1. He only speaks English even though we all speak Filipino. And when he tries speaking for Filipino class, he has an American accent. We live in the Philippines and we're not conyo. Also, he has a weird stutter. It's not the typical one like "Stu-stu-stutter", it's more like "Stut *pause for a second* er" like pausing a video.

2. Even as a kid, he would create stories based on games he would play. He has always loved telling me those stories even now as a teen. But he expects me and our youngest brother (8 years old) to act out his stories with him and play. When our youngest brother refuses to follow exactly what happens in his story, teen brother gets mad and cries. There was a point where he cried so hard about our little brother teasing him and he told me "it makes me wanna kill myself". When we won't play with him, he would play by himself, acting everything out.

3. He says weird things. He tells me his characters from his story visit our reality and annoy him. He also says things like "I have a concussion", or randomly repeat "Adult diaper" or some other word he found funny that day. He told me he was a musician and he knows lots of languages. I don't know if he's constantly roleplaying in his head or what.

4. Last, he doesn't understand social cues. Our mom would be mad and he'd still be laughing. I'd be in a meeting for work and while I'm talking, he would talk to me about his game. Our little brother doesn't do that. He would see I had my headphones on and then come back later.

I'm just worried about him and his future. He's a nice kid but he's very weird. I don't know if he's just quirky or what. Thank you for doing this!

- [deleted]

- Are you a RPsych? How are you dealing with the cases you have during this pandemic? Is there a way to access affordable mental health care for those who cannot pay for consultation, assessment and therapy aside from hotlines? I am pretty sure there are a plenty of people who are financially challenged right now.

- Is excessive daydreaming a sign of ADHD? Or a disorder of its own? Thanks!

- If I want to start consulting with a psych professional, what info should I give? yung psych na ba mag gaguide sa kunga ano mga kailangan nyang personal info?

- Death anxiety. Is it normal or suicidal?

- First of all thank u so much and magandang umaga.

Consult po. Im feeling burnout sa work. Almost 3 yrs and half ko na dala2 ito pero mas nag peak sya this past 6 months. Wala nako pake anu mangyare saken sa work. Even kun ma fire ako i dont care. All im thinking is money. Pinaka napansin ko is feeling lagi ako walang oras. Kulang sa oras. Kahit 2 days off feeling ko kulang na kulang. Gusto ko lahat ibuhos sa pagtulog. Am i mentally ill na poba? Salamat.

- [deleted]

- How does anxiety/stress affect the stomach? When I'm anxious wala akong appetite and nag ddry heave ako :(And also what tips can you give to lessen my anxiety and worrying?

- How much money do therapists/psychologists (di ko alam proper term) usually charge? And how long will it take for them to gave/prescribe medicines?

I want to be properly checked kasi so need ko malaman kung magkano para mapag ipunan.

- Am I suicidal if I know I shouldn't but I wouldn't mind it if I die today pero di ko ginawa deliberately? I know self harm is bad so I don't do it, pero kung isang araw maaksidente nalang ako bigla I wouldn't fight it either. I have no will to live, I'm just going through the motions with no

end in sight, pero I know the consequences if I actively try to kill myself and naawa ako sa mga taong iiwan ko if I do it. The person who kept me from doing anything just passed away, and her, and the family I have left with me thinks na all I need is to be busy or find a new hobby to distract me from my "negative thoughts" as if on my "happier days" hindi ko naiisip na ang lungkot ko pa rin, I'm just good at hiding it lang talaga.

- As someone who's is taking a Bachelors in Psychology outside of the country (di pa sure kung magma-masters) and is passionate in helping others, I want to ask:

From your own experience as a Mental Health professional, how bad/good is the mental healthcare of PH?

- Hello po Tanong ko lang if it is **normal sa isang tao** yung everyday kapag nakaka trigger negative thoughts na *fru-frus trate sa sarili nila* and contemplating that. And after an hour nawawala naman siya. **Sign ba yun ng depression or just ignore it na lang baka OA lang naman ako**

Anyway it has been 2 months since I've experience this

- Any advice po para mawala yung social anxiety ko. (Shaking during speeches and even talking to other people)

- Hello I have a friend struggling with anxiety. May paraan po ba para matulungan ko sila?

- Hello, I'm 16 years old. I participated on a free consultation last month (Aug 25). Less than 20 mins nagtagal yung consultation and ni-resetahan ako ng Jovia. Yung reseta ay sinend sakín thru text. Ang nakasulat "present this to any watsons store and discount...". Pwede po ba itong i-present sa ibang store other than watson, and valid po ba yung reseta after 2 years??

I am experiencing anxiety and symptoms of depression for 4 years na. Hindi ko parin sinasabi sa mga magulang ko na may ni-reseta sakín kase hinde sila naniniwala sa depression kase "masayahin" raw ako. At tsaka, 5 kami sa pamilya at tatay ko lang nagpropovide ng pera. Madadagagan gastusin kapag pinabili ko sa kanila gamot, ehh continuous raw kase paginom ng Jovia. Ayun po

- Ang mental disorder ba eh genetic and/or hereditary?

- When do you need counseling and when do you not need it?

- How to deal with past trauma? I've been bullied for 4 years during elementary. Gaslighting, extortion, public humiliation, I've faced all of that. I'm in college now and sometimes, whenever I see or hear stories related to that I get flashbacks so I cry myself out. The bullies have never said something to me to apologize like a simple 'sorry' would do naman eh. I never dare to check their socmeds too.

- My Grandmother has been recently showing signs of Dementia, she doesn't have frequent episodes she is acting normal most of the time, tho when episodes do happen it's unpredictable and abrupt it has put her in dangerous situations before

I was wondering what i can do when it happens since i am the one taking care of her most of the time, and if there's anything i need to know about patients with dementia?

- ano pang pwedeng gawin ng mga taong diagnosed na noon pero can't afford maintenance or continuous therapy sessions especially this pandemic? ang nakita kong option dati is free "sessions" sa PGH pero mukhang punuan doon

- Okay lang bang mangamusta regarding therapy sessions? I have this friend na ayaw ipaalam sa iba re his therapy for various reasons na I understand naman. So ako lang nakakaalam. I helped him start going to therapy kasi nahihiya sya. Pero eventually sya na pumupunta on his own. If nagkakakamustahan kami is hindi ko maopen up yung topic kasi I don't find it appropriate. I don't know why, pero I think it's because I consider it something too personal to ask about it. So hinahayaan ko nalang sya usually ang mag open up. I wonder lang if it's okay to ask about it on my own.

- I find it difficult to get help, like ive been checking clinics online - asking for their schedules para sa walk in.. pero just cant take the next step to actually go

- Haven't read through but how do I get a job when I have crippling anxiety? Can't get a job, can't get therapy because I don't have a job, how do I get out of this cycle.

- Is ERP better than CBT in managing OCD?

- Me epekto ba talaga ang cocomelon sa mga toddlers? Mukhang JJ na yun anak ko eh.

- Is it me or does it look like whenever my past time seems extremely dull, I tend to forget almost everything? I'm 19 btw

- i often wonder if i'm an introvert, has phobia in public spaces with strangers or a hermit. I can go outside but i often find myself repeating my interactions(embarrassing/awkward ones) again again in my mind weeks after the encounter. and scold myself for being a weirdo.

- Hi OP, I tend to get irritated/angry easily (depending on the situation) and then I tend to run my mouth and say awful stuff but lately I've learned to immediately stay quiet for a few mins until the peak of my anger passes. Would you recommend that this is a good way to take care of my anger issues haha

- normal po bang hindi magpa evaluate sa psych kasi takot sa possible diagnosis?

- Anong pong gagawain ko kung yung memories about bullying is nagrereply pa rin sa aking utak kahit ilang years ng nakakaraan?

Ano po kaya magandang gawin kapag may mental health issue ka pero hindi ka makakaavail ng mental health professionals due to some issues like parent belief?

- I actually completed an Anger management therapy course before. My temper had improved greatly but I still have some certain days of excessive irritability and occasional anger. This pandemic increased these instances although I am still within the "threshold."

Aside from the take time out before reacting, breathing, avoiding triggers or mentally preparing yourself before facing their triggers etc, what are the most basic or perhaps innovative tips can you give?

Thanks!

- Recently, I quit my low paying job. I'm now in my dream job working only 4 hours a day and getting paid really well. However, I've been feeling empty lately. Like I have no achievements or no significant wins. It feels so flat and lifeless. How to get out of this state?

- Hi! Thank you po sa willingness nyo tumulong lalo na sa mga nahihiya na magpacheck tulad ko.

I have a problem overcoming yung mga bad experiences , for example heartbreaks. Pano po kalabanin ang maingay na utak?

salamat po!

- Hi, OP! I don't have any questions, I just have a suggestion. Please put "AMA (Ask Me Anything)" sa title mo para in the future, when someone search for "AMA" in r/ph, they can find your post.

- Self prescription, mental health issues that can be dealt with alone. When to seek help from professionals

- Hi OP, tama po ba yung pagkaintindi ko na may mga specialization ang mga psych professionals? I wanted to go to therapy but I'm just wondering if there are psych professionals here in PH that specializes in childhood neglect or complex PTSD

- I have a friend whom complaints a lot and blame others for his downfall (why is he is tambay or failed to get a degree). He just stay there at home waiting to win from lotto, plays gacha games all day, and occasionally trash talk his family why he become like this.

At first its kinda annoying but his one of my few friends that I don't want to lose.

Note: this is before and after covid lockdowns.

- Thank you for doing this. I'm struggling with overthinking and it's debilitating. My day-to-day living is already affected and I don't know how to cope. I simply want to stop overthinking. Could you share some insights?

- Hello. I just graduated psychology this year and I'm planning to get my masters degree sa clinical psych din. Any tips?

- Why is it when I accomplish something I've worked hard for, I tend to feel like I don't deserve whatever rewards that come with it?

- hello po, what advice could you give someone who constantly has suicidal thoughts and actively self harms? they know that they're not okay but refuse or are scared to get help.

- Hiii love u/charaughtera thought of you as I read thru this thread, I need this pero in these times, seems like you'll benefit from it more

Saw din si Tinkay and yun mukhang a gloomy weekend to all of us haha

Just a reminder na it's okay to be sad ha, it means kasi we know the feeling of being happy, pero pag sad pa din ikaw love, hug kitaaaa 🤗

- I am a Medical Doctor and nagpost din ako ng similar to this kahapon. Salamat maam/sir! 🙏
You are badly needed in this trying times 🙏🙏🙏

- Modafinil — does it work and can it be taken by people with depressive disorders?

- In moments when I want to get myself checked and assessed, I wind up think na baka I'm faking it lang or manipulating myself to feel certain things para pasok sa certain disorder.

Sometimes when I get a panic attack, my mind goes off to say I'm faking it too. Ako lang ba to? I mean like subconsciously alam ng self ko na fake ako. Or does it also happen to others?

- Aight I only have one question, does busting a nut actually help relieve stress
- How do you draw the line between being really depressed and talagang down lang
- Hello, Let me start by thanking you for the time you give for us.

I need help regarding of being alone. I don't know how long I have been feeling this but the first time I can remember feeling this is when I was first year college. I am 22, graduated 2 years ago. I have this reccuring feeling that I am alone. I always feel this once every year. Sometimes, I just think that I am being dramatic, or my friends think I am. I always go to this "emo" bs that I feel alone, like I don't have friends or someone can understand me. I feel bad because I do have friends. I am with my family, but I do know if you get that friends is different for me. I did some stupid things when I feel that like posting "emo" bs *c r i n g e* on fb in the past, or writing poems and haikus about how alone I feel and it feel like it is not right, I do have friends. They are not ride or die kind of b, but I feel they will be there if I needed them. Right now, I kinda lowkey feel alone. I told my friends this, I think they symphatise but they can't help as this is my own issue. I am a gamer, so I don't know maybe because I don't have someone I could socialise with gaming since I dont have a gamer friends, I do like shopping/bonding with friends but kinda cannot do that rn, but if having friends to bond with is my issue, why did I felt it even I bond with my friends/classmates back then. I am so confused myself if my issue is valid or if it just normal. Idk. I am gay btw if that is something. I actually not gay but that is the short description, the long description is I am transwoman non-op. I just want to know if what I feeling is normal or if I need a psychiatrist, or what do you advise.

These are some of the haikus I wrote last 17 Apr 2020:
(It is on my note app)

"No man is an island"'s true
All of us' happy
Turned around, I am lonely

Emotion is a thin air,
Wished it, you didn't?
You got it, don't regret it (you deserved it)

I picked some of the lighter. The others is too dark, even for the present me. LMAO
- Have you guys experienced handling adult tantrums?(DISCLAIMER VERY LONG POST)

I want to share some stories about our church's driver/helper,unlike a regular drivers that we know(like jeepney drivers,taxi drivers etc.)na palaging nasa daan hindi ganun ang ginagawa niya.Kokontakin lang siya kapag kailangan maybe only 3 or 2 times a week kung sakaling may ihahatid,susunduin o may pupuntahahn ang pastor(seldomly since may sariling sasakyan naman ang pastor),not saying he's rude but sometimes his actions is a little bit out of place.It all started nung bagong member palang ako and there is a yearly church activity na kung saan ang

mga kabataan is nagtuturo ng mga bata sa iba't-ibang lugar. One time he comes para sunduin kami. I was watching over the children habang nagliligpit ng mga upuan. And then isa sa mga kasama ko ang nagsabi na kakausapin lang niya at after a while a bumalik na ang kasama ko para tulungan akong magliligpit. I was carrying some materials para isakay na sa van and then I hear some strange noises sa may harapan ng sasakyan it sounds like someone is screaming. I check it out and I see our driver shouting, kicking and punching the vehicle's dashboard. I asked to stop and what he's doing anyway. He respond na "binabastos niyo ako?" I was confuse and tinanong ko siya kung anong nangyari at bakit siya nagwawala. "Pinagsabihin ako ng kasama mo" he said "ano ang sinabi niya?" I asked "Sinabihan niya ako na maghintay" the driver responded. "Sinabihan?" I said to him in confusion "Inutusan niya ako sa harap ng mga tao, pinahiya" he said (he's referring to the people na nasa lugar at that time) and this makes me even more confuse. I don't hear their conversation but it seems nothing was wrong. I assume it was a misunderstanding and I said to him na calm down and huwag masyadong maingay cause he's making too much noises. He responded "Mahirap tong trabaho ko 10 years na akong Driver hindi ako ginaganyan ng mga kasama ikaw! Kung mas highblood ka mas highblood ako huwag niyo akong pagsabihan!" as he continue to shouts, punching the dashboard and inuuntog ang noo niya sa manibela. I have no idea what on earth is going on so I try my best na mapakalma siya hanggang sa siya'y tumigil na and after a few minutes dumatin na ang mga kasama ko and then sumakay na sa van. I didn't tell them what happened and about doon sa kasama ko na kinausap itong driver it seems like nothing bad was happened, cause again the driver mentions before na may mga ibang tao doon so kung may nangyari ng na masama magkakaroon ng gathering or tension just like we normally see. Well that's our first scenario.

Another worst thing that happens is yung nakatanggap ang pastor naming ng tawag galing sa ibang simbahan patungkol sa driver naming na nagwawala raw doon pinapunta ang driver doon kasi mayroon siyang susunduin na bata na representative ng church namin sa isang activity (parang childrens ministry sa pagkakatatanda ko). Kaya mula sa bahay tumawag saakin ang pastor pinuntahan ko ang pastor naming at bumiyahe kami sa kabilang bayan kailangan kasi ng pastor ng kasama kasi medyo may katandaan na pastor naming. Pagdating namin sa simbahan na iyon we saw the driver banging on the floor while screaming and everything looks like a mess at there we're people gathering around. Sinabo saakin ng pastor na ako ang bahala sa bata siya naman ang bahala sa driver. Nakita ko agad yung bata kasama ang isang nakatatanda at tinanong kung ano ang nagyari, here's the story, uwian na nung mga oras na iyon (hapon na kaya tapos na ang mga activity doon sa parang program nila) and the driver is expected na sunduin ang bata, however nung palabas na ang bata tinawag siya ng isang organizer sa program para ipalista/isulat ang pangalan nitong bata saglit sa listahan ng mga umattend (I think is for double checking). Nung isusulat na raw nitong bata ang pangalan niya saktong dumating itong driver na tinatawag na ang bata, sinabi sa kanya ng bata na saglit lang, nung narinig daw ito ng driver minura niya itong bata at sinabing iiwanan niya of course my maraming mga nakarinig may isang nakatatanda (senior citizen, I presumed) ang lumapit sa driver at sinabihan ito at doon na nagimula ang pagwawala (not sure if the story is true but that's according to the witnesses around there) Now back to the pastor naman I can tell na gumagamit

na siya ng pwera na itayo ang nagwawalang driver he's trying na maitayo ito maliit lang naman ang driver at may katangkaran naman ang pastor but he's struggling maya-maya may pumasok na binatang lalake(around mid 20s ang edad) at nakita ang pangyayari.Lumapit ito para tulungan ang pastor.Now I appreciate the help na binigay niya but it makes things really worst,but I guess I can't blame him since he's not aware of what's gonna happen.Habang binubuhat nila itong nagwawalang driver sinabihan niya ito na huwag makulit or magulo something like that,natulalang saglit ang driver at mas lalong tumindi ang pagwawala (again ayaw nga niya na pinagsasabihan siya).The driver said na huwag siyang pagsabihan and said that he will kill this young man.From that moment bumitiw muna ang pastor and told me that maghintay muna kami sa labas at hintaying lumipas ang pagwawala nitong driver and I assume na mapapagod din iyon.It took quite sometime pero nagsiuwian na ang lahat tsaka palang ito kumalma and we all went home habang kami ay nasa biyahe the driver asked the pastor kung nasaan yung matanda at yung binata na sinabihan siya at para daw mapagsabihan niya din ang mga ito at dapat siya ang huling magsasalita pero hindi pumayag ang pastor.Nung gabi ng iyon naikuwento saakin ng pastor na tumawag itong driver dahil hindi raw ito makatulog sa kadahilanang hindi raw ito nakakabawi sa pagkakatanda niya,hindi sigurado ang pastor kasi hating gabi na raw noon kaya pinatayan nalang daw niya ng telepono,not sure kung tama ang ginawa ng pastor o ayaw lang niya siguro ng problema.

Isa pang pangyayari ang naranasan ng isang teacher na pinadala ng pastor sa isang lugar.Minsan kong naka-usap ang teacher na ito dalaga pa siya noon pero ngayon may asawa na at nag-share siya saakin ng karanasan niya sa driver na hindi raw niya makalimutan ni hindi niya raw aram kung "trajedy or comedy" ang nangyari ayon sa kanya.Ito ang nangyari that day siya na teacher ay naatasang magturo ng mga bata sa ibang lugar.But first kailangan niya munang pumunta sa simbahan as well as hintayin ang ibang bata mga walong bata ata ang hintay niya doon sa simbahanbago pumunta sa lugar ng pagtuturuan.The driver came para sunduin that morning at para ihatid sila sa lugar na pagtuturuan which is mas marami pang mga bata ang naghihintay.Pagdating nila sa lugar na tuturuan isa-isang bumababa ang mga bata dahan dahan.Siyempre dahil siya ang teacher siya ang mauuna para alalayan itong mga batang bumababa.Nung bababa na ang huling dalawang bata pina-andar nang driver ang sasakyan(L300)kaya nahulog ang isang bata habang yung isa naman ay naiwang nakakapit.Nataranta na raw itong si teacher kaya naman humabol siya para tapikin ng ilang beses ang likuran ng sasakyan yung bang ginagawa ng mga tao para tumigil kasi nga may nakakapit na bata.Pagkatapos nito huminto ang sasakyan at bigla daw tumalon ang driver sa daan at nagsimulang sumigaw habang pagulong-gulong iyon ang kanyang nakita pero nabali ang atensyon niya sa bata.Mabuti nakita sila ng dalawang church member yung mag-asawang matanda na naghihintay sa kanila lumapit sa kanila itong lalakeng matanda kasi nakita nito sa malayo ang pagkahulog ng isang bata,nataranta na ang teacher sa nangyari kasi umiiyak yung dalawang bata habang itong driver naman ay sigaw ng sigaw sa habang nakahiga sa daan inuna muna ng matanda ang mga bata tapos sinunod nito ang driver,akala nga raw ng matanda naaksidente ito kasi nasa daan,kinausap daw nila ito nung itinayo na ng matanda at kaya pala ito nagwawala kasi tinapik daw ng malakas ang likuran ng sasakyan.Naguluhan na raw itong si Ate Teacher kaya nagtinginan nalang daw sila ng matanda.Nagpatuloy pa raw sa pagwawala

ang driver at tinatawag lahat ng bata para humingi ng tawad sa kabastusan na ginawa nila at sa kabagalan nilang bumaba wala raw ibinigay sa kaniya ang mga ito kundi problema hindi din naman mayayaman itong mga bata ang sabi nito sa teacher at nagsimulang ikumpara ng driver itong mga bata sa ibang mga bata pero hindi ito kilala ni Ate teacher, sinabi ng matanda sa driver na huminto na raw ito at sunduin nalang ang mga bata mamaya. Sinabi ng driver sa teacher na huwag siyang pagsasabihan at nagtatalon ito sa harapan nila ng matandang lalake at this point hindi na nila alam ang gagawin and then naniningil itong driver sa kanila inalok nalang ng matanda ng pagakain/almusal itong driver pero ayaw nito. Kaya since tapos na ang tungkulin nito pinapauwi na ito ng matanda para makapagpahinga, hindi raw ito nagustuhan ni driver kaya sinabi ng driver sa kanila na sila ang umuwi at nagsimula nanamang sumigaw at tumalon, nabubulabog narin ang mga nakatira. Tumingon itong matanda kay Teacher na medyo natatawa at sinenyasan siyang pumunta doon sa bahay ng matanda kasi doon nila tinitipon ang mga bata nakaabot sila sa bahay at maya-maya nakita nila na umalis nadin ang driver. Again gaya ng sinabi ko matagal na itong nangyari kasi yung matandang lalake na nabanggit ko kanina ay matagal ng patay at si Ate teacher ngayon may-asawa na, iyon daw ang una niyang karanasan sa driver and she's not aware na ganun pala iyon.

Naranasan niyo na po bang humawak ng ganitong sitasyon?

- To summarize the thread:

Q: Literally any question

A: Magically come up with 1500 pesos every two weeks and go into therapy regularly

- I have a question. Why are there so many Godless atheists in the psychology profession?

Doesn't it make you feel empty? Don't you feel like there's some entity that created you and all this universe seen and unseen.

- Can anxiety or depression cause chronic bronchitis?

- I sometimes explode in uncontrollable anger. What's wrong with me?

- Hello! Clin psy student here, currently debating if go na with online internship. Is there a big difference between teleconsult and f2f? So far sa class hrap kami to keep the conversation going 😊

- Do you have tips on how to keep your sleep schedule? I think I have insomnia. A physician just prescribed melatonin for me and I've been sleeping well recently.

- Is having mental health problems can lessen your cognitive ability? Also, does it affect our memory recall?

- How do you deal with anhedonia? It's been bothering me for weeks now, and I can't shake it off.

- Why do most depressed people push their partners away, but not their friends and family members?

- What are you looking for when diagnosing a person as 'clinically depressed'?

- Hello OP. Are there any legitimate, certified practitioners of Psilocybin therapy in the Philippines that can perform the treatment safely? What is your opinion on the use of psilocybin as treatment for depression and anxiety?

- If I go to a shrink to get a proper evaluation & diagnosis and validation of what I already know which that I have or had clinical depression -- I feel like that act would invalidate whatever findings because I came into that doctor's office loaded. Is this common?

Have never seen a shrink in my life by the way.

- doc ilang red horse ba ang equivalent ng isang budget friendly na therapy session?

- Good day, minsan nakakalimutan ko yung ibang alala ko lalo kung masamang alala tapos kapag na experience ko siya ulit or kung parang katulad bigla ko naalala at nagiging overwhelming sa akin. Nagiging masyadong emotional ako pag ngayari yun. Minsan naman super saya ko tapos bigla na lang ako malulungkot ng sobra kahit wala naman ngayari. Pinakaworst siguro di ko ma control galit ko kapag bigla ako nagiging emotional.

- What are some example of verbal abuse that people might not be aware of?

- What could be my mental disorder, kasi, problem ko kasi is i think a lot. Not like overthinking which is thinking about negative but I think about everything, randomly. Nag search ako sa Google 'why do i keep zoning out' and it said nga dahil lang daw automatic na magprocess ang brain ko sa madaling task kaya nadidistract mind ko. Siguro, i'll settle it that way pero I could have a maladaptive daydreaming. Sana masagot. Salamat!!

- How do you know if you, yourself is now suffering from depression? Also what things are need to be done to overcome it?

In Procrastination, how to get the work done before the deadline? Is Procrastination good or bad?

Self sabotage why and how to overcome it?

Tips on maintaining a healthy environment for your mental health?

Not sure if pwede to how to reach your potential or self improve.

- Hello po. Thank you po for doing this.

My question is, how can you heal your inner child if you still have to stay in the same home where you got the trauma? Is it possible to mend your family relationships while also noticing the unhealthy patterns in that family?

- what practical distress tips can you recommend, especially for young professionals living alone in the metro? i do mood tracker, breathing, and journaling but my emotions sometimes get the best of me.

- Hi po, this is not MH related pero tanong ko lang po. Paano ko po ma overcome yung irrational fear po?

Sa akin yung phobia ko yung maggots kasi nung HS pa ako, inuulanan ako ng uod havang kumakain ng lugaw sa lugawan. Napansin ko din po na nagdevelop din ako ng tryptophobia.

- Thanks for doing this! Any tips on spotting green and red flags when talking to a psychologist/psychiatrist for the first time?
- Do you know any free therapy consultations around the Philippines that can accommodate online sessions? :)
- Hi, sometimes I overthink too much. Is this normal?
- hi po, is it possible po ba na mabuhay normally ang isang tao na was abuse in her childhood and is still living and close to the abuser, and keep that secret all to herself/himself? or will it take a toll on her/him soon
- While I was abroad, I was prescribed with fluoxetine/prozac by a psychiatrist which I took for the 1 year I was abroad. I also met with a therapist weekly. I'm in the PH now and have since stopped the meds kasi naubos na. I was never directly like diagnosed or given some paperwork regarding it pero does it mean na diagnosed ako? Hahahaha. Labo slight eh.
- Hi! Ask ko lang kung okay lang ba na tumatawa ko pag may nangyaring di masyadong maganda sa paligid ko or pag naiinis ako? Instead na magalit, dinadaan ko na lang sya sa pagtawa? 😊
- I feel like I'm in a loop but I don't know how to get out of it. I'm not good at describing how I feel kaya I don't want to open up to anyone. Is this normal? Ano bang dapat kung gawin. Should I go to therapy?
- No question, I'm just here to say how awesome you are from doing this. Much love and keep doing a good work!
- Good morning! All my life, I've been trying to avoid my emotions due to past childhood trauma and my family. I grew in an environment where tough love is being given. Last 2019, I had some memory issues going on. Is this normal?
- Still confused between Psychologist and Psychiatrist could you help me out? And which one is better to consult if you are having depression and anxiety?
- I want to try hypnotherapy. I used to party a lot and there are some memories in my head that are unclear. It's been haunting me for the past 3-4 years. Because I was on drugs I couldn't remember things very well. But I feel the eek in my veins whenever I think about it. The problem about it is I don't know what went down if I was just hallucinating. I tried a lot of times to remember but I can't. Just writing about this now makes me want to vomit my guts out
- Hello, I believe I may be suffering from depression and anxiety, however because of covid it's kind of scary to go to a clinic for a consultation. First question, I dont think talking would help me, so can I skip trying a therapist and go straight to a psychiatrist? I understand online consultation is available, but it feels hard to get a hold of a good psychiatrist. Is there anyone or a site you could recommend that specializes in this area? Also do you know how many times on average do patients switch medications for depression before finding one that works for them?
- How do I connect with my relationships if most of the time I'm thinking in a logical way while most of them are not? I want to meet them in the middle. Kasi most of what I would do is not to talk nalang about it para di na mag-escalate.
- Should I open up about having depressive episodes to my parents? I'm scared that they would feel like they're at fault even though they aren't.
- How does one go about getting adderal for adhd.

- Can it still be professionally/clinically determined if an adult had autism as a child? I was suspected of having an autism/being in ASD as a kid but we weren't able to confirm because we couldn't afford to visit a psychologist back then.
- Around 3Q last year, I moved to a new apartment alone after living with friends for so long. It felt really lonely so I moved back with my Mom in Dec 2020. However, I started to feel more and more isolated from people. Sometimes, I find myself longing to hangout with friends and family, but when I finally get a chance to be with them, I feel a little uninterested. Sometimes I also just keep scrolling feeds in FB, IG or Twitter out of boredom or whatnot but I don't really feel connected with my friends' posts. All my planned trips in 2020 and 2021 got canceled, too. I stopped making plans altogether, even with work and school. I still show up, but I just don't really feel excited about anything lately...maybe except those series in Netflix like Squid Game. How do I turn things around?
- How good are mental health professionals here in the Philippines at diagnosing adult ADHD? What treatments do they usually provide for it? Do we have actual drugs for it here?
- Is there a way for me to stop doubting and become always anxious of the consequences if ever I choose one decision over the other? Career, relationships, personal life, etc. Thanks!

​

Edit: Better wording

- Not necessarily about mental health, but how is your work-life balance as a clinical psych professional during the pandemic? Is there a lot of stress involved? How flexible/rigid is your schedule? Do you work with colleagues often? How's the pay? I'm planning to go into the field po kasi :)
- Can i ask, what should i do if the person close to me is suicidal, he tried reaching out for a psychologist but it felt more of a problem rather than a solution and he doesn't know what else to do
- How long does it take to be clinically diagnosed with something? How to know the diagnosis is correct?
- [deleted]
- Do you think may correlation ang anxiety at gastric/acidic problems? Di ko na alam uunahin sa dalawa eh.

I'd been ro 3 different doctors and kung anu-ano nireseta at marami na rin akong trigger foods na tinanggal sa buhay but the issue still persists. Hard to sleep at night because of breathing problems plus insomnia with intrusive thoughts pa

- I don't feel human sometimes. Not like an alien, just not human. I feel like I'm pretending to be human and my emotions are forced. Like I would have to force them and act them out because that's what's expected of that role, but I really feel nothing at all. A previous commenter who's a doctor said to pursue a psychiatrist first rather than a psychologist for therapy. Thoughts?
- Hello. Do you know any clinic that offer free services?
- Hello po, do you have any tips for solving overthinking or having negative thoughts in general?
- What do i do to help my bestfriend with depression?

I think he is depressed, he lacks motivation, always gloomy, he said he attempted taking his life multiple times.

I try to be there for hi but its hard, things are made even worse because of school.

- I have lots of thoughts of me doing a lot of stuff I dont wanna ever do and I also keep reminding myself of some embarrassing moments in my past at completely random times
- Are there ways to know if somebody has multiple personalities? (Just curious about this OP)
- Hi, thank you for doing this!

My question is, is it normal to feel like you're getting dumber and dumber kapag depressed ka? I used to be an overachiever but now, at my job, my highest standard is the bare minimum lol

And when I look back on my high school years, parang di ko kilala yung overachieving self ko na yun hahaha like, who are you and why are you in my memories?? 😊

- Are you a Registered Psychologist? Is it worth it now to pursue a career in this field?
- Hi, how to deal with a family member that do not listen, self-righteous, spreads gossip, and prioritize other people in way that is damaging to the family?
- Hello po. I would like to share this, it started since I was a kid(cant really tell the specific age). Like I have this kind of behavior na I check stuffs like 10 times and have a certain pattern in doing them, example po yung switch ng lights, I have to turn off and on (4-8 sets) again to make sure na na-off ko talaga sya and yung lock po, I make sure to put my hands on the locks and touch them 4-8 sets. Like my brain isn't accepting what it sees dapat talaga nafefeel ko yun or nahahawakan and sometimes it's frustrating na. Thank you po
- Magkapareho lang po ba ang psychologist at psychiatrist? How do you decide which one to consult with?
- Any advice on my case? I'm someone super scared of public speaking. During f2f, when im tasked with reports or even recording myself speaking, i have a really hard time doing it. Before the night of report, i will not be able to sleep. The worst part is when im waiting for my turn. It feels like my heart is going to burst out of my chest and i get super uneasy(constantly fidgeting or moving my body). Then during the time i speak, my mind goes blank and forget what i have to say. Afterwards, i usually shake(maybe due to adrenaline?)

I would like to also ask who i should approach for this problem, is it a psychiatrist/psychologist/guidance counselor? And tips for dealing with this

- Hi! Not really a question on mental health but do you know any online consultation that specializes on Gender issues?
- What's your stand on self-diagnosing?
- [deleted]
- I have the traditional Filipino parents. Should I just stay away from them due to their toxicity?
- Hi, Po! I wanted to ask your opinion regarding availability on counselors. Its been so hard to find counselors or psychiatrist here in our country lol!
- 1. I pick on my thumb skin without noticing. It gives me satisfaction. Manonotice ko na lang pag masakit na or dumudugo na. I'm not sure if it's because I have dry skin but Googled that it can be OCD?

2. Sometimes I also feel like I'm not in the present? Like I'm still in the past. Dont know how to explain but Googled again that its depersonalization?

- Hello, I like to ask on how to deal with parents who have the mentality of "superiority" ? They always think that they are always right just because they are older. They mostly won't listen to any advice of the rest of younger family members, (we are already on our early and mid 30's by the way) they will just say "mas nakakatanda kami kaya sumunod kayo". Also, they like to assume anything like "baka naman ganto ganyan yan?" and will believe in it even though if you prove them wrong.

- Thank you for doing this :>

I'm a psychology student and interested in venturing clinical psych in the future. I just want to ask how your journey was especially in regards to your job hunting experience.

- My girlfriend (her therapist suspects that she has body dysmorphia although she was not able to continue her treatment due to the pandemic) are not confident with her body figure and just how she looks. Is there anything that i should try to avoid? Does telling her that she is beautiful does more damage than helping? There are times when she doesn't even believe me when i tell her that and i just don't want to hurt her more even if my intention is to help her.

- Hello po, normal lang po ba na habang nagbabasa ay kung san san pumunta yung isip mo? Minsan po kasi nahihitapan ako mag focus sa readings kasi pag nanabasa ako bigla nalang ako may iisipin na ibang bagay

- Hi, my friend have extreme anxiety like when he had a check, his bp was high due to his anxiety even though he is still young and healthy, how can I help him decrease his anxiety? Do I need to force him if he's unwilling to do it?

- Was prescribed fluoxetine and clonazepam for anxiety. Yung clonazepam yung pinakahelpful now. Parang alcohol without the warmth. Concern ko lang addicting po ba ang clonazepam. Sabi ni doc, hindi naman daw. Was hoping for your second opinion.

- How do I deal with getting anxious about time running out? For example, if I have an hour of free time I try to watch an episode/read books, but instead of fully immersing myself to what I'm consuming, mas nagfofocus ako sa kung ilan ang remaining time na meron ako. In the end, hindi ko naenjoy yung kinoconsume kong media.

- What should I do to get a diagnosis? I've been wondering if I have ADHD and I really want to know how to manage it but I'm not sure where to start.

- I randomly space out and what happens is that I either daydream or remember embarrassing moments. I noticed that this happens a lot recently and it is an involuntary action. Is there something wrong with me?

- Uhm, I don't really believe in the whole mental health thing. I just think you just "suck it up", by no means am I starting an argument or anything. But my friend seems to have this anxiety thing, how do I help him?

- [deleted]

- Hello, sometimes I look in the mirror and think to myself that "Yep, that's me." and I look into my hands and am amazed that wow I can actually move this. Is this normal?

- My family is dealing with a member diagnosed with depression. She's an adult that throws tantrums whenever things don't go her way or she isn't given things she demands and those are

expensive things. Given the pandemic situation, the household isn't on a financially stable position.

We are getting exhausted because it seems like she doesn't want to help herself. For us siblings, it looks like she's using her mental health as leverage to get what she wants. Our mom, as a solo parent, don't even know what to do anymore. Idk. She seems manipulative lalo na sa mom namin. I personally don't wanna talk to her because I know the things I could say would definitely not be good.

- Hii, do you have any advice for someone who is self sabotaging. Specifically, someone who knows what to do, want to do it, and then giving up without even trying. Its like, motivation = zero. It has been my problem even before the pandemic started. Always too scared or tired(or is it just in my mind) to try. And i also think it has to do with the environment im in, like, sometimes they think they are motivating me with their words but it would actually just make things worst.

- Normal lang po ba na kinakabahan ako kung nalock ko ba yung pinto? Pag aalis ako ng bahay at pupunta sa malayo vinivideo ko pa yung paglock ko para di ako kabahan.

- I'm a lawyer with ADHD but I keep this a secret. Kept it away during my time in UP too. Do you think that, as a society, we've become more open to the condition? If I decide to come out, would this affect my reputation?

- Porn addiction or other addiction? Naiinherited ba yung traits? I need a perspective from a fellow Filipino.

- Hello po, I have a friend who says he's going to take his own life because of a bad break-up.. should I be worried that he will actually go through with it?

I do notice his lifestyle changes like heavy drinking and not eating enough, he's very thin right now po.

- Thank you for doing this!

- What school did you go to? Was it hard to get into that school?

I am planning to study psychology/psychiatry when I go to uni in a few years(I'm in 11th grade)

- If I have to be honest with myself, I would like to ask if this is normal? I don't feel motivated when someone says they believe in me. It doesn't give me a "boost" when someone says I can do the thing.

"I believe in you!" "You can do it!"

Just doesn't have an effect to me. If any, mas lalo ako nappressure and in turn, I mess up the thing they expect me to do. I feel worried kasi when other people are being told by this, parang nabubuhayan sila ng loob. Pero sa akin, parang it doesn't have much effect. In my mind, I feel like why do I have to impress these people? Before kasi I would die for everyone to get everybody's approval. I'm past that now. But now I have this situation, almost completely opposite.

Is this normal?

- Ano pong pwedeng gawin pag tingin ng isang patient meron syang Avoidant Personality Disorder?

- I'm currently taking online class, but when I look to the activities needed na ipasa even days pa naman ang deadline, I already feel tired ,I always avoid to do it right away kahit na wala naman akong ginagawa and I always feel na ang dami lang dapat gawin, even playing computer games or watching random videos on youtube, I didn't even have the urge to do? Is this a sign of burnout of I'm just a lazy? One thing, is always stay up late even though tapos naman na ako sa dapat kong gawin, I avoid sleeping this past few weeks.

- How do you deal with ghosting? Especially when you have invested so much time and emotions to the person. Because tbh, aside from being heartbroken, its mental torture too 😞

- Is Stoicism a good replacement for therapy even though Stoicism is it's ancestor? I have schizophrenia (not diagnosed just yet) and I use it as a replacement. I don't have money to visit therapists or psychologist syaka di naniniwala parents ko dun :(

- Hi Doc, late ako sa session mo.

Back in the day when I was picking up a career, I regarded teaching as an option but I didnt choose it. In fact, I said to myself I shouldn't even consider it (no offense to educators out there, I admire all of you, it was a personal decision). Pero over the years I keep on having this stream of thought of becoming one. My friend also once told me that I look and speak like one (probably because I was sharing/teaching him something back then) which may have influenced it even more.

Is this phenomenon normal? I don't hate it per se, but I don't like it either. Is it ever possible of getting rid of such thoughts?

- Hi! Just wanna ask. How could I solve procrastination and laziness and get my motivation back after experiencing a difficult breakdown? I mean, I'm aware already that I need a mental health prof. like you to consult with, but I don't have the budget for it yet so I'm doing the most practical way as much as possible. Sorry...

- Hello po. I have manerisms po since elementary gang ngayon 27 yrs old nako. Dami po akong naging manerisms ang iba nawala na, ang iba mawawala saglit at babalik na naman. Pati po fiance ko napansin na manerisms ko pero thankful ako kasi tanggap nya pa rin ako. Pinapagalitan nya lang ako tuwing naandar manerisms ko na naman.

Ito po mga lists ng manerism ko sa ngayon:

1. Pinapatunog ang throat (parang may nabara sa lalamunan)
2. Pinapatunog ang throat (parang beatbox)

P.S napapansin ko po na naandar manerisms ko tuwing kinakabahan o na eexcite at pag may iniisip.

- [deleted]

- Is shyness normal if there is stress? What i mean by stress is constant crying(I've had an experience before na umiiyak ako once every two days minsan twice sa isang araw, constant cringing to the point that it's painful at least every hour naalala ko (minsan once every 5 to 10 minutes I timed it cuz it was so painful), emotionless and chest pain.

I'm really confused kung may social anxiety ako. Sinasabi nila palagi sa akin na normal lang ang nararamdaman ko pero bakit para sa akin hindi. Parang may stress involved at hindi ako masaya doon.

I also have self-esteem issues and had experienced bullying before.

I have also been nauseous about wearing certain type of clothing as a child. Is that normal? Is that connected to shyness?

- [deleted]

- I stopped biting my nails years ago pero it came back recently. Gusto ko lang malaman if related ito sa mental health and if it is, what does it mean? I'm only a teenager.

- I can't stop imagining scenarios in my head all the time and it even affects my sleep. Can you tell me some way to stop my brain from thinking? I just want to sleep 8hrs a day

- [removed]

- What are your thoughts about narcissism and its effects on the people around the person?

- I tend to overthink a lot, anything that could help me stop overthinking?

- Any ideas on how to remove intrusive thoughts? Been having a lot of them lately.

- Hi, OP! First off, I really appreciate you starting this thread to help others have a clearer understanding about mental health. The 2020s has been real tough for everyone, so having a safe space for discussion is welcoming.

My question is kind of sensitive, but how far can one intervene or approach someone who has a strong suicidal ideation? Like, them at the stage that they have a vivid "perfect scenario" in mind, or maybe being very active in their self-sabotage (such as picking up vices in the hopes of it doing them in, taking the extra steps to place themselves at risk like choosing to walk near the roads), but not yet doing self harm or making plans.

- I want to break up with my severely depressed GF but I'm afraid she will kill herself.

What should I do?

- I'm not sure what to do. Late 20s female, I've been experiencing a bit of stress after moving into a new job (strictly WFH), but nothing I can't handle.

My roommate noticed that I grind my teeth when I sleep. Grind to the point that you'd wonder if my teeth are still there. I was told by an acquaintance that these are signs of anxiety

I'm generally a happy person and never really sought therapy. I've had traumatic experiences (physical & mental abuse) but I think I got over it pretty well. I do have random times within a day wherein I remember a mistake I did before and end up verbally berating myself. Oh and I still get startled/scared when a man (in work or otherwise) raises their voice. I've always thought this was normal but apparently it's not?

Just not sure if this is enough to see a psychiatrist/psychologist for?

- bakit masama po ang mag self-diagnose?

- Hi! Why do I feel empty sometimes??

Sometimes, there is this random moment where I will feel so empty. As a means to avoid that feeling, I'm trying to get in touch with my friends. But sometime talking with them does not really ease my feeling of emptiness. I'm also trying to reflect what is the reason behind this feeling

- Are there any counseling services with face to face sessions available in metro manila right now?

- Hi! Where can I get free consultation for mental health check up? Thanks!

- How are you able to tell if a person, who is fully functional (able to get up, eat, hold a job, live normally at least, how it looks like on the outside), is suffering from depression? Or is there such a person in the first place? How do you determine if a person has depression vs if they are just sad?

- Hello! Wanna ask about my mental status. I was diagnosed with an adjustment disorder last April with depressed mood & anxiety. Is it possible that my condition moved to depression and anxiety na since I feel sad and down most days. I understand that the adjustment disorder was d/t the traumatic event that happened to me. But lately, I can't actually distinguish where the emptiness is coming from 😊

- Thank you OP first of all. I was diagnosed with Major Depressive Disorder and was on Escitalopram. Due to covid I stopped my consultation with my Psych and meds as well. Hindi ako palakaibigan na tao and my social circle is mabibilang lang sa kamay, may trust issues ako na feeling ko pinaguusapan ako palagi pag nakatalikod na ako, i always feel out of the norms parang di ko ka level ung mga taong nasa paligid ko. I started feeling more and more direction (career and life) kasi wala akong feeling ng accomplishment, getting diagnosed with diabetes makes it worse. Previously I was suicidal, hopeless, and very sad now wala na akong maramdaman. I feel hollow na, I started laughing at dark humors and I started enjoying suicide jokes (memes more) but I no longer have ideation. Do you think nag evolve na? Thank you again OP

- What are your ways of being mindful? Its hard for me to finish my to do lists of the day cuz I can't focus

- How can I prevent thinking about my regrets on the things that I was unable to do during our pandemic?

- Hi OP, thanks for doing this! Is there a likelihood of having a clinical depression if I can't feel any positive emotions for months now? All I could feel are negative emotions.

- Hi! Was wondering how it is working as a clinical psychologist. I graduated with the same bachelor's degree but have been working in corporate. I've always wanted to switch to clinical psych but not sure if the job can give a living wage. I'm scared I'll take a master's degree and won't be able to sustain a living with the profession.

- Hello po masama po ba ung sobra over thinking kasi nung grade nine po ako nangyari saakin ung at na depress ako pero ngayong para ok naman po ako

- What could be the cause of anxiety the moment you wake up from sleep? I usually experience it.

- Is it normal to feel empty every single day? I mean, I used to be in medication for clinical depression in my age of 13 however that was only in 3-4 months until my parents stopped my medication abruptly without alerting my therapist.

That was 5 to 6 years ago and I think my mental state and cognitive abilities are declining as years passed. I've lost interest in my hobbies and in everything. Sometimes I wonder if I'm real and that I feel like the world is a dream. My mother has manic depression (and some speculated schizophrenia) and I'm wondering if I managed to get it from her or if maybe they're just not so good parents.

I did get my mother's face making me appear feminine though I'm a male and also her asthma. I'm scared if I might become a male version of her. Is what I'm feeling normal or not? I'm just scared that maybe I'm just too sensitive or weak and looking too much into it but I'm just so tired.

My suicidal thoughts became the norm now and I have no trusted person to confide in my family (mother is religious, father too scary to talk to since he's always nitpicky about everything from the undone dishes to simple clutter, and my sister and brother thinks I'm just an attention seeker.)

I don't know why I'm still here. Did go to a free checkup to a doctor at my school and the guidance counselor but all they talk about is pray the sadness away to God. Sometimes, I'm sorry for this, I just imagine killing everyone I know then myself. I've also been wasting my money and not even caring if I manage to be hit by a car or vehicle while walking. I did once get hit by a motorcycle in my pelvis (not bleeding, but bruised) and didn't care about it. I didn't even accept the guy's payment and just walked as if nothing happened.

I'm really sorry about this if it's too long. I'm just at the end of my rope and I'm not sure if I can keep on going. I'm not trying to be edgy or seek attention. I just want to feel happy and normal again.

- Hi. I'm feeling this for few months na. Kapag nagiging aware ako sa paghinga ko, parang may tendency ako na pigilin yung paghinga ko, kaya ang nangyayari naghahabol ako ng hininga. Is this anxiety? Napaparanoid ako, kaso natatakot naman akong magpacheck up coz daming tao sa hospitals and katakot magkasakit these days.

- I failed the board exam last October 2019, ang lapit na din ng grade ko to pass kaso hindi pa pinalad. How to move on from that? Out of the blue, nakakaramdam ako na feel ko parang I'm a failure. Para bang yung moment na yun eh na define nya na ako.

- How do you let go of anger that's been caused by a relationship trauma? I decided I would forgive but every day, I still struggle with the doubts and the anger. I don't know where to start even though I've read extensively on healing already.

- Hi OP! I feel like I have been regressing into my old anti-social self from being in this work from home situation for over a year, and now I don't even bother joining nonwork chikahan/e-numan sessions. On top of this I have been withdrawing into my thoughts and daydreaming much more often lately. I was googling whether this is normal for people at this time and somehow I came across personality disorders, and I was able to relate a lot to a certain one that I read about. So now I want to consult a professional to see if I can get an official diagnosis. Do I need to see a psychologist or a psychiatrist? Thanks in advance. Edit: I already had one counseling session

with a therapist but she said she's not a psychiatrist so she can't give me a diagnosis. I just got a bit confused since I thought seeing a psychologist would be enough to get a diagnosis.

- Is it wrong to think that human emotion is a person's greatest weakness? I have reached to a point where I always try to get along with anyone based on how they react rather than perceive their emotions.

- [deleted]

- Trauma po ba yun pag natutulog nang may hawak na kutsilyo? I've had a rough life for as long as I can remember

- I've always knew na I have moodswings as a child, this is due to generics. However, upon the pandemic, not only na mas matindi yung mood swings ko even though na hindi ako nag PMS.

My severe moodswings also worsen nun nag start mag online school and even till today, it includes unnecessary breakdowns during times na when things could be fixed naman easily. How do you address this and also how will you psychologists/psychiatrist determine if someone has signs of severe depression and intense emotional fluctuations.

- Hello po! Isa po akong grade 12 student na may malaking interest sa psychology and Im considering taking psychiatry as a future career. Tanong ko po, pano ko po alam kung kakayanin ko po yung career path na ito? Alam ko po med school is extremely hectic and I dont think i can get through that without a passion for what im learning, pano niyo po nasabi na psychiatry ang gusto niyo talaga gawin?

- [deleted]

- 1. Are consultations still not allowed in person as of the moment?

2. Bakit inaabot ng 2 to 3 months ang schedule sa PMHA?

- Hi. What is the best treatment for anxiety/panic attack? Thanks in advance.

- Do you know what depersonalization/derealization is? If so, how often do you encounter this term in your field and have you had clients that suffer from this disorder?

- Hi! Do you provide free consultation and write prescriptions? I'm fine with telemed through video calls.

- Can someone with bad social anxiety or general anxiety get through medical school? :((Online classes now pero ang dali ko padin matrigger :((

- Hello, OP, is there a disorder concerning the lack of common sense?, It's a weird question but Im generally curious..

- After 8 years of relationship, my GF broke up with me a month ago. As if I lost half of my personality. How can I move on? There are times where I feel depressed and anxiety starts to kick in. Thanks in advancs!

- Hi OP, I have a question. Last time I cried, yung sobrang iyak was the day or last moment that I was able to hold my mom's warm hands. It's almost 3months now. I've been bothered.. wondering how much more pain and loss can I handle. I already lost my brother, in 2015, yung guardian ko and grandfather last 2019. And now si mama. I'm left with my younger sister. I've been living on my own since I graduated college. Been working hard since then kase I was supporting my mom for her medication and expenses sa bahay nila. And now I tried really hard to get back to work after ng libing. I still cry when I recall those moments, when I miss her. Nararamdaman ko yung literal na heart broken. Napapatanong din ako sa sarili ko if was it too

soon for me to try and get back on track. I really can't afford to take a break from work kaya naisip ko it might help me to atleast magfunction ulit. Please advise if you have recommendations for activities na dapat or pwede kong gawin. I am aware naman with the things I am doing, I'm trying to take care of myself. I still have my sister and my partner pero I am far away from them pero I regularly talk to them via phone call. I am also trying to communicate more with my other relatives. Is this normal. Am I rushing things to be okay? Alam ko normal to feel na nagbago din ako, from masayahin to pagiging tahimik. Sometimes nakconscious na din ako sa health ko pero I am trying to live and eat healthy. Minsan natatakot akong matulog thinking na baka may mangyaring masama. I can't tell if these are anxieties kase hindi naman ako aware having them before.

- What are the chances that my dream/nightmare is true? I woke up crying. In the dream I was watching it happened to me as 2 or 3 yr old child. I remember asking my psychiatrist what are the chances that its true. But i told her not to answer it if she thinks i cant handle the truth. She asked me then if i wanted to be a referred to a trauma specialist. I still do not know what to make of it

- [deleted]

- Hello. Is it normal to forget things easily or certain moments? Pwede bang magcause dito 'yung mga SSRI meds kahit na ilang taon nang nakalipas?

- Can you test me for any mental issues?

- Is there a correlation between a mental health of a person and the dolomite sand in manila bay? Does it really enhance the mental health of an individual?

- I wish this was done more frequently :((maybe like once a month because I'd really need that, and I know others do too

- Does Duterte's behavior have a name in your field?

I sometimes think he really has mental issues.

- Is it really worth it to get a mental health coach? seeing the price for the monthly pay for a health coach (about Php 1500-2500) made me back out on not having one (because my parents are just gonna complain to me "pInApAbAyArAn kA nAmln nG iBaNg TaO pArA TuMiNo kA pErO hInDi kA pArIn nAgBaGo").

- Hi, I don't know if you will see this but I need to ask a professional. My aunt's sister died and it triggered something in her. Now, she's staying with us because during the wake she was out of it. She's been here for about two weeks now and we all thought she was getting better but then the next day she would lose her mind and start screaming at everyone and tells us she wants to die. She refuses to eat because she thinks we put in bad stuff in it, she even suspects that we tamper with her medicine. She's always asking us to quiet down even though it's a quiet day, sometimes she would say there are people whispering in her ear. She would sometimes hallucinate and try to find the people that aren't there and would be so sure that they are here. She also started forgetting some stuff, for example she had just taken a bath but then she'll go in again because she says she hasn't taken one. There would be nights she wouldn't be able to sleep even after taking her medicine(they kinda work like a sleeping pill too) but she's fighting the urge to sleep.

We keep thinking we wanted to be here for her and help her but do you think its best that we bring her to a rehabilitation center so the people and doctors there can help her better?

- Hi prof, just asking, is there some kind of way to make myself tilt proof? for example every time I play online video games I would just be tilting for days haha, can I "fix" that side of me or something?

Also this phrase "a healthy body translates to a healthy mind" is this true?

- Hi medyo late ko na to makita pero sana masagot mo pero ok lang kung d mo masagot kasi busy ka. May friend ako na naglalaslas sya as coping mechanism nya, sinabi na nya sakin na wala syang plano mag suicide hanggang laslas lang, meron po ba akong pedeng gawin na parang support para mabawasan abg paglaslas nya? Or any better solution?

- What can I do to let go of emotional baggage from a recent breakup? Having thoughts of being not good enough and having self doubts. I felt so invalidated by my partner of more than 7 yrs.

I am trying to love myself by eating healthier and having consistent exercise but at the end of the day I keep on thinking about what had happened and going into self pity and then crying myself to sleep. I want it to stop.

- Hi, what can you say about the notion that there is an alternative treatment for ADHD aside from taking meds because some parents don't want their kids medicated? Thank you so much.

- gorl how to deal with jealousy sa ex (na first love) ng partner mo ;((((

- I tend to forget things too often, like the go in to another room and forget what you were gonna do, but instead it happens too often that sometimes I forget what I was doing at the moment, even forgetting where I put my phone multiple times even doe its either in my pocket, on my hand, or just somewhere too obvious, Im getting kinda worried about all the gaps in my memory

- How to make friends without experiencing anxiety?

- Hi, was given Escitalopram for what my psychiatrist believes to be dysthymia. I think I might have an anxiety disorder also, but not sure as my psychiatrist didn't bring it up. Do psychiatrists often get their diagnoses wrong because of similarities between different disorders?

- Hello, sought help from a psychiatrist sabe possibly bpd but wasn't fully diagnosed kasi i never returned. Then went with several therapy sessions pero she didn't labeled whatever is wrong with me and just suggested coping stuff, meditate , journaling, less coffee and all but didn't really helped.

Not sure what to do with this po but i know something is wrong with me. I think the psychiatrist was right as I was reading several topics about bpd. They said dbt helps. Meron ba tayo nun dito sa pinas? And how to go on with this because ayoko naman ma project yung issue ko sa ibang tao. Thank you po

- Hello, can I ask how would an adult person go about seeking diagnosis for ADHD in the Philippines?

I heard ADHD medications are strictly controlled here but people can still get it. What and where would be the correct process to legit receive or buy medications?

Any recommendations for people struggling with ADHD affecting work life balance? Thanks in advance for any answers!

- do i really have adhd or am i actually lazy like my mother is telling me

- Hi po! I don't know if you're still answering pero I'll try my luck ehehehe pano po ba pag bigla ka na lang talaga nawawalan ng gana? Like your mind is screaming at you to do this and that pero your body just won't? Also po yung pagiging indifferent tapos later sobrang takot na takot? idk if i explained it well pero i hope medyo naiintindihan huhuhu

- I can't remember that I have a traumatic experience when I was younger. In fact, I'm in a very nice family. But I have a long term depression (had 2 therapists) with anger issues. How could I help to know the root of it and deal with it?

- Hi OP! I have a friend who has a history of self harm (multiple times and even life threatening ones), he/she talks to me every once in a while but i cant seem to listen to his/her problems or give advice for it since im dealing with my own demons and listening to other people's problems really exhausts me and i feel awful about it. Every time i cut short a convo, i always make sure to tell him/her to seek professional help. Is there any other way that i can help him/her?

- Hi! I might be late na on this trend but I hope mapansin.

I get random flashbacks about the traumas I suffered as a child. Be it sexual, physical, and/or verbal abuse. I am 31 na as in today is my birthday. Gusto ko talaga maintindihan bakit nag fflashback etong mga bad memories na pilit ko kinakalimutan.

A bit background:

A bit of background:he family who adopt me made me feel I am not their biological family. But we suddenly got "close" when I started to earn money

- Good morning!

I just want to ask if what's the best way po to sleep? It's more than a year since nagkaroon ako ng maayos na tulog and body clock. Katulad ngayon, gising pa ako. 4:00 am and gising na gising pa. Bukod sa hirap matulog, I do experience anxiety and regret sometimes. Btw, nanggaling ako sa isang traumatic na relationship (trust issues, etc..). Should I try sleeping pills? What's the best way to cope up po sa ganitong sitwasyon? Minsan dinadaan ko nalang sa laro kapag sobra na ang nararamdamang hindi maganda. Thank you po!

- [deleted]

- I get a really bad headache everytime I feel upset. Is there something wrong with me?

- Hi, Sparkle_88. I consulted a psychiatrist months ago pero hindi ko na tinuloy yung program nya. So, this is mu story, i like being anonymous and Reddit is a perfect place for me. I like going to a place, mostly videoke bars (i am from southern part of the metro and i like going up north to give myself another character - a little). I am a good singer, and so that is my first offering to my audience to like me. I am insecure with my face and body, naiinggit ako sa mga artista, all the time. One night, i cried so hard sa banyo kasi walang pumansin sa boses ko, and

when people do, i have this high energy. I like living anonymously. Live in small spaces, and few friends. I can feel that this is some kind of disorder.

- How bad is the access to mental health care in the Philippines?

- Where do I reach out for possible Adult ADHD?

- Hi! I want to ask if there's a solution of not getting tired?

Hindi po typical na pagod. Like more on pagod na mabuhay. I find myself getting tired even in conversation. Facing my obligations. Dealing with my siblings na I'm fully aware na gusto ko sila sagipin sa mediocre and toxic environment na meron sa bahay. Pagod na mag-aral. Unbothered if hindi ko mapasa yung mga dapat kong ipasa...

And yet, I still had hopes everyday na aayos din 'to. All is well ika nga po ni Rancho sa 3 idiots. Pero everyday din po walang progress.

- Hi. Pahabol po if that's ok.

Yung addiction po ba ay symptoms ng anxiety or depression or its a mental difficulty?

May gambling addiction po ako and I tried many times to stop but my will power is beaten most of the time. The strange thing is, pagnananalo ako, wala lang. Flat affect. Walang feeling. Pero pagtalo ako, I can feel it. Para bang mas gusto ko na matalo kasi may nafe feel ako. Or maybe I'm depressed.

- Hi, i have problems, in communicating in a front of lot people- i can speak clearly with my friends but when it comes through reciting even it just an introduction, i always feel discomfort and fear... (heart rate increase, overthinking on what should i say), and there are also time that i feel "kaba " for no specific reason, i always feel this since i was in JHS... and i hate it

- [deleted]

- Im curious makakasuhan po ba kayo if you give psych test for free?

Title: October 10 is World Mental Health Day. Help us raise awareness. We are 5 experts on mental health here to answer your questions -- Ask Us Anything.

Post Text: Your mental health matters -- especially right now. We are a panel of experts who either study, treat, or live with a mental health disorder. Ask us anything.

* Halley Cornell: <https://www.webmd.com/cornell-halley>

* Nicholas Grant, Ph.D:

<http://glma.org/index.cfm?fuseaction=Page.viewPage&pageId=1019&grandparentID=532&parentID=584&nodeID=1>

* Hansa Bhargava, MD:

<https://www.webmd.com/hansa-bhargava>

* Neha Pathak, MD:

<https://www.webmd.com/neha-pathak-md>

* Smitha Bhandari, MD: <https://www.pathgroupatl.com/>

* Proof:

<https://twitter.com/WebMD/status/1313169586200682501>

EDIT: Thank you for joining us today. We are signing off for now.

At WebMD, we want to help our members when they need it the most. [Here is a list of crisis resources, hotlines, and websites that may be of help if you or someone you know may be in trouble.](<https://www.webmd.com/help/crisis-resources>) If you think you need immediate help and cannot speak to a family member, a medical professional, or a member of the clergy, please reach out to one of these organizations or dial 911 immediately.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- A lot of people in my community (in the Rocky Mountains) are deeply suffering, emotionally, because we are not only isolated from friends and family because of the virus, but we're also unable to go outside because of the terrible and incessant wildfire smoke.

Our eyes, noses, and throats sting & burn if we attempt to. Our coughs are terrible.

How do we take care of our mental health when we can't do practically anything? We can't even take walks outside and it's been like this for over seven weeks now. Most of us still work from home. What can we do to not have cabin fever?

- What are your thoughts on treating looooong term depression/anxiety (20+ years) where therapy and many different pills, exercise, good diet, normal sleep schedule, and moderate social interaction didn't help?

- I met with some therapists years ago as I was struggling to concentrate at work. All they did was listen to me, wrote some notes and told me to come back the following week. This continued for months with two separate therapists. No coping mechanisms offered; no books suggested for self-improvement; no active engagement. Ambivalent. Radio. Silence.

This continued for months before I gave up and realized I was wasting time from both of our lives and my co-pays.

After sharing this with other people, they noted that their therapists generally did the same thing. Is what I described an appropriate approach of a therapist as supported by the APA?

- How can I tell when my depression/anxiety is manifesting physical symptoms vs having an actual physical illness I may require help for? I had a bad mental health day yesterday and last night got so dizzy and nauseas I can barely stand. I don't want to call in to work if it's all in my head.

- [deleted]

- What do you believe is the best way for someone with anxiety and depression (or people with mental health issues in general) to work up the courage to seek help? Working up the courage to even look up therapists in the area can seem like a huge challenge.

- Hi there! First off, thank you for opening up the conversation regarding mental health! My question, what are your thoughts on the use of psychedelics (specifically psilocybe) and the future of mental health treatment? I personally believe that a singular mushroom trip saved my life, and love that its becoming part of the conversation throughout North America

- Within the past 20 years have practitioners in your field begun considering the connection between gastrointestinal health and neurotransmitters (epinephrine, norepinephrine, dopamine and serotonin)?

If a patient is diagnosed with a mood disorder, do you think doctors should consider improving gastrointestinal health as part of a patient's therapy or is this a red herring?

Edit: added word "mood".

- Why is mental health care so expensive? How can the poor receive mental health care? It seems like mental health is a luxury only for the wealthy or those with expendable income.

- What's your best advice on how to deal with social loneliness and how to get rid of the need to depend on others for validation and self-worth?

- So I've got this... j/k

A common theme on /r/ADHD is the persisting 1980s attitude that only kids have ADHD, it's not real, it's only hyperactive boys, etc. as well as pharmacists treating everyone with a prescription as a drug seeker.

Given the extreme demands on physicians time, is there anything that can be done to improve their continued education to alleviate such issues?

- I've been recovering from a breakdown due to depression, anxiety, and PTSD for a year now, and have had 3 major suicidal incidents. I had to stop working last August. I've done intensive outpatient, intensive case management, partial hospitalization, back to intensive case management. Right when I thought I might be ready to go back to work, COVID hit. Then, in June, my wife was diagnosed with stage 3 breast cancer -- she's only 38, which means really bad things, in terms of survivability (she's getting excellent care, and there's every reason to be hopeful). Not to mention the world in general.

I've been in therapy for years, and I'm on Wellbutrin and Buspar, and I believe that they're all doing fuck-all for me. I was on a higher dose of Wellbutrin, and that made me feel bipolar, and caused me to cycle between depression and hypomania. In the past year, I've also tried Viibryd (horrible diarrhea, all day, every day) and Trintellix (killed all my emotions, made me impotent for months, even after stopping), and in the past I've tried other SSRIs, which I stopped for similar emotional and sexual reasons. I did about 50 sessions of TMS, which was a total waste of time and money. My psychiatrist wants me to do ECT, and I'm just not going to do that.

I've lost faith in both psychiatry and psychology, and I'm running out of energy to try and get well. I no longer actually believe in a world where I will recover in any meaningful way. My therapist just smiles at me and tells me to force myself to keep going. Her actual words are, "you just gotta force yourself!"

What advice do you have for someone who's been doing everything their care team has asked them to do, and still feels like killing themselves four times a week? Because I'm running out of

steam, and I feel like my therapist and psychiatrist are both calling it a win to have me alive, and that's as far as they're going.

- [deleted]

- [removed]

- How do you help a person in your life suffering from a mental health issue such as bi-polar disorder? What about when they push you away in order to shield you from their problems?

- How can you tell the difference between a therapist or organization that is really trying to help you, or one that is just trying to make a buck off of you?

- What is the most effective way to get a diagnosis for your mental health when you feel utterly hopeless and like nobody cares?

- How can you distinct 'mood swings' from actual mental health issues? Like, if I got an F on my university class, I could be depressed for a certain amount of time before brushing it off. We don't call that a mental illness(or do we?). A person who actually has depression would react the same; what distincts depression from mood swings?

Also, can someone be self-aware that they're mentally sick? My parents used to tell me most of those who claim they have depression don't actually have depression; instead, they claimed it's just a certain issue in their life bothering them, and remedying that would make their 'depression' go away. That is, they claimed categorizing their personal issues in names like 'depression', 'schizophrenia' and such is just a band-aid to find a comfort zone they can belong. What do you think about this(personally I think it's 70% bs and 30% borderline truth)?

- [deleted]

- What makes you qualified to call yourself experts in mental health when the majority of you appear to be content creators of some sort with little to no clinical background working with clients with mental health issues?

- [removed]

- What can I do to lessen my anxiety from invading my relationships with those I love? I take meds, exercise, and eat healthy.

- Hello, first off thank you so much for doing this! I could never afford care no matter where I looked or asked and it was daunting. I'm not sure where to go for non-profit care..

And now my question is this - I have a problem with conversation in that I feel like I'm not interested in it, even when I'm not depressed. So it gets worse during my depressive moods. I just feel soulless and like people wouldn't be interested because I don't feel like chatting. I would rather do things like art, gaming, traveling or watching shows. I feel as if I've lost my sense of humor as well and only laugh with something I've seen on youtube vs a joke a family member would tell me.

I can't pinpoint what I'm feeling or what's causing this. Any thoughts that might help? I do wish to make better relationships but it feels difficult. I don't wanna be so distant.

- I have a friend who suffers from VERY severe bouts of depression. She is getting professional help and her partner is supportive and takes care of her. But I always feel like there must be something that I as a friend could do better on her dark days, other than saying "I'm here for you

if i need to talk." And then just waiting. What can people do who have loved ones who are dealing with mental health issues?

- Why aren't brain scans more prevalent in mental health diagnosis?

- I am a chronic depressed person. I'm 37, diagnosed at 17. I have been through the ringer on meds and currently take a high dose of a med that gives me wicked side effects of I forget even one dose. I have looked a few times at Ketamine treatments to help out or reset my brain. Do you recommend it or am I asking way out of subject?

- How do I get to a point where I care about myself enough to get help?

I know it's counterintuitive but I think I care about money more than myself. I've convinced myself that I shouldn't get help because it's expensive and I've convinced myself that it wouldn't help. I feel like I know what would probably help (like sleep/exercise) but I don't think I really care enough to try? Any suggestions?

- Hi, thanks for doing this, it's a great service.

My question is: what's the best way to let go/accept a traumatic memory? I've come to somewhat of an acceptance, but still have some minor issues with it.

- What do I do when nothing fills the void anymore?

I use to enjoy playing video games and reading but I have to force myself to do them and it feels like yet another chore.

I just sleep not because I am sleepy but I just don't want to be awake/boredom.

I've been a NEET since 2013 I have agoraphobia and I haven't driven a vehicle in 4 years due to fear of driving.

I have GAD,OCD,Panic Disorder,psychosis(NOS), schizotypal personality disorder,and homicidal and suicidal intrusive thoughts on a daily basis.

I take 9 psychotropic meds a day to stay "normal".

Also I am hypochondriac so in the entire year of 2020 I've only left my apartment twice due to covid-19 and it was to go to doctor visits.

I can't find enjoyment in anything anymore and it feels like I am on autopilot all day long.

Thanks for your time.

- [deleted]

- I'm afraid to take 'medicines' (that doesn't mean i am hesitant to take professional helps in the form of sessions,counsellings etc or do meditations etc).I'm reluctant only because i feel that once u take medicines etc u have to continue taking it or become depend on it.How much is that true? I'm depressed and is feeling low for a 'long time'..so i should say i'm more than compatible with it now but i now my brain is not functioning properly because my academics is on a all time

low. Will u advice me some non-professional methods to tackle this situation of me.?like music,non academic activities etc.Thanks

- Why are psychologists allowed to give up on me? I know that ive been depressed forever and tried many meds, but when they say "i dont know what to do" it destroys me

- How could I spread awareness about mental health?

I'm a guy that suffer from bad mental health myself but I wanna help others. How could I do it?

Send message to people? Post something on social media (hate those)? Go outside and talk to strangers?

I have no idea what is effective or not.

- How does someone get a good diagnosis? USA healthcare. My PCPs over the last 20 years seem to just be guessing.

- I'm feeling disconnected from the world. Not a corona thing. More that I am perceiving my own values and beliefs as out dated or misaligned with the common person. A general sense that I don't belong here anymore, no one wants me, not all of me anyway. I've nothing to work towards and nothing to look forwards to. I feel like I just want to stop caring or feeling bad. I do suffer occasional bouts of anxiety and depression. I always feel like I've done something wrong too.

How can I reconnect?Is it okay for me to just medicate myself out, like if I got a xanax prescription?

- [removed]

- Although I feel that I suffered for a long time, I was finally diagnosed with moderate depression in 2017. I've since been on Lexapro 10mg, only once weaning off for pregnancy and restarting after giving birth. I know it's such a low dose, but there are medical opinions out there that say SSRI's should only be taken for a limited amount of time (3-6months). Obviously, I have bypassed that ... because they help. So much. It's a whole new world on them! I have been in talk therapy since 2012 and with these two working together, it's been so beneficial.

After going on them, I discovered my dad is on SSRI's and so is my aunt. I believe my mom needs a diagnosis, but would never.

All that to say, do you hold opinions on SSRI duration?

- I have type 1 bipolar disorder and I would like to ask how to get rid of the fear that I'll fall back into another manic episode? It's been about a year and a half since my last one and I've taken my meds on time since and improving other aspects of my health and I am way better than I was back then. However there's always this lingering thought that one day my brain will go crazy again and then boom another psych ward visit. Any advice would be nice. Thank you.

- Dont you think with increased technological use and isolated lifestyles that we are heading towards, mental health of global community is going to get worse? What are some steps that an individual can take to help people around.? Are you guys leveraging technology to create some solutions, I am very passionate about this topic specifically because I have dealt with anxiety/depression myself in the past and really want to do something for the people suffering

- Is it true that depression can significantly impact memory retention?

- Are you concerned that your field is too reliant upon pharmaceuticals as a tool for therapy? Wouldn't promoting lifestyle changes be more sustainable and lower the risk of dependence or side effects?

Do pharmaceutical industry sales representatives have an inappropriate amount of influence on how patients are treated for mental health disorders? If so, what can be done to stop this?

- Why is seeking mental health help from a doctor so costly?
- What can you tell a patient (me) who underwent all known drugs and therapies for their illness without any result and is now getting disillusioned by all medical care workers?

At the start of a treatment there are no guarantees but at the end it's always my fault if it doesn't give positive results.

What can I do with a therapist that gives obvious terrible advice? (Why don't you get a baby? Babies make people happy... Why don't you try drugs, maybe that will give you a goal in life... why don't you visit someone who can see color auras and predict your future? You haven't tried it so you don't know if it helps...

What we do isn't therapy anymore because clearly you aren't putting effort in it. Same price though.

I feel that if walking or biking or coloring doesn't make you instantly happy, there is nothing more a therapist can offer.

With all respect for the job but I have encountered some very bad doctors and therapists that only made the situation worse.

- First, I'd like to start by thanking WebMD for this.

This is my question:

I suffered from mental psychosis for 3 years, as I was hearing voices almost 24/7, until I finally sought help from a professional. I have been on medication for 2 years and a half now but I feel like I became less creative and lazier mentally. I stopped writing and stopped reading books for example and studying became less interesting for me, I even stopped playing soccer and when I play, I'm less determined to win the game or even score a goal, exactly the opposite of how I was before being on medication which I have to say helped me to be a normal person again but changed me and took some of my favorite hobbies away from me.

What steps should I be taking to solve this and get active again?

- How to get rid of my social anxiety? It's been eating me for quite a month now. Everytime I go out, the feeling of being under constant watch makes me feel sick. I haven't always been like this, but particularly since past few months it has started to happen. Like everytime I am out my heartbeat gets a lil fast, I feel conscious of myself, feel low on confidence and I try to reach back to my place as soon as possible. This has taken care of me, I'm not ready to give up to this feeling. But still I doubt what could be the cause for it and how to tackle it down.

- What are some good resources for someone to find a therapist?

- What if seeing a psychologist doesn't seem to be helping?

- How do you stop an existential crisis? I've had them almost every night for years now and I really want them to stop.

I'm already super stressed from online university work and various other things. What would you recommend?

- As I understand it, for generalized, day-to-day challenges, our mental health is up against three primary things: stress, anxiety, and depression.

In the multiple times I've seen a mental health professional in my life, I've learned a lot about anxiety and depression, but surprisingly little (to nothing) about stress - which seems like the most relevant (and most prevalent!) right now.

How do I cope with overwhelming stress?

- How can I notice the difference between being really bored and a sort of initial depression?

- How can someone overcome their fears of stigma, permanent records, or being 'locked up' for expressing what they are going through to a mental health professional? Is this a reason why people don't seek help?

- Could you explain the term organic mental disorder? Because by the definition aren't all mental illnesses due to organic causes? Is there other forms of mental illness?

- I recently experienced a minor traumatic event (partner had a sudden medical event and I had to call 911 - everything is ok now and it seems unlikely to reoccur). I feel like I've emotionally recovered from the event but I'm still feeling unusually foggy, distractible, and tired a week later (despite going out of my way to get good sleep).

My therapist thinks this is a trauma response - if so, is there anything I can do about this other than taking it easy and practicing self-care?

- Is there sufficient empirical data to establish what ****quantitative**** changes take place in neurotransmitter levels when a patient is prescribed SSRIs or SNRIs? That is, can we see or count neurotransmitters or is direct observation not technically feasible?

What would happen if a person with perfectly healthy neurotransmitter levels and no symptoms of a mood disorder began taking either? In simplest terms, are these "happy pills" that will give an increased mood to anyone who takes them or do they only help those who already have a biochemical deficiency or imbalance?

- How can I help my friend that has some level of depression and anxiety but can't seek professional help because her parents don't think it's necessary and it's for crazy people?

- Depression is something I'm sure I've been fighting for years now, and while I'm still mostly functional, there are times when I want to do something and just... can't. It's difficult for me to explain. I want to know, how can I talk to someone like my dad about it and show them that I'm not lazy? It's a bigger problem than that and I need help.

- What are the most popular treatment modalities today, and what modalities were once popular but used minimally today?

- I am a 22 year old male eat healthy and not overweight. But it Feels like i dont have energy and my head feels kind of heavy. What can i do about it?

- How do you think the covid lockdowns will effect the future of how people view mental health?
- I suffer from severe depression and social anxiety. I make too much money to be approved for state or federal aid, but I don't make enough to seek professional help. What options exist for people like me?
- [deleted]
- Hi all. I've been diagnosed with C-PTSD. Can you talk a little about what distinguishes C-PTSD from PTSD? It kind of comes and goes in waves for me as I'm getting treatment, today is a bad day. Do people ever fully improve from a PTSD diagnosis? Or are there any permanent neurological changes?
- The UN stated that youth mental health will be one of their advocacies and goals as a response to the pandemic. What is something that you think is vital towards reaching this global goal, that people aren't aware of?
- I have had clinical depression since my junior high and high school years but made a jump to major depression in my early 20s. I'm currently in my early 30s and have stopped taking medication due to the extreme costs to seek any professional help, insurance is not very good. My fiancé does what he can, when I let him in, during my down phases but what more should I do to keep an open dialogue with my fiancé if I all would rather do is lie in bed and shut out the world?
- Is it ok/normal that my mental health has actually increased during the pandemic?
- Does socioeconomic status affect the incidence of mental illness? Also, at what point is it appropriate for society to criminalize mental illness?
- Most advice for sufferers of mental health starts with or greatly involves a social support system. What advice can you give people who don't have a social support system to rely on?

My recent episodes of depression stems from the crumbling of the little social support I had left deciding that their income taxes are more important than human rights. I can no longer depend on my family and I'm afraid of driving off my boyfriend and only remaining friends if I burden them with my problems.

- How do you get over grief? I've recently lost a pet and have very good reason to suspect he is dead... am on the look out for his body somewhere since he was last seen lying in the middle of the road. I don't really know what to do at times.
- As a 28-year-old who recently graduated with a B.A. and was just this week diagnosed with ADD, I'm grateful to have a diagnosis— and, I feel sorrow that I struggled with this my entire educational experience. Is there anything being done to screen kids for mental health issues as they move through the school system, similar to how physical/eye/hearing exams are required? So many kids go undiagnosed or misdiagnosed because they don't appear to have symptoms but are deeply struggling internally.
- How much does therapy cost with an HSA type healthcare plan? How do you start seeking help? Does seeking therapy go on your medical record forever, and can that be used against you in the future? When do you know you should seek therapy?
- How do I deal with my anxiety when I'm with people? It hurts alot so I can't enjoy conversations.
- Is depression and anxiety able to be diagnosed through telemedicine?

- What are the current treatment options for treatment-resistant depression? The only thing I've found is modern-day shock therapy. What are your opinions of this as an option for people with treatment-resistant depression?
- I'm currently pregnant and am a little disheartened by the lack of options for meds for me regarding anxiety. I was using CBD prior to my pregnancy and that helped "quiet" a lot of anxious thoughts, but I've stopped till I see my doctor. What safe options do pregnant women have, if any, to help alleviate anxiety?
- I have had friends call me and tell me they are thinking of ending it. What is the best thing to do in that situation. I have done my best by just talking to them but I have always felt that I could be doing something wrong need to be doing something better. I recommend they get help later and continuously check up on them. And luckily they are fine and getting help now. But for the future what do I do?
- In the world today it seems like people I my care about depression and anxiety disorders and avoid people with any other mental health issue. How can society overcome this and except and help people despite how different from the norm their mental health issues makes them?
- How do I find community and belonging?

It seems to be a big factor in mental health, for me at least. But being 30yo with a new country, new job, low energy due to a medical thing, and covid... How to find human connection?

- Is medicine always effective for treating minor anxiety while therapy being an alternative that might not work for everyone?
- How important is one's mental health?

And what does it mean when a person suddenly purposefully say he wants to get hated by the ones he cared for to 'protect them'?

- Can anxiety and/or depression cure itself without the individual ever knowing they had mental health problems and without taking action against it?
- I've been told I lack purpose or a 'want', I have no idea how to figure out what I want from life.

How would I go about that? It's getting harder and harder to drag myself out of bed to go to work every day. I don't care for that.

- About medicating for ADD/ADHD:

As I understand it, amphetamine is/has been(?) used to treat ADD. Then lisdexamphetamine was developed for the purpose of treating ADD. Lisdexamphetamine doesn't have any effect, or at least not any noticeable effect, on drug addicts as regular(?) amphetamine usually does.

Did I get that right?

How does it work?

/Freyra

(Diagnosed with ADD, treated with Aduvanz/Elvanse.)

- I have reached out for help regarding depression and had my first session today. I felt as though the problems I'm facing are really really small compared to what others could be going

through. My main problem that is causing the bulk of my depression can be fixed if I change jobs. I can't just switch jobs though. How can I overcome this thought that I'm wasting their time?

- Is mental health something that should always be checked by a doctor or does it depend on its severity? Sort of like letting common cold pass naturally versus going to a doctor for a headache that's been ongoing for a week.
- Are there any known solutions to the 'I can afford health insurance just not the copays' dilemma? I feel as if I need therapy but u cannot afford to go sadly.

Asking for within the US.

- Why are people hesitant on getting checked out for mental health problems when they are just as damaging compared to non mental health problems?
- What is the best way for someone with lifelong depression to support a loved one exhibiting recent signs of depression?
- Is there a timeframe between being mentally healthy to the point of having mental health problems, or does it just happen? Is it something inherited that is dormant in people until it's triggered?
- What are some of the best non profits in the MH space?
- How do you ask your regular doctor for medication to help with anxiety without seeming like you're asking for drugs? I've been an anxious person since I was a child and spend a lot of days just laying in bed because I'm too scared to go outside. When I told my doctor this she said "people don't realize about medications for anxiety that they're very addictive. You could try meditating." I receive aid to pay for my health insurance, and of course do not have access to a therapist or any other mental health professional without being on a waiting list for years probably.
- Is mental health problems contagious? Sort of how a professor's mood in a college classroom can set the mood for all the students. With extended exposure to that mood over a long period, can it have long lasting effects to the students?
- What does the research say in regard to treating anxiety with cannabis? Isn't this a healthier way than big pharma which many don't have access?
- Today I had to put down my dog of 16 years. After dealing with depression and anxiety for the past 2 years this really hit hard. What are some healthy ways to deal with grief? Is distracting myself a bad idea?

p.s. thank you for all the answers so far and thank you for raising more awareness on such an important issue

- Why are psychiatrists not in-network in health plans? Scarce in employer sponsored, or in Medicaid. If you can find one, the wait is long.

What do you think we can do to lower barriers for prescribing and covering costs for patients who WANT to remain engaged with treatment and take their meds, but cannot due to "the system?"

- I'm not very open with my depression and anxiety with my friends and family and workplace too. Bring an introvert and worsening anxiety I've been keeping to my self and keeping others

from engaging in any conversation. And work place have been turning into my trigger for anxiety and making it worse. I'd like to explain to them what I'm going through, but never I tried, just kept with the thought if trying.

Any feedback?

- What does one do when a person suffering from a mental illness refuses to take treatment?

What can be done when they are reclusive and resist social integration?

- Do you believe we sometimes feed mental health by diagnosing people? I mean no disrespect but after I was diagnosed with major depression and anxiety it was good to be aware of, at the same time, treatment became sort of a crutch.

- My brother was recently sectioned in England. He was diagnosed with psychosis. He frequently talks about being a god and is full of conspiracy theories and believes very strange things.

How am I supposed to talk to him? Is there anyway to help him see he has a problem and needs the medication?

- To what extent do others struggle to maintain emotional composure and professionalism in the workplace and what are some good tips for doing so? I often feel alienated from peers and colleagues, unappreciated by management, invisible to the customer. It can be hard during episodes to get through the day while I end up brooding. I haven't experienced this at my new job and I hope it will turn out different, but I could use some help with this.

- I have been having constant mental breakdowns for the past week and have completely isolated myself from all of my friends because i feel like im a burden to them. How do i get help?

- How do you find a good therapist? What should one look for? There are so many kinds of therapy out there including CBT, ACT, REBT etc how do you know which one to look for?

- What are your opinions on involving exercise and meditation as part of a treatment plan for BP2?

- What can I do if I'm worried about another adult's mental health? Bringing concerns up to the person has caused them to completely shut down and make even more erratic decisions. They are the guardian of 2 kids and it's affecting the kids as well.

- How long has it been since humanity has had to worry about external threats to our lives and what has it done to our psyche?

Most of the population doesn't have to worry about wolves or other wildlife showing up in the middle of the night and trying to devour us while sleep. We have the capability of predicting incoming natural disasters and being able to evacuate areas before the weather hits. What has this done to influence the way our species behaves?

- Hi everyone and thanks for doing this. I think, like many others, that the pandemic situation has created several challenges for people who thrive on social interaction and routine. As well as these things, I was recently diagnosed with Epilepsy and as a result am no longer driving for the time being (very frustrating). Learning about epilepsy and the effects it has on me has been relieving though because after years of testing I finally have answers.

I generally have an awful time staying focused/on task. Now that I'm grown and on my own, I'm seeing that this is impacting my mood a lot more than it did before. I didn't want to talk to a

doctor about attention disorders because I thought it might just be situational, but the longer this goes, the more I become frustrated with a lack of memory, and focus.

Can you speak on the importance of dealing with these types of disorders to maintain mental health?

- Why does anxiety seemingly trigger for no apparent reason while other events that would likely trigger anxiety don't?

I'm asking this for myself. I suffer from anxiety often and my therapist and I can't quite figure out the triggers.

- I've (22F) recently figured out that instead of anxiety and depression as core problems, they were merely symptomatic to undiagnosed ADHD. My parents don't believe me and deny the obvious symptoms. In addition, because of my recklessness and impulsivity, I've gotten myself into a lot of debt, almost \$10k. What resources are there to help me with my financial struggles that affect my ability to pay for rent, groceries, and medication? What resources are there to help me restructure my life in a way that allows me to use ADHD to my benefit? And how can I convince my parents that the ADHD is real and not just in my head?

- Is there any literature that I can reference that helps/guides the parents of a child who suffers greatly from anxiety and depression? Seeing what my son is going through is crushing me.

- How does situational depression and anxiety turn into long term? Why doesn't situational depression and anxiety always go away after being out of the negative situation?

- How can I tell if/when my social anxiety is an actual symptom of mental illness, as opposed to general awkwardness that everyone, even neurotypical people, feel in such situations?

- I've started therapy the last few months for a long term eating disorder and other anxiety issues.

Something I've been really struggling with is determining what things around me are real especially after finding out my partner had been saying they were happy when they were not.

I've been practicing DBT, but I can't tell it's working.

Do you have any advice on how to tell if therapy is helping?

- I'm not suicidal, and I fear death, but I don't have any reasons to live. Is there a way I don't exist but stay alive?

- My ex-wife was with Borderline Personality Disorder. I only realized exactly what that was and how bad it could really be in our last year together. She's not getting the help she needs and I've left her as the only viable option was to help myself. How and why are personality disorders not considered mental illness? It's incredibly harmful to her life and, seeing how our president clearly has NPD, it's baffling to me that they're not considered illnesses.

- What's the deal with mindfulness?

- Are EMDR and TMS effective treatments when SSRIs aren't tolerated? What are effective non-chemical interventions for panic disorder and PTSD?

- How do you get doctors to take you seriously when anxiety is a symptom and not a cause?

How much training to general practitioners actually get when dealing with mental illness? I can't tell you how many times I or friends have been written off because there's a MH diagnosis in their chart. How do we advocate for ourselves when we are treated like we have no idea how to separate our symptoms or that we are aware of our own health?

- What can we do daily in order to protect and maintain our mental health?

- How is one supposed to balance therapy with work/life? Also what level of disclosure do you recommend at work? I am an hourly worker and it is very difficult for me to schedule sessions every week or two without negatively impacting my financial situation as well as risking my job

- So, I'm a writer. I tend to go overboard a lil bit on realism or "realism" in my writing, and I want to depict mental health issues and therapeutic practices for them accurately. Specifically, I want to know about what mental health issues arise in people who have killed other people, both justifiedly and questionably justifiedly. What therapeutic practices are used to help these people cope and get/stay healthy?

- Destigmatizing mental health issues is helpful, but the true challenge has to be accessible prevention and treatment. We Canadians have established accessible healthcare for most ailments, but mental health services are mostly prohibitively expensive, which leaves the government void of credibility when they claim to care about this issue. A large number of mental health conditions are manageable or preventable through education, therapy, and pharmaceuticals. My question is:

When governments try to destigmatize mental health issues in order to normalize them, are they not in effect absolving themselves from having to use our tax dollars to prevent and treat these issues? How can we ensure that government puts our money where their mouths are?

- What is your take on the Great Barrington Declaration? I.e., Do you think the lockdown's negative impact on mental health could eclipse risk from COVID, especially in the young?

<https://gbdeclaration.org/>

- What's the best way to deal with PTSD? My husband has epilepsy and his last seizure caused him to black out and attack me physically (not knowing who I was). I constantly fear he'll have another seizure like that and blackout and attack me, but I'm not willing to leave him because of a medical condition he cannot control (also we've been together for 12 years and have 2 kids).

- With an ever-increasing ability to connect with people around the world, what can you do to convince friends to seek help when they live hundreds or thousands of miles away but are clearly in mental distress? Conversely, how do you convince long-distance friends who are reliant on the internet for communication to unplug and find treatment when their mental state seems inextricably linked to using social media?

- Is there a definition of a good mental state?

- Best ways to overcome crippling depression to the point we can't get outta bed, work, keep apt. clean (that's being paid for by an agency attempting to end homelessness). I take Lexapro & Wellbutrin, my gf takes Zoloft... She used to take Gabapentin but we noticed a pattern that when she takes it she wets the bed 3/7 days. I looked up every med she takes and the only one that I see ppl complaining about bedwetting is Gabapentin. It's not listed as a side effect by the manufacturer but if you google search Gabapentin causing bedwetting a ton of ppl complain about it. What's strange is b4 taking Gabapentin she took Benzos for anxiety and sleep and never had an issue. Has there been any research on this? We are running out of sheets and the

mattress pads we have, have to be drycleaned and we are poor. We got her adult diapers and a plastic bed cover. We also switched to a dr that's not terrified to give benzos. All she takes are 2, 1mg Kolonopin. When she made the switch to Gabapentin she didn't ween down and didn't experience withdrawals. I know that our country is in an opiate crisis but I don't understand why so many doctors act like prescribing Kolonopin is the same as prescribing fentanyl patches or 120mg Oxy.....Also, I personally believe there are RC benzos/benzo analogues much more effective and less addictive or dangerous than ones currently offered by doctors. That's a whole other issue. The main thing I'm inquiring about is Gabapentin and bedwetting. I think that doctors or the manufacturer of Gabapentin should make ppl aware of this.

- What signs should I look out for to assess my own mental health? I often don't feel particularly sad or depressed but I would like to know if anything is going on under the hood.

I know the most likely answer is seek help or go to therapy, but my question is specifically referring to what we as individuals can pick up on to assess our own mental health. Thanks!

- Please excuse this question, I don't mean to be rude. Could you convince me of seeing things with the framework of "mental health"? The idea of construing it as "mental health" and "physical health" always seemed so strange to me. Is that really the most truthful or accurate way to construe people?

I read a Russian novel and a French novel (Brothers Karamazov and Les Mis) that were able to describe human states in ways that were very emotional, spiritual, and experientially resonant. It's like they had somehow managed to capture the spirit and experience of things like familial love and unending despair in words, and I could feel those things so deeply as I read those books.

Compare that to how mental health construes it -- PTSD causes this or that chemical to be abnormally low or high, depression is indicated by low serotonin (I think?), etc. etc. When I'm introduced to mental disorders in this fashion, I feel like I've learned nothing of value (as a common person taking in this information, that is. I'm sure this kind of information is very useful to mental health professionals.) But the way these things are described in those novels, I feel like I'm actually learning something! It's like someone's really getting how I feel, or I'm really understanding how a mental disorder might work.

I think that's a big part of why I'm skeptical of construing these things in such an empirical and, dare I say, *dead* way, as "mental health".

Throwaway account because questioning the idea of "mental health" is probably going to get me thrashed.

I'd also like to add that I've very, very recently discovered the utility of construing things as "mental health". I'm dealing with some mental health problems myself, and seeing it that way helps me make it so that I have a plan for what to do to get back into shape.

Ironic that I'm using "mental health" to describe myself after expressing distrust of that phrase!

- I feel like every time I tell a doctor about my BPD (Borderline Personality Disorder) diagnosis, I'm immediately written off as either being an attention seeker or a lost cause. Even though BPD specific treatment has worked incredibly well for me, I can't shake the stigma that medical practitioners have about type 2 personality disorders.

I guess my question is if that's still the prevalent way of thinking for medical professionals? That people with personality disorders are an untreatable nuisance?

- Have you met any famous people?
- What are some things I should keep in mind as a friend of someone with Dissociative Identity Disorder?
- My brother is suicidal and apparently has BPD. What are good ways to interact and help someone with these conditions? My brother gets extremely irate anytime anyone talks to him about anything related to responsibilities + improving himself; he is quick tempered (and honestly a little scary to be around sometimes; our family is constantly walking on eggshells around him). It's also quite exhausting to try and help him when he does nothing to help himself (but I want to be there for him!!!).

On that note, what should one do when the mental health of others triggers your own issues? My brother's remarks about our childhood have brought up some of my own anxieties.

Thank you!

- How to support people diagnosed with COVID-19?
- What are your thoughts on the amount of high school students with clinical depression? What kind of education reform would help this?
- As someone who:

- * Was diagnosed with bipolar disorder at age 12
- * Doesn't have/can't afford medical insurance
- * Lives in a rural town of <5000 people

What can I do to get myself on track to prevent/manage suicidal thoughts/depression? Any advice is appreciated!

- Why is that green thing with two heads always following me?
- In your professional opinion, with all due regard to your credentials, did Jeffrey Epstein, in fact, kill himself?
- How to come out of grief of baby loss during pregnancy. My (dad) healthy baby nurtured for 8 months in full was lost today due to cord strangulation. My wife is inconsolable. On top of this my Dad has been very weak post cancer surgery few months ago and it's recurred. This is with the pressure of Covid around. How to deal best and how can my wife be okay?
- How do you talk to someone about mental health who has never sought mental health services before and thinks doing so is a sign of weakness? Who thinks having conversations with a therapist are a threat?

I've seen therapists my whole life, starting when I was young and once I became an adult with more regularity to deal with stress and anxiety and also simply to take care of myself in a more holistic manner. My parents have both struggled and continue to manage with addiction and depression so I'm very sensitive to the need to take care of my physical and mental health.

My gf on the other hand has never seen a mental health provider, thinks me doing so I largely. Weakness and scoffs at the thought of seeing one herself.

- My wife and her sibling have had a very traumatic upbringing, the details of which I won't address here. They are all very strong companionate people but still suffer from this deeply embedded trauma. They are from a culture where seeking help is seen as a weakness and makes them ostracized, I have often heard them say therapy is for white people. I love this group of people as my own family was never this tight knit. I am wondering if there is any way I can help them get or even want to get the help they need.

I myself have generalized anxiety disorder and depression and see a regular therapist. However if I attempt to use methods I have learned for myself on them I am greeted with disdain and push back. Am I fighting a losing battle or is there something I can do for these people whom have so lovingly welcomed me into their minds heart and culture so that I may be able to share some of the solace that therapy has given to me? Thank you for doing this.

- My mother suffers from anxiety attacks that can last hours starting in the morning, but they almost never happen at night. She is already on medical treatment and has gone through several different medications. What can I do to help her?

- How rare is it for middle aged males to be diagnosed as having Asperger's / Autism?

- Two questions:

1) I find that the people who I know who have ADD/ADHD don't seem to think that either : a) they don't need meds because it makes them feel "weird" or b) think they don't need it because they're "fine" but they don't seem to really understand how hard and frustrating it is to live with a person who has ADD/ADHD and the news articles don't really do a good job of showing just how serious this mental health issue is and how serious it is to get a hold on it early before they live a life where they either can't take care of themselves or are a hardship on their family. so I guess my question is why are people in general supposed to be accepting of a person's limitations re:ADD/ADHD when it seems that people who have ADD/ADHD don't seem to have the same type of consideration for others around them? (I realize this sounds cruel and heartless but I know of at least five people who have it and as a person who doesn't I feel that those five either don't care about how this is impacting me or don't care enough about me to really understand that they need their meds and as I've mentioned earlier , everything I read about ADHD always tried to put a positive spin on it instead of dealing with it head on and telling the truth, that this is a serious issue if you don't get it under control and that it makes life harder for people around you when you don't.)

2). As a person with a mental health issue, I've done my fair share of research into the history of mental health post WW2 and I feel that after the whole Willowbrook institution fiasco we have been very anti institutionalization, which in general is a good thing, but isn't what we are seeing unfold right before our eyes in some way a consequence of that decision? I know that education

and the way news is reported has a huge impact on what's going on, but I've seen and read things that I honestly can't attribute to anything other than sheer mental imbalance.

- A lot of people disagree with the statement

'One can develop severe depression through addiction'

I think depression is a symptom of addiction. Is that correct?

- How to identify if I'm being Gaslighted by all the misinformation on the social media because of the politics ? How can I reduce anxiety and fall asleep quickly at night ?

- My mom suffers from delusional schizophrenia and depression. The medication she is on makes her a zombie, but when she's not on the medication, she sees people who are trying to attack her and she is scared to zero quality of life.

Although I am assuming the medication is the best choice, it's very difficult talking to my mom. She can't hold a conversation. She now only calls to ask for money.

Is there any hope for her condition?

A second question: I suffer in worry and a lot of guilt that I cannot do better for her. I had to move away to preserve my own mental sanity and protect my family. How does one deal with guilt of second-hand mental illness, as it were? I love my mom so much, and I fight the feeling every day that I gave up on her. I feel like I'm the only terrible son in a world of people who sacrifice so much for those with mental illness. I feel ashamed that I'm not strong enough to fight along with her most of the time.

- I have tried seeing a therapist (talk therapy) and it did nothing for me. I am currently seeing a psychiatrist and have been for the last 2.5 years. I have tried so many different pills and nothing is working. I get lots of sleep. I probably don't exercise enough (but who does?). I eat pretty darn ok.

So what is next? Do I just keep trying more and more drugs and hope that eventually something works? Should I ask for a referral to a different doctor? I am very close to just giving up on treatment since it has been nothing but a waste of time.

- Things are happening really rough with my girlfriend because of me struggling to accept love as well as my anxiety and lack of trust. Not because I don't trust her per se but because I don't trust myself and I overthink. Any recommendations?

- How long does the depression symptoms from a concussion usually last? I've already got depression, but ever since I suffered a concussion at work about 10 days ago, it's been worse. I just want to know if this is from my injury or from everything else going on in my life

- Sure, what do we get from contributing to your data collection pool? And haven't we had this "day" several times this year already?

- Sure, what do we get from contributing to your data collection pool? And haven't we had this "day" several times this year already?

- How does mental healthcare work when all it does is teach you to mask the symptoms better? I cannot fathom how a doctor who does nothing about the actual problems (society and the extreme dysfunction under which it barely operates, poverty, abuse at work, pretty much all the things that breed most mental illness) has any ability to have any kind of real impact. It's like

hiring a roofer to teach you how to deal with being wet when it rains instead of fixing your damn roof. How does this work? Is it just a scam and then you sell the patients dope to cope? I have spent a lot of time on this issue and don't see any way anyone can do jack shit about poor mental health, other than to fix the way we live, and that's not what therapists or psychiatrists do at all. How do they expect to fix the patients problems from their office without actually doing anything?

- How do you suggest one best act in online-centered interactions with individuals showing clear symptoms of Psychopathologies, if not already openly aware and behaving erratically through computer-facilitated video-media interfaces? (i.e the individual is live-streaming)

Thank you

- What can you do if you end up with an idiot doctor who misinterprets what you say, overreacts and puts you in an even worse situation? What do you do if you have a doctor who doesn't listen at all and puts the wrong diagnosis down that will then follow you around? Plus what can a therapist or psychiatrist actually do to fix problems? Will they put more money in my bank or prescribe a livable wage? Will they fix our extremely dysfunctional and broken society which is the roots of most people's problems? All I see is risk with no chance of reward when it comes to seeing any kind of mental health doctor.

I guess my question is how do you protect yourself, and what can a doctor actually do to help cure the problems instead of teaching you to ignore them better?

- How can I stop myself from constantly worrying about an upcoming project? I can be notified about a work order a week in advanced and I will absolutely won't stop thinking about how difficult or how combersome my job may or may not be even when I know the work won't be difficult or when I'm not even sure what the situation will end up being like until i actually get there. I have constant anxiety about about my job that when I'm not working all i can think about is the endeavour i might face. i need help because i can't rest.

- Why do you think men's mental health still isn't taken seriously by a lot of people? This year has been hard on me too.

- Im pretty sure Im not depressed but I have no motivation at all. I am moving along in life just fine but most of the time I feel like nothing matters. is this normal and why could this be?

- Why are people with self harm issues automatically perceived as being suicidal? Although it's been almost 6 months since I've cut, (I'm back on meds and stopped drinking) and don't "plan" on every doing it again, it's always in the back of my mind. I don't understand why it's a release for me, and wish I did. I've had quite a few hospitalizations only because I went too deep by accident. It's always "Do you still feel suicidal?" Nooo, I was never trying to kill myself. "Well, why did you cut?" I don't know!

- I was recently diagnosed BPD and now see traits of it everywhere. It's been fascinating learning about personality disorders. Do you think increasing the mental health literacy of community is important for society to function better and if so, what would be the best way to do so?

- Over time and from experience I've discovered that my personal mental health is most impacted by

- basic physical care - hydration, diet, exercise (perfect for low-grade depression) and sleep
- access to non-judgement peer support groups for people who are facing the same problems I am facing
- access to peer support in general

None of these modalities require consistent or active intervention by professional healthcare workers. As such there seems to be an inherent conflict of interest in promoting such modalities for the average person.

What are the issues and biases of professional healthcare systems in regards to supporting these non-professional forms of mental health treatment?

- How do you feel about introducing psychedelics to help with mental illness? I know it's not for everyone but many could benefit from it.
- Does smoking weed affect depression and does it interfere with seroquel?
- How does a deaf person from birth experience auditory hallucinations?
- What would you recommend to someone who has been struggling with (traditional) treatment resistant depression for the majority of their life? Constantly switching antidepressants every three months dealing with side-effects for minimal gains is not something I'd like to go through anymore.
- Where do you draw the line on deciding if someone has anxiety? I feel constant butterflies about everything big or small. It keeps me from focusing at work sometimes and most nights I don't fall asleep for an hour at minimum. I'm not sure if that's normal anxious behavior or if it's close to a disorder or not.
- I have a difficulty in dealing with people with light mental disabilities or things like that. I could go on full indulgence mode and not demand anything, but I know that's not the way; they won't be able to achieve anything if everyone threatened them this way. One needs to balance demanding that they work on becoming better just as we all; and indulgence and understanding. How can I do that? Also, how to say they might be annoying or not wanted in some particular situation (not necessarily because of their difficulties) without being a douchebag and destructive?
- How can i know when someone is just upset or if they have depression?
- How can i know when someone is just upset or if they have depression?
- I have a question for you.

Why didn't you post this in r/ama ?

- My wife has BPD and depression. She is also very superstitious, and has family members who refuse to recognize that her BPD is real, or that she went through sexual abuse from her father, as a child. Her own mother even says it didn't happen. They blame mental disorders on demons, satan, witchcraft, etc. Straight up saying that disorders are not real, actively telling her that it didn't happen, it's horrible.

Due to this superstitious indoctrination, which her BPD may contribute to (hearing things, seeing shadows in the dark, thinking AC ductwork noises are demons in the house to name a few), and her familys refusal to acknowledge the situation, she's become far more paranoid lately. Losing sleep, freaking out over the smallest noises, can't sleep in the dark, the list goes on. I'm afraid it

may start affecting our 4 year old. I came home today and my 4 year old was saying there are ghosts in the walls.

Unfortunately with our current financial situation we can't get therapy for her. She at least has some meds that help (which her family says she should stop taking). So do you have any methods or advice on how to help her not be so paranoid ? Book or video recommendations ? Something I might be able to do ?

It's hard for me to be sensitive to some stuff anymore because she keeps listening to her family, when I've explained to her why and how they're wrong. She still thinks there are things in the walls when I've shown her videos of the exact same noise, and it's obvious it's the ducts. That's just a couple of things, and I'm starting to become dismissive about it. I just don't know how to handle it anymore.

Anyhow, sorry for the long post and thanks in advance for any help.

- It's funny. Today was the day it clicked to me that I struggle a lot with my relationship with my father.

What would you say is the most important people need to know regarding the healing process and overcoming these deep seeded issues?

- How many of your colleagues have done their own therapy work? I've seen a lot of classic co-dependence among mental health workers, trying to "fix" other because they don't want to deal with their own stuff.

- What are your opinions about the medical model being applied to psychotherapy (i.e. that mental health is akin to physical health with diseases to be cured)? Related to this may be the question about how you see medical insurance in the U.S. affecting how therapists treat clients?

- How do you make sense of the fact that suicide is preventable yet no one is at fault when someone dies by suicide? I work with suicide loss survivors who often feel a sense of guilt or that there is more they could have done that might have saved their loved one's life. When they hear the common message "suicide is preventable" it can feel like their guilt is being reinforced. Any advice on how to help this population make sense of this?

- How does one get out of the feeling as if they are in like a well with the lid on and the water is so high they struggle and scrape at the lid, only enough room for their lips out of the water to breathe? One eye twitches from stress, their work makes them feel worse and cannot take days off or threatened to be fired. Where they become so stressed and anxiety that they cry in public and they have no one to talk to and cannot afford therapy. There are days of upbeat feels but it's like too much and under it all you still feel the shadows pull around and threaten to pull you back into that well.

- Not sure if it fits here.

How can one feel lonely even if he has close friends ?

- Have you had instances where you felt like something is always missing, you're not feeling a deep sense of satisfaction, and something's always off? Like time's not enough either?

I'm having these issues and they're just not going away. Any advice?

- My company made it a holiday (Friday off if it lands on a weekend), I spent today playing videogames, cleaning my house and getting personal chores out of my way. Am I doing it right?

- I'm not sure if you're answering questions anymore but I wanted to ask just in case. I've had pretty severe anxiety since 2016. I am afraid of talking to people at times because I get an intense urge to gag, which I absolutely hate since I have a phobia to being sick. Like throwing up. I hate it. I am in constant fear that this will happen to me especially when I travel. I have to take valium to get groceries, and it's been especially harder now these days. I have seen therapists but I am not able to at the moment. Is there anything I can do to help deal with my reality? I also have lower back pain and recently diagnosed scoliosis that has been feeding my depression. Some days I feel like I just can't. How do I stay positive? Thanks.

- I live with chronic treatment resistant depression and severe generalized anxiety. I was diagnosed 17 years ago and have been on numerous medications that only helped minimally while giving me terrible side effects. A few months ago, I had a traumatic reaction to an increased dose of Lamictal and decided it was time to wean off my medications and "reset" my brain and try microdosing and supplementing with nootropics.

Oddly enough, my mental state is about the same without the medications as it ever was while on them (not great - regular bouts of major depression and daily high levels of anxiety). At least I feel a little better physically without the medication side effects.

Question is - what can someone like me do about daily suicidal ideations? The most minor experiences can put me in a tailspin of negative thoughts, ultimately telling me I'm useless, worthless, and would be better off dead. Plan in place. These feelings have burdened me for as long as I can remember. However much effort I put into mindfulness etc never works for long. I can even end up feeling stupid for even trying.

Is this something I just have to learn to deal with? It truly feels like I have a distinct, separate dark soul that is stuck with me (sorry for the emo description, but that's what's going on).

- Ok so hopefully I'll get a reply but it's a bit late since this was posted

A relative of mine has chronic fatigue, not many doctors seem to understand it or they just stick to their textbook because it's the NHS and they're getting paid anyway

So anyway, what would you advise to someone who has CF and it's just getting worse, shes now bedridden and has very little reserves of energy. And the case with CF is that crashing even mental crashes cause exertion that worsens the condition. And she's a tad neurotic so that doesn't help lol. Do any of you have any experience with CF, anything you think might improve the condition?

Because it's just been a downward spiral really ever since diagnosis about 8 years ago, a doctor recommended physical therapy which is the exact opposite of what you should do with CF and made her really bad. Any help would be greatly appreciated

- Depression doesn't seem to go no matter what. N number of counselors, 6 years of meds but nothing works. I have 0 willpower to do anything yet I have big dreams. That causes a lot of

stress because I don't want to work (no motivation) but I want to reach the stars. I try and try but give up.

I really want to change myself from this emotional good for nothing mess to a strong practical human.

Any help?

- Hello there? Thanks so much for this. I'm a doctor (family doctor) and I have suffered moderate to severe depression over the years. I have been at my best for 2 years straight with a low dose of venlafaxin. I want to get pregnant perhaps in 2 years. Do I have to quit using antidepressants before getting pregnant? Do I have a higher risk of getting post partum depression?

- Since the DSM V usually associates illnesses to decrease in productivity, or dysfunctional relationships with other people, do you believe mental illnesses can still happen to people who are functioning normal or even above average? Have you diagnosed people with serious mental illnesses even though they are highly functioning?

Also. How do personality disorders start? Do you think specific genes can predispose people to them? Also what are the current treatments for them?

- Is it possible that ADD/ADHD could be misdiagnosed or present as major depressive or even bipolar disorder?

- How about making mental health day on a work day, so it helps me and my mental health?

- What exactly is mental health? Does this include psychotics? Pedos?

- What are your thoughts on prescribed antidepressants when depression is caused by external factors and not primarily chemical imbalance?

- This year has been like running a marathon without training as far as my mental health has been concerned. I've ended up on antidepressants because I would burst into tears at random things. Thankfully I've been able to see my old therapist remotely due to coronavirus but I've had a really hard time finding therapists or psychiatrists who take me seriously when I'm discussing my treatment with them.

I have often felt _worse_ because I met with a therapist who won't treat me like an adult and actually listen to what I'm saying. It makes me feel even more like I don't matter and more reluctant to seek help when I need it. The latest episode was when my psychiatrist and I disagreed on my antidepressant dosage, it neutered my emotions and I wanted to lower the dosage. He wants to raise it. I ignored him and lowered it anyway and I've felt a lot more like myself since then.

It seems like there is no standard of treatment in psychiatry that actually considers the patient's input on their own treatment. Nobody knows me more than myself, I should know if what I'm experiencing is distressing or not. How do I find therapists and psychiatrists that won't treat me as though I'm incapacitated?

- Are there any studies on the effects of long term use of psychiatric medication?

- Why do I parrot speech patterns and other people's mannerisms without knowing I'm doing it? I always notice after I've done it and I try not to but it's like my brain REALLY wants to parrot speech patterns

- I suppose I'll phrase this as a question but it's more of a statement. I was in NYC when I had Covid-19 in March, mild symptoms outside of the loss of smell/taste which are hardly mild symptoms given they're neurological. Left to Florida and was very healthy, mentally and physically for 4-5 months. I returned to NYC to my apartment which triggered PTSD despite only having "mild symptoms." This led to serious anxiety, and depression/trouble concentrating. I was concerned it was somehow related to Covid but after meeting with top neurologists/neurosurgeons/cardiologists in NYC it was ruled out due to a variety of reasons, but lack of latency and dormancy is a driver.

I'm still having trouble with clarity about a month later although CBT is absolutely key. Dr. David Burns' books should be prescribed to everyone negatively affected by the pandemic...anyone with a wide enough prism to realize the gravity of the situation.

A daily mood blog structured the way a psychiatrist would recommend is paramount to maintaining and developing a healthy mindset. Studies show limited difference between placebo groups and anti-depressant receiving groups so it's important to change your own brain chemistry. A reason why a lot of people are experiencing depression now is due to over-active amygdalas resulting in a down-regulated pre-frontal Cortex which can result in cognitive limitation and later depression/hopelessness. Resolving the chronic stress is the first step.

The question part: do you propose CBT is more powerful than the average anti-depressant/anxiety drug?

- In the future I see mental health becoming a luxury, along with mental care. There will be a definite need for keeping the average person functioning in society *without* being mentally healthy. How shall we go about it?

- How can you feel less stressed? What's a good way to ease your mind? How do you combat fatigue or burn out?

- Bullying:

I am a professional sports athlete. I've been vulnerable with the wrong people in my training camp. When I joined my training camp I was in really deep depression from my childhood (abusive parents). But they use it against me to put me down, curse at me in passing and isolate me from team gatherings.

But they uplift each other and post on social media about mental health when famous people die (like Mac Miller, etc). We are all African American minorities (the people who have drama with me) and they claim to want to uplift our race, but treat me like shit.

Why do people do this? They're not who they say they are or think they are. If you stand for something, there shouldn't be an exception to the rule! I've done nothing intentionally to harm or put someone down, but they go out their way to make me feel like shit.

I finally found a great therapist who helps me understand the trauma I've been through as a child to better cope. I used to mix up being told I was shit as a child with being told I'm shit by training partners. It's hard, but I ignore it now instead of feel sad in their faces. They can't tell at all and it makes them upset that I hold better composure and focus. But on the inside I am sad sometimes.

Where does hate come from? Knowing what others have been through to kick and burn them while down? I'm not perfect, but I don't deserve the way they treat me.

- As a hypochondriac, what can I do to not be rude to my doctor?
- Well, thanks to covid 19, I have found myself currently between jobs, so to speak. So far, I am mostly fine for someone who has acute ADHD, but as I am applying for new jobs in my area, I wonder if and how I should mention my ADHD to my possible new employers, should they invite me to a job interview?
- Ironically enough, I have been contemplating suicide consistently for the past 3 weeks. What are your thoughts on cymbalta and betterhealth?
- Do people ever recover from schizophrenia? Do black mold cause it?
- How do I know for sure that I'm depressed? I don't feel like killing myself or anything, but I think I am?
- Ah dang I made it in too late to ask a question for them. But I've got this cool temporary Hugs award, which seems fitting.

Any of y'all need a hug?

- What should and shouldn't you do if you have a depressed friend?
- What exactly is dissociation and why is it frowned upon?
- How to cure depression without money plz ty??
- Mental health conditions have proved refractory to psychotropic management. Ongoing scientific research within the past 15 years has illuminated many mechanisms as to why the current psychiatric paradigm of medication management has proved inadequate.

How do we help medical professionals within and outside the field of mental health better understand that the optimal approach to treating severe mental illness is to model a patient's underlying issues from a systems biology approach in order to supply individualized care which can avoid the long-term, and even short-term, utilization of psychotropic medications, and at the same time be expected to provide a superior outcome to the current medication management paradigm that dominates clinical practice?

- What is the best approach to have a conversation about mental health to children? My daddy ended his life 7 years ago. My 8 year old daughter is starting to ask questions about him and I know the "how" is coming. My 12 year old struggles as well (she knows he was mentally not well). I struggle as an adult to deal my emotions, so I can't imagine how my kids feel.
- What do you think is the best way for an organization and/or individual to target suicide prevention?
- How long do you think it'll take until depression, anxiety and other stuff like that will stop being looked down on?

- I take Bupropion for depression. I also suffer anxiety for small things, but large problems don't really affect me. Even on anti depressants, I still feel completely disconnected from everyone and everything. It's like I'm a little pilot in a vehicle or something. What causes this?
- Have any cool new medications come out in the last few years? Seems like most of them cut off both the lows and the highs. Feeling bland isn't vastly better than down, IMO.
- What should you look for when seeking the help of a psychiatrist?

In my experience advocating for others, the patient will typically go in and tell the psychiatrist what they want, how much, and the doctor prescribes. I have even seen it done by text message (ie... "Dr. X, I need a refill and I would like to try X mg this time." Then PA or doc sends it to the pharmacy no questions asked, no appointment). Is this normal?

I find this practice to be extremely concerning, especially among dual diagnosis patients. However, I can see the measure of one's wellbeing is quite limited in a 10 to 15 minute appointment, especially when the provider is running late.

Having said that, is that really the highest level of science psychiatry offers? Self medicating, but with more dangerous drugs?

- Are some people actually happy? I don't remember the last time I was happy. I was told most people are just content, not actually happy. I guess I'm content but like...negative content.
- What pisses me off is that there's always these mental health days like here in Canada, a huge day for everyone is called "BellLetsTalk" and it's all about erasing social stigma and telling people it's fine to not be okay and bla bla bla.

But ok, I'll tell everyone I have anxiety and depression, what now? All I get to do now is ask my doctor for a referral for a psychologist, who will refer me to a 2-3 month waiting list. What am I supposed to do during that time? All I get is three more months of contemplating suicide alone in my bedroom waiting for a call to go see a psychologist, who is of course terribly expensive, who you see once a month - which is no fucking help at all.

These mental health awareness days are pure bullshit and companies love to tag along with pretending about how important it is to raise the issue of social stigma, but the real suckers who need the help are all here getting no benefits out of it.

- Im very quick to cry and get emotional really easily. Are there anyways to help with not breaking down in the moment? Should this be a goal to aspire to?
- I'm don't really have any serious mental health issues per se, but I sometimes randomly just start feeling really angry, I have theoretical arguments with people about scenarios which have never happened, I feel extremely pissed off at small things like seeing a crumb of food on the floor. Luckily, I've never taken out any of my pent up rage on anyone but I feel that if I don't find some sort of outlet to dispense my feelings, I might end up hurt down the line. What should I do about it?
- My mom has lung cancer and hasn't been able to leave her home for 1.5 years now. This means COVID restrictions here in Canada for her are old hat- isolation along with physical decline. It frustrates her a lot.

What do you recommend to lift her spirits or do as the end of her life is not far off? Lately she seems really down, lack of appetite, and without purpose. I am trying but at a loss. So hard to see her like this.

We bring her things to do, visit, stay in touch more. Recently I asked her to knit me a blanket. She is now done. Your help would be appreciated. We are all sad.

- Two parts to my question. I don't suffer from a mental health condition so I don't know what a lot of the people who are going through but I have had times where I wasn't happy due to work / life stresses.

1) what's the best way to monitor your own mental health so you know to start taking steps to help yourself early?

2) when someone with poor mental health is affecting you or your peers negatively, what's the best way to improve the situation productively? I'm finding I tip toe around issues because I don't want to make stuff worse. More broadly how can we help people with poor mental health in the community?

- How do you know if someone is faking their mental health problem like depression? From what I know, most evaluation rely on self-reporting so there is a possibility that a person aware of symptoms might report it to look like he have those symptoms.

I hope I get my point across.

- "Mental Health isn't real. If you think you're having a bad day, you need to tough it out and be a bigger person than finding fault about feelings."

What is an example of a patient and 'kill'em with kindness' approach of an answer to the old guard type mindsets out there?

- Mental health professionals on Reddit? You guys are gonna have a field day!

- What is your recommendation for assisting someone whose trauma creates panic attacks and depressive swings - someone who is relatively fine one minute, and then either in a panic attack or in a spiral of harm ideation and negativity? I struggle sometimes with finding the best way to support someone and help lessen the pain of their lower moments.

- With life, I feel everything is "out of fire to frying pan". How do I overcome this feeling?

- Is there a reason I shouldn't kill myself? Thanks

- Is it common for people to have worse social anxiety now? I swear, I am on the verge of outright agoraphobia over here and I was a bouncy hyper-extrovert child once upon a time (before life happened).

- I'm 33 and recently been diagnosed with Fibromyalgia. I'm trying my best to deal with it. But am struggling mentally to feel like I have a purpose and that I'm not a burden to my family. This is making my depression and anxiety worse than it has been for a long time. How can I cope with this?? And stop feeling like a burden to everyone??

- Are there good therapies for people with really bad executive function issues? Eg, I could be told I should try an exercise, but then I would have to remember to try it. So I could try to keep a calendar or post its or ... And somehow I suck at every organization technique, including giant signs taped to my mirror. Or to things I care about. I have horrible habit extinction. I feel like I constantly try and fail things, and it gets annoying to go over the same things with different therapists.

I forget to *eat*. Drink. Move, etc. It's baaaad. And my daughter has this too. I'm the blind leading the blind.

- Is it bad or abnormal to be on antidepressants for 15 years straight?

- Hi. I have been going to therapy for the past 6 years. It took me a while to get used to it but finally this year I think I can see some amazing change on my mental health. I am from South Asia where mental health is still a taboo subject luckily I had few friends who were very supportive. So if anyone reading this please don't give up on therapy, it's going to take time and if you don't vibe with your therapist please try another one.

My question is how should I deal with all the gaps that I missed out in life? I left my college and jobs because it was too hard to focus due to depression. Now I am coping well but I feel I have to catch up on so many things but sometimes it can be bit overwhelming. Thanks in advance

- Why do so many doctors not care to read about the side affects and withdrawal symptoms of SSRIs? I've personally gone through withdrawal from Venlafaxine and was told absolutely nothing about how hellish it would be. I've heard many other people complain about the same thing with a variety of drugs.

- Any good resources for self treatment for a self diagnosed narcissistic personality disorder? Not kidding. Or other treatments.

- My (f30) husband (m35) is constantly rejecting me whenever I try to initiate sex. He had his own issues going on, his own excuses, his own mental and physical health. How do I not let it get to me? How do I not let my own self esteem or worth be impacted? How do I get out of the constant thought if not being happy because I'm just not happy?

- [removed]

- What makes it your responsibility of expertise, to tamper with the minds of people, that have suffered a traumatic brain injury?

- ... it is? I thought it was Double Ten Day!

- Why is WebMD so untrustworthy?

- 15 years of treatment resistant depression and borderline. Tried every medicine under the sun. Tried DBT, CBT, group, etc.

What's the nuclear option for someone needing help? Where do I turn when \$250 doctors visits once a week still doesn't help?

I don't want to be institutionalized and ruin my career. I don't simply need more dbt. I need a drastic change in my head.

- I'm a young woman who has suffered from post viral ME Myalgic Encephalomyelitis + POTS Postural orthostatic tachycardia syndrome, it's a common condition (twice as many people

suffer from ME as MS) with severe disability. For years I have been medically gaslit by medical professionals, GPs, psychiatrists, physicians, people from my own family, blamed for my real physical condition as being psychosomatic with it's "all in the patient's head".

So many people with physical conditions are treated the same way (as hystericals), ultimately being blamed for not willing their way mentally out of physical illness, with medical trauma as a result, and counter productively poorer mental and physical outcomes as a result of being treated for alleged mental illness.

An experience of mine was suffering from fainting due to postural orthostatic tachycardia syndrome, and loss of sensations in parts of my body due to neuropathy, i kept losing consciousness, and this was waved off as me being "anxious" and in need of "a hot cup of chocolate and mum's love" by medical professionals, a way of handling the situation which directly resulted in me developing panic attacks for years after.

How does someone with chronic illness best protect their mental health in a system that systematically gaslights them, and how would one go about helping doctor's and professionals realize that things they don't understand does not equate that women are hysterical hypochondriacs?

I want to help others avoid experiencing mental deterioration directly as a result of mistreating physical illness as mental illness, and would really appreciate your insights

- What are your thoughts on raising awareness but not increasing mental health resources.

Surely that just raises their awareness with no assistance to get better, resulting in hopelessness and frustration.

- Does bi-polar get worse with age? I ask because knowing people who have it seems they only slip further than staying the same or getting better.

- When should I stop taking my medication and realize that I'm, "all better"? I know you can't give me a concrete answer since it's different for everyone, I just want to know what are some key things I should look for?

- As someone diagnosed with obsessive compulsive disorder, it's incredibly frustrating when I hear someone say "I like x this way, omg I'm so ocd". How do we get the general population to recognize that this is an actual mental issue and offensive?

Also, when it comes to ocd, are there certain therapies you've found that work better than others?

- Every year, at this time when everybody is preparing for holidays I struggle most with anxiety and depression. How do I stop this? Here's my story. [filming my anxiety attacks](<https://youtu.be/-5Zd75iJK6I>)

- I appreciate all the helpful answers, including "keep a schedule, socialize, exercise" etc but how? Many of us don't have a job or anywhere to go to get out of their everyday surroundings. There needs to be more socially distanced and virtual activities. Where are these? We're coming into rainy and cold weather now and social isolation is going to worsen.

- A dear friend who has battled depression for about seven years started refusing to shower a bout a year or two ago. He says it hurts, makes him anxious, and he feels vulnerable. He hasn't showered in months and can't hold a job. He does have a psychiatrist but I m not sure

he's open regarding this issue. He's very sensitive about it. How could I help him, or is there a treatment?

- Several years ago I was assaulted for no apparent reason. The cops didn't catch the people. Ever since I think a lot about fighting and the thoughts are intrusive. I ended up seeing a psychologist but it didn't help too much. It seemed like she would just ask random questions and we go on random stories. Any advice on finding a new therapist? Is this something psychologist can even help with? Coincidentally I'm pretty sure I ran into one of the assailants recently. I think we recognized each other but I didn't know what to do or say.

- how does one go about living their life with suicide scars? i have two massive, massive scars on each wrist, from palm to elbow. though i'm no longer suicidal, as a young adult, i often wonder how the scars will affect my ability to get a job, attract a partner, etc. i feel like if i were to wear short sleeves, people would assume i'm crazy and either not trust me, or not respect me as they would someone without scars. i don't have enough money to get any kind of major surgery, and honestly, i, personally, don't mind them. i just don't want future opportunities to be dependent on how long my sleeves are. is there significant stigma around this? how do you go about dealing with that? - thanks.

- What field of science exists to make humans "immortal"?

Title: I am Dr. Victor Schwartz, the Chief Medical Officer at the Jed Foundation (JED). To wrap up Mental Health Awareness Month, I'm answering your questions about how to help a friend who might be struggling with their mental health. Ask me anything!

Post Text: I'm Dr. Victor Schwartz and I have over 25 years of experience as a psychiatrist working in college mental health. I am a Clinical Associate Professor of Psychiatry at NYU School of Medicine, and prior to becoming Chief Medical Officer at JED, the nation's leading national nonprofit organization that exists to protect emotional health and prevent suicide for our nation's teens and young adults, I was the medical director of NYU's Counseling Service, and served as University Dean of Students at Yeshiva University.

As a doctor who has spent his career focused on mental health, I know just how much it can help to reach out to a friend who might be struggling. Just starting a conversation with a friend can make a real difference in someone's life. Trust me, I know!

Friends can usually tell when something is "off" with their friends, and they are often the first to recognize the early signs of mental health problems. They want to do something to help, but don't always know what to say or how to start the conversation. Seize the Awkward, a campaign developed by JED, AFSP and the Ad Council, aims to educate young adults on how to have those conversations and support a friend in need. For this Mental Health Awareness Month, we teamed up with musicians Billie Eilish and Ava Max to create videos of each artist speaking about mental health from their own experiences, which you can watch

[here](https://youtu.be/_XFd0RLKQWA). Check out [www.SeizeTheAwkward.org] (<https://seizetheawkward.org>) for more resources.

I'm looking forward to answering any questions you may have about how to help a friend who may be struggling with their mental health – ask me anything!

Proof: <https://i.redd.it/tp7wm38gpz031.jpg>

UPDATE: Thanks everyone for joining my AMA about mental health. Sorry I couldn't get to everyone's questions! Just because Mental Health Awareness Month is coming to an end, it doesn't mean the conversation has to stop. Continue to check in on your friends all year round. If you're looking for more resources on signs to watch out for, starting the conversation or following up with a friend, please visit: www.SeizeTheAwkward.org.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- What's the best way to stop stress eating?
- How do you help someone overcome their social anxiety?

Also what are the best ways to help someone who is grieving?

- How do I stop the downward spiral from anxiety into depression? It's usually triggered by romantic relationships, or lack thereof. I'm afraid it will be this way from my entire life.
- Why are there so many people with obvious, crippling mental health issues now? I'm starting to think that we don't have a mental health epidemic but rather a quality of life epidemic evidenced by the rise in mental health problems. What do you think is causing it? Even autism is increasing in the general population.
- As someone that friends come to a lot with mental health struggles, the biggest hurdle miles above every other struggle is finding a way to get them help that they can afford. With more and more insurance companies making more and more hoops to jump through just to get BASIC mental health treatment, and yourself being one of the professionals that has more power than I to help change happen here, what are you doing to help people who suffer from mental health issues that cannot afford treatment?
- What are your thoughts on Assisted Suicide? I ask because my deceased husband passed in 2012. He drove out to Yellowstone where he went to seek out wolves (his favorite animal) and then had planned to jump from a waterfall. We convinced him to make the trek back home and immediately began to set up help for him. A week later he shot himself in the middle of the night on a hill in a park all alone.

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The catch is that I knew he was going to Wyoming to end his life, it was a fight for so long with him that I finally gave in. (then his family and I (who had a change of heart) asked him to come back). For so long now I have felt awful that I stole what could have been a peaceful moment for him and turned it into a bullet in the middle of the night. Did we do the right thing I have no idea. - I think my friend has a depressive disorder, but he refuses to get help from a professional. Are there any ways I can convince him?

- Hey Dr. Schwartz. My foundation has been having tremendous success treating veteran suicide and other mental health issues with ayahuasca and other psychedelic based therapies in conjunction with talk therapy. What is your opinion around the growing evidence supporting psychedelic therapy? If legalized, would you ever consider incorporating it?

- [deleted]

- > Friends can usually tell when something is "off" with their friends, and they are often the first to recognize the early signs of mental health problems.

Is that the case when you've had/displayed symptoms for the problem since before you met them?

- Hello Dr. Schwartz, mid-30's new york male here. In recent years, myself and my family/friends, pretty much everyone I know has noticed a marked increase in the amount of unstable/mentally disturbed people. We see them on our commutes daily, sometimes multiple times a day, we see them at work, in universities, on the street, everywhere.

* I'd like to think there isn't an increasing problem and that I'm just noticing it more as I age?

* Can you confirm if there has been a recent increase in the amount of mental health related issues in the U.S. and is there any significant correlation with Cities/Suburbs/Urban areas as being factors?

* What is the "game plan" for mental health in the U.S.? Is there an initiative/push to make it a priority? I think we are all in agreement that it's a priority, but what can you tell us from a policy / professional p.o.v.?

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Thanks!

- How do you overcome anxiety and make new friends?

- Hi Dr. Schwartz, I'm a student at Washington State University where we are still dealing with the aftermath of our quarterback, Tyler Hilinski's suicide. Our school has told us they've partnered with your foundation to try and make progress surrounding mental health. Could you talk a bit about what higher ed institutions can do to help their students? What they should be doing? And how other students can help create a culture where we can talk about these struggles?

- I have been chewing the inside of my cheek for about 20 years now. Though I know it increases chances of oral cancer, I most often do it unknowingly out of anxiety. Sometimes I notice I'm doing it but am unable to stop. I realize this is some sort of compulsive behavior, but where should I start to help me stop?

- Dr. Schwartz, why do you think anxiety effects so many people? It seems more prevalent now than say 20 or 30 years ago.

- What are some good coping mechanisms for a partner or family of someone with medication-resistant depression? Any resources or support groups that you know of?

Also, what's your opinion on the rules and regulations about anti-depression drugs? We've had issues with meds being out of stock, unable to get info on the phone, unable to pick up in

another state while travelling, unable to order multiple months' supply at once. Any thoughts on how to balance making drugs available to those who need them while trying to prevent abuse?

- As someone with bipolar 1 and intrusive thoughts OCD, I'm finding great difficulty in having those around me understand that these issues are ever-present and change in intensity over time.

Do you have any suggestions about how to better communicate my limitations in a way that makes others aware without making me seem disingenuous or asking for attention?

I generally get good feedback when I tell people, but they so easily forget when I get into a particularly bad episode that I'm struggling with an illness and that I don't mean to be so difficult to be around.

- My twin brother committed suicide and I repeatedly asked our 2 best friends to reach out to him and they did not. I have been having my own mental health challenges since then and have mentioned I would like for them to check in but they have not followed through. Since then I have created a support network for myself without them, but how do I get them to recognize the importance of reaching out? How do I get them to embrace asking how I am doing? They already lost one good friend to suicide, how can they not be concerned with losing me?

- My dad seems to have fallen into a dark place. However, in his culture mental health is stigmatized. How can I encourage him to get help?

- It was 2 years before I realized I needed help, I just didn't know that how I was feeling was truly wrong and not just me not performing as well. It was then my wife started to know. I told her. It was 1 year after that (much treatments did not go well) that my friends and coworkers first mentioned something. Later I found that they had noticed at about that time, not much earlier.

So that would have been 3 years after symptoms first started to show. And many people in my support group did not really have friends that could have said something when they started.

Wouldn't a more reliable solution be to better teach people what those symptoms are in themselves, and that those need to be addressed by a medical professional and isn't just "life"?

- How do you break up with someone who has problems handling their mental health without making it worse?

- What is your opinion on using psychedelics such as psilocybin mushrooms, to treat mental problems like anxiety, depression, PTSD and so on?

- What is your stance on involuntary holds and treatment? Do you think they make it harder for depressed individuals to seek out treatment?

- What is the biggest misconception the general public has concerning mental health? Was there anything that surprised you about it when you first started?

- Thanks for your time! A couple questions.

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I've been reading up on Cognitive Behavioral Therapy, and doing the exercises. Amazing stuff, it's almost surreal to see issues that have plagued me for years just...stop being issues. Here's my question. CBT is concerned mostly with \"irrational\" thoughts/beliefs. What are some good resources on how to be with emotions coming from fairly rational sources, like grief/death?

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My other question is about boundaries. I'm working on developing a more concrete sense of what my boundaries are, and I'm trying to root them in something rational. I've been proscribed the idea that if I feel like I've been violated, then I have been. I appreciate the wisdom of this - especially the effort to address my tendency to minimize my needs - but the flipside is that, I worry that I could end up giving credence to a feeling that might not be just, or fair. It's important to me to have a point of reference outside of myself. The question: is there any formal standard or reference in the psych community of what constitutes personal boundaries? Or perhaps, a standard for identifying intrusive or disrespectful behavior?

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again, many thanks.

- Have you explored connection between gut bacteria and mental health? Or even better, attempted helping people by changing their diets i.e. influencing gut bacteria? I am asking since connection between moods and gut has already been established by the science just not of research or, I hope not, interest.

- I have a close friend who I'm becoming resentful of - she has two friends, and makes us carry her burden of severe anxiety and depression. It's one thing to help, but she doesn't put in any effort at all. She claims she does, but she absolutely does not. We've been tending to her every need including getting her to eat, doing her laundry, etc. but now it's been non stop, we're afraid if we don't take care of her she'll literally die.

It's exhausting, and straining on my mental health as well - she makes us guilty for good moods. What can I do at this point?

- I tend to attract women with borderline personality disorder almost exclusively. Why?

- What are your thoughts on psychedelics as a tool to manage depression, PTSD, and other mental illness? What are your thoughts on psychedelics for the betterment of well people?

- I had psychosis two years ago. How high is the chance of relapse if I stop the medication?

- Recently diagnosed with ADHD (will start meds soon) . Are there any overall tips for staying sane for the times I don't have access to my meds?

- What is your approach to preventing disruption in medication adherence for patients when circumstances are out of their control. Personal case comes to mind: psychiatrist stopped practicing on short-notice and PCP refused to respond to desperate pleas for a renewal of a prescription that had been well-documented in patient's medical record for over five years. What could've/should've been done to prevent a situation where a patient goes through this, loses their meds for three months and is suicidal without them?

- How to protect children from developing future mental illness later on in life?

- Hi Dr. Schwartz. My boyfriend has bad social anxiety and anxiety disorder in general. He is afraid working in His Job because he is afraid to stand up for himself. He is also afraid to leave his Job. He is basically afraid of everything and I am at my wits end. He is waiting to start another therapy, but that will take a while. In the meantime: is there anything I can do or say to give him Security? We don't have a real every day life any more because all He is is afraid and depressed. I feel helpless myself because nothing I say or do seems to have any Impact..
- How would you suggest someone moves on after a serious relationship ends. How do you forgive yourself for the mistakes you made and continue to improve?
- Can you explain why other med pros treat anyone on an anti-depressant so bad?? Even to the point of denial of care???????
- Is it true that psychiatrists/psychologists tend to avoid or even refuse to treat borderline patients? Secondly, regarding recovery for BPD pt's, is it possible for one to recover with proper treatment, discontinue treatment, but maintain that level of recovery they achieved, or would it tend to worsen?
- My question isn't related directly to the question st hand, but rather the broad spectrum of mental health in general.

As a person who was formally working in the mental health field(psychiatry wards) for several years, I've seen a lot. Why do you think that having an open discussion about mental health and it's importance is such a taboo topic that doesn't get the attention it deserves, and how do you propose people break the stigma so people can get the help they need quicker? Mental health is a vital part of your wellbeing and overall health, so it shouldn't be as stigmatized.

- What would you say is the biggest misconception people have about those with mental health issues, or mental health in general?
- Are you concerned about all the mood-altering drugs that get prescribed these days? It seems like most of them have side-effects that are worse than the initial condition and nobody really knows what the long-term usage implications are.
- Friend of mine with major depression, an anxiety disorder and now Ptsd from a sexual assault by a trusted friend went to a psychiatrist for the last one (mostly) because she was unable to study for possibly career-ending exams. The psychiatrist implied heavily during the (only) meeting that she wasn't actually asleep through the whole assault and must have wanted it. How can I help her to see another professional after she's already been further broken and betrayed by one? It's been over a year... Things have only been getting worse.
- Its the anniversary of my friend's murder, and I think about him all day. He was killed by a woman with an incredibly long history of mental illness and just a really rough awful upbringing, and he has some mental illness in his family so he always donated to our local NAMI group. Every year I donate and my work matches my contribution to them. What is like.. a good way to get people involved in mental health month or awareness? What about mental health in prisons (the perp was just moved from juvi to prison, and will have MUCH less access to care, although she had about 450+ violations in juvi against guards/other inmates)? While I hate this woman for taking my friend away, she also was dealt just the world's worst hand that set her up for failure. I have family who author clinical suicide prevention books/research too! Thank you for doing hard work..
- What was your MCAT score?

- [removed]
- Hi Dr. Schwartz,

I just finished my first year of university and a major part of my experience was trying to care for a friend with severe depression and anxiety. As the year went on, I started questioning whether she was becoming too dependent on me and using emotional manipulation to try and control me.

My question is: how do you support someone with a mental illness without them becoming dependent on you?

- What kind of advice can you give to a mother who has Borderline Personality Disorder? to help prevent her children from eventually having it too??
- I struggle with procrastinating if that counts. I could waste a whole day on Reddit if I wanted. What should I do to stop?
- Do you think that kids are being overly diagnosed with autism because general physicians don't understand the signs and think any kid that isn't "normal" must be autistic? Similar to the 80s and 90s epidemic when any kid who was spirited was diagnosed with ADD even though they didn't actually have any real signs of it.
- Users, please be wary of proof. You are welcome to ask for more proof if you find it insufficient.

OP, if you need any help, please message the mods

[here](<http://www.reddit.com/message/compose?to=%2Fr%2Fiama&subject=&message=>).

Thank you!

I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit](/message/compose/?to=/r/IAmA) if you have any questions or concerns.

- Is transgenderism a mental health issue?
- Any advice for someone working 80 hour weeks in a kitchen?
- Do you think there ever be a cure for tinnitus?
- What is your number one suggestion for an SSRI? I've taken Celexa, Prozac, Zoloft, and now Wellbutrin. (For major depressive disorder). Wellbutrin is great but the side effects are becoming discouraging. I've tried a slew of medications for anxiety as well do you have an alternative instead of medications at all? Thank you so much!
- How / when is Adderall use a good idea in adults who have a hard time focusing at work? How can individuals tell when docs tend to over prescribe?
- What are some symptoms of mental illness that aren't as talked about? Anything we should be especially wary of?
- How to stop procrastinating/avoiding studies?
- Are migraine headaches and depression related?
- Hi 🙋

My friend has a mental issue but I'm not sure what it could be? She is 100% always in a bad mood and no one can talk to her without her being offended. Sometimes she will be happy but

not for long. She smokes a lot of weed and acts manically happy then but as soon as her high is gone she goes back to being angry. It's unnatural how angry she is, could it just be her personality or is this a mental issue?

- What would you advise for a person who can't afford therapy to cope up with OCD?

- Is there a way I can be more social? I don't really know what to say during conversations, especially when my knowledge on things like sports and politics are very limited. What can I do?

- Have a friend who can't handle stress in any way, even the slightest inconvenience can turn their mood sour. Any advice?

- Hello Dr. Victor Schwartz, my friend has been struggling with depression and fluctuations with dissociation. From what I understood his mom is almost non-existent as a mother figure in his life and his dad tries to keep the family together but doesn't act like a father figure much either. He vented to me that his dad tries to shake the boat and yells at him when he tries to ask his mom to make better decisions even when my friend tries to be rational and calm. I don't know the entire story but he says he sometimes forgets that he has a family so he can be normal. I'm assuming he's forcibly forgetting about his troubles. He also says that he really wants to move to another relative's house because their family treats him so well. But trying to communicate it to his family that he wants to move there in a couple years has made his parents extremely angry at that relative's family and he feels guilt for causing the bad blood. From all the time I've known him, he's trying his hardest and still trying and hoping for a better future for himself. I want him to find happiness but I want to be sure that I'm doing it in the right way.

So my friend wants to be happier and in a more stable environment but he's afraid of hurting his family if he does. He'd also feel guilt if the family collapses.

Should I encourage him to find his own happiness and despite whatever happens to his family?

What's your take on this?

- What do you say to a friend who has just lost their father at a young age?

- Hello about 6 months ago I discovered I had asperger syndrome and depression and is there ways to know about the unknowns like how can I tell if some have mental health issues without doing complex test?

- Thanks for doing this! Any idea why all antidepressants seem to make me feel like a zombie? I've tried so many different ones (Paxil, Zoloft, Prozac, Lexipro, etc.) and I have to give up on them because I have absolutely no energy. I tried them each for a few months and it never works out. I have bad panic attacks (while driving, specifically) and the meds help, but the lack of energy doesn't make it worth it, unfortunately. No therapist or psychiatrist can quite get it right. Thanks in advance.

- How would you suggest describing CFS to my family? The name in and of itself is atrocious and a poor representation of the misery I feel. Research seems to be lacking severely, but I would love to be able to describe it on a chemical level and not as another silly name to be easily misunderstood. I've also had many friends think they have it, and with as much as 91% of people being non or misdiagnosed, what tips should I give them on their initial "adventure" to a diagnosis? Mine had taken nearly 10 years.

- What are the options with a person who is unable to support themselves financially (or otherwise) who has a history of sporadic violence towards his family, who actively experiences hallucinations, was a long term drug user but has been clean now for 18 months but still has the same symptoms, and whose family can't afford treatment for him, and can't afford to support him on his own but is afraid of him living with them because of his violent track record?

This is in Chicago, USA.

- What are your thoughts on the field of positive psychology?

Like people always posting on Facebook about doing gratitude exercises, vision boards, affirmations, law of attraction, positive thinking, visualizations, "smile/stand taller to trick your mind into being happy," reiki, etc

- Have you done any studies or research into proper gut health correlating to improved mental health?

I (26F) have suffered from mental health issues for majority of my life and only in the past 2 years did I actually find a treatment that has vastly improved my overall depression and anxiety through low dose bipolar medication which helped me to put my life in a much greater place. But a few years prior to a good diagnosis and treatment, I suffered from C. Diff for 5-6 months. I was left with a plethora of GI problems and have done a lot of looking into the correlation of good gut health to good mental health. I found that my mental health significantly decreased throughout the ordeal and really did not improve much until I started my bipolar treatment. I had many failed attempts with antidepressants in the past, no surprise knowing what I do now. Most insurances do not cover effective probiotics and the decent ones that can be bought over the counter can be pretty pricey so I cannot always keep up with taking them consistently.

- What is your opinion about the new APA guidelines for the treatment of men?

- Thank you for what you do and helping to bring more awareness to this subject! As a mental health professional working with adolescents and families I appreciate what you're doing :).

What is one thing you think even mental health professionals could do a lot better to help people in their own lives who might have mental health needs?

- I've struggled with depression and anxiety for 15 years now. I've tried lots of different things - citalopram, fluoxetine, sertraline, mirtazapine, paroxetine and now venlafaxine.

I've had varying results with them, on the whole the depression aspect is fairly well managed. But the anxiety attacks still come. Often with no warning, for instance this evening a loud noise set me off and my heart is racing even though I know I am ok.

Should I be looking into beta blockers, or some other type of medications?

- I am going to see a therapist today for the first time. Mostly to deal with some childhood trauma that is starting to resurface. I am pretty nervous about meeting her and what to say. Any advice?

- Hello! My mother in law suffers from mental health issues that are undiagnosed. We live in California and we cannot seem to find any help. She believes people are always out to get her/drug her, and makes up stories she believes very strongly to be true when they aren't. We

have exhausted every phone number for every program and no one will take her because she is currently on parole, or is not on medication to regulate her problems. My significant other and I were able to keep her for a few weeks at our place but couldn't make it a long term scenario and we have gone broke trying to put her up in hotels. She is currently at a shelter and spends some nights outside and she seems to have less clarity than ever. What do we do??

- Hi Dr. Schwartz, thanks for doing this for the community.

I have a friend whose been battling depression for several years now and I don't know how to help. He has a good life, health, job, partner, and family. However, he always compares himself to his more successful and wealthy friends. As a result he always beats himself up to a destructive point for not having more and doing more. He told me he lives a sad existence; is lacking a mission/purpose in life, and that every day he feels a deep dissatisfaction/sadness in life. He's also uncomfortable in his own skin because he was always called fat as a kid. He's not fat at all now. He has everything he needs to succeed and knows what he needs to do but consciously sits idle choosing to suffer.

He can't figure out why he always chooses to suffer.

What can I do to help him?

- Are we ever going to find a better way to find the right antidepressant combo than just trial and error?

- Dr. Schwartz,

In your opinion, how important is the connection between a therapist and client? For context, I had tried to keep going to therapy as I have had depressive and anxiety issues since I was 17 years old, but every therapist I went to I felt closed off, and as though they were almost robotic, even when plenty of other people have had great success with the ones I did not do well with. A few years ago, though I found a therapist who has a very similar personality to me, with similar interests, and she is only a few years older than me, and I've been seeing her since then. She helps me tremendously, but I feel like the reason is because we have such a strong connection. A lot of my friends have seen therapists who they don't connect with well, and they stop going abruptly, and when I encourage them to try again, they don't want to repeat their less than ideal experiences again.

So, do you think that it matters a lot how compatible as people you and your therapist are? I have tried to tell my friends that it takes a while to find one that you click with, and when you do it can be life changing. I'm curious though that might just be an experience I have had, and not the norm.

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Thanks for doing this, the work you and others like you do is inspiring!

- I would like to ask about ADHD medication|Treatment. The most common medication is Adderall or Ritalin I've been so afraid to seek professional assistance due to the fear of addiction, but I know friends/cousins that have been diagnosed with ADHD and they perform and feel much better with medication. Would there be a way for a professional to keep me on a

low dosage and control the medication? Or will I lose control eventually and get too addicted and would want for higher dosage?

- My friend has some mental health issues and occasionally reaches out to me for help. It's always awkward to talk to her. How can I support her?

- Has anyone showed up as a Jedi by mistake or on purpose thinking it was a Jedi convention?

- Something I've noticed, especially with fellow students in my high school, is that people seem to just write people with depression a prescription for depression meds and be done with it, which sadly does not help. I have multiple friends diagnosed with depression and a majority say that professionals almost always try and give them a higher dosage, instead of recommending them to a counselor and giving them therapy. What are your thoughts on therapy versus medication?

- [deleted]

- [deleted]

- Is it possible / advisable for a person who thinks they are not mentally healthy to sort of treat themselves? For example, if they lack a support structure.

- There have been talks about mental health patients being prescribed exercise and potentially PT. As a PT I'm curious at to your thoughts on that. We know exercise can improve mental health and overall health and well being but how do you think that prescription would go?

- One of my very close friends suffers from depression largely due to childhood trauma and has been very suicidal for a very long time. I've talked her out of it on multiple occasions and twice now she's asked for help after a failed attempt. She recently got out of a mental hospital and I'm terrified of the possibility that it didn't help enough. How can I ask her about it and not make it sound like I don't think she could get better?

- So my girlfriend is currently suffering from clinical anxiety and depression and I'm doing my best to help her in any way that I can. She has a lot of good days but then she'll regress and have an episode that could be set off by the slightest thing. Is this going to continue to be something to look out for and do you have any recommendations for the future? I love her to bits and just want what's best for her

- Why does your picture say 3pm Eastern Standard Time (EST) when we are currently on Daylight Saving Time (EDT)?

- What do you do when your friend is far away and tells you she wants to kill herself in a text, but won't respond after that? And you have no way of sending anyone over because you don't have her address, just a cell number

- what signs may a person show if he has depression?

- Hi Dr. Schwartz! I have a best friend that I've been close to for around 8 years now. She wound up leaving her long term boyfriend (7-ish years), being single for 2 years, and now is currently doing a friends with benefits relationship with any man that shows her interest. She is juggling 4-5 guys at a time with this type of relationship. I'm worried about her because she's becoming a different person and continues to push me away. She was seeking help with a therapist but has told me it wasn't helping much and I believe she quit going to her. She has suffered from depression in the past and was on medication for it but I believe she no longer is.

I'm not sure what to do anymore because she only wants to talk about her men / sexual exploits and never asks me about myself. I've been dealing with this for months now and continue trying

to be a supportive friend but even after talking to her about my feelings it's still reverting back to that. Is there something I can do to help or should I give her space?

- what's a good way for autistic people to get better at social situations?

- How does a post college party culture adult separate if they are an addict and need to be 100% sober or that they made some dumb choices and bad habits in thier youth that they are totally able to stop/ change?

- I've been struggling with depression for several years due to my parent neglect and psicológicas abuse, but this year it was different I started living alone away from their grasp but it's been so hard to me being an active individual I've fucked up serious business opportunities due to extreme anxiety because I don't think I can do it and o don't even try, for the past 2 months I've barely left my apartment and recently I've ran out of money but I just can't get myself to do things, I'm afraid all the time everything will go bad so I don't even try. I'm tired and disappointed in myself I wish I was dead everything would be easier but I haven't even tried to kill myself. I just can't get myself to do anything I'm even eating a lot less now .

My question is, is there any method or something to help me get out of bed and start doing things, to remind me that I'm worth something and capable of doing things?

- Hey Dr. Schwartz! Thank you for what you do:) I'm really struggling with my mental health right now, do you have any life advice for me?

- I take care of a four old who has been acting out and discussing events of sexual abuse when enduring court ordered visits with her father. She won't talk about it with the CPS investigators so she keeps being returned to father because it is being ruled unsubstantiated. What is the best type of therapy she can be put in to let someone professional work with her to gain information as well as to extinguish sexualized play acting?

- Both for myself and a friend- how do you find a psychologist that fits your needs/lifestyle, especially after having a horrible relationship with one (or several) in the past? I've tried interviews, none in my area were willing.

- What's your opinion on WHO declassifying gender identity disorder as a mental illness? Or whatever they did

- I have a 13 yr old family member (not my child), who has not been to school in a year, has selective mutism, is definitely on the spectrum, and has suicidal thoughts. He is being treated with anti-depressants. How can I best help him? I try to be non-confrontational. I'm really worried for him, though.

- Hey doc. My friend has been using Prozac to help with her depression and BPD. This is gonna sound a little crazy but she wants to try magic mushrooms with me. I know that Prozac is an SSRI and mixing the two can lead to Serotonin disorder, so I'm wondering how long she would have to wait or even if she could do em at all? Thanks again for all your work and have a pleasant evening.

- I don't have a question at the moment as much as I just want to thank you for doing this. I hope it helps a lot of folks.

Actually, I do think I have a question now. I know a couple of folks on LinkedIn who have had a hard time getting work. They seem employable enough it's just that for various reasons they haven't found the right gig. My concern for them is that they are starting to spiral down into

depression over their situation, which obviously won't be great in their job search or in their life in general. What might I tell someone in a position where they've had a long-term unemployment situation that they're still good enough and have that be believable? I fear that in the all the talk of they're being record low unemployment, this will probably just exacerbate the problem because they'll feel as though they're all alone and not being able to find work.

- A friend of mine asked how to tell the difference between having prolonged feelings of unhappiness and depression, is there a difference? How do you diagnose depression?

- how many people with mental health issues do you think are in prison/jail and what do you think about the care they receive while in there?

- [deleted]

- I had depression for over a year and I've been finally ok after almost 6 months. It was a lot of suicidal thoughts and I got very close to actions. I was able to make it through thinking of family I have and the one I'll have one day. I'm afraid that it may come back if something bad happens which I've had a string of in my life. If it does, what tips do you have to make it through the best I can?

- How as parents, can we help our adult kids get the help they need after a trauma? Especially if our child doesn't think they need help. But their depression and anxiety is written all over their face. And how can we support them if they just want to drink it away instead of talking about it?

Also, what is your take on this new trend of "No contact" after an argument? I don't understand this, aren't we to keep the lines of communication open after an argument?

- What's the best way to stop hating everything/everyone?

- What is the best option for seeking out mental healthcare for low income individuals?

My SO is saving up to visit a councilor (not a therapist, not a psychiatrist, we can't dream of affording that) and even after insurance we are looking at \$160/session. That is a tough sell for someone who does not know if they can afford rent or not until the 3rd week of the month.

We are considering "getting religion" and seeing if church elders might get her the help she needs, but I'd rather not resort to that if at all possible.

- Why is it so hard to find private practicing psychiatrist? I've only had luck in the past with psychiatrists when I was in the hospital, but the moment I get out with prescriptions there is no taking new patients.

- What's the advice on how to live with ADHD while trying to avoid daily medication?

- How to help someone who despite of factual evidences of their high skill and intelligence, still questions their competence?

- A friend of mine has been diagnosed with schizophrenia and currently take Orap and Siroquel. It doesn't seem to work too great. He always want to lower his doses or go without. Is this normal? I worry about him. I live in Canada, do you have better medication for him in the US?

- What's the difference between a real mental health issue and just plain old attention seeking?

- My wife has battled cancer twice in the last two years. It has left her really worn out mentally, and it does not take much to tip her over to a melt down of crying and despair, along with racing thoughts of dying and her cancer returning. I have helped her through this struggle the best I can, but i feel she would benefit from some healthy positive support counselling, but she just

does not want to even consider it. How do I continue to support her, for what I feel is something way above my skill level?

- I have a decently high functioning depressed friend. He acknowledges he's depressed, wants to be better. Has great health insurance. Has treated his depression in the past and had great improvement in his quality of life.

Can't get him to schedule an appointment.

Have you experienced a similar situation and identified a good next action to help people get the healing process started?

- Do you consider Batman and The Punisher to be insane or mentally unstable?

- how do I know if my friend was traumatized or not?

- I work as a language teacher and I have a psychotic disorder well managed by medication. Is it still a very good idea to never breathe a word of it to anyone I work with? It's hard keeping such a tremendous secret.

What are your thoughts?

- How do I get my cousin in permanent psychiatric care?

- How do you address binge drinking in college students? It's definitely normalized in our culture. How do you draw the line between "being a dumb college student" and "functional alcoholism"? How do you motivate patients to change and go for more intensive CD treatment if needed?

- Why is exercise never prescribed to treat depression when the endorphins are so effective at mood elevation and mood stabilization?

- My brother has anger issues, he likes to hide in a dark room all day and play games or watch Netflix on his phone. He hardly leaves the house except to go buy food and school. When he gets upset cause we ask him to go out he screams and shouts and starts raging by hammering, slamming throwing and breaking things. I think he smokes too. He cuts when he is upset. He is only 13... Probably watches pornography too. What do I do? My parents r so conservative and refuse to seek help despite the obvious problem. To be honest I don't really care about him but it affects the home so yea. Anyways my family is pretty much dysfunctional.

- Did anyone consider calling it Jed International foundation?

- Hi Dr Schwartz, do you prefer using the DSM or ICD?

- Well i have very bad mental health issue, i think its brain trauma, it sorta controls me, help, i think if i take drugs ill be differnt and i dont want to be differnt i want to be myself, and not change what will drugs do to me im scared ..?

- How are you supposed to get better if your stuck in a situation?

Medications, Cognitive behavioral therapy, really nothing he can fix a bad situation that your stuck in that is hanging over your head.

Many service members commit suicide all the time when a simple discharge could really help.

Mothers with postpartum, loss of a loved one, really anyone going through court for any simple charges, anyone going through a divorce, or an unwanted pregnancy in some of the handmaiden states.

What can help these people?

- Can you elaborate on the implications of the gut brain axis and mental health? Particularly the *clostridium* species involved?
- My girlfriend has very intense anxiety. What can I do as a boyfriend to make her feel better?
- I have a question. I have a longtime friend who I know has suffered from mental health issues in the past. He seems better now but I get the sense that it still haunts him and he keeps it hidden 99% of the time.

Any advice for how I should approach my friend?

- How do i cure my insecurities and crippling depression? asking for a friend
- If you're still around, how do you afford it? I need help and can't do & \$95hr.
- ¡Hola! What are some quick and easy ways to assess oneself and other mental health?
- ¡Gracias!
- [removed]
- How do I find cutting edge researchers to help me with Lewy Body Dementia?
- How can i help those with depression that fight against us helping them?
- Any suggestions on how to help a family member get the help they need to move forward with their life? This person is stuck and is not working or going to school. They had a few setbacks that put them into a depression. They are over the worst of it but have never been open to counseling. It's affecting the entire family.
- I have a friend whose pretty up front about her depression/habits/bpd and we've been working on getting her help for some time. My question is, what can we do to help her through moments where she's not motivated/doesn't want to be better, and get her back to being the more rational person we love? She always regrets her moments of lapse, but they're so consistent I just wonder if there's a way to help though that specific demotivated part.
- How does a person with autism let to cope with severe anxiety, as well as a laundry list of PTSD symptoms from rape, abuse, sexual trauma, abusive childhood, and abusive relationships? I... I'm in a much better place in my life, but these ghosts of my past haunt me daily, sucking joy and the drive to do anything from me... I'm hoping my insurance let's me seek help but it's a gamble. A lot of the time I'm a wreck, and I don't know how to just keep on swimming like this. It's to the point normal everyday interactions leave me with so riddled with anxiety, and worry about not seeming passable, and receiving even more judgement
- I have severe depression. I cry to myself all the time and feel isolated even while sitting with family. I also have suicidal thoughts and pray for death to come to me. What can i do??
- So almost a year ago, someone I loved very much committed suicide. It wasnt entirely out of the blue they had depression and bouts of isolation. The first few months were the hardest because I felt so overwhelmed by the grief. It's not as bad anymore but I have these dreams where I get to see him and in the moment its peaceful but when i wake up its torture and the

rest of the week is filled with anxiety and depression. Are there coping techniques to deal with this?

- Hey Vic! I'm actually an EMT student (about to graduate), and something I've been particularly interested in is eating disorders. They're a problem I had awhile back that I've since recovered from and it's one of the reasons I got into EMS. My question is:

How do you tell someone at their worst that they can get better, that light is at the end of the tunnel, in a way that isn't cliché or sounds insincere?

I don't imagine this will get a reply, but I hope to hear back from you nonetheless!

- Hello, what can one do if they are unable to talk about their feelings? Even with small things, I have trouble communicating with friends, family, and my partner. When I think about saying what's on my mind I start to tear up and get a knot in my throat. Then I don't talk about it because I don't want to cry in front of them so it stays bottled up.

- Would you be able to come to a 3rd world country (that was in a conflict for many years) and assess some kids? I have noticed many young kids behaving "out of place"(all under 12). I have talked to some and most of them have been abused or see their parents fight violently. I want to help them but I don't know how. Talking to those kids just makes me super sad. Those kids would stare in the void, laugh suddenly and their reactions are all kind of delayed.

- are you a medical officer?

- I have a Fearful avoidant attachment style. Whats your biggest advice on healing this to Secure attachment style?

- How do I help my older brother? He is 51 and a lifelong bachelor. He is pretty much a self-described hermit and isn't really a people person. He is close to losing his home because he has stopped working due to an unknown illness. The doctors have run every test in the book and say he's fine and one doctor suggested he may need to see a psychologist. My brother thinks the doctors are wrong and is adamant that something is physically abnormal and refuses to work. Now he told me if he loses his home he, "Will not stick around to watch that happen". I pushed him on what he meant by that and he said he was just in a bad mood and not to take him seriously.

I know this guy is a mess and really needs help but he is honestly in so much denial, I can't even begin to help him. There is much more to his life story, I can't even begin to tell you. I don't want him to do anything stupid- is there anything I can do?

- I have a friend with Aspergers, who has told me she also has psychotic episodes and is bipolar and she mentioned something called catatonia. She goes to a psychiatrist regularly but I was just wondering if you have any tips on how to be a better friend to her. I also have a friend who is suicidal and has social anxiety but he lives in another country currently. He seems better but I am afraid of talking to him one day, him being on the edge and me not knowing what to do and I'm trying to encourage him to seek support but do not know how. I'm also worried about my grandma and mother. Grandma cries constantly since grandpa died and she's lost weight. Mom gets angry all the time and cries pretty easily and she has threatened suicide some years in the past. Should I try to encourage them to see a psychiatrist or a psychologist? How could I otherwise help them?

- You aren't by any chance Glenn "Hurricane" Schwartz's brother are you? You two look a lot alike
- I have a friend who was super motivated to try out new things like meditation, exercises, good diet. But now he doesn't do anything..... literally nothing. He said he has the burning desire to do things but he just can't and he is asking me for help...Then I saw your post, what can I do?.... any advice would be appreciated.
- Should I seek professional help for what might be memory problems if I'm only 20? I don't remember 3-8 grade at all, not in terms of teachings but in terms of what school I went to, in what order I went to each school, what my teachers names were ect. I also have to do math every time someone asks how old I am because I don't really remember that either.

If these problems are normal I don't want to pay for/worry people about it. I don't really know how to ask people for help about this in real life either

- I have bpd, anxiety, depression, adhd, social anxiety. Q9rked my ass off to support myself but burn out every 2.5 years. Will I ever be able to work, date, live, not want to commit suicide? It never stops!! Ever! Give me hope!
- Why are some people more fragile than others? Sorry if that comes out as a stupid question.
- Have you heard of the card company [ThoughtfulHuman](<https://thoughtfulhuman.co/>)? You should check them out. They're a different kind of card company and have lots of really good mental health awareness cards
- Hi there! I have a friend that had a first time panic attack on his way to work like 2 weeks ago. Since then, he has this anxiety that creeps up on him every time he goes out or is amongst people. The circle is that he goes out feeling kinda ok - starts having anxiety about having an attack - anxiety builds up - he feels overwhelmed and goes back home. He has been off work since then, done medical tests which all came back clean, seen a psychiatrist that says he is producing too much adrenaline.. how can I help him?
- My now ex girlfriend met a woman while she was away on vacation with her sister. When she got back she told me she hadn't really missed me and thinks she should explore her possible sexuality. Now the thing is she's completely obsessed with this woman according to my friends, even though they have a huge language barrier and she gets frustrated by her a lot. What confuses me is her sudden and extreme change of heart, because everything was going really well between us (for almost two years) until she went on vacation. When she came back from vacation, her personality was also changed considerably from what I've seen and what our mutual friends told me. They even said they barely recognised her... as if she's a complete stranger. She was 19 and I was 18 at the time. Six months have passed and most of that time she spent working a 48h factory job so she could afford to go back to that country again... My question is: is this actually normal/healthy behaviour or is something wrong?
- Is there a cure for depressive nihilism? asking for a friend...
- What's the right balance between giving someone too much space and being overbearing when they're dealing with mental health problems? (This is my partner who I live with, with both of us in our early 20s and mentally ill)
- Can you prove I'm fucking real and actually alive and not already and always been in hell? I settled so long ago and I hate almost everything and have punished myself ever since. The only thing that keeps me going is that I might eventually die. I used to experience a lot of odd

things until I gave up on pretty much everything and now I have pretty much no connection to anything. I use to have really bad anxiety and panic attacks but now I don't and I just don't feel any emotions really at all unless I'm really high.

- What are your thoughts on the JEB! foundation?

- How to stop thinking and stressing over a recent past relationship ?

- Is there a cure for panic disorder? I started suffering from panic attacks and extreme anxiety a few months ago and it's very frightening. I can not afford to see a therapist since I do not have any insurance, but sometimes I feel like I'm slowly losing my mind and it scares me to death. Will I ever feel normal again?

- Hello Dr. Victor Schwartz,

How can i be more understanding and help a very close friend of mine who is suffering from major self-esteem issues with anxiety? What all can i do when she starts to overthink, overreact and over analyse things which in turns affects her life and relationships?

- [removed]

- Hi Doc. Question: Do you think it would help if individuals realized that their minds might not be as reliable a reference source as they believe? In other words, subjective opinion isn't really worth obsessing over.

- What is your personal opinion on anti-depressants, do they really work? Do they just make things worse? Are they just placebos? Your opinion on SSRIs vs NDRIs (Wellbutrin)

I've done countless hours if not days of research from all over the internet, and ultimately have been finding conflicting conclusions.

Can you share your personal/honest opinion?

- Can Generalized Anxiety Disorder be cured without medication?

- Hey doc, can you recommend any online services or tools that can help you get an idea of what mental issues you have?

- How Do You Know Someone Mentally Unstable ? Does Talking And Answering Yourself Count?

- Hi Dr, how are you?

My father is in his 60s. He been suffering from sychological misbehaviour for years, talking and fighting with himself, which led to many big family issues, like not talking or seeing his daughter for 15 years now. Is there a way we can help him? Note that he will never accept to go to a doctor.

Thanks in advance.

- How to talk to girl with big busms without being distracted? Also how to make them fall for me easy? Thanks. Fyi, im average looking guy 4'9, best height, sounds like fortnite fyi. Just sayin. Thanks in advance.

- How do you deal with an extremely egoistic, megalomaniac and a stubborn narcissist friend? I really value him for his good qualities; I just want to help him ease out irl..

- Hey i have mild anxiety and some depression to boot, besides the meds im currently taking can you give me any tips to deal with random anxiety attacks?

- How do I help a friend who has anxiety? It's severely affecting her life and her ability to leave her home, and medication doesn't work for her.

- Hi Dr. Schwartz

So a friend of mine (known him my entire life) is a pretty compulsive liar and I want to understand why someone lies to even their closest friends. For example, My buddy Nick planned a trip to the phillies game.. just Nick, our liar friend , and I were going to go. Nick was MIA (he was running the broad st run) in the morning before the game at 2pm. So my friend who lies a lot calls me and is getting pissed that Nick isnt answering his phone and he's wandering what the plan is... Meanwhile he's saying his gf is sick and he might not be able to make it because he would have to stay and tend to her.. Anyways, Nick finally gets back to us like an hour before the game. Our liar friend doesn't respond so Nick and I just go to the game without him. Nick sends a text to our liar friends gf saying, "hey i heard you're sick.. I hope you feel better" to which she responds saying "Idk why he's telling you this, I'm not sick at all, and he sold his ticket days ago"

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Now why?? WHY? would someone goes to this weird and unusual lengths to lie to their closest friends for literally no reason.. just tell us you aren't going! I can't understand the motive behind this... can you perhaps explain?

- Where do I refer a friend to who is ready to commit suicide due to severe dental pain?

They're unable to pay for services.

- My husband has trouble with insomnia. Usually his bad times of insomnia tend to last 1-2 weeks with 2-3 days of very few hours of sleep, like 1-2 hrs a night during those days. And only a few times a year. He's not had much luck with a lot of insomnia medication either. Lunesta, Ambien, Restoril, Tranxene, Trazadone, OTC supplements have not worked or have but then didn't help hardly ever again. He was on Klonopin some years back as needed for sleep, and that helped but he didn't want to stay on it because of the possibility to become addicted. And now doctors are so afraid to prescribe anything like that at all.

He hasn't had a bout of this kind of insomnia in the past 9 months, until this month and he's having a lot of trouble this time around as it's lasted for 4+ weeks. He does have generalized anxiety, so of course not sleeping at all causes more anxiety thus likely makes it more difficult to sleep and so on. It's a toxic cycle.

His regular doctor will not prescribe any controlled substances and has offered no other options other than him seeing a psychiatrist. Which he's fine with doing! But it takes about 3 months to see any psychiatrist in our area because we don't have many here, and apparently the offices we do have split their patients into groups based on their insurance. And we have great insurance that does cover 100% of any mental health related services, so our ins. isn't the reason why it takes so long to get in.

So, any opinions of what he can do in the mean time until he can get into to see a psychiatrist? He does have an appt next week with a sleep disorder specialist but he's afraid they'll just brush him off too.

- What do you feel is the single biggest issue in the field of psychology today, and how can the field of mental health research/practice over the next 50 years seek to address this problem?

- I can't believe I missed this as I don't know where to begin with helping my friend. He says that someone in a flat above his has taken an aggressive dislike to him, has threatened him and

shouts abuse at him late at night. I have spoken to most of the residents in the flats above his and there is no one that fits the bill, my friend has also never met the shouter.

​

He also had exactly the same problem with a neighbour in the place he lived previously, complaining about the noise my friend made at night when 'crumpling tin foil' He cannot see the connection between the two. I have tried to explain that the shouting he hears may well be real but his interpretation of it being aggressively directed at him is an incorrect assumption.

​

I am worried that this current situation will deteriorate if he does not get some sort of help but I don't think I can convince him he should talk to someone, as my efforts so far are being interpreted by him as criticism when I have put a lot of care into what I have said to try and avoid being critical. Has anyone got any advice on what to do?

- Hey there doc! I think its important especially now in 2019 for us to be talking about mental health. I really appreciate you doing this AMA.

That being said my youngest sibling (of five boys) is struggling with depression. Almost two years ago my father was let go from his exec job and it took a huge toll on all of us, but it seems it might have taken a part of my sibling that we all really want back! He barely speaks when spoken to and struggles to find confidence in himself.

My parents have been saving so he can see a psychologist or a therapist (what-have-you). I'm curious what is the best way to move forward?

Thanks again for doing this very important AMA.

- As suggested by my therapist, I tried to go out of my comfort zone and go alone to a local Activities Fair to find some things of interest to do this summer, since my narcissistic husband and I recently separated.

In the middle of a conversation with one vendor, I began to sweat profusely on my face which is how my anxiety presents itself. I could tell the guy talking to me was getting uncomfortable but kept talking to me like a champ.

All I could do was try to figure out how to break away without seeming weird (too late for that!) or rude. Thank God my phone began to ring the Super Mario ringtone that is my son and I yelled, "Gotta take this call. It's my son," over my shoulder and just basically ran away. Lol

I guess it may take a while before I try that again. Granted, it was hot as hell in that enclosed room in the back of the public library but I kept thinking, why isn't anyone else all sweaty? The things that go through our minds...

- What is the best way to help someone who is expressing suicidal thoughts and it appears they may be doing it to get back into a relationship that has ended?
- Do you have a recommendation for a therapist versed in the healing of a person with trauma as a result of 34 years of mental abuse at the hands of my husband, recently diagnosed with Narcissistic Personality Disorder, in the Fort Worth, TX area? I have been seeing a local therapist and made the mistake of giving permission for my husband to see the same therapist. She has sided with him and is making me feel that I have to defend myself and is eliciting my sympathy for his current position which is living somewhere besides our home now. This is the last thing I need right now.
- How do I deal with feelings of failure?
- What's the best way to talk to someone with asperger syndrome?
- I'm the only one my friend can really be open with about her suicidal struggles because we share them. How can I relate to her and help her feel understood and that she's not alone in her feelings with out commiserating and making her feel hopeless?
- In your opinion, what is the most effective way to treat preverbal trauma that presents as passivity/sexual fetishes?

Title: June is Men's Mental Health Month. What would you men like to be done for you, what problem would you want help with or advice on, or what discussions would you wanna have?

Post Text: Can be absolutely anything

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I'd like to get rid of this stereotype once and for all that men don't ask for help because of toxic masculinity

I saw a study of thousands of men who had committed suicide, and it found that 90% of these men were either in counselling when they took their own lives, or had just finished seeing a psychologist

They asked for help. They just didn't get it

- I just want someone to love me other than my family
- Sincere expressions of gratitude. You'd be surprised how much a simple "thank you" can mean to someone, especially if they are feeling like nothing they do is ever noticed or appreciated.
- You've seen the video where the Lady Ted talker was taking about shame ? And how it affects women, and she tells the story about how the guy challenges her and says "the women in my life are harder on me than anybody else, my wife and daughters would rather watch me die on my white horse than fall off".

In all my life no man ever told me to be a man.

Plenty of women did.

When I mentioned this to my therapist, she said that "this is because they learned it from the men".

I want to have a discussion about how women are absolutely brutal in reinforcing unhelpful male stereotypes, and dismissive as fuck when you don't meet their standard of male, all while asking us to be vulnerable.

That's the discussion we need.

- How about some male exclusive spaces for boys and fathers?
- We need a world that doesn't tear men apart for being men.
- I'd like that for the whole month, when the subject of men's mental health is brought up in the media, it isn't immediately turned into a discussion about how it affects women and how they have things so much harder.
- [removed]
- Stop telling us to improve ourselves after we went through the painful journey to improve ourselves. I lost weight, got off drugs, quit smoking, started a business, overcame many psychological issues due to abusive childhood, and found my peace in this world. But when I struggle with something the advice is to "go to the gym" or "wear better clothes" or "make more money" or whatever. No matter what, nothing we do is good enough.

I agree you should constantly try to be better than you were the day before, but it's not always the solution. Sometimes things just suck and I'm tired of being told to go to the gym to fix some unrelated thing. Instead I would like to be heard and understood that some situations are just shit and wearing trendy clothes or getting jacked isn't going to solve it. Sometimes empathy is the solution, not the bench press.

- Nothing. Because talking about my problems isn't going to change anything.
- I want Suicide Booths to be installed in every city
- Men need an alternative to therapy. Talk therapy has been acknowledged to be less useful for men than it is for women. Currently talk therapy doesn't seem to have a replacement readily available.

I do not mean we need to replace behavioral therapy (such as CBT) or psychiatric work done by a licensed psychiatrist. I am talking about the type of therapy I seem to keep getting as opposed to the best treatment I ever got was from a man who hated me, he ran a men's group focused on grief and abuse. It was powerful, and impactful. Some of the stories from those other men still guide me.

I ran a group like this focused on anger and its causes when I worked at a homeless shelter. The men always told me it was some of the most meaningful conversations they'd had in years. (I am not a psychiatrist or licensed counselor, I just started the conversation off and mediated the time)

We need more of these groups for men. They seem to be hard to find.

Jubilee recently did a video that somewhat shows such a group in action:

<https://youtu.be/NvOQI5Tm4qM?si=enk1mNJlboxAQRQC8>

- The big problem for me is that in order to see someone about my mental health, it means I have to take time off work, which costs me money, which is the entire reason I do my job...
- I'm 43, since when has there been a Men's Mental Health Month? Since when has society cared about Men's Mental Health?
- To stop labeling "all men are rapists and abusers". When you condition young boys and men that they are an animal when in reality the overwhelming majority are probably sweet and kind you get men who resent women.

I have younger brothers that are 10 years younger than me and they told me constantly that they were being told they were the former almost weekly. They won't go near a woman. It's way too risky.

Eventually, you believe you're worthless unless you're 6 foot, 6 figures, and a dong the size of an axle rod. No wonder kids are offing themselves.

- Acknowledge that all the 'bear' and other comparisons are incredibly insulting to the 90% of men who are not rapists and perpetrators of sexual assault.

Yes, we get it - women have it bad dealing with bad men - but the men who are not bad get tired of being lumped in.

- Don't let past trauma or abuse define who you are today. Didn't realize until I reached adulthood how prevalent and pervasive mental and physical abuse was and that I suffered from it. I thought everyone got hit and/or yelled at for things they didn't do at one time or another. Explore different ways to help you heal. Still working on this myself.
- My dudes..... get into roleplaying games. Dungeons and Dragons, Pathfinder, Vampire the Masquerade. Whatever the fudge. You can create a character with your mental problems and roleplay them out. Talk about them as a character concept as an interesting take and people will listen.

Building friend groups, socializing, getting your mental anguish out as an rp. moments and not to mention being a part of a glorious story.

- I'd like to not be treated like trash or a criminal by the people around me
- How about this - can we cancel that BS "man or bear in the forest" meme?

It makes me so damned sad that many women think that law and order is all that keeps men from raping/killing etc.

Most people, men included, are decent enough.

- Nah it gets overshadowed by pride month, just like international mens day is usually the same day as international toilet day or something. Majority of homeless are men, 80% of suicides are men, men are given on average 60% harsher sentences than women with similar records and crimes, women win the vast majority of divorce cases, but all we hear about is male privilege's.

- I'd like to not have to immediately go on the defensive after being open about a personal struggle. I know that's not exclusively a guy thing, but it's been my experience that even people who are genuinely wanting to be helpful will sometimes turn it into some sort of comparison or express that whatever issue I've mentioned is now also a problem for them.
- The irony of Men's Health Month and Pride month being the same month. Once again we will be pushed to the background, because society continues to value us less and less.
- What exactly does it being men's mental health month accomplish? Do we get waivers for free therapy or something? That would be cool. Because just saying "hey it's this month now" doesn't accomplish much.

Source: I've lived through several Hispanic history months and were still tossing poor Hispanic people into camps or leaving them in the economic shadows. Shit, they might start calling us vermin in the mainstream media p soon here

- Big investment in mental health services. It should be much easier to access them. And we need to tackle stigma around accessing them. That does seem to be happening, but not quickly enough.

I'd also like a discussion about men just being nicer to each other. So many men are just dicks to other men, even their own friends, completely unnecessarily. There's just no need for it.

- Get me a sturdy rope, just in case.

There is nothing to be done as long as suffering is perceived as weakness, let alone mental health issues.

- The discussion I want to have are the quieter traits of masculinity that too often get overlooked in favor of the vocal:
 - Combat is not conducive to great leadership. Diplomacy is.
 - Being introverted does not mean being timid or weak.
 - It's okay to keep your ambitions outside of the corporate realm.
 - Changing yourself for the purposes of attracting women *is* being a people pleaser.
- This thread is the first time that I've seen this topic brought up without someone chiming in that men don't have it so bad and we should be focusing on women's issues instead.

Yes, it is true, women face a host of unique issues navigating their day-to-day existence. The reality of women's struggles doesn't preclude men's issues from also being a problem. What would I like to be done? I'd like people to be able to give at least intellectual assent to the idea that we can care about more than one thing, and that struggles in one group do not indicate a lack of struggles in another.

There is a miniscule cohort of humans on this planet that really do live life on easy-mode. All of our discussions will be more productive if we stop lumping in the "others" with that tiny percentage of the population.

- I just want to be held lmao
- That men are one of the most vulnerable populations because we have the same emotional needs as others but are constantly deprived them

That our suffering isn't a failure on our part

That I don't need to "improve myself" through my hardships (to an extent)

That a large part of male dysfunction in society comes from the despair we feel from not being accepted or loved even in our frailty

That we should be more understanding of men trying to connect with others even if it's sloppy. A guy awkwardly trying to get to know you isn't predatory, which our knee jerk culture treats it as sometimes

That men do not have it easy, and privilege is a divisive and harmful conception of society
- I know society has mostly moved past this, but I wish men were afforded the same courtesy of non-generalized statements.

We were all told that "not all men" is implied, and that "if you are not a predator you shouldn't be offended". Try saying "women are trash", and you'll get "sure, some women. But you can't just say women are trash, that implies all women.

For the record, I don't think women are trash. I just wish men weren't exempt from non-generalizing.

- Women: stop bitching about toxic masculinity while rewarding it in your dating preferences. I'm not saying "change your dating preferences", because they're **your** preferences and you have **every** right to them (and I'm not being sarcastic or facetious here, I really do believe that). I'm saying that when you use toxic masculinity as the actual metric for how much you want to date a man, don't then turn around and pretend you hate toxic masculinity or that it's something being perpetuated by men, because the vast majority of us hate toxic masculinity and don't want anything to do with it; those of us who do suffer through it only do it in order to date women.

Toxic masculinity is yours, you own it, you uphold it, you enforce it. Please just be honest about it.

- Id like for men to stop being treated as a second class citizens because of the false narrative that we're Evil and we deserve it.

- Women have 250 Shelters to every 1 men have - yet the vast majority of homeless are men.

- It being socially acceptable for women to take advantage of men, use them for free drinks and food even tho they NEVER intended on giving him a chance.

- Men lose their kids to the mother in 95% of custody cases by default - even if the mother is a deadbeat and the father is normal - women get the kids BOOM! no questions asked.

- Paternity fraud is rampant and there's no consequences for perpetrators.

- Men can never be victims in hetero relationships, it's never believed - they're always seen as the predator and women are always viewed as the victim by default.

-Women can hit men out on the street and no-one stops her or bats an eye. If a man hits back he'll get mobbed and told "WTF is wrong with you?! - you piece of shit!"

- If a couple gets accidentally pregnant and the Father wants to keep it but the mother doesn't. He has no say.

- If a couple gets accidentally pregnant and the Mother wants to keep it but the Father doesn't. He has no say And he is forced by law to pay child support.

Men are not valued as fathers by society or the law.

Fighting for Mens rights is seen as extremist terrorism - but let's be real the system isn't perfect for ether gender so why is fighting for one "admirable" while fighting for the other is "Patriarchy & Misogyny"?

Men are expected to fend for themselves - always..

We get no help, we're not believed - we are not being heard.. we are dismissed and ignored.

R.I.P. my fallen brothers.. society failed you..

- Instead of treating our depression as if we are asking to be loved and cared for, the support should be driven to make us feel needed and strong. Guys have an innate nature to want to feel accomplished and great. Yes, we appreciate love but we also want to feel appreciated for what we do, including taking care of our families at the cost of at times sleep or cleared minds. Many times it's a thankless job we take day by day and sometimes a little acknowledgement goes a LONG way. Many of the boys desire even a text from our loved ones that goes along the lines of, "thank you for supporting us even on the days when you want to give up." In an age where mental health is being ridiculed for being something pansies chat about to something only spoken by women, a lot (vast majority) of us men don't talk about our feelings still to this day. We either have no friends to talk to about our struggles nor are we comfortable telling our spouses if they are of the opposite sex for fear of it being weaponized. We should be able to communicate our struggles but in a way that helps us men and be spoken to like men. Yes, huge shocker, men and women are different. We think differently, we act differently. Sometimes even the boys letting us know that they see us and they are proud of us for stepping up and being there for our families is a huge deal. Watch us glow up when we are given the news that our kids smiled at a photo of us. Even for those without kids, watch us glow up when another man sees us grinding and tell us that we are doing great out there in our field. A hell of a boost in our day and a pep in our step. I mean I can go on, but that's at least one thing I've picked up this past few days that needs to be addressed.

- as with each year, we need to have more conversations about male isolation, depression, self-harm, suicide, and sexual abuse/assault.

guys take their lives 5x more often than women do.

they're much less likely to seek mental health counseling or medical care.
they're frequent victims of sexual assault/abuse, but very few people outside of the mental health sphere care, or even want to acknowledge it.

be a helper by being a listener.
don't offer advice unless it's asked for.
someone turning down your advice isn't a personal attack.
you getting angry when someone doesn't want to hear your advice is not helpful.

don't tell anyone to "get over it", "deal with it", "move on", or "try to forget about it".
regardless of how recently or long ago it happened, the pain of trauma is real.
invalidating someone is much worse than saying or doing nothing.

blaming the victim is one of the worst things we can do.
shaming, mocking, or ridiculing someone for being a victim can be terminal.

expressing fears, anxieties, sadness, vulnerabilities, asking for help, needing compassion and empathy, seeking medical/mental health care, and shedding tears doesn't prove you're weak--it proves you're strong.
by shutting down someone's emotions, you're telling them that they don't matter to you.

nobody gets through life alone.
if you can't help, then at least don't cause any more hurt.
take pain seriously. listen if you can.

gently suggest professional counseling/medical intervention.
and remember, change doesn't happen overnight.
patience is a huge part of empathy, and regressing is part of the healing process.

thank you.
- I would like the term toxic masculinity erased from everyone's memory. Can we just go back to calling the dude a dick instead of labeling an entire sex?

It would be nice to be able to express our feelings without them being held against us as being weak or not a real man. There has been this massive turn that we are not allowed to have an opinion/wants/insecurities without shame tactics.
- SO - Don't offer unsolicited advice, don't give us directions, don't tell us where to park - all unless we ask

- Stop being blamed for shit that's not our fault. Acknowledging misandry exists. Stopping the 'All men this... All men that...'
- Even if we have some extra muscle strength, we have an innate need to feel safe too.

A ton of men live in trauma, fear, anxiety, depression, etc. and it's mindfucking because you don't really even know how to articulate the feelings of danger.

Yeah, you don't fear walking down the street as much. But you also can't control your mind and so much suffering is generated by your own brain.

Plus, scary shit can happen to us too. Sickness, death, danger, trauma, abuse, etc. anyway.

Just being bigger and stronger for a time doesn't make it all better.

- discrimination in education. punished more often and more harshly, graded lower for the same work. 2/3 of college students being women isn't a fucking accident.

young men spend the first 20-odd years of their lives under the control of people who hate and objectively discriminate against them. people with the support of the government. you want men to feel better, to connect with society? make society stop kicking them, especially when they're young and vulnerable.

- 1) One thing I'd like to see is more resources that can help guys see what resources and tools are out there, or what ways we can re-engage in the world.

I hate getting stuck with the issue of going to work and coming home and having no life outside of that, nor any decent skills to create a hobby from or to fix my home with.

2) It would also be nice to have some ideas or excuses to get together with other guys to create friendships or other bonds with. If you're not into sports or don't see the point in drinking at an expensive bar, then it seems like there's not much left to connect with unless you are already in a different group. (Hard to develop any friendships as an adult).

3) Last thing would be more helpful things for relationships and having sex. It seems like the majority of stuff out there supports and encourages women, but barely anything out there to help men except to place a much larger burden of the relationship on them and to say sex is something you should live without instead of acknowledging it's a need for a healthy long-term relationship.

Nothing out there seems to address this in relationship advice or education, and too many guys get stuck in what they consider a dead bedroom type of relationship where they have no intimacy needs met.

**Edited to include the third concern due to the post accidentally being posted before I was finished with it.

- Sometimes I don't need you to deal with my problems at all, it only makes me feel guilty that I'm now forcing my problems on you. If you care, just go hang out with me, tolerate me a bit, you don't need to act any different from usual.
- To have government institutions allocate more funding on men's issues (male mental health, boys' education, male DV shelters, more awareness on male victims of rape/SA, an institutionalised male safe space, etc.)

And the announcement must be public. Making it public will alleviate a lot of anxiety surrounding men's issues, and make it seem like the world does care about men, and not just 'optics'.

- My mental health is soaring already! My girlfriends organising my birthday party and it makes me happy knowing that.
- [deleted]
- Wanna highlight the consequences of false hope. 🤔
- Nothing to add yet but I love this is a thread.
- Divorce and family law. What a shit show.
- Would be nice if the west would stop shitting on men at every single opportunity and then some. Probably solve most 'mental health' issues men are having.
- Forget it, June is also pride month, so you can guess who will be demanding all the attention and getting all the media coverage.
- The day I bring my mental health concerns to Reddit is indeed a sad, sad day.
- The real fact is that nobody gives a shit about men. We ARE the help everyone needs. We just want appreciation
- I would like a job, being unemployed is making me depressed and I'm starting to lose hope that I will get one
- The stigma our workplaces have about men taking sick days or mental health days. I took this week off work because I fell through a table & bruised my ribs at home last weekend & my boss thinks I'm out partying with hookers and blow. I'm not even seeking compensation or anything
- The concept of "man" in general. What it means to be a man has changed. Being a man myself in my early 20s figuring out wtf it means to be a man in today's day and age is confusing and stressful at times.
- A Man's Convention - Free Haircuts, Skin Care Classes, Group Therapy, and BJJ.
- To be able to share negative thoughts without a woman saying "but women/toxic masculinity", cheating, or leaving.
- Sometimes it's ok to admit that your situation is just super fucked and you are gonna be in that for a while...people keep forcing new tips on me and I'm fed up of telling them that it doesn't work(they get a little offended after this)
- Just someone who is loyal. Loyalty is hard to come by these days, most women only go for money, and soon as you fuck up if you're lucky to have someone, they cheat on you or leave you instead of listening to you,
- My Dad once told me that throughout his 20's and 30's he was single, and very much invisible to the world. He had an excellent job, cool cars, and a nice house of his own- but he was basically invisible to society and he said that he lived day in and day out very very lonely until he found my mother. He explained that, for many single men, it is lonely because nobody thinks to

check in on you, call you, talk to you, etc. It was difficult for him not to feel down on himself as a result.

It broke my heart. My dad is by far one of the most interesting, funny, caring, brilliant humans I have ever been privileged enough to have in my life- let alone to have as a dad. He is the greatest force in my life besides my mother. He is the center of my universe and provides stability and grounding nomatter what. Men- you are NOT invisible. You are NOT invisible. You are NOT invisible. Every human being has social value- please do not let the world make you believe that you don't. I wonder sometimes how my 30-year-old Dad would have felt if he knew that one day he would be infinitely important and cherished by his family and his community. You guys rock. Love is abundant. You are not invisible.

- I want the nearest homie (gender irrelevant) to be like "I got you bro. It's gonna be ok." Then we embrace in a 10 second bro hug.

- It's depressingly pathetic that so many people respond to this thread but no one speaks the truth. Maybe it's fear of cancellation or being called some sort of phobe. When has anyone seen any ad or event for men's mental health in June? The month has been hijacked by the "we will never be satisfied or stop crying about everything until we have more rights than everyone else" alphabet club. It's hard to focus on mental health of anyone when the streets are filled with parades of naked people and rainbows.

- What the hell's Men' Mental Health Month? That's the first time I've heard it.

- Never heard of it

- I thought June was "Pride Month".

- For Men's Mental Health Awareness Month, I'd like 20% off all fishing gear. Then leave me alone.

- In the U.K. it's in November.

- Too late. I fixed my own

- Single women can only turn down every other request for a date

- Men lack a support system. There is only one (1) mens only shelter in the USA, that in itself is an absolute joke. We have nobody to talk to. Mental health support for men is not nearly as available as it is to women, especially single mothers. We get no government benefits to help us like women do. We are constantly taken for granted and dismissed as disposable. Veterans get crap support and suffer even more than civilian men. All around rejection from life and women wears us out.

Try being: peaceful, honest, faithful, feminine, respectful and supportive. Try doing all the things you want, be the person you want. Stow away the selfish nature and reciprocate to him. That's it.

- Don't laugh men out of your offices that have experienced rape because you believe that 'only women can truly experience that' (actually said to me from seven different offices). This crap is real, traumatizing, and hurts to no end when we can't get the support we need and we're made to feel like less of a man because it happened.

- I'd like for mental health companies to start putting effort into promoting mental health resources for men instead of solely focusing on pride month in June...I'm not even kidding...it is insane how much MENTAL HEALTH organizations ignore men's mental health. See what I mean > [https://youtu.be/yM5_sv8AP6g](https://youtu.be/yM5_sv8AP6g)

- I wanna be happy

- I just want a hug
- I just want to feel valued for being a person not for how hard I work.
- I'd say don't Even stress it because there are like mine to think like you do and understand but then there are others who have these "opinions" and sometimes it's best to just pay them.No mine especially the ones on the internet
- I'd say don't Even stress it because there are like mine to think like you do and understand but then there are others who have these "opinions" and sometimes it's best to just pay them.No mine especially the ones on the internet
- We should be more realistic about how sedentary lifestyles cause mental health problems.

~25% of Americans are considered completely sedentary. That shit is awful for your mind as well as your body.

- Stop shoving this stupid pride thing down our throats.
- Find something that brings me joy
- I thought it was LGBTQ+ month?
- [deleted]
- My dick won't suck itself :
- Since theory of relativity says that if you feel weight, there is an object accelerating against you, and that gravity is not a force therefore it can not create movement, but it just warps spacetime. And we live on a planet that we believe to be round, would not that mean that the planet is expanding on all sides?

So how is it that it does not seem like the planet is expanding, and how does it push us then?

Title: Do people without any mental health issues actually exist?

Post Text: Don't we all have to deal with anything? Is there really someone in the world we could call a 100% mentally healthy individual? If so how would we define this?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I think everyone has mental health issues but not everyone has mental illness/disorder
- As of 2019, [1 in 8]([https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/mental-disorders#:~:text=In%202019%2C%201%20in%20every,the%20most%20common%20\(1\)](https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/mental-disorders#:~:text=In%202019%2C%201%20in%20every,the%20most%20common%20(1)))) people suffer with a mental health condition.

The rest of the 7 will still deal with difficult times, stress, depression, anxiety. The difference is they are able to deal with these situations and emotions in a healthy way, and their symptoms don't meet clinical thresholds for a mental health condition.

People over pathologise nowadays. Younger people especially experiencing normal human emotions such as sadness or stress jump to thinking they ****must**** be mentally ill. The growing tendency to pathologise normal human behaviour and emotions increasingly leads to the belief that people ***without*** MH issues are somewhat rare. But no, they're the majority. The silent one, too, as you won't run into non mentally ill folk if you're accessing services for your mental illness.

Everyone has stuff to deal with. It's about how you deal with it, if you can deal with it, how distressed you get when dealing with it, if what you're dealing with wouldn't be a problem for the mentally healthy... etc. Those 7 of 8 people are able to deal with adversity, low mood, stress, anxiety effectively, without the impairment of any illness that would otherwise make those emotions/situations really difficult to handle.

- My friends boyfriend has absolutely zero mental health issues and ngl me and my friends are fascinated by it. I feel like its way more rare to find someone whose not mentally ill nowadays
- I'd like to break the news. I know a few who do not have any mental illnesses at all. They haven't faced any kind of depression, anxiety or any sorts of mental health condition. When i told them about certain illnesses, they went like, "woah, i never knew about this and i never will because I've always been happy" and the advice given by them to me was " hey stop being sad. Be happy" when i was in the worst periods of my life. Needless to say, they do exist. People without any kind of problems exist.
- I think mental health illness and issues are the price we as humans paid for being the smartest species in the world. There is always a give and take for everything in the universe, and we as humans have accomplished so much but it all comes at a price.
- I think everything is a spectrum, like autism in a way

Sexuality , mental health issues , disabilities

Everything

Everyone's a bit of everything even if its just a trace

- This is a complicated question. Everyone may have issues, but not everyone has issues that affect their executive functioning to such a degree they need therapy and medication, or their daily lives are affected. When it is a true uncontrollable hindrance in your life, it's not the same as when some people get sad etc.
- I don't think that one person exists without mental health issues, unless we count babies, they might be without any mental health issues, unless something bad happens.
- I think if you grow up in a good household it's reasonable to not have any. Most people also probably just manage on their own.

If I just focus on work and not much else then my mental health issues don't really come up. As soon as I try having relationships or deeper relationships it's clear that I have some issues, so for a while I just focused on work and not much else. That is not a fun way to live though.

- Everyone has their own battles and Everyone has anxiety from time to time but definitely not every person has a mental health "issue" not to say it like that but like not everyone is diagnosed with mental health struggles.
- Mental health issues are the side effects of existence in life
- Everyone struggles with emotions. We are human. Sadness, stress, anxiety, guilt, happiness, anger, depression are all emotions every human (minus people with antisocial personality disorder) has the ability to feel. This difference is most people are able to manage these emotions when they feel them. People with a mental health condition are unable to manage certain emotions.

I get depressed and it's like "whatever, just a bad day or 2" and the next day I'm fine. My husband gets depressed and it's more than just a bad day.

- Weirdly my friend's boyfriend has zero mental health issues. His parents went through a divorce but he's still the healthiest and emotionally stable person I know. It's genuinely fascinating

- Show me someone who thinks they have no mental health issues and I'll show you someone with a major personality disorder

- I feel like this too sometimes because everyone I met has some kind of mental health issues. Unless it's just an attraction thing. I'm not really sure.

- Yes and no. I would say that people with mental health disorders tend to put themselves in a box, sometimes we shouldn't label things.

- Nobody is 100% mentally healthy but some people have far worse mental health than others to the point it can be categorised as a disorder or issue

- Half of all Americans will have a mental health condition in our lives. Some professions are more prone to them. For example, 80 percent of people in food service will have one or more behavioral health challenges at some point.

Basically, if we don't have one ourselves, we know someone who does. If we have one ourselves, we know more people who do. If we have one ourselves, we have a confirmation bias where we are more apt to 'see' people with illness. If we have one ourselves and are on this subreddit, a self-selection bias also kicks in.

- Anyone can feel sad, and anyone can be depressed. It's when it's persistent and characterized by negatively impacting your quality of life that it's considered either: situational depression (long-term depression caused by external factors), or clinical depression (characterized by repeated, frequent and persisting episodes of depression).

[Situational vs clinical depression. Article written by a psychologist, B. Juby. July 2023.](<https://www.medicalnewstoday.com/articles/314698>)

- Yes they exist, you can go thru shit without having mental health issues depends on your perspective and response to situations

- People with mental health issues definitely exist.

What an invalidating statement, OP.

Behavior has meaning. And people are all different.

Im grateful that you do not have those heartbreaking and sufferable experiences and are privileged to not have to struggle in those relationships.

- I've meet a lot of people in my time. Nobody is immune to situational depression and anxiety. Like nobody. Those without mental health issues and disorders exist for sure. Soo to answer your question yes there actually are.

- What some people call issues are just the normal spectrum of human emotions or fairly normal reactions to big life events. If we are talking about disorders or persistent issues then no, I don't

believe everyone has mental health issues. But I also don't believe everyone is 100% healthy, at least not all of the time and that's normal. No one is really 100% physically healthy either but that doesn't mean you call them unhealthy.

- I have a newer friend who doesn't have mental health issues. Like at all. He's never experienced anxiety, which he some times feels bad about because all of his friends have and he can't relate. He also has never gone to therapy, and is overall a really great person. Granted, I haven't known him for that long, just a few months, but he seems very genuine.

- I am working in a website for social anxiety. Will anyone be willing to take my survey and share your personal experiences and effective coping strategies, I would greatly appreciate your input. Your valuable insights will enable me to kickstart my project with a solid foundation. Thank you in advance for your support! All responses will remain anonymous and no personal data is recorded in the survey.

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfUymBIAhRI7nY4cXdCsJmKc7CuTa-yPqsbmClcUr2BG_yWNA/viewform?usp=sf_link

- What's mental health according to you?

Is mental health just that you dont have any mental illness.. or its how much we have enhanced our mental capabilities. Now what is the limit of mental capabilities?

- Depends on what you define as mental health issues.

But yes, there are people out there who exist without the experience of any mental illness or mental disorder, and many who have never experienced a temporal but complete psychological breakdown either. It still blows my mind. I can't imagine what that kind of life would be like. I try not to think about it because it just causes me to feel more depression and grief that I can never have that kind of life. It doesn't mean that these people don't experience any hardships and other kinds of health issues in life, though, and whatever their hardship may be is valid. I wish all people from all different walks of life any kind of support and betterment.

- Some children. I used to be a child with no worries, extroverted and always happy.

Constant bullying, my father who cheated on my mother and some other factors changed that. Now I'm an introverted suicidal teenager with social anxiety.

- Mental health is a continuum and even those of us who have a diagnosed mental health condition can experience positive mental health. It is never a fixed state and can change daily, weekly, monthly, yearly. The more protective factors we have in our lives, the greater the likelihood we will experience positive mental health, or at the very least, 'bounce back' sooner.

- I'm going to say almost everyone without a mental illness or disorder has experienced things like anxiety, depression or even just stress and grief. But as for people who don't experience this on a day to day basis, they definitely exist.

- This question is so interesting, I always question the same thing all the time. As a person who has been through and still goes through anxiety, I've always felt alone in this journey of coping with this. Until I started my degree in Psychology, I always felt this madness, but it isn't, it's a condition that makes you feel that you're stuck in a mental jail. Then I started getting to know how childhood and so many factors contribute to mental illness or any behavior for that matter. And let's be real here, no one has had a "perfect" life, we've all faced something that scarred us and caused us to behave in a certain way that sometimes feels beyond normal, to us or to

society. But getting a diagnosis is where the boundary lies when our human definition of "normal" crosses a line.

- you've never met a completely normal protective happy member in society? my ex "best friend" was one of those. which is funny cuz i'm the complete opposite. those people exist, yes. there are people that don't understand or acknowledge mental health issues as real things and they're able to just obliviously function just fine in life. idunno how they exist like that, but they do.

- I've always thought this!! Mental health issues? Surely we just mean LIFE.

- No. But there are people that exists that have mental health issues that don't really debilitate their life.

- My identical twin has no diagnosed mental health issues. He's physically active, socially active, really clean (like he keeps his space clean), eats and cooks healthy, etc...

I have major depression and anxiety disorders. I can barely keep my bedroom clean, struggle to do anything physical, live in social isolation, eat horribly, etc...

I'm the one who started and quit smoking cigs. I'm the one who developed a drinking problem and had to quit.

I would be surprised if he doesn't live 5-10 years longer than me.

It's really depressing to think about... the toll mental health takes on us. I'm not mad at him I just wish I was more like him. Of course he has his struggles. No one lives a perfect life.

- I would argue that I have 0% mental health issues.

I sleep for 8 hours, I eat well over 2,500 calories a day, and I exercise by running for 1 hour a week (approximately 6.2 miles).

[Studies indicate that a healthy proactive balance of eating, sleeping, and exercising exponentially mitigates a lot of mental health issues]

I work 8-10 hour days in 100-110 degree fahrenheit weather on the flightline, sweating to death and drinking up to 1 gallon and a half of water to compensate. I only drink 1-3 energy drinks a calendar year, I don't smoke, and I don't drink alcohol.

I'd also like to add that I meditate and pray periodically. My view of life is contentment over happiness, over materialism.

I am well connected and have positive relations with my religious and social communities.

[Other Harvard studies indicate that having and maintaining good positive relationships with people is another outlet for long life happiness as well].

I have a half dozen younger brothers and sisters raised in a religiously conservative loving home with no extremism. Parents allowed us to exercise free moral agency and do our own thing without fear of reprisal or abuse of any kind.

I am currently undergoing a divorce with two children, I am not a proponent of the divorce at all and wish to go to couples therapy (obviously, that's not what's happening). And in spite of all of that, I would argue that I am a fairly positive person, happy go lucky, moderate, and without any form of mental health issues.

[(I am not saying that I'm perfect or normal in a social sense. But I would argue that I have no mental health issues of any kind)].

- Emotional distress I think is a species trait that we all suffer from to some extent and we just haven't evolved past it. Many have developed coping skills to deal with it though.
- If a certain psychological situation harms society, then society defines it as a disorder. I think if a situation like this increases my odds to fuck a girl, then it's even more normal
- i think everyone is dealing with something but not everyone has mental illness, like something may cause you anxiety but you dont have it ykwim? also i dont think people realize how much physical health has to do with mental health
- Yes, everyone has issues but not everyone suffers from mental health problems. Learn to deal with problems. As a psychiatrist I treated thousands of patients and now I have passed on that wisdom through my books, *Us Unhinged*, *US Unhinged* and *US Fractured*. Check them out on Amazon or on my website drshilapatel.com
- I think if the brain is wired to destroy, burn bridges, hurt yourself or others, create chaos then it's a disorder. A healthy brain, not the person, will build bridges, construct things -new solutions, ideas, relationships etc. Healthy brains manage new environments in constructive, productive ways. Lots of people experiencing mental health problems live mostly healthy lives and they just need some counseling and move on. Other people, no matter the counseling or therapy, always find themselves making bad decisions, leaving trails of destruction, hurting themselves or others or they're constantly paralyzed by anxiety, fear and overstimulation. Popular psychology has really muddied the waters.

Title: I hate how everyone has mental health conditions

Post Text: It's like everyone needs to have something wrong with their mental health Cus it's been made into a trend?

Mental health is very serious and I think it's become so sensitive and touchy that you can't deny someone a diagnosis or meds otherwise it's "disgusting" and "you're ignoring them".

Like no you just don't like public speaking, social anxiety isn't just not liking public speaking?

It's like no one understands the difference between a problem that needs attention to help conquer (example: fear of public speaking), and a problem that needs medication/therapy to help alleviate (example: social anxiety)

(Additionally: fuck you if you self diagnose and never get a proper one. Then just parade about with it, you're a massive problem and are the reason mental health is treated as a joke by most people)

EDIT: I'm working on replying but literally find myself saying shit over and over again, so I'm having a break and will return fresh and make sure I'm on it for responses.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- As someone who was psychotic and severely depressed as a teen, I never told anyone and I think people are mixing have mental health issues with being mentally ill.

A lot of things are a mental health issue, like grieving a loved one that died. Having some anxiety from being physically bullied a lot. Being depressed over a huge breakup for months. These are mental health issues, but it doesn't mean that a person is mentally ill!

I think people are getting the two mixed up.

- People literally brag about it in social media. People say "my mental illness does this, my mental illness makes me do that" it's like a competition. These are the same people that hang out with friends, have a grand old time, then tweet out "god my depression makes me so lonely" ?????? Someone I know tweeted out one of their personality traits is "having a mental illness" like wtf is wrong with you. People who are actually suffering don't brag about it on social media and it completely distorts what people actually go through.

- To be fair, Mental health conditions are far more common, more well understood and easier to identify. But I think there's far too many people who fake one to seem more unique or to excuse their actions.

- This is actually a severe problem. I ended up being homeschooled because of my anorexia and severe GAD (generalized anxiety disorder) when i was in highschool however, id have girls that would ask me how to be anorexic or would say i just wanted attention (i was 94 lbs at this point despite being 150 lbs to begin with). My school counselor didn't take me seriously because it was such a trend to have depression/anxiety etc. I was a lay-low kinda student so my counselor pulling me out of class to press the matter to see if i was faking it because of the amount of people who do was embarrassing. I left high school and finished through homeschooling (wich went quite well actually)

But yeah, it was astonishing how many girls WERE faking for attention.

Moral of the story is this, please don't treat these conditions as trends. It takes away the seriousness, and people who ACTUALLY deal with them are treated poorly because of the amount of people who fake it.

Im currently doing much better after a suicide attempt in September :) im now on medications to manage my emotions and going through therapy. I've also gained a whopping 54 lbs in total.

- If you elaborate self-diagnosed, I think it's fine. I think it was essential to be able to openly speak to others about my feelings of depression, for the time before I was clinically diagnosed

as depressed. Many of my friends feel the same as me, but they are too anxious or it's too expensive. I still think it's ok for them to talk about it.

- On the one hand I agree with you. I have bipolar but was completely misdiagnosed because when a psychologist/psychiatrist hears you're fine for a few months they immediately dismiss depression as a possible diagnose. This is because so many people misdiagnose themselves as being depressed when they're not (according to the DSM definitions) but just feel lackluster for a few weeks.

But on the other hand, I do believe there are a lot of people walking around with mental health issues that go undiagnosed, and they should be encouraged to get help. Even if the diagnose is somewhat exaggerated it might lead to the person actively looking for ways to better deal with their issues, improve themselves, which is the whole point behind psychology. Having a name to your problems, and with that a way to deal with it, makes all the difference.

- I appreciate the transparency and honesty people suffering from mental illness have gained, but YES it's so frustrating to see people "a little sad" and therefore self-diagnosed with suicidal depression and severe anxiety (exageration for effect, obviously).

Having a mental illness does not make you "special" or "woke", its debilitating. It's not cute. People need to stop using it as an excuse for a personality, it's insensitive and obnoxious.

- I received a depression diagnosis as a child and have struggled with cyclical depression throughout my life, although I haven't admitted that to anyone other than my doctors for most of my life.

There are lots of reasons people who do or don't have depression do or don't seek help. And as a person who has been diagnosed with depression and for a long time had a lot of difficulty seeking out help, respectfully you don't know what people are going through or why they do or say the things they do and fuck you for trying to generically make people feel bad.

I don't totally disagree with you but neither do I think your post is justified.

Also, being pressured or bullied or manipulated in humiliating ways into dealing with a problem that shouldn't matter, like say public speaking, is a great way to develop a benign common fear into medicated social anxiety.

- I only self-diagnose because I'm literally incapable of seeing a psychiatrist currently and my therapist believes there's a high chance I have ADHD. She could still be wrong tho idk man

But yeah people who take one test and go "OMG I have depression!!!!!" need to stop

- I think it's arrogant to assume that you are truly suffering and other people aren't. Rates of mental health issues are higher in this generation than previous ones for a few reasons including 1) increased awareness, meaning people can acknowledge when something is wrong, and 2) an increasing disconnect between what's a healthy/natural way to live life, and how we

actually live life. I would say that most people suffer from mental health issues at some point, and if you are one of those people you will probably encounter more of them as you move between the related pages or groups. Try to give people the benefit of the doubt and be more understanding.

- The problem is that through all the social media people believe (at least subconsciously) that all the others are: Always successful, always happy, good looking and just generally live a dream life, while that's actually mostly fake. But a lot of people feel like they are not good enough, because of that.

So they need to find a reason they aren't like that. And it's more often than not a mental health issue. I think many people actually have mental health issues because of social media (and a lot of other things new technology does with the humans) but I also think a lot of people who "brag" about it all the time are just trying to excuse themselves for not only chilling in the Bahamas with their insta-model-/Vlogger-Partner.

- I had a strong stance like this until I was diagnosed with autism and social anxiety. After that I try to not judge someone and the way they handle their business. As long as I'm not affected I ignore people who seem to be milking their mental health for sympathy or forgiveness.

- Human minds are weird ass things, the society we've built isn't the best for them at times. There's a lot of people with mental health issues, we need to get better at helping them, but we also need to realize that the severity is pretty variable. It's not always dramatic, life ruining, or any of that, usually isn't actually.

Mental health is something to be managed, any mental health issues someone has should be handled as well as it can be so they can move on with their life, not something to use for attention or whatever other weird shit people do.

One of the biggest problems is health care in the US is a clusterfuck to deal with, mental health is just as tricky if not more so, and it's rarely as urgent or obvious as physical health. A lot of people just can't afford the care they need, or are in living situations where they can't get it like being with parents who don't believe in any of it or just living too far away from the resources they need to reasonably be able to access them.

I more or less self-diagnosed myself with ADHD, mentioned it to a psychiatrist and she pretty much just took my word for it and gave me some pills. Not sure about her methods, didn't really like her in general, but the medication has really helped so whatever. My point is that self diagnosing isn't entirely bad, if it can help someone learn more about what's going on and better handle it then that's great, a professional diagnosis is better but isn't always an option.

All in all, we need to handle mental health issues a hell of a lot better, the glorifying and attention seeking is bullshit and really needs to stop, but more importantly the accessibility and quality of care needs to drastically improve. Though people talking about their mental health stuff to explain to others or vent is good, done my fair share of that.

- You can mostly tell the real ones because they don't harp on about it and only bring it up when it's relevant and/or use it as an excuse for shitty behaviour. I am diagnosed bipolar but it's never been something I make a big deal of. Just another health issue I struggle with. And most of us

have some as we become older. Mental health issues shouldn't be ignored. But they aren't special, they don't make you special. And they aren't an excuse for anything.

- I post this every time this topic comes up.

Growing up I always heard people ragging on others for 'romanticizing' mental illness and explaining what 'real' mental illness was like. They would say that people with an actual mental illness would behave a certain way or feel specific things. Someone in high school who posted her self harm pics online desperate for attention of any kind because of other mental health issues? Completely faking. What the fuck? No matter that she's cutting for a reason and clearly needs help, nope, she's just a person faking and making it harder for those with mental illnesses. Aside from the fact that the attitude of harshness towards is what actually makes it harder for those with mental illness.

I was diagnosed as clinically depressed with anxiety, and to this day I still second guess myself because of this new stigma around mental health that everyone who claimed to have some sort of illness is faking or attention seeking. It used to be that you never talked about it, now if you do, unless you talk about it in just the right way, there is a nice group of people to sit there and call you fake or attention seeking. Even if they are, that speaks to a deeper mental health issue as well. Yeah, a small number of people just want to be trendy and cool for saying they have one, but who are YOU to decide who is and isn't doing that? Are you their doctor? No? Then just be supportive of the open discussion of mental health.

Every thread like this often has someone saying 'I have [insert mental health struggle here] and I wouldn't do this because that's not what people with [thing] do.' That mindset of someone suffering came about by others who decry anyone who talks about their struggles. Now, to be seen as authentic, we've come full circle and you have to hide your mental illness to be seen as viable.

So yeah, I don't care if people seem to attention seek about mental illness. You don't know their struggles.

- Its not a fucking trend. Hell mental health issues are *extremely* undertreated in America.

Turns out, a lot of folks have a lot of problems. Its my job to treat them. Its not a 'social' thing to be mentally ill, and people like you claiming 'its just a trend' drives people away from seeking the help they may need. I would rather a thousand people see me that arent suffering from mental health issues than turn away one who does.

- Oh yes, the idea that mental health stigma is being busted is a myth. Don't get me wrong, anything which helps to reduce suicide rates etc is great. However, lets be honest, a large chunk (not all) of this stuff is phoney, where normal behaviour and feelings are turned into a pathological disease. There is so much sexy 'mental health talk', with celebs and royals queuing up to share how crap they feel. However, things like schizophrenia aren't being dealt with, they are being buried. Severe psychiatric conditions which involve things like homelessness, supported shared housing, horrific medications and treatments, and stigma which is so bad, mental health campaigners are silent on the issue.

- Our society would drive anyone mad, so it's not hard to understand why a lot of ppl are mental these days. but ya it is super annoying when ppl make their mental health issues part of their personality.
- Lol we live in strange times dude. Humans are fucking COMPLICATED. Brains are so complex that we mostly still consider it to be uncharted territory. We are so far removed from the days of hunter gatherers, instead of using intuition we ask Google, and then compare ourselves to strangers out there who only post manicured stories they want people to see. We eat highly processed diets that SERIOUSLY adversely impact our mental health (know how many mood altering hormones are created in the gut?), we work from sun up to sun down in little offices where we get hardly any sun and have little work/life balance.

So yeah.. many of us have mental health issues. It's not that it's a trend, it's that society is fundamentally *broken*.

- As a social work student with intent to go into the therapy field, I actually agree. I have many mental disorders, ALL diagnosed by health professionals in the psychology/psychiatric field. I have been properly diagnosed, and properly medicated. If you think you have a problem, don't self diagnose. Go to a doctor. Therapy and psychiatry is covered by most insurance companies, sometimes even state provided insurance. By self diagnosing, people are weakening the legitimacy of those actually struggling with diagnosed disorders they are trying to mitigate. Complaining about not liking public speaking and thus saying it's social anxiety is wildly out of bounds unless you are properly diagnosed. Many people don't fully understand the extent of mental disorders, and what the actual symptoms are. A common one is depression, or OCD. Depression doesn't mean you're sad, it means you slowly stop getting out of bed, you call into work, you either have insomnia or you sleep for days, you stop eating or you binge, etc. OCD doesn't mean liking things clean and neat, it means if you don't sweep up that spot on the floor in the next 7 seconds you're going to die in a terrible accident. It means if you don't turn the light off just right your mother will pass.

So many people take one psychology class and think they have x y and z. It makes it tricky for those actually struggling and it makes it difficult for people in my field to correctly diagnose without fear of over-diagnosing.

- I agree. There are people getting diagnosed as ADD or ADHD that really are just being kids. Kids generally don't have the same attention span as we want them to.

Depression can be a bit trickier, because getting it wrong can be disastrous, so overdiagnosis is probably the best option there, but I know for a fact I could have gotten diagnosed with clinical depression when I was 15, and looking back I wasn't depressed I was a teenager who had moods like everyone else, and my girlfriend left me so I was sad for a while. I wasn't clinically depressed, I was a bit sad for a week or two. That happens to a lot of people, but we can't change anything wit depression because what about if we don't give someone real help and they have real problems, the worst case is suicide and that shouldn't be a possible outcome

- As someone who actually has autism and has basically had three years of school messed up it annoys me so much when people say they have a 'mental health condition' when they don't because I actually have to live with something that has made my life near impossible sometimes, yet these people can benefit of it without any of the actual pain

- Okay I see what you're saying about self diagnosing and then parading that self diagnoses around. So what if you really are depressed or have anxiety but because of family pressures or money or whatever reason you can't go to a psychiatrist. Are you a piece of shit for thinking that you might be depressed even though you haven't had a professional diagnose you?
- People don't seem to understand how annoying it is when they claim to have anxiety despite not being diagnosed. Anxiety is seen as just a cute little personality trait that makes you nervous around new people, when actually it's a debilitating illness that can ruin your life. But when I tell people I have anxiety they just respond with 'oh yeah same I'm so socially awkward haha' and it's like no Jessica you're ANXIOUS that's not the same as an anxiety disorder
- I am not depressed, nor do I have any mental health problems.

But I hate it when people meme about depression and suicide. It's not a joke.

Since people say they actually are depressed, and I think they subconsciously feel the only way to communicate their feelings are through self-deprecation and jokes.

People need to know this isn't true, and that there are people who want to help you. Get help- and stop making fun of your problems

- Had a friend who was so sure she was depressed and anxiety ridden but had never been to a therapist, doctor or anything and had just guessed it. I xut her off pretty quickly. Ive also had friends who had been diagnosed and was on medication and just stopped taking it. Like one day. She got into such a slump and you could see she wasn't herself. Eventually i talked her into seeing her doctors and psychiatrist again and they changed the medicine so she felt a bit better and shes definitely better. Mental wellbeing is so important. I hate it that everyone suddenly suffers from depression or anxiety when I was diagnosed as a teen and still have really bad episodes and as a kid i felt i had to keep it to myself because it was so taboo. Okay rant over
- I am diagnosed with ocd and depression anxiety.

Watching dumb attention whores say that they have ocd or "I'm so depressed"
It's like shut up go home and get ur head out ur ass.

People like this are making people with actual mental health suffer. They make it seem like it's no big deal.

Yeah Britney you like when ur makeup is perfect, no it's not ocd.

People think they are depressed because they are in a bad mood. Or cause they don't like partying. They still enjoy life and have a jolly old time like ten seconds later, but I am stuck like this for every aching moment of my bleak existence. And no ur break up with Brad while quite emotionally difficult is assume isn't a mental illness. Like depression.

And no you can't self diagnose ur mental illness you scum. Why do people treat mental health different then any other health issue?

If people had this attitude towards epilepsy or cancer or the covid-19

Everybody would freak out. I mean my moms friend thinks anxiety is just a lack of faith and positivity. Not that it's an issue with ur brain. People think mental health isn't scientific at all. Which is stupid because you can identify a psychopath from their brainwaves.

Our society as a whole needs to get a better understanding on these issues, but most people with mental mental illness do not speak about it because society treats it as weakness and no biggie. Or they treat it like we are just inane crazy people.

Thanks for coming to my TED talk for more info go to www.peoplsuck.com

- For a while, I thought that there was no way my anxiety problems were legitimate because a lot of people I knew were faking or exaggerating common emotions. After I started going to a therapist, I realized how much deeper my anxiety runs and how it has affected me. It's not fun or glamorous. It doesn't make me more "relatable"-if anything, it makes me less so. I agree that this should not be a trend

- I was just thinking about writing a post to say I wish it was ok to tell people that you were mentally ill without them feeling uncomfortable.

I have bipolar 1, I am medicated but every so often I may slip into mania or depression. Either one of those things make me act stupid and I try to isolate myself until they are over so I don't embarrass myself or upset anyone.

It's so uncomfortable for me and whoever I'm telling in my family and friends that, sorry I can't come, my bipolars not right at the moment and I'll let you know when I'm ok again.

I hate having to feel how awkward I'm making them feel but if I don't show up and say nothing that's hurtful too.

I wish more people would talk about it so everyone can get over it and not be weirded out.

- I understand this issue too. I've been diagnosed with depression for over 6 years. Whenever I see somebody, normally a 12 or 14 year old self diagnosing themselves I get a little upset. If you feel something is wrong, go to the doctor and have the assess you. And be 100% honest. If you're lying, there's other people that could be needed the help that you're occupying just to feel a certain way.

Mental illness is not something you want. My family's had an extensive history with it. My mom was bulimic and anorexic and died from it. Seeing her suffering throughout my life - I wish I could describe it but I just can't. People die because of this stuff. You shouldn't be diagnosing yourself because of a trend.

It's a battle everyday that I wish nobody'd go through. Struggling with your own mind to keep your body alive, healthy, and unscathed. It's a battle nobody wants to fight.

I feel like the people OP talks about use their mental illness as an excuse like "Oh I have depression. I can't." Or "Sorry, can you do it? I have anxiety."

Which yes, for people who actually have these issues are normal excuses, but they aren't used on a daily basis. I avoid activities where I'd need to say that and I never share anything about my mental illness because it's embarrassing, people will treat you differently for the rest of your life.

If you think mental illness is a trendy or cool thing, trying living in a mental health facility for a while, then come talk to me because it's messed up.

- Being diagnosed borderline personality disorder, I get pretty upset at people who say thing like "I'm so depressed kms lol jk jk" or how females get labeled as more mental than men even though the suicide rate is 4x higher for men. Anxiety is crippling, not just a dislike for something in particular. When I was hospitalized, I saw people who were schizophrenic and to have someone who very obviously isn't say they are is infuriating. I think there needs to be a stop to romanticising mental health issues, it's ruined a lot of lives. It's not something to be desired

- I really resonated with that final "fuck you" statement. As I high schooler I see people seek attention by pretending to have a mental processing difference or mental health condition or other quality of the such. And as someone with many processing differences I always took heavy offense by this stuff. I acknowledge that I may not have mental health issues but I'm still thankful that you said this

- I think people who claim to have mental health issues get lumped in with the people who really do sometimes.

- I mean, I don't know if social anxiety is actually real mental illness nor do I know if I actually have it, but I don't know what to else to call "having a difficulty talking to your peers". But I agree on everything else though.

- Yesterday Shushant Singh Rajput who was bollywood actor committed suicide. In his recent movie he taught his son about life and why suicide is not solution.

He was idol for youth. Everything looked awesome. He was extremely intelligent person.

Secured rank 7 in exam for engineering where 1-2 million appeared. He could do every kind of pushup. He was handsome. He was tall, nice smile, successful.

And ews morons are confused why he committed suicide if he had everything.

He did not have peace of mind. He was passout of my college that makes it too personal. And that in time I am dealing with depression myself.

- you ever talk to a fellow human ? mental health issues are common place. blame it on the governing bodies of our countries taking all funding away from helping the people and putting said money straight into the furnace that is "Business"..

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that's why you feel everyone is mentioning it. because everyone has issues relating to their mental health and have no where to help with said issues.

- Clinical Depression (24M) here. My mother suffered from depression her whole life and never made any good choices to help it. I from a very young age was always sad. I had a good solid childhood growing up. Nothing terrible happened to me. But I progressively started hating everything and didn't care about anything. Then my mother had a complete mental break down.

Ill leave it at that. And it broke me and pushed me down and down. And I never said anything to anyone. Until at 22 where I was very suicidal and just wanted to end it I finally reached out and got help. But during my high-school days of social media being a giant part of everyone's life mental health became the normal of everyone. And i knew people who weren't suffering at all. And they just post online about how their life is so terrible and all this stuff and I just couldn't believe my eyes. I know for a fact everyone suffers at some point in life. I really do. I just could never imagine someone else wishing they had the same issues I do. Or anything of the sort. Its more than okay to feel down or crushed under the weight of the pressure of events that happen in your life. But from the point of view from a mentally ill person who needs medication and therapy to be stable and get through life I just want people who don't need those things to know you don't want to know the other side of mental health more than you already have experienced. If you need help then absolutely 100% go and get it. I wish I would have a lot sooner in my life. But if you really don't have a mental health issue then please please don't pretend. From the bottom of my heart please just support everyone and wish the best for everyone! Love yall reddit fam

- I have always been very quiet about my mental health issues. I was raised by an emotionally abusive mother and was always "faking" any issues. The only illness my mother acknowledged was my T1 diabetes and she completely went overboard with it. She still often says "you have diabetes you can't have anything else wrong" ... I'm 23 now and last year I was diagnosed by a professional with anxiety and depression. Got meds for both.

But all those years of 'dont show it, it's fake, no one will believe you' and now the whole bandwagon mindset... I feel like i shouldnt be taking my meds. Even my bf has said he doesnt think I'm depressed and I'm functioning fine. He says when I take the medicine I'm "too happy"... so I still dont know what to do.

Also I'd like to point out that people with mental health issues can still function. It's not always excessive situations like public speaking... it's not wanting to get out of bed every day, playing one mind numbing game all day, being up at 2am not tired at all.

- I've had anxiety literally my entire life and it wasn't until last year at 22 that I was diagnosed with Anxiety Disorder (I'm on meds now and its made a huge difference). One of my big no-no's is driving. The last time I tried I literally had an anxiety attack and blacked out behind the wheel.

Because of people parading around with their "anxiety" whenever I tell someone I don't drive (and they ask ALL the time) because of anxiety attacks they act like I'm lying or bullshitting. I'm just lucky the last time I had an attack while driving it was in an empty paddock and not on a road. I'm slowly working my way into being more comfortable with cars - just starting the engine and using all the switches etc. But its going to take some time before I feel comfortable enough to try driving again.

I'm really getting sick of people not taking me seriously. It's hard enough having to deal with stupid ass anxiety and then I also have to deal with the pressure friends and family put on me to "get over it."

- I've been diagnosed with several manic depression.its the sister diagnosis to bipolar disorder. It causes me to have extreme highs and even lower lows and all while trying to balance suicidal thoughts no matter what mood I'm in. Before I was diagnosed I knew something was wrong with me but refused to look up anything online before I didnt want to tanker with anything with my mind. I do believe if you have something mentally wrong with your self you know someone is wrong but you just cant put your finger on it.
- Some girl I go to school with always posts on Instagram her Bart Simpson vhs edits and says she's not okay and stuff like that. Once she said "im fucking broken" on the caption but the post was a full fledged titty pic. Pisses me off, because my sister has anxiety attacks and stuff like that and it pains me to see people trying to make it "part of them"
- In my country "social anxiety" isn't really a thing. All i can do is learn how to deal with social anxiety. I've read some things about it and I think I have it. I would love to get diagnosed by a professional but that isn't an option. Everybody I know thinks I have social anxiety. I've gone to therapy to learn how to make friends. Idk, is that enough to self-diagnose? Stuff isn't that black and white.
- Thanks to the 14 year old edge lords. "OH DUDE IM SO DEPRESSED!" "Haha yeah me too, youre a cool guy!"

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As some others stated it , you can really often spot the difference by how people talk, or not talk about it. Most people who are really depressed, face social anxiety or whatever never-rarely talk about it because they try to hide it.

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Those 14 year old edge lords just use every chance to get attention by talking about it. "Oh dude i just cut myself again last night!" "Wow youre so cool!".

Fuck outta here

- Apparently everyone has anxiety nowadays
- people with genuine mental health issues tend not to put it out for all to see.

like you said about fear of public speaking and having social anxiety are different, fear of public speaking means you're a bit scared and may stumble over words but social anxiety means you can't order your own food sometimes, for me i need someone with me when i go out in public so they can speak for me or be like a support so if i were to "mess up" someone is there. people with fear of public speaking don't need that emotional support like people with anxiety.

people seem to claim mental illnesses to "fit in" like hunny you don't want to fit into this group of people, you don't want to be apart of the mental illness group, it's not fun, it's not a joy to have.

people say they're funny because they're depressed, like yes humor tends to stem from trauma as a coping mechanism and trauma is a cause if depression, but just because you're funny

doesn't mean you're depressed and these "comedians" like to claim depression to make their humor more funny. (i'm talking about funny high schoolers not comedians who've actually opened up about struggles)

sometimes these people who claim to be mentally ill tend to get really offensive towards people with actual mental health problems.

- Top many people don't know the difference between depression and a bad day.
- The self diagnosed, crazy because it's the in thing people annoy me greatly. I have been mentally ill most of my life and it is not something that I brag about or even talk about much, it's something that will always be there and I need medication to control, but it doesn't define me or my life. People who feel they need something to define them and choose mental health issues probably do actually need therapy to figure out why they feel they aren't good enough just being themselves.
- Oh my god I can't agree more. People that usually self diagnose HAVE NO IDEA how ugly mental health problems are. It's not like " oh my god I'm anxious around people sometimes" or "I have an eating disorder because sometimes I don't eat". These people have zero idea how absolutely ugly real mental disorders are. I have gone through severe depression and major anxiety/ panic disorder, anorexia and also my psychiatrist is suspecting I am bipolar. I also have ADHD and I can't tell you how destructive this has all been to my life. I take four medications every single day and am prescribed a fifth medication that I'm supposed to take if I start experiencing a manic episode . I used to have a problem of forgetting to take my meds which lead me to a freak out on the floor screaming and shaking. Have they ever had a panic attack at work? I'm on my fourth attempt of going to college, I dropped out of college three times already. I used to panic at school. Have these people been around other people that have real mental disorders who are marginalized by society and struggle to be apart of society. These people, like me aren't a pretty sight. Having an eating disorder isn't a pretty sight. It's shameful. All of this is shameful. Being in a mental ward of a hospital isn't a pretty sight. Mental health isn't this instagramable picture. The same people that self diagnose their mental health "problem" wouldn't be comfortable around people like me at my worst, they would probably be afraid. They would probably be afraid of others I've been around who have mental health issues.
- I know a bit about mental health, but not much. So I can't really talk about it. Not to brag, but I'm one of the only people in my friend group who is mentally strong and stable.
- It's a double edged sword - we have more awareness and understanding now which is good but people will exploit it which is bad.

Feeling sad or down doesn't always equate to depression.

Wanting to spend some time alone or being too tired for social interactions doesn't always equate to anxiety.

Wanting things to be neat and tidy doesn't always equate to having OCD.

Diagnoses should only be given by medical professionals and not from google. You also shouldn't be able to go to a GP and say 'I think I have depression' and they throw pills at you and a label - it should be investigated before any diagnosis is made.

Everyone suffers from mental health problems in their life - grief and stress are probably the most common - but not everyone has a mental health condition.

- There's a difference between self diagnosing because you're in a situation where you can't get the help you need (not enough money, parents who don't take it seriously, etc), and self diagnosing for attention.

Mount Everest wasn't discovered till 1856 but I'm pretty damn sure it existed. same with mental illnesses. just as many people had them before but until now they weren't taken seriously and therefore not recorded.

I think a lot of the issue is people like you making us feel like we're faking and just looking for attention (this is a very real problem that affects mentally ill people) and quite possible indirectly causing people to not get help.

Signed, a person with diagnosed ADHD, Anxiety, and Depression who spent years of their life believing they were just making excuses

- exactly!!! i have huge anxiety to the point where i can't even breathe without thinking something is gonna go wrong. then i have my friends/ people on the internet that say "omg i have so much anxiety, i got nervous during a presentation!!! i'm literally a psycho LOL" amongst other things. my mental illness isn't quirky or cool, it's terrifying.

- I've been diagnosed with aspergers and add but to be honest other people complaining about their mental health was never annoying to me, although in my friend group I keep my diagnosis secret but you can tell I have a socialization problem

- Absolutely agree, especially with the self diagnosis one, I am not clinically diagnosed, I dont know when ill have that option, so I dont say I have depression, but feeling worthless for over half a year and hating existence is a pretty telling sign... but at least I'm worth more than the people that self diagnose and parade it around, those are scum human beings, so at least I got that

- i'm diagnosed with depression and anxiety right now but I self diagnosed for a while because it's pretty clear when you have both of those things, i get what you mean though because some people clearly don't have it and they're saying that they do

- We went from "you can't talk about mental health issues or else people will think you're nuts" to "here's my bio with every mental illness i've diagnosed myself with". People don't understand that it was never about "normalizing" mental illness, it was about making society understand that you aren't insane if you feel the need to see a therapist. Mental illness shouldn't be used as a crutch to justify every single thing you don't have the guts to do or bear.

- I would kindly invite anyone faking to experience the real thing. Then they'll know...

As someone with awful anxiety. I pray that if I have to suffer please don't let anyone else suffer this. Not even my worst enemy deserves this.

It's not a joke.

- I have a mental health condition

- I think you're swinging at two different arguments here, the rising amount of mental health cases being reported, and people's ability to consider themselves Pseudo-Scientist and approximate the wrong conclusion from a small amount of information. Like your public speaking example. However I don't think the two are completely linked, stigmas about mental health are becoming less prevalent so more people are seeking assistance, while at the same time there are still shitty people in the world who will use systems intended to help the less fortunate to try to advance their own cause. Unfortunately it's hard to avoid.

- I used to agree with that opinion. Until I realized that I had a lot of mental health problems. It's been proven that social media can make people depressed. Most young people are using social media non stop, which will trigger these problems. We are also recognizing. That mental illness is not as rare as we once thought, obviously not everyone is schizophrenic or Bi-polar, sometimes mental illness is less conspicuous and we see that now.

I do agree that a lot of people really don't understand how bad some mental illnesses can be and would not be so keen on claiming to have the illnesses they say they have if they actually had them in any major way (I.E. OCD, sociopathy etc.)

- My favorite is when everyone claims they have "social anxiety." It's usually people's way of saying "I'm scared to talk to boys/girls." Social anxiety is much more intense than just being nervous around people that you don't know. It's a crippling fear of constantly being watched / judged.

I was watching a streamer say they don't go out often because of social anxiety, and I'm just scratching my head because 15 thousand people were watching her stream (don't remember who it was, it was a hosted stream from someone else). Like, what do people have to gain from that? It's obvious you don't have social anxiety, else you wouldn't be streaming for 15k people to watch and judge you. I think people just want others to feel sorry for them or something, I really don't get it.

- To be fair, mental health was not seen as serious even before a lot of people started self-diagnosing.

- As someone with actual diagnosed depression and social anxiety, thank you.

- I never got diagnosed besides depression, but I know that there is something with my brain. The thing is that I don't have psychosis, but it does not mean that I have the full control of my brain all times. It is so hard to get to the doctor in those times though and explain it well though. I can very calm and logical when talking to the doctors, also am highly educated, that they take my situation not as severe. I am stuck with myself alone.

- People who say judgmental stuff like this are exactly why I don't ever talk to people about my mental health. I know it's not the point of your post, but people like you make me feel ashamed to try to talk about it. Not being believed and being made to feel silly and weak is the worst.

- Follow up comment but I hate when mental illness is an automatic assumption or explanation for being a shitty person. That entitled white lady yelling at someone to speak English because we're in America isn't acting out because of her anxiety, she's a racist asshole.

- I feel like the people who openly talk about having a "mental illness" are usually the ones who are faking it for attention or are real confused about what it means to have a mental disorder.

People these days do not realize that it is normal to FEEL sadness and anxiety at least a few times a week or even a few times a day. Examples: Running late and feel anxious? Normal. Failed a test and feel anxious? Normal. Broke up with your significant other and feel sad for months? Normal, not a disorder.

Just because you FEEL those emotions often does NOT mean you have a mental disorder. Humans naturally will experience a wide variety of emotions throughout one day. We are not wired to be content or happy all of the time. A diagnosis can however, be made when you have felt that way every single day and it has impacted your life for a period of longer than 6 months, according to the DSM.

It's a huge slap in the face to those who have actually been diagnosed with a mental disorder to hear other people say they have it and use it to get attention, when really there's nothing wrong with them. You are making those who struggle every single day look bad. If you think you have a mental illness, please do not read about it on Google. Book yourself a doctor's appointment and go to clinical psychologist before you self-diagnose.

- i completely agree. i have been diagnosed with complex PTSD following sexual assaults & it isn't ever taken as seriously as it should be. people say "i have anxiety too". no. anxiety & PTSD are two very different things.

- Yes. There are so many people on the internet saying they have mental health issues that I'm wondering myself « Am I normal? I almost feel bad for not having any kind of anxiety. »

- Unfortunately my mental health conditions were ignored as a teenager and it affected my relationships, work, education, overall health in my 20s. At almost 29 I am struggling every single day and see no end but I have made and continue to make progress. I don't think everyone has mental health conditions although obviously everyone may feel anxious or stressed, etc. if they are going through a difficult time.

- I fully agree. I've been diagnosed by professionals, gone to therapy, take meds every day, and even went to residential therapy. I don't use my mental illness as an excuse to be a dick or lazy and I really hate when people self diagnose and use it as if it's a real diagnosis. If you're sad, that's ok, if you're upset, that's ok, but you can't just say you're clinically depressed and romanticize it. I used to self harm a LOT, I didn't do it for attention, I did it cuz I had little to no control over my life at the time. feelz

- really takes away from the people ACTUALLY suffering from mental health.

- As someone who struggled severely with depression in high school, to the point of skipping school and failing classes, I never had the urge to make sure everyone knew I was struggling. I talk about it now because it was a big accomplishment making it out of that, but at the time nobody knew what was going on except my family.

I also have been diagnosed with ADHD, and I find it so incredibly obnoxious when people who maybe shake their leg claim they have it, it's a lot more than being hyper.

- Being someone who was diagnosed with major depressive disorder, I get peeved at people who self-diagnose, and then even more so when their self-diagnosis stops them from living life.

Or on the flip side- someone who knows they have issues but victimizes themselves because they're more interesting as a person with the issues. (I had a friend who was diagnosed with anxiety but she refused to actually do anything to fix it. She'd get prescriptions to try and just throw them out.)

I'm open about my mental health. Not in the sense of like "woe is me" but normalizing it. I'll let my team know I'm off to counseling, get what I need, and come back in better mood. I tell people I'm happy because I'm making my life great and depression is just a part of my body that needs to be maintained like washing my hair.

- I have weird little neat habits? I must have ****extreme**** OCD

I got a bit nervous before a soccer game? It is ***definitely*** severe anxiety.

That stuff is so common on the internet and IRL, it's jerky and insensitive to people actually suffering from mental conditions.

- People just don't know the difference between being sad and being in ****d****epression. They feel bored and they just call it depression, anxiety, whatever. That's why they think nutella is healing depression somehow.

- Well I hate how everyone has mental illness as well, but we can't control it. But that's not what you are saying, you hate people who fake mental illness. Most people don't fake it, I wish I was faking it instead of dealing with depression and anxiety (diagnosed by my doctor). I don't know anyone who fakes their mental illness and all of my friends who have illnesses are not faking it. But I understand the frustration when you meet someone who fakes it.

- I know people who use "anxiety" as an excuse to not have to do shit. They've never seen a doctor or been diagnosed, they just call it "anxiety" because they don't like having to clean, or take care of their kids, or go to work. Omg my "anxiety" is so bad today, can you watch my kids? Um, no. If it's that debilitating, get your ass up and get some on some medication. Hell, smoke a joint. Just don't use it as an excuse for lazing

- Relatable. I hate when people say "this makes my OCD/Anxiety rise like crazy".

I have diagnosed General Anxiety Disorder and Possible OCD (my psychologist has helped me through some rather deep stuff with OCD related scenarios but didn't diagnose that since I have the anxiety disorder already) but all of my problems are for real and I've been dealing with my problems since I was in the 3rd grade. Anxiety disorders absolutely suck.

- I guess I've been lucky because I haven't really noticed people speaking in these terms.

Maybe it's just a question of the pendulum going all the way to the sensitive side; so it can eventually balance out to a place where people don't trivialize legitimate cases nor do they disrespect the diagnoses to exaggerate their own situation. I think about soldiers in the early 20th century who were suffering with what we now call PTSD, and to this day anxiety/depression disorders still have a certain stigma in different social circles. I will say that it's annoying for example when people describe themselves as "neat freaks" and say they have OCD.

- When everyone has mental health conditions, no one has mental health conditions.

- I have mental health issues but I haven't told anybody
- When the first thing that person tells me is that they're ADHA, severe anxiety, depressed, and aren't on their meds. I definitely have doubts
- I've been diagnosed with OCD and PTSD and I've had eating disorders most of my life so it's safe to say it's a bit of a mess inside my head. I agree mental health has been sensationalized so I don't like talking about mine because I don't want to look like another one of those people who thinks being stressed out over legitimate stresses is an anxiety disorder. Since so many people are so open about it people I become close to are usually surprised when I open up about my mental health to them because I seem so "normal" they say.

On a related note, I'm not personally bothered when people say things like "I have to have the apps in organized folders on my phone, I'm so OCD like that!" But I do wish more people knew more about what actually having OCD is like. It's actually quite debilitating in a lot of ways and if more people were knowledgeable of the symptoms it would be caught during childhood more often than it is. My parents don't even know I got diagnosed with OCD as an adult and when I think back to how I was as a child idk how they didn't realize something was off about me.

- Well, everyone has undiagnosed mental health condition.
- I struggle with my mental health conditions every day and my best friend recently got laid off and she is upset over it. Now she says she is depressed, has ocd and is an alcoholic because she drinks sometimes. It really bothers me. Since when did mental health conditions become an accessory you can just wear for pitty? Bothers me so much.
- Agree. Too many people think they have anxiety when in fact they are just worrying about something. Anxiety would be worrying about everything, all the time.
- Same with me. I've had depression, anxiety for 3 years or so. Never, ever have I liked talking about it. Quite the opposite, it made me feel many times worse. And then are here these 14y olds that write it down on their profiles. Just because you get sad doesn't mean you have depression.
- People mix moods with mental health conditions
- I would rather more people got the attention and diagnoses they need. I've been dealing with depression for years, but never did anything about it, until my boyfriend made me, because it's just a lot of crying, and lack of enthusiasm for things I used to enjoy.
- As someone who has self diagnosed myself I can agree with what you say, the reason I know I am depressed is because I can stay in bed all day doing nothing but exist and have been suicidal in the past. The reason. I have self diagnosed myself is because my anxiety won't let me go to a doctor or therapist and get help. Godamn is it. Annoying when u can't even talk to your own family without feeling fear for no reason.

I understand what you are saying and do agree with 100% but there are a few cases out there like me.

Thank you for reading and have a great day.

- If someone has been diagnosed by a doctor who are you or anyone else to tell them 'being afraid of public speaking isn't a mental health problem?'

- I have been professionally diagnosed depression and anxiety, as well as previously had suicidal tendencies. But I wasn't diagnosed until I turned 20 and finally opened up to my doctor about it.

The whole reason I never did is because an absolutely absurd amount of girls at my high school had "Mental Illness" and would use it to get attention or get out of class. I mean like the class president pretending to have social anxiety to get out of doing a presentation that she never finished, but then turning around and giving a speech during lunch. Of course once someone ACTUALLY had a mental illness or disorder, they were outcasted not only by the kids at school, but the whole town. One of my best friends was pulled from school by her parents because she had a manic episode, I never saw her again. It certainly didn't help that even the mention mental illness was frowned upon in my small town and by my own family.

However, I do fall under self diagnosis. After I had my first real panic attack all the way back in middle school, I went to a counselor, they suggested I may have an anxiety disorder. I went home, looked up what anxiety was (because I genuinely didn't know what it was) and began to realize that not only did I have all the tell tale signs of anxiety, but I also had signs of depression. It scared me for all the reasons above. I never saw the counselor again, never brought it up to my parents or friends. Not even when my dad was diagnosed with anxiety and depression. Not even after I put a gun in my mouth. I was scared to admit there was something wrong and scared of what people would think of me.

Over time I recognized that I probably did have a mental illness, once I moved out and got into college, I did research and finally began to understand what was going on in my head. It was during college that I talked to my doctor and got the diagnosis of depression and anxiety. The main concern was my suicidal thoughts and tendencies, and they helped me to research therapists, medications, and group sessions for people in my area with similar issues. I'm currently seeing a therapist and check in with my doctor regularly. But I would have gotten this help so much sooner if it hadn't been for the many people in my life faking mental illness and then turning away from people who genuinely needed help.

- On the social anxiety point, I love public speaking but have Autism and so much of that is social anxiety in day to day conversation but in a controlled setting, I love debating and improv.
- Omg I'm so very much depressed and I cut daily, why is life so sad. Oh and my papa don't love me no more. Such depression wow very sad. Like for Al Qaeda share for Robert Pattinson
- I am aware that's its not the best idea to self diagnose your self with a mental disorder but I personally feel justified in self diagnosing my self with anxiety as I have quite a few issues that I really should see a professional for but because of well.. my anxiety I'm too scared to tell anyone, I have a hard time talking about stuff like that with other people to the point where I'd rather cry in a corner. Due to my anxiety I have to deal with things such as getting anxiety attacks bad enough to where I'll be crying on the floor while clawing at my arms. I'd love to get help and

get properly diagnosed but the absolute of anxiety I feel when talking about it won't let me And I don't wanna be a burden

But other then that, yeah your opinion makes sense

Title: Does anyone else struggle with keeping a job due to mental health? How do I earn a living if I can't get out of bed to go to my job?

Post Text: I really struggle with being reliable and going to work all the time, some days/ week it will be fine and I'll be in on time every day and feel really good and then with no warning it's like I can't move or do anything and I feel almost paralysed with depression. Everyone else just seems to commit to things and build a career so easily and I've never met anyone who feels the same as I do. If everyone else can do it why can't I? Does anyone else struggle with this? If so do you have any tips or anything to help?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Yea the worst part about things like depression and other mental health issues is it makes those incentives to get by foggy? Why else would you want to work when the incentive to do just doesnt feel worth it. Like it feels the absolute worse when you can't enjoy your hobbies anymore after a long days of work. You often say to yourself, what the hell is even the point of being here, am I just here to suffer, etc. I feel you, and unfortunately, it ain't easy to get through

- Yes definitely. Yesterday I finally got an actual diagnosis from my psychiatrist: long-term chronic depression, also knows as high-functioning depression or dysthymia (there's a sub for that btw /r/dysthymia). While I do get out of bed, I often do it at about noon. I have my laptop near the bed so I can attend my work meetings in the morning from there. Then I go to a coworking space because I can't stand being alone all day at home, but now I'm exactly there and I have done very little actual useful work and I feel terrible about it, and yet I keep postponing or avoiding it like the plague. I feel guilty, I feel like a fraud, I feel worthless.

- i am on disability for this reason. its terrible. everytime i get a new job, i do good for a couple months and then i start calling in sick due to debilitating depression and then i either get fired or i quit.

- I'm not diagnose, but I've been feeling what one might called "depressed" for about 6 years now. Ever since then I've found it extremely difficult to keep up with college assignments and tests, had to drop out once, started over in a lower tier community college and shits still hard. On top of that I have a remote part time job working for an artesian and I even struggle with doing that sometimes, not turning in projects on time and stuff.

Hell, I even struggle with going to therapy, I've already booked appoints multiple times and someday I couldn't even bring myself to show up, or I'd show up for not two sessions. I really need to seek out help but at this point it's embarrassing for me reach out to my therapist again (there's only one available where I live)

So idk, maybe reading about someone who's more of a hot mess than you might make you feel better lol

- I think this is a much bigger societal issue than most of us realize. There are people on assistance (welfare, disability, whatever their country's version is) who have *some* ability to work, but not enough to support themselves. There are people who can't hold down a job long

term because of their mental health issues, so they bounce from job to job, sometimes with long periods of unemployment between.

Most full-time work would be too much for me and detrimental to my mental health. But being unemployed was also very detrimental to my mental health. The only reason I'm currently able to support myself is because I'm able to work from home with flexible hours. And 'support myself' may be too grandiose a term...more like 'subsist'.

I don't know what the solution is, but it definitely sucks.

- I end up in jobs any highschooler could have even though I have two degrees, I freeze when it comes to going after anything I actually qualify for on paper. my ultimate motivation for even showing up to work is that I have to if I want to keep the place that houses that bed I struggle to get out of. lol 🤪 or the insurance that pays for my expensive autoimmune medicine, surgeries, therapy, etc. really that's it.

having something to look forward to, a goal, a need, my dog, other things that motivate me there too.

- I have a hard time finding one and keeping it. I have night time agoraphobic disorder which means I can't be outside when it's dark. I'm terrified of walking outside at night alone. During the summers ok but winter time hours never fit into a work schedule. There's a certain point where I had to leave almost by 4:30 in order to be home before dark. If I start any earlier than 8:30 or 9 it's also too dark.

I'm trying to become a tattoo artist but even that has its challenges because I have to get a driver to drive me home a lot of times people to take me there. My anxiety prevents me from driving outside of my comfort zone without a panic attack and I'm terrified of taxi drivers and taking the bus alone.

I'm having a hard time building clientele so I have to take on a part-time job. I'm currently working at a nursing home but it doesn't pay me very well and my boss is extremely toxic.

On top of that my boss, one of the manager, and some of my coworkers at the tattoo shop are telling me I'm not trying hard enough in my tattoo skills because I'm only there two days out of the week. I'm working at my other job three days out of the week I spent two days at the tattoo shop and I give myself the other two days for my mental health. I was doing a lot more days in a row at the tattoo shop and only giving myself two days off in a month but that let me down the road of extreme burnout and drove me close to a suicidal relapse. It seems like everybody else is able to come in right after they get off their jobs if they have a part-time job. Also a lot of people there have friends and family that come in and get tattooed when they're starting off and I don't really have much time for that. I feel like everybody else has such an advantage that I don't have because of my disabilities.

I always feel like I'm getting close to relapse and so I've been trying to not take on all these extra days but there's so much pressure from everybody right now wanting me to be in the shop

more. I'm tired of people just thinking I can get over my fears and I can just do what everybody else is doing. One of the managers at the tattoo shop when I told him I have my anxiety he says well you might have to learn to overcome it. I tried getting case management to drive me and the supervisor won't let people give me rides because she says it's "enabling me".

Not to mention if I ever try to talk about being mentally ill jobs won't want to hire me and the soon as they find out I am the fire me. I also have a hard time getting to work on time I'll have PTSD episodes in the morning, depression episodes, and my ADD always wanting to make me late. I have gotten better with getting on time to work because I've had to but sometimes it can get really hard to do.

- Depression can be debilitating, I struggle with severe depression and being on antidepressants has helped. I recommend talking to your doctor about what's going on

- I completely understand. I've been unemployed (for the most part) since 2021 because of anxiety, depression, and bpd. I'd be fine and then one day I'd wake up and have a panic attack about going in or I'd get there and just feel so moody and depressed I'd leave.

I wish I had some advice, but I don't. I'm lucky to have a husband who's able to work, but we do struggle to get by.

The guilt is always there, and it sucks watching people my age have careers with seemingly endless motivation.

You're not alone ❤️

- yeah, wasn't able to keep my last two jobs cause of extreme anxiety and depression. Moved in order to live with family overseas (and in a fucked country where I don't speak the language, ect). didn't feel like i had a choice. i still have doubts about whether i made the right decision.

but that's what severe depression and anxiety does: can't think straight and constantly fighting

- Seems like you have lost control over your own life. I think you should be rather mad and angry, that you don't control what you do, but your mental state does. Or do you let it? Have you given up and found comfort in your suffering? What I'm doing here is trying to get you riled up, because you most definitely should be and need to be. There is no tip, there is no life hack, it is just a matter of what your values are, and how you act on them. Would you like to have your life in control or not? Would you do anything you can for it? Would you go to work even though every part of you tells you to stay shut? If yes then act on it. Nobody can do it for you. And there is no miracle advice, it is in fact just a matter of doing. Having a job is important, it keeps consistency in your life, and a meaning of some kind. These kinds of things are a remedy for depression and such. But when you are comfortable in your depression you will have every incentive to ignore this. You can do it, stand up and go, it won't be easy but nothing of value is easy. Good luck.

- I'm almost certain that you have some sort of unresolved past traumas that you haven't been dealing with yet - but your body is literally trying to get your attention, and it only gets worse if you continue along on this path, ignoring it (believe you me!). I can recommend that you start practicing mindfulness on a daily basis and start a meditation practice (nidra yoga), I can recommend [Ally on YT](<https://youtu.be/ApQ9NovgnA4>). Also reading these two books: Power of Now by Eckhart Tolle (especially this one!) and CPTSD by Pete Walker.

A small exercise, that you can do - every time that you get these thoughts, let them "simply" pass and then focus all your attention and awareness on the underlying feelings, be with them fully! - don't ignore them, by going out for a smoke or whatever vices that you have. This is essentially exposure therapy and the only thing that I have experienced that really works for stress/anxiety/depression etc., and not just a bandaid like taking a pill. By doing this practice, you will slowly but surely see that these hard/uncomfortable feelings will start to dissipate! But you have to do this work, and it won't be pleasant, but it needs to be done - if you truly aim to get better.

Keep on the good fight, and remember that this too shall pass!

- I wish I knew the answer or how to help. I sought out an answer for myself and came across this post. I struggle to hold a job. Even if it's a good one I somehow mess it up. My depression gets bad and I end up quitting. I don't know how to end this vicious cycle. If I do keep a job I have excessive absences. I just can't get myself to go some days. I don't know why. I feel like a failure because other people can, why can't I?

I also feel helpless. I know I need money. I have so much financial debt. But nothing keeps me going. I also have issues with being overweight and in pain.

I'm just depressed, I have been for a long time. I wasn't diagnosed until Oct 2020. But it stemmed from my dad's death in 2005. So this has been ongoing. Anxiety and panic attacks, which at the time I didn't even know that's what I was feeling. The fight or flight response. I feel like I was able to keep it at bay for some time. From 2009-2020. However I had attacks and didn't even know that's what they were.

I was drinking heavily on the weekends. Since being diagnosed I am on medication and not drinking. But now I struggle with keeping a job. My poor boyfriend is so good to me and I feel like I'm putting him through hell. I just don't know what to do.

I'm sorry I wish I had advice for you OP. But as someone else commented I am in the same boat and you're not alone.

- Hate the "get medicated" route too. The medications to help with anxiety/depression make me too drowsy and tired to show up anyways. Always had to pop a zofran so didn't feel like I was about to throw up everytime. Asked for accommodations and the job didn't give me any so I quit. Title: I failed at everything. Is there any good reason not to kill myself?

Post Text: I've tried cultivating indifference, but still the tiniest things cause me immense pain. Today my manager gave a lecture, without raising her voice, about something I did wrong at work. It hurt me so much I spent ten minutes at the end of the day crying in the bathroom. I have no social life or dating prospects because I can't drive and I'm too scared to learn. I don't see any reason not to give up and kill myself, except maybe that it would hurt my friends. I can't even get myself to neutral. All I can manage to reach is a facade of "coping" that conceals from others and myself my inner insecurity and deep desire for death. I recently started a new job after being unemployed for years. For awhile that was making me feel better, but I've returned to

my normal self-hatred and more-or-less constant sadness. I have a deep desire for someone to care about me that I wish would go away.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- The Stoics support suicide, but, from what I've read, not as a response to mental anguish, but as a reasoned response to circumstances: as a way to refuse to do what is unjust, or as an acknowledgment that their work was done. Yet Epictetus was a slave for much of his life, and did not commit suicide.

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I recommend reading *A Brief for the Defense*, by poet Jack Gilbert, and *The Labors of Thor*, by David Waggoner. Neither of them diminish the reality of suffering or of our inner anguish. But both poems offer perspectives that you may find helpful.

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Life is hard. It's our first time becoming adults and growing old. Every life is new to the person who is living it. We are all rookies. Take care of the basics, at least: eat well, sleep well, and move your body. Endorphins are your friend.

Wishing you peace and, in time, satisfaction and joy.

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The stoics say the door is always open. Seneca thought that about who chose to smash his head against the wall instead of live a life of slavery made a brave choice. The Arabic slave trade would often make male slaves eunuchs. That isn't to invalidate our less severe problems. But it's a wake up call that we have power to awaken and face our problems, even if we forget ourselves and forget that we do. Seneca said most men spend their lives afraid of shadows and illusions. He means that our judgement of things, which are often erroneous, rob us of enjoying the present moment. The stoics understand that life lived in the past leads to depression and life lived in the future leads to anxiety. I hope you find reasons to live.

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- Therapy. You can be so much more after.

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Accepting and understanding your fears is key.

At you level, you might need therapy though. I also do therapy and found it helped.

I'm wondering if what youre experiencing can be traced to a difficult childhood with abuse and/or trauma, or terrible self-esteem. Very common with people with Autism, ADHD, abusive parents, childhood trauma, depression, anxiety, etc.

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I guess what I mean to say is that it seems you need help. But know that no one will come help you. It is very seldom people will lend a helping hand because everyone walks their own path and also live their own sorrows. This life of ours is difficult and we know it. But it is a difficulty that can be shouldered if you put one foot in front of the other. I'dk if this will help but I hope it does.

First put forth effort on yourself and then things will fall in-line. Wish you the best.

- I'm going to step outside of stoicism at the moment. It sounds like you're in a mental health crisis and possibly massively depressed. I was there earlier this year. Please, just keep on trucking. See a therapist if you haven't already. Maybe antidepressants or other meds if needed. Either way, you can't continue this way. I'll leave a comment that I left on another app that seemed to help somebody else who was going through a bad time too. I hope it helps

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I'm still in the middle of it all so I don't have an amazing success story, but I'm still here, and I have a few less days like the one you're having. I still want someone to come rescue me as much as you do, but they're not coming, so it's up to us to heal ourselves. Stoicism has been

amazing with helping me to start letting go of all the things outside of my control, and IFS has been amazing at helping me make peace with the parts of me that I despise. Pretty good combo, if you ask me, and I've tried everything. You can do this, man! We can do this.

- I tried to kms when I was 19, I rode my motorcycle off a 15 foot bridge into a ravine full of concrete chunks from previous construction. I layed in that hospital bed, body broken and full of despair. I watched as people I thought didn't even see me came into my room and hold me tearful and grief stricken. I cried and cried and then I screamed and raged because where were they when I was suffering? Where were all these people when I got evicted and ended up on the streets? Where were they when I was withdrawing from my addiction? None of those questions matter because as soon as my bike hit that guard rail, I immediately regretted my decision. The last thing I thought before I lost consciousness was "I'm not ready to die." I spent 4 months in the hospital and another year in physical therapy and a mental health hospital. I couldn't understand the conflict within me. I wanted to die and I was ready but then I wasn't? It was so confusing. I finally asked my amazing therapist about it and he said to me "if you were ready to die, why did you put your helmet on?" I can't tell you I have the answers or that I even know what you're going through. I can tell you that it will get better and it's not a sign of weakness to ask for help. Don't make the same mistake I did.

Title: I failed at everything. Is there any good reason not to kill myself?

Post Text: I've tried cultivating indifference, but still the tiniest things cause me immense pain. Today my manager gave a lecture, without raising her voice, about something I did wrong at work. It hurt me so much I spent ten minutes at the end of the day crying in the bathroom. I have no social life or dating prospects because I can't drive and I'm too scared to learn. I don't see any reason not to give up and kill myself, except maybe that it would hurt my friends. I can't even get myself to neutral. All I can manage to reach is a facade of "coping" that conceals from others and myself my inner insecurity and deep desire for death. I recently started a new job after being unemployed for years. For awhile that was making me feel better, but I've returned to my normal self-hatred and more-or-less constant sadness. I have a deep desire for someone to care about me that I wish would go away.

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Title: I'm ready to kill myself I can't take this anymore

Post Text:

25F

I am so sick of this life. Like literal life. I am a Christian so I believe in God and positive thinking but I'm literally giving all this shit up.

I wanted to kill myself at 18 but somehow ended up at college. I graduated in 2020 so that tells you everything you need to know. I didn't think I would make it past 18 so being here now is like what the fuck.

God isn't doing anything in my life. My positive thoughts aren't materializing. I don't even feel connection to the shit I believe in and am wishing for. My mind is literally turned off. I made multiple vision boards, read affirmations everyday, and do all the shit you're suppose to do. I can't do it anymore.

I've been praying for a job that I can start and get into and that will pay me all the money I need and more. I've been battling unemployment and under paying jobs for damn a year and some change. I am beyond that.

I am suppose to be a rich ass artist and had to take jobs at a gym wearing business casual making \$15 an hour. \$500 A WEEK. I FUCKING HATE IT. Haven't had a job all year. My heat is off now because I'm literally not making any money.

I HATE GOD AND ALL OF THIS POSITIVE THINKING SHIT, BECAUSE WHY IS IT NOT WORKING.

WHAT THE HELL.

I'm late on my rent this month, my parents have been supporting me but I'm tired of it. I want my own money. I want a life I love. I hate where I live even though it was my dream at one point. I might have to move back into my parents tiny disgusting home. I HATE THIS SHIT. I'm behind on so many bills.

I got a call for a job making \$17-\$19 but I had to pay \$140 for a background check and license in a field that is not the one I set out to pursue. I DON'T HAVE \$140 TO GIVE TO A JOB BEFORE I START WORKING IT. On top of that, it could take up to a month to get the license. So I'm out \$140 and have to wait a month to even start working. BULLSHIT

I literally don't know what to do. What's the point of all that believing and shit if it don't work. I apply to so many jobs every day. I even made multiple resumes and shit. I literally don't know what to do.

I need money RIGHT NOW and a whole lot of it. Money that's sustainable so I can actually live and enjoy my life, go on vacations and shit. I grew up lower middle class and I hate that's it's following me in my adult life.

I HAVE NO MORE TIME TO WAIT ON ALL THE POSITIVE SHIT I WANT. I NEED IT TODAY.

I would rather kill myself then go through all these downs. I've been more down than up and I'm sick of this shit. FUCK THE WORLD. I RATHER NOT BE ON IT IF IT'S GOING TO BE THIS DEPRESSING.

I've only had one dream my whole life, be a wealthy and succesful tv and film writer, director, and producer. My whole life I've never dreamed of anything else. I started my career as a production assistant and don't even know what else to do with my life after that. I got out that role because il hated the politics and dynamics of it and was getting severly underpaid, and since I'm a PA, nobody gives a fuck.

I've had one dream and one dream only. I don't even know what to do with my life. Even if I did move back in, I would just lay down and mope. I feel dead inside. I hate life. I'd rather it be over than feel this way.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I'm sorry you feel this way. I remember when at a point in my life, I too thought I deserved everything, but in my case it was after being treated horribly all the up til that moment. <bullying, no family, etc..> I feel the loneliest on Certain Holidays. As I said no family, no lover, no one to count on. (I'm glad you have that.[family])

Sadly I learned in this life, even after growing up very religious (am not anymore!), that no one is owed anything. Not even the most hurt of people. It's about not giving up. I know that sucks to hear. But it's so easy to give up these days. Homeless has increased 10 fold in the last decade. Suicide as well, both prominent in men and women. But you aren't alone. You have a family you can go back to, and take that break to focus on finding a better paying job, or hell, go back to school and improve on that education! I wish I had that. Both of my parents are dead and have been since I was 14. Imagining being alone for 12 years, and not having a "fall back."

Remember you have a lot, be grateful for what you have, because I know so many people who don't. We see them every fucking day. Take the time you need to heal, go home. Figure it out. Therapy is always good too.

- Hey.. I recently just got out of the psych ward for suicidal ideation. Which is what you have right now. Maybe go to the ER. Get into a mental facility for a few days or a couple weeks. It does make you feel better. You sound like you want somebody to help you out from your thoughts. Which is fine. Maybe not try and give this one to God. Maybe try some Doctors. I personally hate Doctors. Not all of them, but a lot of them.. ER doctors in particular are a dumb breed. Going to a mental hospital can be scary. But you will feel better. A lot of people have this twisted idea of what they are because of movies and bias. They think you're in there because you're crazy. It's an actually often times a first step towards not being so crazy.. They'll get you started on drugs and therapy. You'll eat a lot, and sleep even more. You'll get a lot of time to

read and think.. A lot of facilities have spiritual therapy there as well. A lot of pastors come into mental facilities for group sessions for spiritual guidance. Some of my favorite therapists have been pastors even though I'm not personally religious.

- I'm also in the arts, music specifically, and I am working on trying to make a film from a musical I wrote. The only thing keeping me going on it is the feeling that it IS a calling... that regardless of the never ending financial struggle, that it is something that I NEED to do. I am also a person of faith, but I'm not going to preach anything about that.

I've been struggling with depression for at least 30 years now. I can honestly say that the days I DON'T think about ending it are the exception, but at the same time, I know that the thing that I CAN do, is wait. I can wait for the worst days to pass, and then there will be days when it isn't so bad. I know bad periods will come again, and I have to choose to wait through those too.

So yeah, if you can at the very least just wait, then you'll make it through. And with the calling to create art, you are going to have to keep at it. The calling is REAL, I can attest that I completely understand when you say that you have a dream and not knowing what to do with your life.

Also, financial problems are super taxing on the psyche. Someday I may actually try to get good at finances, but today is not that day. I'll just keep waiting, and I hope you do too.

- I've been in your position before. To find hope I just tried out a bunch of different things until I was happy. By getting yourself out there and meeting different types of people, you will find people that will add value to your life and goals. For example I joined a running club to get my mental health up and then they gave me an opportunity to do some media work for them. I went to a networking event and made some cool friends and made some connections.

- When i was 19-24, I was an artist. I lived in an old warehouse with a couple other artists. We had no heat and we were cold all winter. I woke up everyday hungry and without any money to buy food.

Broke and hungry and "seemingly directionless", I was so depressed. I cut myself, struggled with drug addiction and made plans to die. Of course I couldn't see it as depression at the time. While I was in it, it seemed like the only possible reality.

But without a 9-5 job I had the freedom to make art all day. I was in the most creative period of my life, discovering my style and expression.

The cold, the hunger, the depression, the loneliness and the struggle were the greatest muse and catalyst for art!

One day, around your age, I got tired of the struggle. Not able to pay my rent, I took a labor job in construction. Over the next five years I apprenticed in a trade and tripled my income. I found my best friend and married her.

But once I had a job I didn't have time to make art. Once I was no longer struggling, once I was actually satisfied and generally happy, I had removed the muse and catalyst to make art.

My point is, the struggle is necessary for creating art. Embrace it. Or don't and get a job.

- Antidepressants can be literally life saving. I know because I've been battling treatment resistant depression for 30 years but I keep going because I am not going to give up all the struggle that I've been through to be erased at this point. Hell I even had ECT, multiple Hospital admissions and finally deep brain stimulation, which is an experimental option for folks like me. it helped. I know you said you have no money but maybe moving back in with your parents for a bit would help. Let someone you know or go to the health department and they can probably put you in touch with the antidepressant option, if you're willing to go there. Some antidepressants can be had for less than \$10 a month.

- This might sound weird, but giving up on god kinda saved my life. I let go of the Christian guilt, stopped believing in "god's plan," and just focused on myself and my morals instead. If there is just one god, he's doing a horrible job.

Call your parents, get into therapy, and do something every day that you enjoy. Even if it's as small as having an ice cream bar once a day, do something every day that makes you happy. Let go of the manifesting for now, focus on yourself, and get back into LOA when you're in a better place. I don't believe in god, but I do believe everyone deserves to live their life. I hope you get through this.

- I feel a very similar way. Being poor is so fucking hard, it sucks the life out of you, makes it near impossible to think about anything other than how ur gonna get by. I grew up poor, never had any dreams other than making enough money to buy me & my mom a house. I know it sounds like cope, but your life is so much more than just a career & a salary. Being rich & successful definitely makes life easier, but it won't fix the underlying depression. Keep applying for jobs, literally anything that possibly interests or excites u. Doesn't matter if you're qualified or not. There's lots of jobs that provide housing, if you can relocate. Regardless, I'm sorry ur going through this. I hope you find \$100 on the ground tomorrow

Title: My mother is dying. Do I owe her reconciliation? If not, is it okay to not attend her funeral

Post Text: My (M51) mother (F71) is nearing death. I went "no contact" with her several years ago. She is a narcissist who plays my emotions like an instrument. Her go-to move is making everything about herself. Since I was in my 30s, the main subject of our conversations was "poor me, give money." I've been generous in directly giving her a lot of money and paying down her debt. She is always the victim and claims that everyone is trying to take advantage of her.

She constantly lies, even about things that don't matter and are easily refuted. She has zero empathy and does not agree that her behavior is problematic. This has been the case my whole life. She neglected my sister and me as children, putting her wants ahead of our needs. There was always money for Tab (Diet Coke before there was Diet Coke) and cigarettes but little for anything beyond our minimum needs.

She suffered from postpartum depression and tried to kill me when I was an infant - a fact that I learned pretty recently. She clearly has mental health issues. She was abused as a child and developed a hatred of men—all men, including me. What happened to her was awful, and I've tried to look at her behavior through the lens of a hurt little girl. I didn't always handle this well

and have been unkind at times. I love her. I don't think she loves anyone but herself. Every interaction since I became an adult has left me feeling hurt and undermined my self-esteem. I was resigned to our dysfunctional relationship, in part because of what "I owed" to my mother for raising me.

And then I married and had children. She always called my wife by the wrong name and sent the girls birthday and Christmas cards for the first few years of their lives, but then she stopped. While I brought the girls around and encouraged them to have a relationship with their grandmother, it didn't go well. She made connections with them and then pulled back. My children didn't understand why she didn't want them around; they were very hurt. She never asks about them. I decided that it stopped with me, and I wouldn't allow her to hurt my children. I ended communication and removed her from our lives.

I don't struggle with the question of whether I did the right thing. She is my mother, and I love her, but I won't tolerate the infliction of pain on my family and myself. I have more or less concluded that the answer is a messy "Yes, I set the necessary boundaries."

Now, my mother's death is imminent. She has been in a steady decline and suffered a major heart attack last night. My sister and aunts are pressuring me to reconnect with my mother using the "she won't always be around" line of guilt. I mourned the loss of her many years ago, and her physical passing will not change my life. I will be sharing the final costs with my sister.

I am thinking about whether the right thing to do is 1) speak to, if not reconcile with my mother, and 2) if I don't, is it okay not to attend her funeral - I feel it would be disingenuous to attend. I am comfortable with not speaking to my mother or attending her funeral. Still, I can't decide if those are moral choices. What do you think?

****TL;DR:**** My estranged mother's death is imminent. I haven't spoken to her in years and don't want to now. Additionally, I have already mourned the loss and think attending her funeral will be disingenuous. Am I wrong?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- My dad has schizoaffective disorder (basically schizophrenia and bipolar) and is/was an alcoholic. I went NC 4 years ago. He reached out to my mom (they've been divorced since I was a teen) once not long after I changed my number to see if I got my gifts. He sent one more set of gifts then never said or sent anything again. He hasn't tried to contact me or my mom since. I don't feel like it's my job to make amends. I'm the child, he's the parent. I've thought about what I'll do when he is on his deathbed and/or passes away, and I don't know. If I go to his funeral, idk how it would do anything for me. I feel like it'd make me jaded to see people supporting the person that is the root to my mental health issues from all the emotional and psychological abuse he put me through. I understand that he has mental issues that prevent him from loving me in a healthy way, but that doesn't change how much he has hurt me. I think you should do whatever is going to make you feel the best at the end of the day. Maybe make a pro/con list

about the different choices. Either way, I'm sorry you have to deal with this and wish you the best of luck 💖

- Do mentioned that she had mental health issues even as a child she went through it. It affected her in a major way as an adult and as a mother. Sorry you had to go through it with her, but I think you should go to her funeral. It's your last time to see her in this lifetime. You don't want any regrets.
- You do not owe it but it's indeterminable if it would be better for you to see her . It is possible you will regret it but it's also possible you will not. If you are in therapy I encourage you to talk with your therapist about it .
- My father just died who I had not spoken to in 20 years. He was always absent growing up and a narcissist as well. Every decision he made in life was to benefit him. He had no empathy and wasn't capable of love. When he died, none of his family told me, therefore, I missed his funeral. I found out on his birthday that he had died 3 months prior via google. In his obituary I was never mentioned, but all his other kids were. It hurt that he considered me dead. In 2021, 3 years before his death, I tried to reach out because he was in his 80's and I figured that was my last chance to fix the relationship. He shut the door on my face and wouldn't respond to any texts or calls. Sometimes you have to just let them go despite them being blood related. Your mental health is #1.
- Your mom sounds Borderline btw. You do not "owe" her anything. If anything she owes you reconciliation. But the thing is with Borderlines there is no reconciliation to be had. They usually suffered horrible abuse themselves in childhood and it leaves them incapable of forging relationships in adulthood... and Ironically they usually have an unusually strong desire/need for a connection they are literally incapable of creating. Without therapy they simply cannot recover.

My mom was Borderline and I lost both my parents young. I'll say this. If you go to her deathbed or the funeral it has to be for yourself. For closure. You won't get any kind of Hallmark moment. The reconciliation you'll have is when she's gone and not able to do new things to hurt you. Then you can start to have an understanding of the relationship.

I would strongly recommend going to the funeral. Funerals are for the living — a lot of people don't get that. It's a tradition across cultures because it is an essential part of the grieving process. You may think you've grieved already, but trust me, you haven't. Just the fact that you're asking if you should reconcile with her reveals that you have *hope* which is normal bc she's your mother. You'll have hope until she doesn't exist anymore. That's the thing you have yet to grieve... no matter how small it is.

- How did you mourn the loss of her already? I'm sorry for asking, but you sound like me. I'm actively in therapy and this came up. It's a trigger I need to resolve now rather than waiting until she's dying.
- My dad alienated everyone, my two sisters moved over 1000 miles away. When he was being taken to the hospital my mother told me it was time for him to go. He was 93. No funeral, no burial service. For the first time in my life I can talk to my mother.

Do what you feel is best for your mental health.

- It's fine to not speak to her or go to her funeral. There's no indication that she has changed. She has made no attempt to apologize, which could have been communicated through one of the other relatives still in contact with her. You will be exposing yourself to not only more hurt, but to the potential for that hope of reconciliation and change.

I say this as someone who had "reconciled" with my dad a few years before he died. After his death, I learned that he had been lying about some serious things during that time, in line with all the issues I had with him growing up. And I ended up in my second round of therapy because I struggled to deal with all the emotions of losing not just him but the hope that some day he'd be the dad I needed and wanted, instead of the dad he was.

I went to the funeral, and I was surprised that his family that spoke actually acknowledge that he had had issues, because they're very much a "don't talk about the uncomfortable stuff." But they also left as soon as the service was over, which felt like being abandoned. So it didn't even provide the comfort and support I was hoping for and have experienced at other funerals.

Don't be worried if other people don't understand. Those who have been through life with that sort of parent understand. You have to be the parent she never was and protect yourself from her bad behavior.

sending e-comfort

- Ask yourself this: is there anything I need to say to her so I can be at peace?

If the answer is no, get on with your life.

At this point, it is your comfort and mental health that matters.

- Simply, you don't owe anyone anything, and no, you don't have to go to the funeral. Do what's best for you and your mental health.

- No, you don't owe your mother anything! Not a reconciliation. Not a sorry. Not an I love you. You owe her nothing, and that includes not attending her funeral. You don't owe your family anything, either. Toxic is toxic and we are not obligated to tolerate it or just take it for the sake of it because they are a parent. Our own mental health matters, and our hearts need to be protected, too! I am in the same boat. My family has talked about it for years, saying that I need to attend their funeral. Its been almost two decades since I've spoken to them. Why would I bother wasting my time showing up and putting on a fake facad? For who? For the sake of appearances? They couldn't be bothered in my life, and I won't be bothered in their death. I'm content, healthier and sleep well with my decision.

- I gave my dad more chances that I should have, maintaining contact long after all 4 of my siblings cut him off. He was a narcissist and a horrible, abusive father growing up. But I finally cut him off simply for my mental health. He manipulated everyone around him, would disappear from my life and reappear when he needed something, and generally just drained me mentally. I gave him an ultimatum on his behavior and he chose to ignore that.

For me, he clearly made a choice and that was enough for me. When he got sick, I didn't change my stance because it had nothing to do with him. He hurt me with his decisions all my life, and at a certain point I had to put myself first. Having any contact with him would harm myself and I just wouldn't give him another chance to hurt me. I felt bad that he was sick, because I did love him. But his choices were the reason he was alone. I didn't find out he had died until days afterwards, and I did not attend his funeral. Neither did most of his family and none of his children went.

It wasn't a punishment, and I forgave him long before he died. It was just the consequences of his lifelong choices.

- You do what's best for you. NOBODY else matters. Noone else's opinions matter! Your emotional and mental health are all all you need to concern yourself with. If you want to go to tell her how you feel, do it. FOR YOU!!! Be your own gatekeeper.

- If you don't think you will get any benefit from this contact, don't do it. It is not your job to make amends with her so she will feel better about leaving this world. It doesn't make you an awful person at all. You are the one who has to deal with your mental health for the rest of your life. Do what is best for yourself.

- I went through something extremely similar but with the death of the man that no one should ever have to call dad . Anyway I swore the day he died I would throw a party on his grave site for the world to see as he was truly an evil person to his kids and wife . So it was an extremely difficult decision to attend or not attend his services (and shockingly when I found out he died I cried , crazy I know because if hate is a word that's what I felt for this person , but my therapist helped me to under the tears). Anyway in the end I decided to go to his services but I didn't do it for me , I did it for those that I loved that loved him and didn't know him as I did . And in its own way it was kinda a final closure for me (mind you I hadn't seen that man in about 13 years prior to his death) . Bottom line you need to make the decision that is best for you and not anyone else .

My mother who is now 76 isn't in the greatest of health and minus the mental issues she sounds very familiar to your mom . The guilt, the poor me, the victimization, etc and lots of lies . I've given her money , I've taking her on vacations that she would have never been able to afford . Now thanks to therapy I was able to move on and allow her back in my life after not talking with her for about 6 years and basically things were good with us but just over a year ago one of my siblings passed away (he had some mental issues which I blame on our childhood , so for safety reasons we had to keep him out of our lives) and when we found out my mother was asked if she wanted his ashes . Her response, nope it's too hard on me emotionally but oh no it can't possibly be hard on the surviving children (yes I get it's her son but he was also my brother and again I blame her for a lot of his mental illness) so let's do what we always do and play victim , put your grief above everyone else's . And what's worse is she didn't even ask about the how he died , will there be a service , nothing !

I claimed his body (or ashes) , I paid to have his remains shipped to my state , my name is on his death certificate. Not once has she even asked how any of us are doing . So for now any conversations I have with her is 90% via text only . I still send her money monthly , still by her things when she mentions oh how she can't afford something (and no I'm not wealthy but I am middle class) . I haven't seen her in 2 years and she only lives 3 hours away . So I definitely

understand where you are coming from . And yes inspite of it all I do love my mother , I just can't be physically around her .

- I have went no contact with my mother for a few years now. I've also said I wouldn't care if she kicked the bucket tomorrow. If she did, I'd attend the funeral for my grandfather's sake (if he's still around) I often feel bad for saying that bc my husband's mother passed about 10 yrs ago from cancer, in her 40s. I feel bad bc some people would give the world to have their parent back, but, at the same time, my mental health is important for me and MY family, husband/daughter. So having nothing to do with her is my only option. Which her actions chose for me. Everyone is different. But, whatever you choose, choose for YOU. Not to please anyone else! Wish you the best of luck!

- You DO NOT OWE HER RECONCILIATION!! Reconciliation is for you & your feelings, it is not owed to anyone! And if you don't want to attend her funeral, you are not required to. You do what makes you feel better and take care of your self & your kids.

I was physically, emotionally and sexually abused as a kid. It was pretty ugly, and it took a lot of therapy to pull myself together once I was old enough. My only regret when my dad died was that he never acknowledged what he did or apologized. But I'm okay with that, it was part of his mental illness and he couldn't . I also lost my mom a couple of years ago, and that was a lot rougher, but we had a decent relationship (although I was pretty upset that she didn't protect me at all from my dad). I miss her a lot, but it's completely different.

I'm sorry for your loss. It sucks to have an abusive parent. But my advice is to make yourself the least miserable you have to be. You don't owe anyone anything!

Title: Ex employer called up sobbing and talking about suicide to try and stop me perusing him for money owed + payslips, group certificate, superannuation

Post Text: As title says

Two days ago me old employer rang up after I sent him an email informing him I was going to raise a complaint with the workplace ombudsman in order to force him to fulfil his obligations as an employer.

He quickly began a sob story about how he has been struggling mentally and could we please sort this out between us only. I told him at most I'm going to give him (a bit) more than the minimum notice period for giving me what I'm owed, before a case is brought before the workplace ombudsman and tax department.

He laid it on real thick, sobbing and even talking about how he's been thinking about suicide "which you know isn't what I want because my friend that killed himself. And my son and wife". While I worked for him he routinely relied on guilt trips and sympathy in order to get away with his bullshit.

I'm not without compassion, I'm all too aware the toll mental health issues take on a person. However it's been well over a year and he has not kept his word a single time, offering only excuses and empty promises.

This man had the audacity to ask staff to work for free, because "times are tough". Well they're tough for me too. I can't subsidise someone else's failing business. (It's fallen over since I left)

I'm sick to death of shit employers who think their dream of having a business is everyone else's problem, and that people should make concessions on their behalf. Hell the fuck no. I didn't sign up for that. I signed up to earn money, that's it.

I made a post in this sub a while back, it was a screenshot of a conversation I had with him about these very issues. People doubted I'd actually do anything about it.

Well I've quit that job, got a better one and am now in the process of dragging him through official channels to recover the money and paperwork he owes me.

UPDATE:

I've just finished calculated estimation of funds owed and fired off an email notifying him he has 7 days to comply before proceedings commence.

This is the "final self resolution" required by the workplace ombudsman in order to get the ball rolling.

Ball is firmly in his court.

I also included a statement about the phone call in which I voiced my objection to his manipulation and emotional blackmail. Ty to those who gave me level headed advice on that point.

I also want to say that this post went further than I thought it would, and while I got many great replies, many of you seem a bit unhinged.

I do not believe such hostility is warranted nor that we as individuals or society will accomplish anything toward a fairer and more just world wasting our energy like that.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Sounds like you've got the right attitude about it. It might be an act and even if it isn't, his mental health issues aren't your problem. He made his own bed and now must lie in it.

- "He laid it on real thick, sobbing and even talking about how he's been thinking about suicide

"which you know isn't what I want because my friend that killed himself. And my son and wife"."

​

Please do the right thing and report that this man is suffering and in need of mental health assistance.

- Sorry but their mental health is not your responsibility
- His mental health issues do not equate to being able to not pay you. If your partner is depressed they don't get to beat you for example. That's not how any of this works.
- Wage theft should be treated with the same penalty as an employee would if they stole.

He is leveraging his depression to control you - i wouldnt even give him one extra minute and neither should you.

- Unless you specifically tell him to kill himself or help him, you are not responsible if he actually kills himself.

He sounds like he needs a stay in a mental hospital. I don't know where you live but do the police or another agency provide welfare checks/wellness check/safe and well check or something similar?

You could say that you are very concerned for his mental health and he sounds like a danger to himself.

Do you need the money right now? Do you know if there is a specific statute of limitations for making a claim? In the US it is 2 or 3 years based on federal laws and the specific circumstances though I think that some states provide additional protections. I would do a Google search to find out the laws and regulations where you live.

You might consider waiting a bit but maybe not wait if you know that his business is going under because if he owes a lot of money to creditors, the banks and businesses generally get their money first and individuals get the scraps if anything.

- My gut reaction--take this with a grain of salt--your boss has been embezzling or doing some illegal shit and is using a mental health crisis to guilt you into walking away.
- I would contact your labour board or a lawyer as that is psychological abuse... which only adds to your case. you are not responsible for other peoples reactions to your self care
- God. Sorry he laid that on you. He needs therapy, he doesn't get to use threats of suicide to get out of what he's owed. That's some middle school shit. We don't do that to another person. It's beyond unkind and in a professional situation it's insane
- Keep on the course. Those who use suicidal ideation in this way have no idea how to express emotion. I'm not here to take away from the distress he's feeling but his mental health is not your responsibility either. If he truly is suicidal then he need expert help, if he's using it as a tool to not go through with his obligations then WOW. Either way continue with what you're doing. Maybe give him local mental health telephone numbers too.
- While it's important to take someone's mental health into account this person seems like a serial manipulator.

My spouse uses the term "weaponized tears". It's manipulative and despicable.

It seems like you're on the right track. Stick to the truth and the process.

- This isn't about his mental health. Threatening suicide to control another person is abuse. I'm not as good a person as you; I'd add this to the list of complaints against this guy and move ahead with the case.
- I have sympathy because I have depression that can get severe and I've been suicidal. But that's not really your problem. For all he knows you're feeling the same way because of the situation and how it's affecting you. You don't get a pass to be a scumbag. My moral compass has never changed when I was depressed. I would still know all this shit is wrong.
- Ex bosses mental health isn't your problem
- He doesn't have mental health issues. That's his management style/how he gets his way.
- Unfortunately, mental health concerns are not being addressed properly in this country. That's because employers don't know how to treat others with the dignity and courtesy they deserve as a basic human right. It's not a natural thing to try to please people who will never be pleased. They will always try to squeeze more out of you than you can reasonably give. This employer probably has someone up the chain squeezing him.

Don't let that stop you from doing the right thing.

- Good on you for not falling for his manipulation tactics. It's absolutely gross how some people weaponize mental health issues, especially their own as get out jail free card they can whip out of their back pocket at any time.
- Whatever sob-story or mental health garbage this guy is giving you needs to go out the window.

Employment is a business transaction, just like how you won't get a day for mental health because you're not feeling well, they don't get out of their responsibilities either.

Any business that needs to sustain itself by paying people starvation wages (or no wages at all) has no business existing to begin with.

- Don't give him any more than the required time. And as a precaution, refer him to services for mental healthcare just in case he's truly suicidal (doesn't sound like he is, though). He owes you and any other former employees your due.
- Yup if he wants to talk about suicide the crisis line is there for that. Him dragging out and withholding pay from people will not decrease his stress level.
- Erm, if your manager can't do his job without being overly stressed and suicidal, he should look for another job. That is not your problem. Your problem is the lack of pay, do what you must do to fix this, report him.

Title: Probably gonna kill myself tonight no there isn't anything you can do to changed my mind please pray for me

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Please don't! Instead, seek professional help and counseling. Call a suicide prevention helpline. There are remarkably effective drugs for treating mental illness as well that could help you.

- Not my place to tell you what to do, but drugs and depression do not mix.

You owe it to yourself to at least make sure this is a 100% sober decision.

- I love you so much. I am sending you so much love and peace. My dm's are open if you'd like to chat <3 I can't imagine what you're going through right now, although I certainly could try. I've had some terrible shit happen to me in my life as well. I love you so much u/cone8042 <3 I have adhd, borderline personality disorder, depression and anxiety, I've struggled with drug use, I'm gay, I have a lot of trauma I've been working on in therapy, I say this just because I hope some part of it resonates with your struggle and I can help you not to feel so alone, although I also know how intensely lonely and how much pain we're capable of experiencing.

- Hey, I don't think you would have posted this if you didn't want to see what other people would say. I hope you read this. I had depression from the time I was in 6th grade until college. I had suicidal thoughts hourly. What stopped me from killing myself wasn't God, or sudden happiness, or anything like that. It was reading and disappearing into other worlds of my imagination. It was waiting for a tv show to come out that interested me. It was waiting for movies to come out. It was waiting to finish a book series first. What helped me to keep going was finding something to look forward to. When you're depressed, you have blinders on. You have blinders to your own emotions, your own thoughts, and to everything around you. Everything sucks, all the time, no matter what. You're blind to what God has to offer when you're depressed. You have to create your own meaning in the world when you're suicidal. You have to be your own inner strength. Death offers a release of this life. But suicide will be your biggest what if moment. I was never happy as a child. I was depressed for over 10 years. If I had committed suicide I would have never found the life I have now. I don't know your life. But I know depression and suicide. It often comes in waves, at least it did for me. It's never a bad idea to wait just a bit. Set some soft deadlines for yourself. If you're in school, perhaps wait for after a deadline to an assignment that sounds like it might be fun. Or perhaps wait until a holiday. Reassess then. Wait until something you like will happen. Do the leaves change where you live? Or perhaps does it snow? Depression and suicidal thoughts stick with you if you don't do anything to try and change them. Small changes sometimes help. They sometimes don't. Drastic changes often help more, but, again, sometimes they don't. I can't tell you that your life will get better. But, perhaps listen to me when I say it took over 10 years for things to change, and it was 100% worth every agonizing moment to keep putting up the soft deadlines, to keep waiting. I wasn't waiting for life to get better, I never thought it would. I was just waiting for some things to look forward to. I don't know your interests or hobbies, but it might be worth a look to see what you can look forward to. Good luck, I will pray for you. I have been in your shoes before, and if you want to talk, I am here.

- You are worthy of life. There is hope in Jesus. Call the suicide hotline. Seek professional counseling. People want to help you. Even though we don't know you, everyone one of us in the comments values your life and knows that God put you on this earth for a reason. Life can be so hard sometimes but there is so much to be grateful for. Focus on the small things, the joy in breathing, the joy of God's creation, the joy of knowing Jesus. Cry out to the Lord. Jesus' heart breaks watching you endure such pain. I pray that God sends an angel into your life so that you know that you're not alone. You have your whole life ahead of you, to build and make beautiful. Hold out and decide tomorrow to get help. Help is out there, I promise.

- One year ago today my best friend since third grade told me he tried to kill himself. He had no idea what he wanted to do with his life and his depression was worse than it had ever been. This week he graduates from basic training in the army. I don't know what I would do if he had succeeded. I am so proud of him and he is so glad he is still here too. I pray that you see that there is so much worth living for. I pray that you see it will get better. Amen.

- I have prayed for you, that God gives you the peace and comfort you need to not take your own life. I have also suffered from OCD for 16 years. It's a horrific disease that can make you feel hopeless. Please reach out to a licensed professional or a helpline. As dark as OCD feels, it will not always be this way and suicide is a permanent response for temporary pain. Please please reach out for professional mental health help. I am currently at my wits end with OCD too and am reaching out for professional help. Trust when I say you are not alone and you can get through this.

- Please don't do it brother. You're only 15. I admit when I was that age was when I first experienced depression. Looking back it was very foolish of me. The world is a lot bigger and kinder than you might think. Just look at all these strangers worried for you. God loves you beyond what you could possibly comprehend. It's the enemy that wants you to feel bad and take your life. I will be praying for you. Feel free to send me a private message if you want to talk over the phone

- I am so incredibly sorry that you feel this kind of pain. I have been on the edge many times. Please reach out if you would like to talk. DM me and I can give you my number. It has saved me to call someone and just not be alone in my thoughts.

1) OCD, depression, etc. = your brain lying to you

2) this is an exhausting fight against your own mind to stay alive, I promise it is always worth winning that battle

3) Stick around and God can use you to help other people in the same pain

I love you. I'm praying for you. We all want you to see the sunrise tomorrow.

- Please don't, I am not from the US but feel free to reach me anytime, I want you to live, I've seen depression, it affected my girlfriend for a long time, it is affecting me right now after the loss of my brother. But your life is worth a lot.

I don't know you but I don't want you to end your life, you will be making this world darker, and we need light, some of us are in a very dark place already, and it doesn't matter how bad you think everything is, you can help bring light into this place. Everybody has a purpose, so don't give up, joy is there to be found, even on the most unexpected of places

- Yeah, I realized that I wanted to kill myself about a month ago. However, in deference to my children I deferred. My life still sucks because of my life circumstances. I still face depression, but I suspect that you might regret your decision.

- My friend, this world needs you here. Your brain may have tricked you in to believing otherwise, but that is a lie. Those negative and intrusive thoughts you are having are not true. Keep repeating that to yourself until you believe it. "My life is worth living. I am worthy of life and love."

Sending you support and love. This pain you are feeling is temporary. It may seem like it will last forever when you're in the midst of it, but I promise that it is all temporary. There are brighter days ahead.

As someone who has struggled with chronic mental health issues since I was a child, I can testify that seeing a doctor and a psychologist can make an incredible difference. Please reach out to professionals to help you. It will make such a difference in your life if you put in the effort. Therapy is a lot of work but it yields a lot of rewards, too. Don't give up on yourself. You are worth it.

May the Lord bless you and help heal your pain. Please DM me if you need someone to talk to. Praying for you ♥

- Put your heart to your chest , feel that that's a purpose!!!!

If you can believe in Jesus

Then in Jesus name I cast the sickness, sadness and depression out of your life!!!

Amen

In Jesus Name he will remind you of what you do have in life that's worth living and help you Praise our almighty heavenly holy gracious joy giving mericful loving compassionate God

Amen

In the name of Jesus any you be reminded that Jesus died For your your sins when you were very after off and still brought you back to a chirstian faith HE died for us believers and he wants us all to help him.

Amen

In Jesus name allow every depressing thought to be cast in to the fire and in Jesus name destroy anything that would make this person feel further from god or Jesus or the spirt

Amen

In Jesus name may god ignite you in the spiritual fire of love and happiness as a guide and annd May Jesus be your saviour and Friend through everything

Amen

In Jesus name I cast out the sadness Jesus knows what your going through and he said is compassionate and loves you

Amen

You are loved so do not stress anymore

“Those who are weary and burdened I will give you rest”

Jesus gives rest his burden is light hallelujah

Praise God and wear the garment of praise and not of despair

- Please don't do it. I realize in the moment your distress may feel very acute and overwhelming but it does not stay like this forever. You are likely believing a lot of lies and distortions that have brought you to this state. you will realize later on how you were not thinking clearly. Killing yourself is not an option.

- I know how heavy the dark clouds of depression feel when they swarm in around you. I know it feels like there is no way out. If you just wait, the feeling will pass. The light will shine on you again. You have take one step into the light by posting here in this moment. I speak light in Jesus Name to your eyes right now. I speak health and healing in Jesus Name to your weary spirit. I speak life and that to the full to your soul and body, as you allow Jesus to embrace you, in His mighty Name. Amen. May you experience fully the love and comfort of Jesus through His Holy Spirit. He will never leave or abandon you.

- PLEASE CALL THE SUICIDE HOTLINE!!

800-273-8255

We can all help prevent suicide. The Lifeline provides 24/7, free and confidential support for people in distress, prevention and crisis resources for you or your loved ones, and best practices for professionals.

- Please get to the nearest mental health clinic or hospital as soon as you can. You need medical help right now. Give them a chance.

- I know I'm late, but spent a bit of time writing this so you better read it if you're still around.

Not sure if you're still here or will come back to hear this but here's my story with my mental health, maybe you can relate to some, maybe you can change part of your mindset, won't beg you to, because our mental health and actions are, ultimately, our own responsibility. Nothing I, nor anyone will say will magically fix you, your situation, your problems. Maybe, however, this can be a spark that ignites something in your mind and allows you to see from a new perspective, which may change the way you think and perceive your situation.

I've dealt with very severe mental health issues since I was 10 (turned 21 recently). I have been very suicidal at times, and still frequently am. I self harm to cope sometimes. Suicide hotlines are shit, maybe it's your thing, but I wouldn't bother. I feel like the people around me don't have the capacity nor do they want to hear about me, my mental health, and my issues. My friends feel fake to me. I'm not a fan of therapists. It's just me and my dog wasting away in my moms basement. I've been diagnosed with severe cyclical depression, severe adhd, severe anxiety, panic disorder, binge eating disorder, and a tic disorder—which some of the tics show as ocd-like urges. I hate myself, my situation, my life. Genuinely.

I always want to give up and stop trying. It's not fair that other people get to live a normal mostly-happy fucking life and here I am at 21 rotting away in my moms basement. I love my dog, videogames, music, and food. I'm suicidal off and on, but why haven't I committed?

To be honest, I'm pretty scared. Is heaven real? Will I just, cease to exist?—like it was before I was born, just nothingness?? Is that it? Will I be betrayed(?) and burn in hell for eternity? Why won't God answer my prayers??? I would die for my faith in God at any moment, but unfortunately it feels like God has left me on my own to deal with my problems that are, at times, too much for me to handle. All of that said, my pain and suffering is so great that it supersedes my fear death most of the time.

I'm hanging on, albeit barely, because I know that things **will** get better. Even though I am stuck living with my mental health issues for the rest of my life, I know I will get a better handle on them, and I know that my situation will improve. This is also true for you, you're 15 going on 16. We are both young and have the rest of our lives to improve our situation. Medication has helped me a bunch, makes my mental health more manageable and allows me to get to work a small majority of the days. I'm not living a perfect life, I'm not but barely doing things I'm supposed to, I'm not normal, and I'm not okay, ****but I know I will be****. I know you will be too, as long as you don't take that opportunity away from yourself. I know you're hurting, I love you dude, take care.

P.s. if you or anyone reading this wants to talk about mental health, your story, my story, or just someone to listen, my dms are open.

Title: I'm really concerned about men's mental health

Post Text: I'm a mental health therapist(f48)who has jumped back into dating (males) after a ten year dating hiatus.

I've met a few men, taken some time to get to know them, and dang. Usually about a month into getting to know these guys I'm hearing phrases like "emotionally dead inside" and "unable to understand my own or other's feelings". They are angry and irritated at the core of their emotional lives and have very low levels of positive emotion. I feel so horrible for them when they disclose these things to me. It's very sad.

I'd like to think that my sample size is low and that my observations cannot be generalized to the entire heterosexual male population, but my gut tells me otherwise. I think there is a male mental health crisis. Your mental health does matter. And I wish I could fix it all for everyone of you, and I can't.

Edit: Yes, the mental health system is completely overwhelmed. I know it's difficult in the first place to reach out for help only to find wait lists and costs that are way out of hand in most

places. Please keep trying. Community mental health centers usually have sliding scales and people to help get access to insurance.

There are so many mentions of suicide. Please, seek help, even if it's just reaching out to the suicide prevention hotline.

<https://suicidepreventionlifeline.org/>

I'm trying to read all the comments, as some of them are insightful and valuable. I appreciate all who have constructively shared their thoughts and stories.

For those who have reached out via private message, I am working on getting back with you all.

Thank you all for the rewards.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- When I was 28 a couple years ago my 4 1/2 year relationship ended but just before it did my ex (28f) told me she lost respect for me when I had a mental breakdown after a traumatic personal event. I remember going to her and expressing how depressed and stressed I was and her response was to "be stronger," no conversation to help, just that it was embarrassing for me to be acting like that. She brought this up when I ended it (still depressed from the recent event) and once again mocked me for being so affected by the situation. It was then I knew I was making the right choice to walk away. The mental health stigma will continue as long as women and men ridicule for reaching out and expressing these bad feelings, not just the good.

Edit: A little late, but I will clarify that it wasn't a full on mental breakdown but for my usual stoic demeanor the sudden expression of sadness, grief, and general depression was as close to a breakdown as I have ever had - it left me in a very dark place and the breakup only made that worse. Thank you for the kind words, it has been 2 years since then and while I haven't dated since I am now aware of what to look for in a future partner.

- Sorry for dumb question but, what's the difference between a mental health specialist and psychologist?

- As a male with mental health issues. Nobody cares.

- To add a positive side, I feel like i'm very lucky to have the friends I have. We're all dudes in our early 20's and the amount of times we've all opened up to each other about our emotions is pretty often. Crying is not rare and while we do mock each other a lot it always comes from a place of love and usually not during a rough patch for someone.

We've talked about friends/family deaths. Fears and anxiety about becoming an adult and having no fucking clue what we're supposed to be doing in life. Relationship trouble, general mental health shit. Just all around a lot of open discussions between grown ass men. I don't know how rare our friend group is or if it's a cultural thing (we're swedish) but there are straight guys out there that at least try to be emotionally open and vulnerable. Hope this maybe cheered you up or some shit idk. We exist.

- >I'm concerned about... mental health

and

>I'm a mental health therapist...

I mean it's nice a few of you actually do.

- I'm a male 39. I went to rehab about 13 years ago which was basically therapy camp.

People are so messed up. By far the most revealing group therapy we ever did was the men's only group. The secrets that came out there were insane. Rapists, rape victims, incest, murder. It was so intense.

So many people have so much darkness inside them but as a culture we don't talk about it.

I was one of those people before I went in but realised that I would never be happy if I didn't share how I felt. Which since doing so I've not stopped because I'm sick of pretending everything isn't insane in the world around me. It takes too much effort to pretend anymore.

My therapist compared me Teflon when I went in which I took as a compliment. However he explained that it wasn't a good thing to not let things bother me. It wasn't a sign of strength as I thought. Was way too many men that I know pretend it's all fine and it's hard to be around them. Overall I prefer to be around women now because they are in general more open. Open men I am of course really glad to be around.

- I think it has to do with the times we live in. Men for the longest time were ignored when we brought up our mental health issues because men are expected to just "get over it" or "man up". With mental health being more talked about nowadays I think men are starting to talk more and more about how they feel but now we don't really know what to do because we still have this weird view of what we should do as men to cope with our mental health issues. It's a definitely a weird but dangerous spot to be in as men.

- As a man in his mid 40s I can confirm. I believe its very much a generation thing. Im part of a generation that was raised to be rough, tough and fearless. Showing emotion is weak. I can't stress enough how unbelievably difficult it is for us to open up. A number of my friends are in the same boat, and I only know this because we've worked hard together to open up a bit and talk to each other.

- I am as well, but this is more. I think we're seeing the natural response to an unending pandemic that really hurt our abilities to cope.

My 17 year old is telling me he feels very disconnected and numb. That sounds like depression to me and I'm looking for a therapist for him. Not as easy as I thought it would be.

I know I'm feeling that way too, a bit, but I'm female and we do seem to be wired to get mental health a bit faster. Probably not, "wired," as much as societal.

I would love to be a fly on the wall in a group studying the social mores of this very unique time one hundred years from now.

- 35M , I see it. My generation seems to have a keener mind to speak about mental health; doesn't mean anything changed but awareness is rising.

Older generations are so tied up I'm doubtful any of them make it out. The cowboy generation left its mark on us too, but we all had our fathers as an example.

It's all too common, stay in line, get a "good" job, and provide for a family. Then the 30s hit and these guys either hit the sauce too hard or become a megalomaniac.

Also, it's a commonality in life and if you take a look around it's not like it's unspoken. I've had my struggles and on the outside now, the answers are everywhere.

A little bit of courage to talk is all a man needs. I can't help but talk TOO much anymore; all speech is therapy. The old grumbling man who spews negativity paints a clear example, attacking the people close to him out of pride.

- There are a lot of toxic messages being directed at all men these days, and we're all expected to silently swallow the toxins and not give a word of complaint. I hate Trump, but a part of why he won is because he represented a way for predominantly straight white men to lash back at society for the bullshit we're being made to swallow.

"Bullshit? Such as what?"

Cancel culture. The left has become obsessed with identity politics. Who is the common villain to blame for all of society's ails? Straight white men. There isn't a better boogey man to stand up. Why? Because nobody will dare oppose it or stand up to a claim. Women can dogpile on men, and it's not sexist. To protest, you're sexist against women. The LGBTQ community can dogpile as well and to oppose their claims would be considered transphobic. People of any other race can also dogpile on us, because to oppose them, you just get called a racist. It's the holy trinity of identity politics to blame, dogpile and smash straight white men in all discourse about what's wrong with society, and men typically won't say anything since we tend to "man up" and "deal with it". Instead, we bottle it up. We swallow it. We hope the toxin dissipates over time, but it rots our soul in the process. We can't ask for help. It's a waste of time, because there isn't any. Nobody listens because nobody cares. How many cases of domestic violence do you hear about being committed against men? Very, very few - not because it doesn't happen, but because men don't report it. Yet, men silently suffer DV just as often as women. How many DV shelters can you find for men in your city? Usually none, and one if you're lucky. What about those of us who are facing homelessness? If a woman faces homelessness, there are lots of resources for her to use, including the possibility of living with friends and family. Men? We don't matter. Men are left to fend for themselves on the streets, withering away until we go crawl under some rock to quietly die where we won't bother anyone by inconveniencing them with our presence.

How little do men matter to society? We're disposable. If a man dies, it doesn't really matter. We're meant to die. In a sinking ship, when passengers are being loaded onto life rafts, it's "women and children first!". When negotiating for the release of hostages, it's "please release the women and children as a sign of good faith", and when it comes to war, every boy at the age of 18 has to sign up for the draft, but women of similar age don't. If there's a mining accident or

some other workplace disaster and a handful of men die (because of course its just men!), then does society and media care? Do we get a candlelit vigil in our remembrance? Nope!

Bottom line is that adult men are expected to come last and die first because we matter the least. How do you suppose that might affect our mental health and attitudes towards life and society?

But then, when you consider the dismal state of marriage and family, it gets even more abysmal. A lot of stink has been made recently about systemic racism and how a lot of it is very prevalent and unconscious in various institutions. While there is some truth to that, is anyone raising their voices and shouting about the overt systemic sexism in our society when it comes to treating men fairly? 50% of couples get divorced. 80% of the time, the divorce is initiated by a woman. Sometimes, it can be a “no fault” divorce, where a man doesn’t even screw anything up, but he gets divorced for “irreconcilable differences”. During divorce proceedings, he loses 50% of his net worth he worked his ass off for, grinding away at some thankless job just so that the wife and kiddos had a roof over their heads and food to eat. And, *most* men absolutely love their children, no less than women do, and yet when a divorce court rules for child custody, it is almost always granted to the women! The divorce lawyers know exactly how to game the system against men, they know exactly what gets children taken away, exactly how to fleece men of their money and maximize their pain, and how to limit the amount of time a man can spend being a father to their children... as far as the legal system is widely concerned, men don’t deserve anything and shouldn’t get anything. If you end up owing child support, you are threatened with stiff jail time for not paying. In other words, lose 50% of your net worth, then pay 50% of your paycheck, and if you don’t work, then you go to jail. Men aren’t allowed to “anti-work”, we have to be wage slaves.

To compound things further: To advocate for men and to be a proponent for “mens rights”, is often seen as sexist and misogynistic, regardless of how much merit an issue men are facing has. Men’s rights advocates quickly get branded as haters, shut down for hate speech by their detractors, and there’s a rush to cancel them — “how dare they speak up for the boogey man/whipping boy! The insolence!”

And then, people have the audacity to lay the current problems of society at the feet of men who’ve been denied the opportunity to be fathers? And people wonder why so many men are quietly facing mental health problems and feelings of worthlessness? Why there’s a quiet seething rage in every man that sometimes manifests itself as a vote for monsters like Trump? Why anyone is surprised that mass shooters are typically all men, who are lashing out from the anguish of their mental health problems in the only way they know how to be heard and seen? Straight white men are the worlds best scapegoats for all problems — “we’re strong, we can take it”, right? But what about those among us who aren’t so strong anymore, or ever were? And under decades of persistent toxicity constantly grinding men down, how long can anyone be strong? When all your cartoons growing up portray men as bumbling, incapable idiots (homer simpson, peter griffin, etc), when sexist statements at mens expense always get a free pass but the same thing said about women would cause national outrage followed by PR trying to soothe things over?

I am an advocate for equal rights. Nobody's gain should be another's loss. Some men are terrible scoundrels (and ought to be rightfully condemned and held accountable for their behaviors), but many men are not. It's tempting to paint all men with the same brush because it's intellectually easy, but it's sloppy and hurtful to the rest of us to be lumped in with the scoundrels.

I think we're going to be facing a crisis in the very near future when it comes to men. You need not look any further than college and university enrollment these days. Men account for only 40% of university students these days and that number is dropping at an alarming rate. In fact, it has been accelerating lately. I wouldn't be surprised if it became 70% women and 30% men by the end of the decade, with a majority of men coming from international students. If this trend continues for a decade, there is going to be an increasing labor shortage of men and that will leave a lot of disaffected and disgruntled men in society — and if history is an indicator, that never leads to good outcomes.

We need to take care of men and treasure them too. We all matter. Nobody should be sidelined because of their gender, sexual orientation or skin color.

- I think one (of many) issue stems from the societal custom of men having to be the initiators of any relationship. I may just be talking from my personal experience, but I think facing rejection from the opposite sex can be seen as the catalyst of a life of self-doubt. Again, this is just my experience, but I constantly look back on my early life and keep trying to figure out where things went wrong. And one incident I keep coming back to was a very harsh rejection in second grade. And while that might sound silly, I think that might have injected me with the notion that there are people who have no desire to be with me. Similarly, I had a next door neighbor who was a girl (we were both kids), and eventually as we got older there was always an excuse for why I couldn't come over on that particular day. Took me a long time to get the hint, but once again it made me feel unwanted.

Since then I've gone my whole life without trying to initiate any relationship or friendship. It's like I touched the stove, got burnt, and knew not to do it again. And in that time, I've never had a girl "pursue" me. Or learn that someone was attracted to me. Outside my own family, I get no sense that anyone actually cares that I exist. Contrast that with most women who are constantly being sought out. They're in a position to turn people away. Meanwhile I feel like I would have to create a persona to draw any interest my way. I'd have to dress a certain way, or make a certain amount of money, or have a great set of jokes at my disposal. It's performance anxiety. When I leave the house, I have to pretend I'm all the things that society thinks a man should be. But the truth is, I hate beer, I don't know anything about cars and think football is boring. I actively have to avoid any situation where any of those things come up!

One year when I was in Disney World, and this girl that passed by complimented a Zelda shirt I was wearing. I'm still riding that high years later, since it's the only time I can remember my outfit being complimented by a girl. And that leads to another issue where girls can't give compliments, or be nice to a guy without looking like they're leading them on. And guys can't compliment guys because that would be "gay". But I don't want to digress.

Oddly enough, I've come to accept my life of solitude. As they say, you can become your own best friend. Is it the correct mentality to have? I don't know, but it's working for me.

- The unfortunate fact is nobody ever paid attention to men's mental health. Mental health care for both genders has always been poor. Men are just late to the game in learning how to embrace it.

Men in particular are taught to hide their emotions it's an ancient trope. I'd like to say it really kicks in during middle school socially but younger when it comes to them dealing with their parents.

Those that are emotional and caring in middle school get eaten alive. From that age on they learn to suppress their emotions. It's only with recent generations that more and more men are acknowledging theirs a problem. We don't know how to deal with it but the first step is acknowledgement.

I'm 26. I'm very close with my mother, and my step Dad (military background) he treated me like his own. I'm naturally a more emotional individual and my mother knew that growing up but I tried so hard in my younger years to suppress it because it's weak. Holds you back. Men are taught to push through and don't let emotions hold you back at all. If it wasn't for my accepting and loving mother I'd be emotionally cut off completely. But I'm not and I'm learning how to handle them.

My mother is divorced from my step dad now. I've been at my Mom's side as she has had to navigate dating in her 50s and I talk to all her friends which are doing the same. Men in their 50s are all almost completely emotionally inept. They don't clue in at all to how their partners feel. They can't seem to grasp the emotions they feel towards their partners. They don't understand the emotions they feel when they love their partner, they don't know how to cope with being hurt. They respond in an extremely emotional manner without even realizing they are. The older generation is an example of men that are 100% emotional incompetent. It's truly sad seeing my mother struggle. Her friends have a tough time too. Asking for the bare basics of respect isn't even possible.

On the other end I feel we have a crisis with the new generation. They are gonna be just as broken in other ways. Unable to develop relationships at all. Social media is breaking them and their ability for human communication. They aren't able to truly feel emotions because they aren't actually experiencing reality. But rather this fiction they live online.

- I typed this all out and I should mention she's Canadian and I'm American, so there's distance involved.

There are nights I don't want to talk to anyone, and I get guilt tripped into having a shitty, lopsided conversation where despite being the one who wanted to talk, she ends up being quiet while I lead the conversation the entire time. I try to fill the void with stories of when I was a boy

scout or some of the shit I used to get into as a kid so she doesn't have to talk as much. Then when I want to go to sleep she acts like I said I hate talking to her and gets all pouty.

Then when we do talk about our emotions she tells me how stressed she is but doesn't do anything to make it better. She doesn't see a therapist, doesn't take the medication she has and is ashamed of sometimes needing it for some reason, she doesn't have a healthy outlet except for the gym like 1 or 2 times a week.

I suffer from very bad anxiety and panic attacks but I've been seeing a therapist and taking meds for 8 years and it's helped tremendously. When I suggest either of those two she gets mad because she "tried therapy, it made me uncomfortable and I didn't go back for a third time". Then I get upset because I know a big part of therapy is finding the right shrink and sticking with it for awhile. She refuses to.

I didn't mean to type a paragraph but I'm honestly at the end of my wits with the nightly call of her telling me she's unhappy with no plans of trying to fix the unhappiness
- So recently the results of a study among college students in the Netherlands were published. It showed that 75% was feeling lonely during the pandemic and 25% were even feeling either suicidal or "levensmoe" (tired of living).

It also said that especially men were struggling with their mental health (though it didn't give numbers).

I found it very disturbing that 1 in 4 young men wouldn't care if they woke up tomorrow. If not more.

The problem is that we are starting to be more open about mental health but are really struggling with how to actually deal with it.

If anyone is feeling like they are done with it. Please reach out to someone. Anyone. Because you do matter, and people do care about you even if you can't always see it.
- It's 100% an issue and the root cause, despite being a buzzword these days, is toxic masculinity.

People often misunderstand this phrase thinking it means that being a man is bad, or that embracing manhood or masculinity is "toxic" when that isn't it at all.

Toxic masculinity is a socialization that happens to men from when they are children - many of us can trace the moment to when we were 7 or 8 and up until that point had been allowed to be our unabashed selves. Then we squeal for some reason and a parent, mother or father, or a grandparent, says "don't scream, you sound like a girl" and suddenly your relationship to the world and everyone around you starts to change. We are taught to repress, to not be expressive, and this is policed by both the men and women in our lives.

There's also a simultaneous socialization. Men are often socialized into believing they will "inherit the earth". That anything is possible, all you have to do is want it or work for it. You can be anything, you will earn lots of money, you'll have a beautiful girl. Or at least, we'll be our own decision-makers, in control of our own destiny. When we grow up, we realize that isn't always the case and it sometimes breeds resentment. Resentment towards those who have what we don't, real visceral confusion at the fact that life didn't pan out the way we were promised, an inability or unwillingness to accept restrictions from bosses, spouses, leaders as a show of our ability to at least control ourselves.

Mixed with the emotional repression, it's a powder keg that explodes into suicidality, substance abuse, criminality, and violence. At the very best, it leads to the type of emptiness you described in your post.

For me, we need better conversations about toxic masculinity. Men are the primary victims of toxic masculinity. Yes, it's important to talk about the ways others are victimized by men, but in order to solve those problems, we have to get to the root cause and support men themselves because we are hurting. And as the playground saying goes, hurt people hurt people. We also have to acknowledge the role women play in enforcing toxic masculinity - mothers raise men with toxic masculinity as much as fathers; friends and girlfriends reinforce expectations around wage-earning, masculinity, dominance, emotions, even height.

Toxic masculinity isn't going to be solved just by asking men to do better. We all need to do better to understand and reckon with the way we socialize and interact with men. Boys need to be supported to be themselves throughout their children and adolescence, to be encouraged to open up and connect on an emotional level. Men also need to have the freedom to express themselves without being ridiculed by friends, parents, coworkers, or their romantic partners. Men need a whole lot of therapy to undo the damage that has been done but just as you can't solve racism by just talking to people of color, you can't solve this issue without talking to women, to parents, to institutions, and employers, and everyone who interacts with men.

In my life and career, I've met with a number of boys and men dealing with issues like the above: suicidality, criminality, domestic violence. They all exhibited one or a combination of many common traits: abused as children, repressed homosexuality, low-income employment, employment in a dominance industry (military), trauma (including military trauma). We can think of these as separate issues leading to separate outcomes in individuals, or we can start to understand that the ways men process some of these adverse experiences is a direct result of the way they have been socialized to process their experiences.

That whether a man is dealing with childhood sexual abuse, with repressed homosexuality, or PTSD from war, that their inability to process in a healthy way, to seek and accept support, to open up and connect on an emotional level, to recognize their intrinsic worth as a human rather than dwell on their "failure" as a "man", is all related to the way we raise our boys and the way that we reinforce gendered expectations with the men in all of our lives.

Let's reframe the narrative on toxic masculinity. Men are dying. Those who aren't dying are hurting themselves and others. Men aren't the enemy, they are a 6 year old boy humiliated by his grandfather at a family event for squealing with excitement.

- Yeah, our society has a serious problem with a lack of mental health help in general.

Unfortunately, that seems to affect men more than women because men are told to just "suck it up." My dad "sucked it up" by drinking and doing drugs, which made him mean and abusive. Now, he's in his 60's and is losing his mind. He apparently got put on bipolar meds when I was young, but he didn't like them bc he couldn't work and it made him into a zombie. So, there's also a huge distrust toward therapists and psychiatrists, too. I mean, my dad lived when insane asylums were dispicable.

I've met a lot of guys who are more comfortable sharing their feelings, but my sample size is very small.

We need to encourage men and boys to talk about their feelings without feeling weak or pathetic. Because I think that's a HUGE reason why domestic abuse is still so prevalent in our society. People tend to take out their anger in unhealthy, harmful ways. I don't know how to fix this, either, but I'm glad you started a conversation about it, OP.

Title: mentioning mental health in SOP?

Post Text: hey all. I finally came across that paper about the "kisses of death" in graduate school applications, but I think I remember seeing a comment on a separate post about how it is outdated.

I was wondering if anyone has insight on whether mentioning mental health struggles — and the fact that this is what led to your interests — significantly negatively impacts your ability to be accepted into a program.

Specifically, I'm in neuroscience, and my interest is deeply rooted in the fact that I've dealt with mental health issues + wanting to understand the mechanisms behind my specific disorders. (That's why I initially became interested, not the sole/main reason I am pursuing neuroscience.)

In my SOP, I mentioned that reasoning. Specifically in regard to ADHD. I also mentioned that ADHD is a disability for me — I did this because they often "encourage students with disabilities to apply" or whatever. I didn't think about the fact that it may be seen as a big detriment in my ability to succeed as a graduate student. I know almost for a fact that my LoR are strong and will support that I can and will be successful in graduate school, but I'm worried they won't be able to see past the fact that I have mentioned that I deal with mental health issues.

I know that the stigma around mental health has significantly improved over the past 15+ years, but I don't know if it still hurts your application.

So far I have gotten 1 rejection and nothing from 4 others (3 of which have sent interviews to at least some people so far). I know everyone is worrying probably too much and reading too

many updates online, but I am interested in hearing if this is generally still an issue. I also know I can't change anything now, but would like to know when/if I apply in the future. Thanks!

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Hm, it's tricky. While your mental health/neurodivergence is an important part of why you want to pursue grad school, it's also basically admitting that you may struggle more with the grad school environment. Grad school is structured (or rather has a lack of structure) in a way that can be extra challenging for folks with ADHD and it might make programs a bit hesitant to take a risk on you. Should it be that way? Absolutely not. I have many colleagues with ADHD and PhDs. Could I see an admissions committee wanting to minimize risk and seeing that as a red flag? Unfortunately yes, it could happen.

- Umm def don't think it's the best move. No point in taking risks, you have no idea who will be the person reading your statements and what kind of person they are.

And honestly, not to be harsh, it's not a super original thing. I wouldn't waste my word count on something a lot of other applicants probably mention. That being said, since a lot people do it, it's probably not like it's suicide or anything.

I have mental health issues and want to keep them under wraps. While they know we're human, I wouldn't want to advertise anything that could jeopardize my capabilities as a researcher. I'm trying to sell myself

Good luck, hope you get acceptances

- Kisses of death is almost 20 years old. Relies on data from 23+ years. Only talked to 80 people. It's a dumbass paper and shouldn't have been published.

Mental health is relevant in two ways. One of which is about accounting for issues in your packet. The other is (maybe) if it's related to the degree. This is tricky because some places don't like that and some do.

There are a lot of reasons why people care about what they do. Those aren't bad at all. The issue is making sure you aren't painting yourself into a theoretical corner. You want to express dynamic capacity and niche interests, which is a tricky line to walk. Talking about hyper-specific personal interests makes that harder.

If you want to talk about it, conventional wisdom is to tie it into a supplementary statement and/or explaining oddities in your packet.

- For one of my reach schools, I discussed my sobriety and how it has allowed me to succeed academically in my SOP. I made no mention of mental health struggles, but focused only on the positives of sobriety. I recognized that was risky, but it was just a reach school. I somehow ended up on the waitlist for Cornell, which totally shocked me that they would like my application that much. But I also have several years of research experience under my belt so I feel like the SOP is only one small part of the bigger picture for an application. All I can say is if you disclose, focus only on the positives

- Hi! I was in a very very similar situation. I am in psychology, and I grew up with Tourettes, and my first research position was in a lab studying tourette's. so it's super super important for the development of my professional goals. When I wrote my SOP, my advisor (a very well respected/experienced researcher) mentioned that it was a risk. But I kept it in, because I am a stubborn person who wants to be proud of my disability (although I recognize that mental health is still stigmatized). My PIs recommendation was to leave it in, but he told me in his letter of rec he would mention that that was part of my journey but you wouldn't be able to tell by working with me. Obviously I don't know if he actually did that, because I can't see his LOR, but that was his recommendation at least.

I think as long as you mention it and discuss the positives of it and how it has shaped you as an academic that it is okay, but don't dwell on it. I would really try to point out how this disability uniquely impacts your story and career. Talk about how, in the past, it inspired you to start this career, but there's obviously other factors that also influence you to continue down this career path that you should then emphasize.

For example, I used my disorder as the opening to my SOP. This a quote from the end of that section that I think really sums up how I tried to frame my story. "What started as a field that I was involuntarily thrown into transformed into a fascination with cognitive psychology, programming, research, and a career path that I eagerly aim to pursue"

Truthfully, having to do all this is really annoying, but I hope we will see a future where we aren't expected to downplay our lived experiences.

- Neuro major here, I'm in PhD. Since most people in PhD are suffering through their own struggles mentally. I do not think that is a good move, also the hiring committee look for people who do not have complains on their mental health because PhD is technically full time job. I do understand that mental health is one of the major issues, but I do not even think it's tricky to mention them. However, if some events led you to have an issue and how you overcame can be a better thing to focus on.

- I feel like a lot of ppl are against this, but I think in your case it could be helpful to talk about if it's a part of your story. You can also mention how you've overcome certain struggles to show growth and also to demonstrate how it wouldn't be a problem in grad school

I talked about my mental health struggles very briefly in my SOP for my master's apps bc I think it was an important part of how and why I got to where I am, and I also wanted to explain why my grades sucked at first and how I had improved. I don't think it harmed my application in any way

- To be honest, it is a bad idea and it depends sort of what disorder we are talking about. The stigma surrounds your ability to complete a PhD and also whether you are doing it for the right reasons even if it's not your primary reason. I'm not trying to diminish your motivation and experiences but a personal statement should always stay focused on your research ability. Mentioning your history with mental health does lend to that. Maybe if this were a PsyD or clinical psych PhD, it would be relevant but not a neuro phd

- Saw this kind of late. While I totally agree that sharing mental health issues in application can seem concerning on the school side, I just want to say it's maybe not that negative according to my experience so far.

I'm not sure if I will eventually get in and whether my experience could apply to other people. I have a very similar background as you: My mental health issue was exactly the reason I decided to devote myself to neuroscience research and my current project. I changed my path from business to neuroscience post-bac to find the neural mechanism underlying depression. I not only put this in my intro of my SoP and in my first interviews to explain why I'm here and how it has shaped my trajectory so far, I also mentioned it during the interviews when I painted the picture of my future research and career with all 3 of my interviewers. I guess the result was positive because I got an invite for the second round lol. I also got an invite from another school too.

That said, I don't think all school can accept this. I don't know if it's just a coincidence, but all the invites I got happened to be from the west coast. Another more plausible reason could just be those are the programs I fit in the most. The school that sent me invites are also those that have ongoing research about depression too(though in my SoP I specified I opened up my interest to include all neural circuits underlying cognitive and motivated behaviors after my research experience). So, I guess we'll just need to face the truth that when our motivations are very specific, so are the schools that we can fit in. But it's not a bad thing, if the school can accept and appreciate the worst of us, it's definitely where we can thrive in, since we won't need to hide "that part" of us even for a little bit.

Title: Gambling is a global health issue, and its impact is getting worse - gambling-related harms include physical and mental health problems, suicide, domestic violence, crime and financial losses, with many people now carrying a "casino in their pocket" as mobile phone gambling options continue to grow.

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Gambling is a science for those making money off of people. They have figured out how to wire your brain for addiction to this. It's very similar to getting a person addicted to drugs.

<https://www.menshealth.com/uk/mental-strength/a42175202/gambling-signs-of-addiction/>

<https://stanford.edu/group/spanlab/Press/bk1101press.html>

<https://www.uclahealth.org/news/article/gambling-addiction-can-cause-psychological-physiological-health-challenges>

- I've linked to the news release in the post above. In this comment, for those interested, here's the link to the peer reviewed journal article:

[https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lanpub/article/PIIS2468-2667\(24\)00167-1/fulltext](https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lanpub/article/PIIS2468-2667(24)00167-1/fulltext)

From the linked article:

International and Australian researchers are calling for greater worldwide regulation of the gambling industry, which they say is posing an increasing risk to health and wellbeing. The team of experts reviewed existing research on gambling, and say gambling-related harms including physical and mental health problems, suicide, domestic violence, crime and financial losses are likely underestimated, with so many people now carrying a “casino in their pocket” as mobile phone gambling options continue to grow. The researchers say online gambling is likely having a disproportionate impact on teens, with more and more sophisticated marketing and technology available to reel people in and keep them gambling. The Australian researchers involved say better regulation is needed particularly in Australia, which spends more per head on gambling than any other country.

- Several ways to reduce harm (because you will NEVER be able to fully enforce prohibition of gambling):

1. Any gambling service must clearly represent the odds of winning and the average you will lose over time that is readily visible on every single game for the full duration that a player is playing.
2. No advertising of gambling apps/sites/locations.
3. Limit repeated buy-in's per day.
4. Outlaw credit based buy-in's.
5. Mandatory referral of people who are recognized as potential addicts to a network of counselors that are fully funded by gambling profits. Cost of rehab/therapy is free to the addict if they choose to accept it.
6. Percentage of gambling profits made by casinos are used to fund anti-gambling educational advertisements.

Title: YSK: If you are having ongoing issues with mental health, you can take your guns into any gunsmith for a cleaning and they will hold them as long as you need as an unspoken courtesy.

Post Text: Why ysk: there are a lot of people out there who own a gun but don't have anyone to give it to during times of crisis.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- YSK: if you are having ongoing issues with your mental health, you shouldn't own a gun
- How about if you have ongoing mental health issues you just don't have a gun?
- Just be careful and visit a dr you can trust, in places like NY and CA if you visit a mental health professional you can have your guns confiscated.
- Perhaps if you're having ongoing mental health issues you shouldn't have guns...

- How fucked up is this? Plus, if I had mental health issues, I don't think I'd be taking my guns into the gunsmith to keep an eye on them.
- Many shops also participate in the hold my gun program. A no questions asked service to hang onto your guns for a small fee. This could be for going on vacation, having children in the house, or mental health.
- This is an exceptionally American problem.

If you want guns you go through psychological screening. And if your mental health declines and they don't revoke your license as a hunter or member of a shooting club you'd just give give the key to that mandatory special gun safe you have to store them in to a trusted person.

But I guess we only have these precautions because we love detailed rules and safety laws. Or because our weakling constitution is based on protecting the people from the might of the state instead of allowing us firearms to each fend for ourselves in case of basically anything.

- What if the gunsmith is having mental health issues? Are they simply not allowed to have mental health issues? Are they guaranteed to never have mental health issues? I need answers!
- I thought you couldn't own guns if you have mental health issues. At least in America.
- Perhaps give the gun away or not have one. How are people with mental health issues allowed guns.

Title: My sister needs mental health help - what can I do?

Post Text: My sister needs mental health help and I don't know where to start. She is 41. She's been diagnosed with borderline personality disorder, PTSD, trichotillomania, anxiety and depression.

She can't hold down a job – any job. She can't form or maintain friendships or life partners because her personality is so erratic. She's prone to emotional outburst and does not acknowledge that her actions affect others. She lies, steals, and self-medicates with cannabis and alcohol.

I watched her grow up and change from a sweetheart to a cold, bitter person. My parents were abusive and she went through a few abusive dating relationships as well. In 10 years, I'm afraid she's going to be homeless or end up in a state run mental hospital.

I think she needs long-term, inpatient, cognitive behavior therapy at a residential facility. I don't know how to go about finding a care center. She isn't suicidal which seems to be criteria for being accepted by these facilities. I also don't think she would need a involuntary hold or anything. Most places seem to be aimed at teenagers.

I don't want her to be in a place where she feels punished, like having restrictions on her possessions. I want her to get help for addictions, but the borderline personality and PTSD are more pressing issues.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

Title: I hate my younger sister who is suffering from depression and mental health issues.

Post Text: I know, the title would make the many of you immediately judge me, however, please bear with me and listen to my story first.

My family is a religious and traditional family so with that said, mental health is not taken seriously. No one's mental health was taken seriously until my third youngest sister started showing symptoms of depression.

I was one of the first to notice the symptoms and slowly but surely I tried helping her address her worries and anything that's on her mind. She was thankful but it never truly hit the core of the problems. I understood and asked for help.

Me and my older siblings finally managed to convince the elders in the family that her mental health is a serious issue and that it must be dealt with as soon as possible to ensure that she can at least live a life without carrying traumas throughout her adulthood like the rest of us did. It worked.

EVERYONE pitched in for all kinds of therapy. Many of us felt jealous and I will not hide that fact because our parents and elders never batted an eye when we were suffering through depression so seeing her get the help she needed and wanted was truly a great progress.

She wanted to be comfortable with her therapist so we went through rigorous process to select therapists that would and could help her. We tried everything. All types of therapy. Different people. EVERYTHING you can imagine. But it never worked.

She says that we don't love her, so we made sure to plan time with her and randomly visit her from time to time since we weren't just "hanging out" with her just because she's suffering from depression. We wanted her to be in our presence. We took her to places she wanted to visit.

After 3 whole year of paying for her therapy, giving her family time, personal time, and just making sure she's seen and heard there was no progress We all know that mental health isn't something that can be "cured" but there where was no progress at all. Nothing. No changes. Not a single day where she would be enjoying her time.

In my second year of college, that's when she started using her mental health to hurt everyone. Any conversation with her will lead to arguments. Something as simple as asking if she wanted to go to the arcade with us will end up in an argument about why we're pressuring her and that the we're placing high standards on her. Asking if she wanted to eat anything will lead to "stop making me eat and trying to act like you care."

I am not an emotional person, and by that I don't mean that I don't cry but it's more of not really expressing my emotions as much as others. However, there was a day she was talking to me

about dreams and goals and she asked me what I wanted to do in the future. Now, the goal I told her was a little silly and not impossible to achieve but will take time to get there. I was shy about admitting that that goal was something I wanted to achieve and she laughed.

"I don't see those qualities in you." And man.... did those words hurt me so much. I still remember it to this day. Now, usually I'd just ignore it but I trusted her and this goal was very special to be so hearing her say that broke my heart. I told her that what she said hurts my feelings and expanded on "if you don't have anything nice to say, don't say it." She brushed it off as me being sensitive, which yes I did cry only and especially when my family members say these hurtful words to me. She was the first to make me feel so damn insecure. Again, I told her that there is no need to shoot down people's dreams and goals but that only escalated to an argument of "i'm just stating the facts" and "don't take this to heart." I was hurt and left her alone after that.

After that,, she attempted suicide. Twice. Everyone was at her beck and call because it was not only heartbreaking to witness her in that moment but she's not getting better. At all. She was sent to a psychiatric hospital, which was what she wanted after refusing to go to school and CPS had to go and talk with our father.

Another two years pass and therapy isn't helping. Nothing is helping. "If you want to talk to ghosts so much go talk to them" will always be her 'logical statement' she uses. "You don't understand my struggles. No one cares. No one loves me. Everyone is pressuring me." These are the phrases I always hear any time anyone wants to help or even communicate with her.

I don't know -- no one knows -- what to do anymore. After almost a total of 6 years, we gave up on therapy. Whatever happens happens. She refuses to stay with a close Aunt in the countryside which she asked for but now refuses to, demanding that if we don't understand her no one will.

So, during my Summer Break in college, I returned home. I've never EVER once had a serious or heated argument with any of my siblings before, but this time, I was yelling at her, however, now that her mental health has truly come into light... I am always getting the short end of the stick. No one can talk to her. No one can have a civil conversation with her. Anytime you say anything that she does not like, an argument will ensue.

"No, you cannot go and berate someone who is telling you that you hurt their feelings." Which would lead to "I am much more mature than all of you! You don't know anything!"

So, being the much more sensitive person that I am, I was forced to be the "good girl" and by this i meant all throughout the 6-7 years that she was struggling, I had to be lenient and "understanding".

"Be the bigger person." "You're an adult so stop it." "Why are you crying and acting like a little kid?" "Her mental health is more important." "We don't understand her so leave her be." "Just let it go." All because she keeps using her mental health for every conversation.

I don't know if this is considered trauma but it has really gotten to me. My younger sister will make me argue with her one way or another and if I ignore her I'm the hateful person here.

I'm so tired. Never have I ever hated someone so much, especially when they're suffering with depression. Your mental health does not excuse anyone from being a horrible person. I hate her. And I hope she sees and experience the consequences of her words and actions. I hate her so much.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Thank you for for sharing. A reminder: if you are seeking resources in your local area, please provide that in the post so that users can share appropriate links and phone numbers. *If you are in distress, please call 9-1-1* or your local emergency number. *You are not alone. Help is available.* If you are having suicidal thoughts, please [click here for a list of crisis support services.](<http://www.suicide.org/international-suicide-hotlines.html>), If you are seeking therapy online, please [click here for a list of counselling services.](<https://thelifelinecanada.ca/pattern-interrupt/ecounselling/>) *If you feel well enough to do so, please do your part to enrich this community.* Now that you have posted, please leave a constructive, helpful comment on someone else's post. Filter by new to find posts with zero comments. Together, we make this community great. Thank you for being here.

I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit](/message/compose/?to=/r/mentalhealth) if you have any questions or concerns.

- One thing I think a lot of people don't understand about DEEP DEEP depression is that not only does it make you a miserable cynic, it makes you spread that miserable misanthropy as-much as possible to the greatest extent possible in each interpersonal interaction. Because you believe yourself to be a burden and that people would be better off without you, you act in a manner that makes that script going through your brain true, even though your friends and family do not see it this way. Make no mistake your reaction is exactly the reaction that the disease wants from the people closest to the infected. The more of a miserable and combative fuck you are with the people around you that love you and are trying to help you, the more the script in your head turns out to be right and the more you create a self fulfilling prophesy. YOU WANT PEOPLE TO HATE YOU, you want them to leave and abandon you, because you are so ugly and evil, untrustworthy and unworthy of existing that the best thing you can do is be an unrelenting asshole and drive them as far from you as possible. So, when you finally do escape off this mortal coil, courtesy your own hand it will come as a relief to those around you. Just my 2cents from dealing with suicidal depression, every situation and person is different.

- At this rate, after I read everything that you have written, she is using her mental health issues as an advantage to hurt everyone. She is too unhealthy for you. You did everything you could to help her and she just flat out refused to improve herself. I would let her know upfront that you

wish her the best in life and hope that she can get the help that she can get, but you can no longer help her. After that, go no contact with her. She is just toxic in general. She thinks her feelings are more important than everyone else's, yet she is so quick to shut down anyone that is trying to help her

As a person with BPD as well as NPD, she needs to do what I do if I know that I legitimately screwed up: she needs to take accountability for her actions especially when it comes to saying hurtful things, yet it doesn't sound like that she is willing to do any of those. She thinks it's OK to be in her feelings but not everyone else.

Go no contact with her, and the whole family if possible, and keep living life.

- I understand what you're saying and you're not horrible for thinking this way. Mental illness is not a way to get away with being terrible like you said. Now of course certain illnesses can affect you to be prone to hurting people's feelings but it seems like she has no guilt or remorse. I would wonder if she has something besides depression going on. A personality disorder of some kind.

There is a name for being a sibling or child of someone who is Sick and their needs being neglected because of this person. Caregiver fatigue also comes to mind. I think they talk about it in My Sisters Keeper. It's about cancer and a bit more literal in taking things from the younger sibling. But your sister has taken pieces from you mentally and emotionally. You've given her so much and she can't even admit it or even show that she knows she hurt you.

Anyway I am surprised her physician or therapist hasn't suggested there is something else going on besides depression especially if the current treatment isn't working. Like a personality disorder which I really think might be part of the issue. Not a doctor or diagnosing but borderline personality disorder seems like it could be it. Because it seems a bit attention seeking and somehow narcissistic and depressed at the same time. Like I'm not saying all mental illness and having depression is attention seeking and will fight against people saying that. But for her to push these behaviors so long and after you tried to pull away she tried something drastic to get your attention again.

I feel like arguing with her feeds her. Maybe don't react to her at all. Just nod and say 'uhuh'. She will most likely try and be even more hurtful but try your best to ignore it. This is a thought. Kind of like ignoring a bully or teasing. You may talk to a therapist yourself about her to try and understand what is going on. But I could also see the logic in just not seeing her anymore. It's understandable if you can't handle her treatment of you.

- Depression probably isn't the issue. She needs to be evaluated. She doesn't sound like a good person. I'm sorry you have to put up with her.

- yeah you have every right to hate her, she is using her mental health as an excuse to be nasty towards you. i dont think she understands her worries about not being loved or cared about will be true if she keeps up how she treats the people that care about her.

i am also curious, has she tried medications? sometimes therapy doesnt cut it and you just need some good ol meds.

- I'm 40 and my sister is 32. You've described my life. It's not you. You can't help people who don't want to be helped. It's like dealing with a drug addict. You have your own life don't let it be ruined by this— my heart now breaks for my sibling and my parent but I've had to learn to separate the person who is always angry for no reason from the sibling I had hoped to have and accept that I'm not going to ever have that. And I support my parents as best I can because this is nothing short of devastating for any parent. Take care of you first- you may have to take care of your parents one day if she really breaks their hearts- be sure you're in a good place if you need to be and maybe get some therapy for yourself. But yeah— she's using it to manipulate everyone because she knows the can- 1000%- what that stems from a professional needs to diagnose

Title: AITA for calling my friend a 'creepy weirdo' after she posted a TikTok about my husband?

Post Text: UPDATE: I don't wanna make another post for the same thing and I doubt I'm gonna be updating again.

1. My husband's practice reached out to Raya's parents and informed them about the situation via an email (as they wanted everything documented), like I mentioned in the comments. The parents have responded. They are shocked and very, very apologetic. They have agreed to chaperone Raya on her appointments instead of June. They wanted to meet my husband personally to apologise but he informed them that that won't be necessary.

2. June's TikTok video is still in the process of being taken down. No new updates on that. I guess she contested the reports or something. I'm not entirely sure. My husband and I have blocked her. My brother is keeping an eye on her account tho, just in case she posts something else about us. We'll see what to do if/when it happens. We're gonna be consulting a lawyer if she bothers us again in the future.

3. My husband is kinda shaken up/upset/annoyed about this whole thing. He's taken some days off from work and so have I. We'll plan a trip somewhere maybe, to take his mind off of these things. Right now, I need to be there for him. I won't be posting anything for now.

4. We haven't contacted her boyfriend yet. My husband is not in the right headspace right now and I feel it'll be better if we focus on ourselves for the time being. We don't want the added headache of how the boyfriend will react/if he's in on this or whatever. We'll inform him after some time. I know this is selfish but I think it's for the best.

Thankyou all for the responses :)

I (28F) am friends with this girl, let's call her June (also 28F). Infact, my husband (32M) and I often hang out with June and her boyfriend; i.e go on double dates, have weekend trips etc. We've known each other for over two years. I would say that we four were pretty tight as a group, up until this weekend.

My husband is a orthodontist. One of his patients is June's half sister, Raya (12F). June often is the one accompanying Raya to her dental appointments. June is also a small time online 'influencer'. She's always recording and vlogging and stuff. Though my husband and I have made it clear to her and we're absolutely not okay with our faces in her vlogs online and she seemed to respect that boundary. We don't use social media (apart from Reddit), and we trusted her word when she said she's not gonna post us online.

Cut to last weekend, my brother sent me this TikTok link with the message 'Dude you gotta watch this'. I opened the link and it directed me to June's TikTok account. She doesn't have much followers (less than 10k) but the particular video he sent me had like half a million views/likes (I'm not sure which). Lo and behold, it was a video compilation of my husband with the title 'God I see what you've done for others'.

The video was honestly the creepiest thing I've ever seen. She had recorded my husband during various of our double dates together, and it was clear he wasn't even aware he's being recorded. In some of the clips, she would start with her face and then pan the camera towards my husband with a 'cutesy' expression and mouthing words like 'oh my god'. The worst one was where he was working on her half sister, Raya, wearing scrubs and she'd recorded EVEN that. She didn't even bother to blur out the kid's face while she was lying on the dental chair.

I showed the video to my husband and he was HORRIFIED. He said it made him so uncomfortable and violated knowing that someone had been secretly recording him. He was angry that she'd recorded him working on a patient.

He texted her asking to take down the video and delete every video she has of him. First she feigned ignorance, then she said that she meant no harm and that it was all for 'online engagement' since, I quote, 'TikToks with hot guys go viral very fast' and that she'd gained a lot of followers after posting that.

This was all so weird but my husband and I got our families and friends to report the video and thankfully it's being taken down now. This pissed off June and she sent me a long ass text saying how I was jealous of her online success and that I couldn't stand seeing her succeed blah blah blah. I replied saying 'you're delusional and unhinged. You're not successful and you'll never be. Stay away from us, you creepy weirdo.'

Now she's all weepy and depressed and has been telling our common friends how 'mean' I was to her. She's also been posting about 'mental health' on her socials and about how mean some women are with their words lol.

AITAH?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- June's public portrayal of herself as a victim and her use of mental health discussions to garner sympathy are attempts to manipulate public opinion. Her focus on herself rather than acknowledging the real harm she caused shows a lack of accountability.
- NTA. I would have suggested that your husband reach out to Raya's parents, let them know what happened, and state that because June violated his privacy, she is no longer welcome to accompany Raya to appointments. They will need to make other arrangements.

Stress that it was both out of line to film him without consent and to post video of a patient undergoing treatment without, he assumes, Raya's consent.

- NTA. Do you feel badly that she has been bad mouthing you and using the experience and feeling of being wronged for content? Do your friends feel like you are in the wrong? Do you feel like you have been the catalyst to her experiencing a mental health crisis?
- >This pissed off June and she sent me a long ass text saying how I was jealous of her online success

I'd tell husband to tell her Raya that because of June she needs to find a new orthodontist. I wouldn't allow June anywhere near me again.

>. She's also been posting about 'mental health' on her socials and about how mean some women are with their words

I would comment

Yes the damage to someone's mental health when they are recorded without knowledge or consent

NTA

- More  than China had flags. I have watched this type of situation go horribly wrong before. It is scary.

1. Massive HIPPA violation. All medical professionals educate patients on various medical topics all the time. Personal medical history is part of that education. We don't even realize we do it.

2. I did not watch the video (obviously) but, after reading your post, it concerns me that the minor's face wasn't obscured. After all, we all know the internet is the safest place for a minor. No predators around /s. Are the parents aware??? And a 20y/o is doing it for views !!! 

3. Major disrespect happened: his privacy, your privacy, your relationship with hubby, her relationship with her boyfriend, your friendship.

4. Her behavior with recording your husband is bordering on an obsession. What is stopping her from making false claims? This has the potential to ruin his career, his reputation, your marriage (although I doubt that will happen), and his life and by extension yours. She needs help and it is not your responsibility to get her that help. Her mental health is her responsibility. Posting about it online is just attention seeking behavior and will not get her the help she needs.

I hope you are taking the appropriate security measures. Not just cutting her out of your life but actual physical security measures at home and in the office. Document everything. Do not block her but do mute her. Tell close friends and family. Get counseling if you have any hint is an issue. Talking to someone (other than Reddit) helps.

- i mean, creepy weirdo with mental health issues tracks, lol. keep her TF away you go your way she goes hers hopefully she gets the help she needs for her and society at large sake.

- NTA. You both told her, she violated the trust anyway, and you found out from someone else entirely. It may very well have been for engagement, but that doesn't matter.

You obviously have a hot husband. But if roles were reversed and she was the hot woman, & it was him doing the recording, he'd be in jail.

People do stuff that causes mental health issues when the consequences catch up, then feign that they have issues. I wouldn't trust her as far as I can throw her. I'm sure the "#mentalhealth" is all for engagement too.

- Well, she's not wrong, she DOES have mental health issues. Also, her boyfriend needs to know about her behavior.

- i would love to have chats with anyone who believes you are the asshole in this situation. having your privacy and your wishes, that were talked about and assured, violated and then further refusal to take it down for the sake of publicity, jealous of her fucking stupidity and ogling and quite frankly.. inappropriate phrases about a married man of her friend as a taken woman herself, AND THEN.. blowing up at you because she was in the wrong and talking about her mental health like this is such a rough patch in her life. some people are so delusional

- Your wording could absolutely have been more neutral, but you were in a triggered and threatened place. If you can recognize that there probably are some mental health issues for her and keep firm boundaries, maybe you won't feel the need to lash out at her again. But she absolutely needed to be told off in no uncertain terms, so NTA for doing that by any means. I am glad you were able to get the video taken down as well. Hopefully she's getting genuine mental health help and not just the social media version so she can respect your boundaries going forward.

- No your not the AH, she NEEDED that reality check. Young people these days think it's okay to use others without permissions to get themselves clout. It's one thing accidentally to have someone in the background of your video un blurred. But another thing entirely to do it multiple times and boast about getting fame from it, then attempt sympathy depression afterwards. I ask you instead to feel good about this one if you can.

Title: Yesterday was my late brother's birthday so I planted this redbud tree and started a movement called Gardening For Mental Health Day. It's every April 21st and it's to raise

awareness of the mental health benefits of gardening. I loss two brothers to suicide, so I want to help others with this.

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- As someone who has struggled with ideation for most of my life, this is a beautiful way to honor the memory of your brothers lost to this ridiculous, evil disease. Also a great way to spread awareness and acceptance for ways to fight it. Getting my hands dirty outdoors was exactly what got me through pandemic isolation and continues to be a boon to my mental health now!
- Post it on the mental health subs. Depression is a SOB to kick.
- To garden, is to hold out hope for tomorrow.. and sometimes when we struggle with mental health all we can do is our best to make it to the next day. Gardening has saved my life, I love that it brings you comfort. When I garden, I am often gardening with my grandmother, and she's been gone almost 15 years.
- It's marked in my calendar for every year. I'll be doing plenty of gardening for my mental health this year anyway. I'm so sorry for your loss. Keep your head up, we're all ROOTing for you ❤️
- Thank you for sharing your story here; I am so sorry for your losses. I think it's wonderful you have found a way to help others through your campaign. Gardening for Mental Health Day is definitely something I can get on board with and spread the message for it within my community. Cheers!
- I'm a veteran and picked up gardening just recently. It's helped my depression for sure. I don't know if the stat is still true; but not too long ago, 22 veterans in the US commit suicide. I don't want to be one of them. And it's hard
- I love this!

I hate that we're relegated to just one day. I know...I know...one day at a time.

Mental Health is such an underresourced and accepted area. The stigma, especially for males, continues to persist.

If you don't know how to deal with someone with mental health issues, or don't know what to say... the answer is compassion. Sometimes, you don't have to say anything. Just being there can make a world of difference for someone struggling.

Keep fighting the good fight! 🦊

- I wish insurance carriers recognized horticultural therapy like Europe does. It's peer reviewed and extensively studied and would do wonders for mental health every day.
- Gardening has been such an incredible part of my mental health journey! Inadvertently gardened yesterday on behalf of your brothers, and everyone who has lost their battle ❤️

Thank you for working to spread such an important message as well as a beautiful way to help heal!

- My husband and I bought our house after the previous owner died by suicide. In her memory, we planted a dwarf blue spruce tree in the back yard and strung it with sparkly solar powered lights that are up all year. When visitors ask us about the lit-up tree, we always take the time to explain that gardening is a wonderful help for many who are struggling with mental health challenges.

- Seeing this makes me so happy I re mulched my front garden bed yesterday. Been putting it off for awhile... I'm a new homeowner and feeling so lost on the gardening aspect of it. My dad was the green thumb in our family and he passed in 2019, so I never got to ask these questions while managing my own garden now. But I do what I can and whenever i get out there I feel closer to him and it is so therapeutic. Every 4/21 in my calendar now is Gardening for Mental Health day. ❤️ thank you for sharing this wonderful idea with all of us.

- We have a garden within us too. With proper diet and hydration and electrolytes, I have cured my clinical depression. I do not eat sugar, dairy, or carbonated synthetic drinks. I do not eat artificial sweeteners, carbs , or processed foods. I have grown into quite the 🌹. Here's hoping your garden with be fruitful.

- That's a wonderful thing you're doing! I'm sorry for your loss but glad you're making something beautiful grow out of it.

Reminds me of a frustrating story. Decades ago I worked at a State mental Hospital. Many residents were there permanently or at least for extended periods. At one time the patients helped garden (on a voluntary basis) the flower beds on the 100+ acre campus of the sprawling facility. Then someone felt they were being used as labor, laws were enacted and the flower beds went away and there was grass and professional lawn care people and no more communing with nature. So I hope your movement takes off and "gardening therapy" takes off.

Amazing things happen as you weed or plant or water or pick with someone in a garden. Suddenly some people can talk more easily. They're relaxed and it isn't as threatening and formal as an office. Similar happens for some people with horses or dogs or music or art. I think gardening is art and life springing sorta out of nothing. Anyway what you're doing is wonderful and I hope it brings you and many others many many hours of peace and joy.

- Spent my evening with my plants last night. Even planted a hydrangea. Definitely helps with mental health

- I truly agree that gardening helps to cope with grief ,mental anguish and depression. It's a great coping mechanism that I accidentally came across which helped me tremendously to keep myself busy and escape the mental breakdown. Now I look forward for my plants to grow and get amazed when a new bud springs along, when I see the roots sprout etc. I encourage people to do some gardening for mental peace

- I'm so sorry for your loss. I lost my sister to suicide many years ago and have struggled with depression my whole life. Discovered gardening a couple years before the pandemic and it really does do wonders for the soul. Winter is brutal. I need to move where I can garden year round lol

- Gardening or working with plants is like meditation and has helped me deal with the stresses in my life with my brothers health

- What a beautiful idea! From watching my UK gardening shows they are so much farther ahead in prescribing time outdoors and community gardening to improve mental health. We need to do more in North America to promote gardening as a tool for well being. I'm a day late but I will be hitting up the garden centre today!

- I garden for mental health!!! Definitely will remember this! Happy Earth Day all!

- This is such a beautiful tribute and wonderful movement! This is why I garden, for my mental health. Even pulling weeds with my bare hands can help me. You are doing a great thing.

- It is loving to see people trying to improve awareness on mental health and kudo to you OP, especially to overcome such a painful experience.

I would love to learn more about gardening, but sadly, we don't have the space where I live.

Completely off topic the first time I read your post, I read as "yesterday I was late to my brother's birthday, so I planted this rebud..." and thought "why the fuck you make yourself even later, by stoping to do gardening".

Wish you the Best op.

- Cool man. April 19th 1998 my brother took his life his birthday is in august. My dad took his own life in 1988. Both bipolar, my dad was never diagnosed because it was a little bit before that diagnose was even a thing, but my brother was. We have our own way of turning grief into something positive, and I always enjoy seeing stuff like this. Mental health issues affect everybody, either directly or indirectly and there's far too little attention being put on it that hasn't become politicized and used as a weapon against the very people that need the help the most.

- Gardening has helped my mental health so much, so I love this idea !!!

- I am running in a 5k for mental health awareness and suicide prevention on May 7th. Your brothers will be in my thoughts.

- Amazing. I'm an avid gardener for mental health. I lost my younger brother to suicide and feel it's important to honor his memory by advocating for mental health awareness! I'm putting this date on my calendar.

- I love this! I also garden for mental health :)

- I garden every day for mental health <3 This is a lovely thing to do for your family. I'm so sorry for your loss.

- A few months ago my son lost one of his friends to suicide, and his health(both mental and physical) declined. It was a lot worse than what I'm writing here but I'd rather not break his trust. After a lot of struggling to figure out a way to help, I gave him a plant. I told him that his plant is similar to his mental health; without proper care it won't thrive. Ignore it and it becomes difficult to care for, but give it the care it needs and it will continue to grow and evolve. He did kill a plant or two or three in the beginning but that's okay, he was still learning. As of today, my son and his plants(he now has 2) are doing really well.

Gardening for Mental Health is my kind of thing and I will gladly support it!

Edit: I am so very sorry you experienced what you did, it's hard losing family, especially siblings. Big hugs to you!

- This is amazing. I almost lost my fiancé to suicide just last week, and I've also struggled with depression. Gardening has been my therapy for the last 4 years, and it's incredibly beneficial. I sing its praises to anyone who will listen. This is a wonderful tribute to your brother.
- its an empowering movement mental health is not talked about enough and i really hope it gets so much more recognition and im so sorry for your losses.
- I didn't plant anything on the 21st, late for the party I guess, but as someone who has struggled with mental health all of his adult life I know how much I love my little garden in the terrace.

I'm going to participate next year and all of the following ones with a new diferent baby plant for my garden.

- My heart goes out to you, man.

While not suicide, my brother in law lost his life to addiction that was largely fueled by terrible mental health and man, he was just the type of guy who was so amazed by life and the way things work. He would've thought gardening and growing plants was the sickest thing ever. I wish he had been able to experience this world.

- Just wanted to pop in and say as someone who's struggled with mental health since middle school, I love this idea! I hope it gets more traction to become an actual holiday!
- Beautiful idea. Gardening has tremendously helped my mental health. I'll be thinking of you and your brothers when I plant my tomatoes 💜
- Lost my grandfather to mental health issues, and I can tell it runs in the fam. I have ADHD and being "still" just invites demons. Gardening especially makes me feel productive. I love this, my guy.
- I find great calm in pulling weeds and gardening. My mom was never real supportive of my mental health, telling me to just think positive, get off my pills so she could have grandchildren, hide my illness from friends and hide my pills.

I really got into gardening and made an awesome front yard for myself and bugs, bees and birds. She got mad at me that I let leaves from my tree just sit on the ground to compost. She laughed at me when I said I enjoy pulling weeds.

I cut contact because I couldn't take her little cuts. I love to garden. I am happier.

- Like many people, I've struggled with my mental health since I was a child. I didn't get into gardening until I was an adult and I'm so happy to have such a healthy and fulfilling hobby now. Through gardening I'm constantly learning, providing healthy food for my family and beautifying my space. It's the perfect combination of art and science to keep me interested but it's also work that provides a tangible reward and makes me feel productive while enjoying myself.
- My heart goes out to you. I started gardening for my mental health. I have always struggled with depression. It really does help.
- Gardening saved my mental health in 2021. I have a new addiction, and the only cure is photosynthesis
- I'm so sorry. I've lost one brother to suicide and my other brother has severe depression. It's such a tragic way to die. I have 5 other men in my family who have died by suicide too.

Title: If you have any serious issue, be it mental health or addiction and this thing takes off, please include someone in your team to address this issue as it will likely only worsen with money. Be healthy apes. 💎🙌🐼🚀🌙

Post Text: Good day, for my fellow apes, I myself have had struggles with mental health and what I can tell you is that some of the hardest times I've had with it were while or shortly after times in my life that I was making or had the most money I've had in my life.

Fortunately I've never chosen to partake in drugs or alcohol (legit, nothing, family history taught me otherwise.) However I've often seen that money only acts as drivers to furthering and more serious addiction.

I'll break from the typical narrative of guarantees of a moon landing given the context of this...

If this thing takes off and you find yourself in a far better position financially or hopefully quite wealthy along with hiring;

- A tax lawyer

- A financial advisor who acts as a fiduciary (financial advisor who is certified and whose primary duty is to protect you financially rather than just work as a salesman)

- A CPA

Also include seeing a mental health professional or seeking help in the case of addiction because otherwise money can tear your life apart.

When it comes to mental health I believe that part of the reason so many celebrities suffer with mental health and addictions issues which can take their life is due to the fact that they can look at their life on paper and believe that their circumstances are better than they could have ever hoped for yet they're still incapable of being happy.

When you feel this way and you can't attribute it to circumstance it is a very helpless feeling and can lead to the worst.

On top of all of the above money can also be very isolating. You may lose a large portion of your support system of friends and family. You may find from a large number of them it becomes an ultimatum of either give us \$xxxxx or we're not friends anymore.

On top of that those who may be considered peers at this stage, other people with wealth are likely to look down upon us as still to them just being apes. While they may hold prestigious positions or come from money.

So beyond the doom and gloom some things I intend to do that I'd suggest.

-Go back to school, get a degree, perhaps in business or finance to help you better understand the position you're in and perhaps grow further if you choose

-Hire a personal trainer and nutritionist, I became a gym rat for years, covid has gotten in the way but it greatly changes your outlook for the better

-Invest your money wisely and safely

I wish all my fellow ape brothers and sisters the best. Please, take care of yourselves and play this smart. There's a reason most lottery winners end up broke and why for many it utterly ruins their lives.

Once you have the opportunity ensure you brains gain a few wrinkles.

For myself, I just want to thank my fellow apes for the good times I've had thus far, the memes, the shens, the shtick and laughs. This has been a riot so far, I hope we can bring about some legitimate change and help break the choke hold and corruption that's grown within the financial and political world.



Comments Related to Mental Health:

- This has become my actual greatest source of FUD now that I'm certain of the squeeze. I'm a little lazy, overweight, and depressed now... How will having great affluence affect these things? My hope is that I will become a better person once my stress is alleviated but my hope is foremostly in my fellow apes here. I would gladly reinvest all of the money I've spent in GameStop just to belong to this community.

Just because monetary problems will disappear doesn't mean we won't still have demons. Reach out to your fellow apes.

- I'm starting a film production company to create mental health videos, helping destigmatize, while legitimizing proper nutrition and physical activity as resources anchors to lead individuals out from their suffering.

- I appreciate this post so much. As someone who's recovering from a lifetime of trauma due to alcoholic parents and a family of drug addicts, I can't stress enough how important it is to look after your mental health.

And I would suggest don't wait for the MOASS to start taking care of yourself. Do as much as you can right now. Check in with yourself, did you drink enough water today? Did you remember to eat? When's the last time you've eaten a vegetable or fruit? Get some sleep, get some sun, get some exercise, even if it's just a walk around the block.

Do not make the mistake thinking that a bunch of money will suddenly make any mental health problems you may have go away. If you're living with depression, anxiety, ADHD, BPD, etc.

you're most likely going to have to deal with that the rest of your life unfortunately. All those self care things I mentioned? Yeah, a doctor is going to ask you to start doing those things too. If you can find little ways to start dealing with it *now*, it'll prepare you for when you can actually afford to seek medical help. Stay strong apes! ❤️💪

Edit: Thanks so much for the award <3

- I started therapy on Sunday evenings on FaceTime. I have a CPA on retainer who loves what's going on with GME. He's actually my new BFF. He's a genius and I'm a tard. With our powers combined he will keep me out of prison as he will make sure I file my taxes correctly.

- Apes, in addition to mental health counseling and or rehab/medication - find your subreddit for any addiction support if that's a problem you're dealing with. R/stopspeeding and its discord has helped me tremendously. On paper, I have it all - wonderful husband, son, growing small business - but no one is safe from bad choices fueled by depression. Even after MOASS my main goal will be continued sobriety and helping others if I can. Everyday is Moon day when you're free from the stranglehold of addiction. Money won't fix the root of your issues but it will help to get proper treatment for them. Love to you all. 76 days today.

- I cannot stress this tool enough, know (roughly) how much you'll pay in capital gain taxes ifwhen the MOASS happens.

[Tax My Tendies!](<https://taxmytendies.com>)

- Thank you friend, I myself have troubles with mental health for over 10 years and I have friends that unfortunately have drug addiction. This message you are sending out is really important and I for one greatly appreciate it! For a healthy moon landing and positivity going forward! 🙏🚀

- Thank you. Great tips. One of my first plans after MOASS is to start going to therapy. I have a lot of issues I'd like to deal with and consistent therapy sessions is currently out of my price range. 🚀🚀🚀

- I'm getting my mental health specialist appointment next week so this fits in well to my schedule, hopefully I can work through my issues whilst also not having to worry about usual money things.

Stay healthy King's and Queen's, we're all family here.

- 100%. I struggle daily with near-crippling anxiety and that is going to get so addressed it'll need a zip code.

- Sign up for cerebral. Just talking to someone once a week helps work the stress out a lot. Take it from an ape who's living for the MOASS...and not much else atm.

- Therapy is very cool. Especially when you don't have to worry about expense. Apes, if you have ever thought about trying some counseling/had any issue that worries you, it's best to start NOW if you can possibly afford it. Even if you think you can't, some providers operate on a sliding scale or will otherwise work with you on costs.

Psychologytoday.com has a great search engine where you can find providers in your area based on insurance, specialty, etc.



- Money won't change how you view yourself or your life overall. Who you are at your core doesn't change with the balance in your bank account.

So it's a good idea to be working toward overall wellness all the time. A lot of employers have EAP programs where you can go to counseling for free and it's confidential. If you have insurance, your insurance covers counseling with a copay.

Most areas have community mental health counselors that charge a sliding fee based on your income.

Besides that, you've got apps like Talkspace, etc. where you can pay a small fee and talk with licensed counselors any time.

Mental health services are so much more accessible than they used to be.

- My whole team is going to have mental health issues.

- My mental health needs a six week spa vacation.

- Along with lawyers, private banking, and an accountant team, my health is probably higher than anything else. I plan on getting back on my medication, getting back in therapy, getting back into my workout regimen and restock the house with good food (with a new fridge since ours won't make it past the year).

- First thing I'm spending money on is a great therapist. Been working shit jobs for pennies in hopes I can afford therapy or get insurance one day. I can't wait 😭

- I had a cocaine problem a few years ago, beat that. Since investing in Gamestop I haven't smoked pot, I've drank 1 beer, and I've quit smoking cigarettes.

When I'm wealthy I'll be eliminating my single biggest source of stress: my job.

Which will give me plenty of time to do the thing that makes me relaxed and happy: home renovation projects. And it won't matter that lumber is the price of gold, cause I'll just use fucking gold.

- I love this community, all you apes have such great viewpoints. So many wrinkles to be gained here not just about stonks. For real, thank you for this post OP. Mental health is an issue not taken seriously enough most times. ❤️

Title: AITAH for breaking up with my girlfriend for giving in to peer pressure?

Post Text: My ex-girlfriend (27F) and I (29M) had been together for just over a year. I broke up with her last week after yet another situation where her inability to stand up for herself crossed a serious line.

The first red flag happened five months ago. She came to my apartment after a night out with her friends and confessed, tearfully, that she had made out with another guy. Her excuse? Her friends were pressuring her to "loosen up" and "live a little," and she didn't want to look uptight in front of them. I was furious but decided to forgive her because she was honest and apologized

immediately. However, I told her that this wasn't okay, and we agreed that she wouldn't go out drinking with those friends again since they clearly didn't respect her boundaries or mine.

Fast forward to last week. She told me she was taking a "mental health day" and would be hanging out with friends. What she *didn't* mention was that she was heading to a cabin in a small town with those same friends. I found out when she texted me after the fact, casually saying she'd be back later that evening. This was frustrating enough, I don't think it's unreasonable to want a heads-up about a trip, especially with friends I've already expressed concerns about.

When she came over the next day, I pressed her about what happened. She initially said it was just a relaxing day with the girls, but something about her tone felt off. I kept asking, and after three days of her denying that anything unusual happened, she finally broke down and admitted the truth:

One of her friends had been pressuring her for weeks to join a threesome with her and her husband. My ex claimed she'd been saying no repeatedly but eventually gave in to the pressure and went to the cabin with them. She swore that "nothing happened" and that they "didn't go all the way," but at that point, it didn't matter to me.

I told her the relationship was over. I explained that while I understood feeling pressured, going to the cabin was *her choice.* Staying friends with people who constantly push her to violate her own boundaries and mine was *her choice.* I also told her she needed to seriously think about why she surrounds herself with people who bring out the worst in her.

She cried and accused me of blaming her for something she "didn't have control over." I told her she absolutely had control unless they dragged her to the cabin at gunpoint, her decisions were her own.

Now her brother is texting me, saying I'm being "too harsh" and that I should be helping her work through her issues instead of walking away. But at the end of the day, I don't think it's my responsibility to stay in a relationship where my trust and boundaries are repeatedly disregarded.

So, AITAH for ending things?

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I'm sorry, but it sounds like she's making excuses and needs to grow up. A lot of people would have broken up with someone after they just made out with someone else but she went to a cabin expecting a three some? Why would she go? It doesn't sound like she respects you. It's not your job to fix her. Maybe she needs therapy and to work on herself before getting into a relationship.

- NTA. It wasn't even just that one day, or three days. It was that for weeks someone else had been telling her to do a threesome with them, WEEKS. WEEKS that she didn't mention it to

you, WEEKS that she had come up with a reason to not be with you - "mental health day". WEEKS that had gone into planning a cabin trip. Then DAYS of lying to you about it even after it happened.

She had control every fucking minute she was lying to you. She was able to control herself from telling you the truth didn't she? She was able to control herself from sounding off when she said she was going to take a mental health day.

You don't owe her shit. Maybe her brother should help her work through her issues.

- She has the worst friends, pressuring and taking advantage of her mental health...

You did the right thing. NTA

- NTA good grief that girl needs to get herself together and seek therapy. You do not have any obligation to "fix" this girl.

- NTA. She cheated on you and made that choice. It would be quite difficult to trust her from here on out every time she needed a mental health day.

What would her reaction be if you didn't text her back for almost a whole day and then said "sorry, I was busy helping a buddy fuck his wife. my bad"?

It's clear she didn't tell her brother what she did. Telling him what happened would be seen as messed up by some but... I'm kinda an asshole and if I was in your shoes and my patience ran out with him I'd probably tell him she cheated on me to get him to leave you alone.

- Nope. NTA. You were clear about your boundaries and she clearly isn't the person for you. She needs therapy. Good for moving on.

- NTA- she broke trust with the one who really cared for her. I don't know how you could stay with her. She might benefit from therapy, to try to understand her choices, for she's indeed made choices to cheat and lie.

- NTA she made her CHOICE and you made yours. You are not obligated to help with her mental health.

Tell her brother, that if he wants someone to help her work through her issues, he can pay for her therapy.

- NTA. Relationships are built on trust, respect, and the ability to set boundaries—not just with each other, but with the people you allow into your life. You gave her grace after the first incident, communicated your concerns clearly, and even set boundaries together. She not only broke those boundaries but actively put herself in a compromising situation *again*.

Peer pressure isn't an invisible puppet master—it's a test of character. And while it's heartbreaking that she seems to struggle with saying 'no,' that's not a burden you're obligated to carry.

Her brother saying you should 'help her through her issues' ignores the reality that this isn't couples therapy—it's a relationship. You're not her counselor or her savior. You can care about someone and still recognize when they're repeatedly crossing lines that matter to you.

Sometimes the most loving thing you can do—for yourself *and* the other person—is walk away.

- NTA. She either needs to get therapy to help her learn to stand up to peer pressure, or she needs to let you go so she can find herself a man with a cuckold fetish. At least then her partner would be into this kind of thing.

If she's having issues, helping her through them would certainly be a nice thing to do, but at this point it's hard to tell just how much of what she said is true or how far she's actually gone. The trust lept out of a ten story window by now.

- Think it through. There were so many times and places she could have told her "friend" a hard no. She must have met this husband, so where and when? If she was being nagged by the friend it should have spoiled those nights out so a NO would have been useful. Obviously even if she was saying no she wasn't doing it very convincingly.

If she gave in so far that it got to the morning of the trip (which would be ridiculous anyway) she could have claimed Taco Bell Tummy and stayed home.

Then at the cabin - a hard no and an Uber or phone call to you.

I originally wrote this detailing every opportunity she had to Just Say No but it got very lengthy. There were just so many opportunities.

Unsolicited opinion but I think far more happened than she admitted - at the cabin and months ago with the man at the bar.

I am a people pleasing push-over to the extent I get to feeling panicky and overwhelmed if I'm being pressured but **not if I have a good reason to say no** - something that matters more to me than pissing off the persuaders. And in a case like this, the fact that I had a partner I loved and to whom I was loyal would be that good reason. I'd drop people flat if they were trying to persuade me to be unfaithful. Any decent person would.

Tell her brother that she needs therapy if she truly was prepared to cheat rather than upset a couple of people, because she does. If there's any truth to her claims of peer pressure, then at least twice it has caused her to be in danger and to risk emotional and relationship loss because of it. She's in her mid twenties, not her mid teens. Time for her to grow up, but it sounds like she needs therapeutic help to do it. Until then she shouldn't be in any relationships because she's got work to do.

- NTA. She needs help, but not your help - she needs the help of a professional in learning to maintain her boundaries. Your doing it for her would only be controlling, not helping her find strength. At this point you owe her nothing, and breaking up is the right choice for both of you. Hopefully, it will be a wake-up call for her to get into therapy before letting these friends ruin her life.

- She specifically "took a mental health day" to go away on a trip that she knew was 100% about giving herself sexually to her friend's husband ... And you're being too harsh?

Dude your girl is a liar and a cheater and no one, not her or her asshole brother, would ever find this ok if you did it to her or if someone did it to him. Never.

Fuck these lying ass clowns.

Edit: this is bs karma farming, so I guess OP actually is the asshole.

- The next time the brother reaches out to you , tell him if she is that weak willed, then the brother should get therapy for her. It's not your responsibility, she cheated on you twice. NTA
- >Now her brother is texting me

Yeah, right.

Next time you do creative writing and you're scrabbling for the final paragraph "I'm being hassled by the family", at least think to yourself "Would anybody's brother say this? Knowing what she did?"

And you're that close with her *brother* after a *year?*

YTA for being a lousy fiction writer, *mistressjamelia (29M)*

- Copying for the future

AITAH for breaking up with my girlfriend for giving in to peer pressure? (self.AITAH)

submitted 17 hours ago by /u/mistressjamelia

My ex-girlfriend (27F) and I (29M) had been together for just over a year. I broke up with her last week after yet another situation where her inability to stand up for herself crossed a serious line.

The first red flag happened five months ago. She came to my apartment after a night out with her friends and confessed, tearfully, that she had made out with another guy. Her excuse? Her friends were pressuring her to "loosen up" and "live a little," and she didn't want to look uptight in front of them. I was furious but decided to forgive her because she was honest and apologized immediately. However, I told her that this wasn't okay, and we agreed that she wouldn't go out drinking with those friends again since they clearly didn't respect her boundaries or mine.

Fast forward to last week. She told me she was taking a "mental health day" and would be hanging out with friends. What she didn't mention was that she was heading to a cabin in a small town with those same friends. I found out when she texted me after the fact, casually saying she'd be back later that evening. This was frustrating enough, I don't think it's unreasonable to want a heads-up about a trip, especially with friends I've already expressed concerns about.

When she came over the next day, I pressed her about what happened. She initially said it was just a relaxing day with the girls, but something about her tone felt off. I kept asking, and after three days of her denying that anything unusual happened, she finally broke down and admitted the truth:

One of her friends had been pressuring her for weeks to join a threesome with her and her husband. My ex claimed she'd been saying no repeatedly but eventually gave in to the pressure and went to the cabin with them. She swore that "nothing happened" and that they "didn't go all the way," but at that point, it didn't matter to me.

I told her the relationship was over. I explained that while I understood feeling pressured, going to the cabin was her choice. Staying friends with people who constantly push her to violate her own boundaries and mine was her choice. I also told her she needed to seriously think about why she surrounds herself with people who bring out the worst in her.

She cried and accused me of blaming her for something she "didn't have control over." I told her she absolutely had control unless they dragged her to the cabin at gunpoint, her decisions were her own.

Now her brother is texting me, saying I'm being "too harsh" and that I should be helping her work through her issues instead of walking away. But at the end of the day, I don't think it's my responsibility to stay in a relationship where my trust and boundaries are repeatedly disregarded.

So, AITAH for ending things?

- NTA - you didn't break up with her because of peer pressure. You broke up with a cheater that make excuses and tried to blame everyone else for her own bad decisions.

You have boundaries that you expect to be followed and respected in a relationship....she broke them multiple times and went so much as lying and hiding the truth because she knew it was wrong and would hurt you.

NTA - move on and if her friends or family want to get involved tell them she's a lying cheater and you aren't going to be the one that sacrifices your own wellbeing and self worth just to try and see if she changes

- NTA whatsoever, your exgirlfriend's behavior can be considered wrong and unethical for several reasons:

Breach of Trust- Trust is a fundamental component of any relationship. By choosing to communicate in a way that was secretive and potentially misleading, she undermined the trust that you placed in her. This can lead to feelings of betrayal and insecurity.

Lack of Respect for Boundaries- Healthy relationships involve respect for each other's boundaries. Engaging with those friends especially in a manner that could be perceived as flirtatious or romantic, disregards the emotional boundaries that should exist between you two as partners.

Emotional Responsibility- It is important for individuals in a relationship to be emotionally responsible. The exgirlfriend's actions caused unnecessary emotional distress to her partner, who clearly wasn't wrong for feeling like something was going on.

Poor Communication- Instead of being upfront about her interactions with her "friend group" she opted for secrecy. Open communication is essential for resolving conflicts and misunderstandings. Her choice to hide this aspect of her life indicates a lack of accountability and respect for not only OP but herself.

Overall, her behavior can be seen as a disregard for the emotional well-being of her partner and the principles that underpin a healthy, respectful relationship. The best thing you could have done was break up with her and block her brother from harassing you, you aren't a therapist it's not your job to help her work through her problems with setting healthy boundaries and being accountable for her own actions.

- NTA. Why is it always when a partner does something wrong it's suddenly up to their significant other to "teach them how to change"?

You're a grown ass adult! You're supposed to do these things yourself! And even if you can't do it by yourself, don't put the responsibility on others to do it for you! Seek help from professionals, therapy, your parents!

You honestly dodged a huge bullet by breaking up with her or else you're gonna be tied down to a child trapped in an adult's body.

- She honestly should have said to you from the get go "hey these people keep saying they want a 3some with me" but instead she chose to lie to you about a mental health day.

Ditch her and, when you're ready, find someone more honest.

- NTA

She cheated and at 27 it wasn't peer pressure it was a choice. If she lacks that much self control, she needs therapy.

Title: i'm worried about my brother

Post Text: my brother has been sleeping for 3 days straight. he's only left his room twice to eat. he himself says he doesn't understand why he's so tired, says it's because he's had lack of sleep recently. but sleeping for days straight? it's concerning. i feel like he has depression based on other observations, but he hasn't been eating either which is weird because he loved to eat. i'm concerned but he won't tell any of us what's going on and doesn't want to get therapy.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Being tired physically can be many causes, stress, depression, anxiety, diet, physical health, hypersomnia.

Lack of appetite can also be caused by many things, stress, depression, anxiety, physical health, too much or too little sleep, physical illness and just like sleepiness, also more.

My advice for you and your family is to give him some reasons to get his butt outa bed, does he really love a certain activity? Do that with him, if hes too tired to do that, find a less exhausting activity, dont pressure him just say "hey we were thinking of doing this would you like to join us? you can join us anytime!" be validating and caring. If he doesn't want therapy I'd still recommend going to see a doctor to talk about this because hypersomnia can be caused by way too many things for it to NOT be investigated on atleast a physical scale. I wish you and your family luck and hope your brother gets better!

Title: What massively improved your mental health?

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Not drinking, going to therapy, lots of self honesty
- Nature. People still overlook this simple thing, and it's hard for many to find nature where they live. I took a trip to the mountains and had never felt more relaxed in my life. Then I moved near the water I instantly saw my mental health improve after living in the city for many years. I think when you realize that so much is alive all around us, it makes you stop and think how small we really are.
- Quit teaching high school. Got divorced.

So much less stress I finally quit smoking.

- Realizing I was an extrovert with social anxiety rather than an introvert, and working to overcome that anxiety.
- As I grew older, I decided to care less and less about more and more.

YMMV. I'm not as successful with it with kids. Kids grow up and their circumstances change, and the things I need to care about or let go change as well.

On the flip side, I decided to care more about some things that have more impact on my life and mental wellbeing.

- 8 weeks off work and some cognitive behavioural therapy. Really though, being away from work has been the best and I actually feel recharged. I go back to work tomorrow.
- There are lots of physical and mental health reasons a person has trouble sleeping. You can do all the sleep hygiene prep you want and might still have trouble.

What I have learned is that, even if you can't sleep, lay down and rest. Just snuggle up in your bed, either silence or soft radio or even a comfort movie, and just lay there comfortably. Purposely do that for as long as you can handle.

Sleep is important, but if that fails us, we still need our bodies to rest.

- Ketamine.

I thought my lifelong depression was actually pretty much handled when I began the treatments (for my lingering "low energy"). By the 4th session I felt what I had never felt before in my life - a desire to get out of bed and accomplish something. Excitement about my possible future, even. I stopped taking 3 hour naps, I stopped giving up on trying to meet goals or improve myself. Everyone in my life noticed a huge difference.

8 months later I'm doing another round, and it IS expensive and inconvenient but I have no doubt it's the best thing for me I could spend my \$\$ and time on.

- Therapy

Shocking, I know.

- Stopped comparing my life to other peoples'; limit my use of social media; therapy and sertraline; getting 8 hours of sleep every night
- Going to the gym. The main source of my depression was the way I looked so I changed that and now just a year later I feel a lot better. I don't feel depressed anymore and I smile every time I see myself in the mirror
- Age and some therapy.
- Therapy and finding a partner. The second one worked faster.
- Living in the moment. Depression seems driven by my past. Anxiety seems driven by my future. If I focus on being here now, it helps tremendously.
- Letting go of my ex. Not only that but holding on was actually causing heart complications and anxiety issues.
- 3.75g of psilocybin mushrooms, taken with intention, in a therapeutic setting. Nothing comes close to that, although therapy (particularly IFS) & avoiding inflammatory food & drink (sugar, refined carbs, fried food, dairy, alcohol) have helped a lot too.
- Exercise.

I know people don't want to hear it, but your physical health and mental health are very much tied together. When I decided to quit making excuses and made physical health a true priority in my life and began slowly taking steps to achieve a better diet, regularly exercise and lost weight, I felt so much better physically, mentally and emotionally.

- I gave up Facebook and caffeine (mostly). Noticeable difference, effective immediately, anxiety reduced by a huge amount.

- Microdosing mushrooms. Swear on my life I've tried every single antidepressant/ anxiety medication combo under then sun for over 3 years with my current doctor and this is all I ever needed.

Title: What is the single most effective piece of mental health advice you've ever received?

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- "We all know what it feels like to run on empty, but many people don't know what a full battery feels like".

This was one of the sayings in my 1st therapy session that has always stuck with me. It was refreshing to open up on things I bottled up, and to know that ultimately I needed ****time**** to heal

- Best thing to do to help your mental health is to not associate with people who are bad for it.

Which is more complicated than it sounds. It doesn't mean getting rid of people who make you feel bad for calling you on your BS. It means getting rid of those who lie to, use, hurt or manipulate you, those who are a bad influence on you, and those who enable or encourage your bad behaviors, regardless of how much they mean to you. It's going to hurt at first, breaking bonds always does, but it's so much easier to get healthy when you stop drinking poison.

- The Cognitive Behavioral Therapy tool for getting out of a spiral of catastrophization.

- Might not be as profound as some but it's in relation to how our foods and what we consume has an effect on mental health. It's so obvious that not getting the right nutrition is clearly going to have cognitive effects. Couple good eating with exercise and I found it a lot less difficult to deal with day to day life.

- It's OK to walk out of an overwhelming situation (regarding anxiety attacks in my case). You don't need to share or owe an explanation to others, and no one will notice anyways.

And hey, some fresh air and quiet can work wonders!

- Two things (already overstepping the topic question), both I figured out way later in life than I wish I had:

1)What other people think about you doesn't matter, and it's none of your business.
("Comparison is the thief of joy.")

2)Life is 10% what happens to you and 90% how you respond to it.

Granted, the second one can be found everywhere now, but that wasn't the case 25 years ago when I really needed it.

I'm about to turn 50 trying not to dwell on countless missed opportunities and the mental health challenges I didn't deal with that kept me from pursuing what I really wanted (re: the more difficult/rewarding road).

- Write daily in a password-protected online journal that nobody else will ever read. It allows you to be brutally honest with yourself, and turning your thoughts and emotions into sentences somehow clarifies them and gives you perspective. Also, regularly read past entries to see what was going on for you in the past and compare it to now.

It's a form of therapy, and it's totally free. You just have to be willing to do it, and do it consistently. But it means you don't have to dump your shit onto other people quite so much.

- Mental health isn't your fault, but it is your responsibility.
- If you're going through mental health issues, talk to yourself as if you're telling someone else with the same issues. What would you say to someone who made the same mistakes as you? Who's having a hard time, sad about their performance, etc..?
- To help reduce your anxiety, just do a little but every day towards the things you need to accomplish, and you will feel less anxious.
- Leave the past in the past. Try to change the past is an impossible task.

Also, being a victim is something that happened to you beyond your control. Continuing to identify as a victim is a choice. Deal with what happened (therapy, books, learning coping tools) and don't let something external that happened to you be your entire identity. At the end of the day we are all responsible for our own lives.

- Basic exercise going for a walk will do more good for your mental health than all the pills on earth.

The medical system treats symptoms, not causes.

You have to fix your issues yourself.

- If I'm feeling stressed, overwhelmed or just generally struggling to find the motivation for the day.. I tell myself to forget thinking about everything that I need to do today, and instead think of just getting out the front door. Make opening your front door the most important task
- There's been a few.

My dad told me once the most important thing is to always make yourself laugh and life will never be too hard. Whatever the situation never take it/yourself/anyone else too seriously because at the end of the day, who cares?

My mum told me when I was going through a horrible breakup that "there's a reason why people write sad songs, embrace it until you're ready to move on, it's ok to be sad" and it helped so much.

Also one rogue doctor who, after I was unhappy constantly at taking anti-depressant medication said she thought I was probably just too uptight and overthinking things so prescribed me beta blockers instead of antidepressants and it basically cured my anxiety and depression overnight. I still get down now and then but in a far more human way and have been for 8+years now.

- "Does it matter though?"

Most things, don't matter. Some things, really matter, those things are worth stressing about, everything else? Nah.

* Family? Matters.

* Someone being a dick on the subway? Meh.

* What you had for lunch? Meh.

* Grades? Important.

​

etc, etc.

- You have to remember that even though some things are out of your control and things like depression and anxiety are very real, voluntary happiness is just as real. If you act miserable then it'll stay that way. Sometimes just a shift of views can start to help

- Stress is like a rocking chair; it will give you something to do, but will get you nowhere!

- Sharing too much of your depression or sadness, reminds the listener of their own issues, and problems. Talk with loved ones but don't bury them in it and be willing to listen to suggestions and ideas

- Speak with someone. Mental health is a life long journey. Asking for help doesn't make you weak.

- Go and exercise. My doctor actually wrote me a prescription for weekly running and swimming. Saved me years of being medicated for depression. Still my go to to calm my mind, and cooking

- love to cook!

- If you are going through depression, buy baby wipes. Everyone deserves to be clean.

That one hit home for me and hard.

- Spending a lot of time forcing myself to think in the present, particularly in situations that are stressing me out (particularly the airport recently, just focusing on the "what am I doing now? What is it I am getting? Where am I currently stood and what can I see/smell?"). Hoping that the more I do it, the more natural it will become and will help me to reduce the snowballing I go through so much, especially about things that are either not my problem, or are hours and hours away.

- Corporate America doesn't give a shit about you as a person, they'll sell you out for a buck. Never sacrifice your mental health for them.

Title: What massively improved your mental health?

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Giving up alcohol. It made me an asshole and the feeling I would have the next day would give me horrible anxiety.
- 36m, getting a mani and pedi once a month, getting massages regularly, and regularly going to the gym for 30-40 minutes 3 or 4 times a week.

All of this has massively reduced my stress, given me multiple things to look forward to as I space them out so most weeks I have something going on, and improved how I view myself.

I also took up painting and I was shocked to hear myself laugh as I had a bit of fun doing it.

- Understanding that mental health is a skill set and not an analysis of my upbringing.

I wasted years with toxic and unhelpful therapists who would dissect my history. They would help me 'understand' my issues. I'd be like "Great! So, what do I do with this info?" And they'd say "Well, now you know you're history so you can make better choices." That for me wasn't enough.

I eventually realized there was a whole field of manualized and evidence-based care out there (that they were gatekeeping saying that nothing else could help me). It would give me step-by-step rules on understanding my emotions, regulating them, helping me build relationships, and giving me the skills to cool off in the worst-case scenarios.

The first and biggest impact in all of that for me though was learning to name my emotions. One of those therapies has a handout that gives you top-level emotions, what causes them, how they affect your body, aftereffects, and so on. Reading those handouts over and over made me realize when past therapists would yell at me I was in denial of a particular emotion, it was instead two things: 1) It was the wrong emotion they were claiming, and 2) I didn't have the skill set to name them. Once I realized what I was feeling the intensity went from 8 out of 10 to 5 out of 10. Which is a huge drop and a lot easier to manage.

If you're curious, here is the sheet. I recommend spending a few weeks just reading each one line by line, and asking yourself if the feeling you're having matches any. I discovered I felt Jealousy, Envy, and Shame way more than I ever knew before.

<https://www.uaf.edu/mentalhealth/dbt-group-handouts/ER%2010%20-%20A%20Model%20of%20Emotions%20handout%206.pdf>

Also mindfulness, specifically the exercise "Leaves on a Stream" got me seeing my thoughts and feelings as something outside of me instead of drowning in them.

[http://actforpsychosis.com/pdfs/A11_Leaves_on_the_stream.pdf](http://actforpsychosis.com/pdfs/A11_Leaves_on_the_stream.pdf)

Edit: Since this garnered so much interest, I highly recommend the website below. It's a free way of learning all the skills in this treatment modality. A real program is superior but costly. This is a good start.

<https://dbt.tools/>

- Therapy. Went from anxiety all day everyday to understanding why my anxiety exists. I resisted it for 3 years but it's the best thing I ever did for myself.
- Sobriety, which seems to be a common theme in the comments. I've been sober for a little under 10 years and in that time my life has completely changed in every way I can think of.
- Graduated college Summa Cum Laude after dropping out 4 times over the past 15 years.
- Got the highest paying job I've ever had right after college which enables me to help make other people's jobs better.
- Met the love of my life who I will definitely marry. I honestly didn't understand what love was before I met this woman.
- Lost ~100lbs without dieting or exercising, lol. (technically not drinking 18 Coronas a day is dieting but quitting drinking is not the same thing as trying to watch calories)
- I have real friends who care about me for the first time in my life.
- I was finally diagnosed with ADHD instead of depression, so I stopped taking SSRIs which were actually making me feel worse and started medication for ADHD. Depression magically evaporated once I could stay focused and get things done.

That's just the short list. I'd have to write a book if I wanted to list all the things that changed. If you're an alcoholic or heavy drinker and wondering why you're miserable, I definitely recommend not doing that.

- Taking up running. I get pretty anxious when things happen I can't control such as not knowing how people may react in confrontational situations or having my schedule suddenly changed without notice.

Running gets rid of all of that anxiety from that stuff, it also has helped me lose weight and keep it off making me feel better about my appearance as well.

- Honestly? The real answer?

Therapy. I've finally healed a large part of my trauma and I needed a therapist to listen, accept me, and challenge my viewpoints where it's not healthy.

I had a huge break through recently and I've consistently slept at least eight hours for the last week. Most of the time I can't hold a consistent schedule for more than three days.

It feels like the shades in the apartment have been pulled up and I'm actually present. I was in therapy on and off for almost six months a few years ago. Bad fit.

I had to go through three other therapists before finding the right one.

I had hour long sessions each week with her for all of this year.

Some of my scars are still there but I feel lighter and I'm approaching things less like a whipped dog and more okay with new things.

- Switching to decaf. The amount of caffeine I had in my system was not doing my anxiety any favors.
- When my husband killed himself.

He was a pos that drank, did drugs abused and terrorized me along with sleeping with a ton of women. He even carried on an affair in Indonesia and converted to islam!

I filed for a divorce and he played games, refused to sign the papers. Refused to do anything to make it easier for me to divorce his sorry ass.

3 months after I filed for divorce he drank himself to death.

He is the reason for my screen name. I finally have a nice boring life and I love it. No more worrying what he's going to do next. I'm free. It did a number on my mental health. I'm happier, I'm not constantly dreading unknown phone calls. My heart doesn't skip a beat every time my security camera notifies me there's movement. Life is nice without him in it.

- I finally found a therapist I clicked with and that made a huge difference for me. I've been in and out of therapy for thirty years and never found the right person I could actually work with. Finding the right one changed everything for me. I've been seeing them for a year and a half and have made many improvements since.
- Working remote has led to:

- no commute stress (I live in a densely populated area)
- more energy to exercise and be healthier
- more energy to cook good foods
- better sleeping habits due to exercising and routine
- no Sunday scaries. I can actually enjoy my day off.
- Stop watching the news. The sky hasn't fallen yet, so I'm not gonna stress about it every day.
- Two things:

Intention - Once I realized the state of my mental health, I made it a point to spend time with friends every week and do things with them that I enjoy, and be present while doing the things so I can let it nourish me. "I like this. This is good. I want to do more of this."

TEAM CBT - Read the book "Feeling Great" by David D. Burns, M.D. or listen to the podcast, "Feeling Good". The systematic, scientific approach has greatly improved my mental health, even without a therapist.

- I stopped watching the news. My anxiety level dropped so much since then. I know I'm out of the loop and it's not a good thing, but it improved my mental health so much
- Giving up all substances. For me, it was alcohol, cigarettes, weed, and occasionally coke. I'll be 2 years sober in 5 months and I'm the happiest and healthiest I've been in 10+ years. I'm

also on a very good mix of antidepressants and anti-anxiety that's really just been the cherry on top.

- Divorcing a narcissistic abuser. No more walking on eggshells every second of the day. It's amazing how much that affects your nervous system and mental health.

- Therapy.

Lexapro

- Therapy + light workouts as long walks for instance + cbd

- Being properly diagnosed and medicated. I went 26 years without knowing I had Bipolar II, I went unmedicated for years because antidepressants made me feel worse and I hated taking them. Finally found a psychiatrist that was able to diagnose me and put me on mood stabilizers. It has done wonders for my mental health. Alongside that is being in a healthy relationship with someone who loves me, supports me, and is understanding of my feelings.

- Buying a task specific ebook reader (Kindle to be specific) for two reasons. Firstly, because I could increase the font size it eased my anxiety about getting "older eyes" and maybe not enjoying reading anymore. Secondly, because it is JUST a reader and doesn't pop up alerts or messages or any other damned thing it eliminated the constant interruptions that were ruining the reading experience on my tablet. I got back to being able to immerse myself in a good book for a while and let the world just spin without me.

SEVERELY LIMITING exposure to the "news". Almost all of the "news" sources now focus on keeping you hyped up and worried so you'll keep coming back and checking-in. I now strictly limit myself to a few somewhat calmer sources and for a very restricted amount of time per day. I'd cut it out completely if I could but I do still want to have some idea of what is going on in the world.

Realizing that there is no such thing as "catching up" at work. Work is like laundry, there will ALWAYS be more so now I focus on doing what is in front of me and doing it well and if it seems like things are "piling up" then to me that is a management problem and they need to delegate more resources/people. This one is HARD because management, even good management, is ALWAYS playing games to make you feel like you "could be doing more".

- Stopped smoking/ switched to low nicotine vaping.

Started a much more consistent sleep schedule.

Minimized drinking to maybe twice a month.

Half an hour run or moderate workout every day.

Half an hour a day outside minimum.

Did a blood test and fixed vitamin deficiencies.

These reduced my mental health issues by about 50% without taking any meds other than vitamins.

- I had depression and while looking on google maps to find a decent building a friend of mine called me out of nowhere and started ranting to me about how he got his ass beat in MLB the Show 22. I don't even like baseball. Playing with my friend literally saved my life. After many, many hours of playing that game with him. I can safely say that a baseball videogame made me happy.

- Transitioning.

I went from looking and sounding miserable and feeling miserable with little real enjoyment in my day-to-day life to feeling happy, being hopeful for my future, and having others comment that I look and sound so much happier now.

Like, I still have mental health issues, but those mostly exist from specific traumas largely stemming from military experiences. The biggest difference is I am now in a position to identify and treat those issues without having to do so through the barrier that is untreated gender incongruence.

- Meditation

Didn't realize how stressful and tiring THINKING can be until I started meditating. I now try to do it 3-4 a week at least.

- As cliché as it is with the Jordan Peterson book, cleaning my room (and the whole house). My mental health skyrocketed when I stopped misplacing things, and didn't live in clutter. I still have all of the things, they're just now in a dedicated place and organized.

Finding an outdoor hobby. It sucks that it's hot, but the sun really does wonders. It doesn't have to be productive or expensive either. Trading the 2 beers at the bar everyday for 2 hours fishing has changed my life, and my wallet. It doesn't matter if I catch anything, but when I do, that dopamine feels way better than "taking off the edge".

- Ketamine therapy has been life changing. I feel like I'm getting back to the person I was years ago.

- Completely cut out weed. Did talk therapy weekly for six months. Got on the right SSRI, meditate twice a day.

- I'll say weed. It stopped my racing thoughts & anxiety. It made all my problems insignificant not where I get complacent but more of "it is what it is" mindset. I have social anxiety but when I'm high I'm not so self-conscious, therefore being my authentic self to strangers and having great conversations. I struggle to eat simply because I've been so used to eating like 1 - 2 meals a day and having the munchies help me get it in

- Stop caring about posting on social media. Stop comparing myself to others on social media. The feelings of inadequacy and jealousy stopped, and it feels like I'm living for myself. Much less stressful

- Coming from someone who has dealt with personal mental health struggles and been in school to become an art therapist for 8+ years (undergrad + masters) mindfulness (listening to what your body needs and wants), self-compassion and forgiveness, time to recharge however that may be for you, taking care of your body (foods you eat, stretching/movement in general, sleep), and most importantly if possible surround yourself with people that make you feel safe and happy 🤗

Mental health is a roller coaster, just try and enjoy the ride and remember the upside down loop will end eventually.

- Accepting that it's ok, to not be ok, therapy, and leaving your fucks at the bottom of the ocean

- I know a few people have said this already, but the ONLY thing that helped my mental health (after fifteen years of multiple diagnoses, rounds of therapy, different medications etc etc) was getting sober.

It just changed my life in every possible way. I was a heavy drinker and occasional drug user (MDMA, cocaine, shrooms, speed) from my early teens all the way through to my late 20s (now 31 and two year's sober) and since committing to sobriety, my entire outlook has changed. I'm healthier physically and mentally, and I'm just happier overall. I still have my problems, I struggle with general anxiety and bouts of depression, but even at my lowest I'm so much happier than I was in my drinking days.

I could go into more detail about what's changed but I don't wanna ramble on. The long and short of it is I used to be unhappy by default and now, my default is happy and excited for the future, regardless of what life throws at me.

- Nurturing a sense of humility.

I did this through some weight loss/weight lifting and Brazilian Jiu jitsu.

Fuck pride and ego; hose obfuscate the truth, that being that each of us is equally vulnerable to the rigors and stressors of life.

Realizing that I'm not shit, and neither are those that have expectations of me, helped me relax. I can only get better from where I started.

"Think lightly of yourself and deeply of the world."

- Miyamoto Musashi

- Working out.

Solved so many problems like my mental health, physical health, my skin and I learned discipline.

- Setting boundaries and not giving a shit about my social anxiety. I honestly didn't think "fake it till you make it" works, but it did and suddenly I'm so much more skilled socially.

- Quit drinking and it's been a year now and I feel like a new person. Anxiety gone and decision making has never been stronger.

- Getting diagnosed with adhd cured my anxiety and depression. For 21 years I thought I was lazy, stupid, bad at managing my time, and a failure. Turns out my brain is just fundamentally different and I'm actually an incredibly hardworking person because I made it as far as I did with a literal disability and no treatment. Add a prescription stimulant into the mix and I can actually clean my house when I want to and I'm in a Masters program now pursuing my dream job.

- Reading the Bible. I didn't come from a Christian background and I'm not even really religious still but reading the Bible improved my mental health a lot. People think the Bible is just a bunch

of rules (which is true for like the first 5 books) but outside of that it is a bunch of really motivating stories and verses that I find really apply to my life. Sorry if this sounds like I'm trying to convert you or something

- Therapy and learning how to practice acceptance
- Giving up alcohol. I can't believe the number of friends who struggle with their mental health but wouldn't dare to touch their relationship with alcohol and/or weed. It's so obvious to me. Fundamentally alters your brain chemistry.
- Therapy and medication, and most importantly, avoiding people
- Therapy
- Exercise, therapy, deepening my connection with my partner, mood stabilizers.
- Realizing I have jester's privilege. But seriously, adopting a mindset of "whatever happens, happens" and just a general I don't care attitude has helped me with anxiety.
- Therapy. Having a professional help you make sense of your thoughts takes a heavy load off your shoulders.
- Getting a divorce from my European wife! SO happy to have escaped the depression and hypochondria
- Coming to the realization that "depression" that so many people like to use as a scapegoat for their lack of achievements is a psychological construct that can be avoided if one has a strong mindset.
- 1. Starting talk therapy — biggest lessons so far: nothing is black and white, how to cope with anxiety + perfectionist tendencies, how to be kinder to myself

2. Disentangling my 9-5 corporate job from my identity.

3. Thinking long and hard about what I actually enjoy (storytelling) and building up a hobby/passion project around that.

4. Some sort of movement. I sometimes have a toxic mindset when it comes to intense exercise, so doing gentle movement like a 15-minute morning stretch or going for a walk helps

5. Building community. I've been trying to build community around various volunteer experiences, which has helped me meet really awesome people I never would've encountered otherwise. The human connection really bolsters my mental health 🥰

- Making authentic choices. The more I focused on doing and being authentically myself, even if that didn't please my parents or my friends, the less depression and anxiety I suffered.
- Leaving a stressful job. Cliche but it is what it is. Also being outside as much as possible.
- Cutting off people who only ever wanted to cause drama & are narcissistic.

I put my energy into making sure my house is tidy because for me a tidy environment means a nicer mindset. I leave my sister's room alone cause that's her area.

I force myself to get out of the house once a week. By going for a small walk with the dog or out with my family or friends, even if it's just for a coffee or I have a little patio with a seating space that I can enjoy.

Getting some sunshine & fresh air is so good for your mental health. I know everyone says that but it does WORK.

- I got off social media for about 4 months. I started practicing gratitude and counted every single blessing in my life, like having a family, my cat, having a job that pays the bills, being thankful for my family and close friends. I also would make Pinterest boards of inspirational quotes. I began journaling and writing prompts. I didn't however bury my emotions, I did cry a lot and had to lean on my mom and therapist to help me throughout it all. I am still taking my antidepressants which has made a difference, but that's just a crutch to it, you should take medication as well as actively making positive changes to your life. I have struggled with depression and suicidal thoughts since I was a teenager and my childhood wasn't happy or enjoyable at all. I've overcome my mental health battles at the age of 24. And even if I hit that bump again along the way, at least I know I am capable of taking care of it all again.

- Taking Creatine - I've been on ADs in the past (which were effective) but since I started taking creatine for sports reasons my mental health has improved immensely. I was convinced it was just placebo/ having greater energy but I've seen research pointing to its benefits.

- Establishing a consistent exercise routine has been a life-saver for me. Combining endorphin release, better sleep, and increased self-confidence significantly improved my mental health. I highly recommend finding a physical activity you enjoy and making it a regular part of your life!

Title: A powerful message about mental health and suicide

Post Text:

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- No one I know personally knows I have suicidal depression. Had it for most of my life. If I were to talk about it to them, I know they would think differently of me. My family would genuinely be happy if I was gone. However, I know it's illogical to die just yet. My wife makes me happy, and we adore each other. There's too much stuff to learn, see, and do to give up just yet. It's a daily battle, but I've made it to 40 so far.

- This hits hard. If I had killed myself in high school like I planned, everyone would have been shocked. No one knew I was depressed.

Even now, my boss was surprised I struggle with anxiety because I'm always optimistic and positive at work. I have to be because if I let myself dwell on the negative thoughts, I can spiral. Also, I was trained to put on a cheerful facade.

- This still makes me cry.

As someone who's sought help for depression through British NHS, I must say, the figures would be lower if GPs didn't just take people for granted and prescribed meds that are obsolete and do more harm than help, if they were trained better how to deal with patients and if the waiting time for NHS-funded therapy wasn't so horrendous. I'll probably get downvoted for this, but honestly my experience with them was horrendous. I'm ok now, but not thanks to NHS.

- As a person who struggles with their mental health this video hit home. I work in a shop and customers are always commenting on how happy and smiley I am when in reality I feel the opposite, spending most of my days off laying in bed trying to sleep off that feeling in the pit of

your stomach which never seems to go away. Just started antidepressants so hopefully things will begin to change for the better. To all those struggling, I hope you find your happiness ❤️

- It's so scary to see how depression can really affect some people. I remember when this ad came out originally and I legitimately shed a tear. I'm not normally able to outwardly express emotions, but this really moved me.

- One of the best commercials about mental health ever made ❤️

- This made me cryyyy, and I have known those who suffer first hand 😞

I also suffer depression, but never to suicide (this also means I have no release when my mental wellbeing nosedives, and that's hard), but one of my closest friends suffers far more. They helped me beyond any person, and virtually resolved most of my trauma, but they still suffer terribly 😞

I'm so humbled that we are each other's closest, best friends for a decade (long may that continue), and our friendship helped us heal too.

Please do be kind to each other, it is not always obvious whose suffering, and offer support as much as you can with kindness ❤️

- If you, or someone you love, are feeling fragile and in need of help or connection,

CALL 9-8-8 in the US or Canada, text 85258 or call 116 123 in the UK, or find your country's hotline number at [*blog dot opencounseling dot com](http://*blog.dot.opencounseling.dot.com).*

You are valuable. You are worthy. Thank you for being part of this community. It would not be the same without you.

- I had a friend who would always mediate our friend group when we got into fights and was just amazing at keeping everyone from being down on themselves. Super positive guy and a genuine friend to us. I was on a call with him the night before he committed suicide, I often wonder if I could have changed things from that call. He was like a brother. We listened to music for hours and at 3 am he hopped off and I had to go to sleep to be able to take an exam the next day. We talked about wills and stuff and he assured me that it was just part of his job (did a lot of construction) but still I was there talking with him. We asked about how he was doing and made sure to ask about his mental health regards to the death focus but he was insistent he was fine. The last words I said to him, and maybe the last words he heard were "I love you bro, goodnight".

We found out he committed suicide by his little brother sending a message to the group chat. At first we thought it was a joke but it wasn't. I cried for a long time and still tear up whenever one of the songs we played that night plays.

I try not to dwell on how I could have been better. You never know what's going on in a person's head.

- Nobody gives a damn fuck about men's mental health 😞

- I feel like both men are depressed, not just one of them. The original video's description on YouTube goes like this:

"At times, it can be obvious when someone is struggling to cope. But sometimes the signs are harder to spot. <...>"

The man on the left was clearly depressed ("At times, it can be obvious when someone is struggling to cope"), while the man on the right hid it under the "happiness" mask ("But sometimes the signs are harder to spot"), but at the same time he asked leading questions, gave away his scarf (everyone watching this didn't understand why he did it at first), etc.

But sadly, they couldn't help each other out in the end: depression blinded the left side guy, so he didn't notice the signs the right side guy was giving to him, while the latter decided to  his life, ultimately traumatizing his friend, the left side guy.

So in my humble opinion, this PSA is about both men struggling. Like someone down in the comments on the original video on YouTube said: depression has many faces, *even the happy one.*

<What is written below is probably nonsense>

No wonder it's called a MENTAL HEALTH & SU!C!DE PSA: the left side guy represents the mental health part, the right side guy represents the su!c!de part.

Maybe I'm completely wrong or only partially.

- Man this hit me like a ton of bricks.

Im sitting here in my home @ 8am. Just had a long cry while being held by my partner. I'm almost 3 beers deep. My anxiety is too much to handle as a 40 year old.

I do everything in my power to smile and hug and love the ones around me, but they don't see this side. A broken man with a broken mind. I hate that I relate with the fellow on the right, but this just may have saved my life. Atleast for one more day.

- This hits deep.

I finally left my abusive soon-to-be-ex-husband about six months ago, after nine years of marriage. Thankfully, no kids, so truly a clean break. In many ways, life has flourished for me: I sold the house we lived and earned a modest but healthy profit, found myself a beautiful condo, went on two fabulous and restorative vacations, my migraines have completely disappeared, I received a sizable raise and bonus at work, I'm re-connecting with both old and new friends, I'm re-discovering my hobbies and interests, and re-learning how to invest in me, myself, and I.

I'm still in therapy, and certainly making progress, but still wrestle with challenging days. For the first three months or so, I cried on an hourly basis. I no longer cry hourly, but I usually still cry once a day or so, give or take.

I tried so, so, so hard to be a good wife. I brought home all the money, I handled the vast majority of household chores and responsibilities, I endured his abuse and laundry list of issues with a smile on my face, while also simultaneously dealing with chemotherapy, monthly immunotherapy infusions, and semi-frequent surgeries for my autoimmune condition. I never yelled at him. I always used "I feel" language when communicating. I spent years trying to connect him with professional, health (physical and mental), educational, and personal resources to help him succeed in life. He was extraordinarily stubborn, and made countless excuses as to why he couldn't or wouldn't help himself. He seemed perfectly content letting me shoulder the entire burden of adulting, while simultaneously treating me like dirt.

Why don't I hate him? Why do I feel like I still love and miss him? Shouldn't I be happy and glad to finally be free of the person who caused me such substantial pain and suffering? Why do I feel compassion towards him? Shouldn't I feel angry at him? Shouldn't I feel hatred towards him? Why did he hurt me? How could he treat me the way he did? I went far, above, and beyond to try and be a good wife. I could never fathom physically, emotionally, verbally, or psychologically harming my spouse the way he did to me. I just don't get it. Your spouse is supposed to be your safe harbor in life.

- As long as you're a good person who is normal and says all the right things and makes people feel good. Most people with depression knows that most people don't really give a fuck.

- Reminds me of [The Faces of Depression](https://www.reddit.com/r/pics/comments/sfs2gw/these_are_the_faces_of_depression/)

- alright alright I get it I have mental health problems because i'm always the life of the party. I make everyone laugh. I learned to be to be the funny guy, befriend strangers from all backgrounds easily even if they were at their worst or best circumstances, and I was always the entertainer. it opened many doors for me. little did I know that I was actually on the path to committing suicide. damn. damnit robin williams same thing happened to you and now it's happening to me. well internet if you don't hear from me you all know why then. hopefully it never happens but i'd rather be patient and let time have me when it's time for me to bow out.

- I was once chatting with a colleague, and I told her that I was going to a festival. She sounded interested, so I said, 'Just buy a ticket and join my group of friends.' We spoke about some of the artists, where she remarked on one that she is not a fan of, as they always pretend too much they value the crowd, but she would love to consider it. While I was talking to her, she was clearing out her desk so that people would not be bothered to have to do it for her. During the whole conversation, I saw somebody who enjoyed life and was planning for the future. When I came back from the festival on Monday, I heard the news she was no more. From that day i realized i cant judge peoples mental health.

- sad! idk i've never been suicidal but there have been times ive wanted to die (or rather, just didn't care if death came then to find me), but depression's a hell of a thing. suicide scares me, but it's something that sadly, some consider. how do we help those that don't even show signs? that hide their depressive states from the world? i don't know how to answer that question, but i think trying to help people is never a bad thing. being nice to people is never a bad thing. the golden rule, i wish, would make a comeback. i'm not perfect and don't always live by it myself,

but it's worthy of broader consideration. everyone is struggling whether they show it or not. be kind!

- This is why it's important to report both depression and manic episodes to your psychiatrists.
- mental health and suicide usually have nothing in common.

Title: Mental Health Denied

Post Text: Hi everyone. I have been helping my husband with the disability claim process and we just found out that he was denied the mental health claim. I don't understand how that is possible that after a 20 minute Zoom conversation that the evaluator denied any rating. He has seen someone at the VA's mental health department a few times and he has been on antidepressants for a few years. How is it possible that he was denied? I am going to appeal the decision, but can anyone tell me if I can write a statement as his spouse and send that in with the appeal? What other supporting documentation can we send?

His entire claim was submitted by an advocate that works for our state and she was less than helpful.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Just because he has been receiving treatment for mental health from the VA doesn't mean the military caused it. People always seem to think just because they have a condition and being treated for it by the VA means it will be service connected. That's definitely not true as your missing the causation part to this whole equation

Read over the denial letter as it will state exactly why it was denied. Or you can post it here and people can help you understand it

- He was treated for depression in military. Was the event detailed and why he still struggles from it?
- Have you considered filing for depression?

If so; hope this helps :)

Cut and paste, edit and submit.

[Your Name]

[Your Address]

[City, State, ZIP Code]

[Email Address]

[Phone Number]

[Date]

Department of Veterans Affairs

[Regional Office Address]

[City, State, ZIP Code]

Re: Duty to Assist and Request for Comprehensive Exams and Medical Opinions

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to formally request the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) to fulfill its duty to assist in the development of my pending claims. Specifically, I am asking the VA to schedule me for the necessary comprehensive medical examinations, including an ACE (Acceptable Clinical Evidence) examination, and to seek medical opinions that may assist in finding a nexus between my claimed and inferred conditions and my military experience or onset during my military service.

If the VA has denied my claim for chronic adjustment disorder but has found credible evidence of treatment for depression, I urge the VA to apply a sympathetic reading of my claim. This involves developing the claim for depression and associated symptoms as part of the broader context of my mental health condition. The VA's duty to assist mandates that it considers all potential conditions reasonably raised by the evidence on record.

Please ensure that these comprehensive evaluations and medical opinions thoroughly address all potential connections, including any secondary conditions that may be related to my primary conditions. I also request that the VA consider any inferred secondary claims and expedite decisions where possible. If certain claims require further development, I ask that the VA render partial decisions on fully developed claims and defer decisions on those needing additional information, as outlined in *Harris v. Derwinski*.

Thank you for your attention to this matter. I look forward to your prompt response and the necessary actions to ensure a fair and comprehensive evaluation of my claims.

Sincerely,

[Your Full Name]

[Your VA File Number]

- So what I am seeing is that a claim was filed for Chronic Adjustment Disorder. His Post Deployment shows what? PTSD? Depression? What does his Separation Medical Exam/History say? His VHA records say depression and that's one of two reasons he received an exam. You're husband was probably deployed to a hazardous fire pay location and has a campaign medal. So for your husband to be SC for this you have to either get him diagnosed with chronic adjustment disorder or get his current doctor write the nexus statement explaining how his current depression is related to his military diagnosed CAD. Not all mental conditions are the same. They each get rated differently. If your POA is of no assistance get another one.

- I was seeing a VA psychologist for over a year and had my mental health rating denied. Once I received the denial letter I requested to see a VA psych, got my diagnosis and resubmit. Was rated 70% mental within 2 months. Hope your husband can get his diagnosis and receive the treatment and compensation he deserves.

- The denial letter states: favorable findings 1) stressor event. 2) treated for depression while in service.

It was denied due to lack of diagnosis. I thought c&p could diagnose tho. The sub posts that they diagnose all the time related to ptsd. "I just walked in and they diagnosed me on the spot".

What gives with this? Smells like b.s.

Title: How do i prove mental health condition was service related.

Post Text: I applied for my disability had a nexus letter and everything showing my diagnosis. The VA recognized and agreed I had the diagnosis (depression and anxiety) but denied my claim. They said it wasn't service related. I deployed twice once to iraq, where I have a letter of recommendation from my Co detailing the types of mission's I ran. I've been out for 12 years now if that makes a difference. I want to appeal it, but have i just out to long. Will I be wasting my time? I was in the Marine Corps during a time where you didn't just go to sick bay especially for mental health. You would be punished one way or the other. You were looked down on. if I only knew then what I know now.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Does your DD214 have hazards pay etc? If it is you could HLR the decision they must use that stressor as weight of evidence

- I don't know about Marine regs or paperwork, but in the Army when you have certain awards or ribbons especially a CIB "Combat Infantry Badge" or CAB "Combat action Badge" they come with the award paperwork which is a form DA 638 and there are blocks on that form that will state the reason for the award in detail, which would include the stressor, IED, Indirect fire , direct fire, IED ect. The awards prove the nexus, so, those type awards along with a clinical diagnosis can go a long way in improving the chance of being awarded compensation for PTSD, anxiety, or other mental health issues.

- What inservice event(s) caused your anxiety/deoression?

- You can use your deployment decoration/medal as proof of stressors from your deployments. It also supports that you got hazardous or imminent danger pay. I used my Joint Achievement Medal from Afgan in my claim. Additionally, I filled out the VA PTSD stressor form of the locations, units, and times my stressors happened.

- I submitted for PTSD Non-Combat (So, I found what closely matched), since it wasn't combat, and took my time to lay it out.

I did not deploy to Iraq, Afghanistan, or any Combat situation. All my deployments were peacetime, and did deploy to Bosnia during Operation deny flight, during the ethnic fighting thing, but peacetime support.

1. Went to mental health once
2. Air Force Photog - I documented some wild stuff
3. Buddy Statements
4. C&P Exam
5. Second Medical Review

6. Even included therapist unrelated to military

Basically what I did was laid out an entire case of one stressor, and connected everything back to the stressor.

It was only 30% PTSD Non Combat, but it stuck. I made it easy I guess. U.S. Air Force Photographer, and Civil Engineer. However, I did have a few stressors. Took some time to confirm. Your appeal should work, but lay it out in some sort of logical fashion. That's what I did.

- Commit yourself to a Mental Health/Addiction facility as an inpatient and the doctors will tell more in their notes than the entirety of your military records and VA exams. My time in rehab is the only reason I'm at 70%; bc lord knows my service records sell my condition short.

Title: Has anyone else had to break up with someone due to your mental health?

Post Text: I just ended the relationship today, I didn't want to but I don't have the capacity to be in the relationship right now with how fragile I am after going through something traumatic. I've been struggling to take care of myself. I feel like I'm losing myself. My meds (that tend to keep me stable ish in the past) aren't working either. I haven't been this rock bottom since 2020. No one deserves to be in a romantic relationship with a partner in the state I'm in. If he's my person or if he meant the friendship thing, I know in my heart that we'll be in touch someday.

Anyways! Curious to what other people's experiences are, if anyone would like to share.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Just got broken up with a few weeks ago by my partner of 4.5 years because of their mental health. I'll be honest, I have mixed feelings. Like on one hand I understand that people like you and my ex aren't in the best place for a relationship rn.

But on the other hand it's just like damn you going to just leave after 4.5 years when I'm literally offering to stay with you through it. It's definitely a selfish move. Doesn't mean it's right or wrong, but at the end of the day I am definitely very heartbroken (your ex probably feels the same).

But if you got to do it, I guess you got to do it. But it really sucks a lot on the receiving end because it doesn't even feel like a break up. It just feels like your partner had a break down and ran away. It sucks.

- I'm on the receiving end of this. My ex broke up with me due to his mental health, he felt he was failing me as a partner and couldn't bear it. Although it hurt terribly, I love him too much to ever hold it against him. I love him so much that I'm willing to let go of him in order to let him heal. I just want so badly for him to be okay.

I know your ex must be hurting too but if you have to take care of yourself right now there is nothing wrong with that. Sometimes you need to put your oxygen mask on first before you can tend to anyone else.

I know if it's meant to be, it will be.

Take care of yourself and focus on getting better!

- I need to understand this because my woman broke up with me over fights that weren't necessary or a threat to our relationship, saying she didn't have the mental health to deal with it and she's had trauma in her last relationship but that dude was a straight up dickhead I, nowhere close to me

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- i'm actually the guy in this exact situation right now. she says she loves me and misses me like crazy, that i was everything she was looking for in a man and that she'll probably regret it, but mentally she just cannot be there for me right now. it's been a very confusing and painful 2 weeks for me since, but i know i don't hate her. part of me wants to still be there for her but it's hard. i told her over and over that i was willing to be there for her no matter what, and i would give her all the space she needed to work on these things while still having me there. i think she believes deep down she can give it time and then she can come back to me when she improved some things, but that's just not gonna be the case, because she has caused me far too much hurt to ever trust her in that way again. if that is something in your mind, i would say it's better to move towards moving on and focusing on yourself. i wish you the best and hope your mental health improves though!!

- My fiancée and girlfriend of 9 years cancelled our wedding right before the big day. Citing bullshit reasons it became clear in the months after that she's in the throws of a mental health crisis and has admitted as much and she can't love or be loved. She's very much not the person she once was and it's heartbreaking. She also refuses therapy or outside help and wants to journal her way through it. It sucks, I thought I had found my person but the universe had different plans. We've cohabitated as ex's for a year plus due to our dogs and she finally moves out next month

- I have done the same... I broke up with him because I didn't deserve him and he deserves better than some crazy emotional mess who can't keep it together and barely making it day by day! My mental health had me in a bad place and I hurt him by being with him like that!! I hurt him by leaving but I didn't know how to be in that relationship and not get help when he didn't believe in depression or anxiety or anything like that!! So I got help after I left him but he's realizing he doesn't want me anymore so maybe it was for the best

- Me, but I actually think 90% of my mental health problems are caused by him
- I've been on the receiving end of this. I had no idea anything was wrong. I could tell she was distant, but we'd been involved with each other for 5 years so I thought she just needed time. I reached out to her on multiple occasions to ask if everything was alright. She would reply either "I'm alright just need some time to myself" or "it's nothing you did or didn't do." I trusted her to talk to me about any potential issues, so I felt no need to pry further.

Eventually she pulled away for too long. I reached out to let her know I felt my emotional needs weren't currently being met. She responded that she felt hers weren't either which was a shock to me. She suggested we take a break and take some time to work on myself. So I did exactly that. I came back several weeks later excited to share my progress. She told me it was too late. That she'd given it thought and didn't think she could be present in a relationship at the moment and that I deserved better.

I tried to explain to her my frustration and hurt at her decision, but it fell on deaf ears so I'll tell you, Reddit stranger. She completely stripped me of my ability to make the decisions. She didn't bring up any issues because she had convinced herself they couldn't be overcome. She never invited me into the internal conversations she was having about our relationship. She robbed me of the choice of whether or not I wanted to stay together. I would have taken a step back and loved her from a distance. I would have supported pursuing therapy whether as individuals or a couple in order to grow. However she allowed her own guilt to self-sabotage herself and convince herself she didn't deserve me in her life; a self-fulfilling pity prophecy.

We fought, tried to be friends, fought more, and it ended with her blocking me everywhere. I spent the next 3 months going to therapy, exercising, and developing new hobbies. Eventually, after discussing with my therapist, I decided to reach out in order to apologize for the fights I'd caused. It ended with us making up, but agreeing we didn't feel ready to return to each others' lives.

We spent the next 5 months keeping in touch through text, sharing details of our lives and where we were currently at in our journeys of emotional growth. Occasionally we even talked about how some things in the relationship went wrong and what steps we, as individuals, were taking to ensure something like that doesn't happen again.

I thought I was her person too. I thought that, although slow, we were working towards a healthier future together. Then, however, she pulled away. I asked if she was still interested and she, politely as one could be given the situation, let me know she had recently met somebody new. She let me know she deeply cared about me and wanted to remain friends, but I let her know I didn't think that's what was best for me.

That was a week ago now and, while not as bad as the original breakup, has definitely resurfaced a lot of complicated feelings. At the forefront of those feelings was that she felt she couldn't be a good girlfriend to me when she ended things, but after we had grown, she made the choice that she wanted to give that better version of herself elsewhere. I learned and grew

a lot from the original breakup. I may once have tried to fight her about it or complain, but I've simply decided to accept her decision this time.

Somewhere in my heart, I do still hope I'm her person and that one day she'll find me again. But for now it's back to therapy for me haha. Sorry for the long reply, stranger, but maybe my story can benefit your growth or the growth of somebody else.

- If the relationship I was in didn't end naturally, I was extremely close to ending it for my mental health. I start hearing things, and get bad disassociation when I start getting stressed. Not worth going insane for any relationship. Lol.

Title: I am afraid that my bf will leave me because of my mental illness

Post Text: I (20F) have been suffering from depression and severe anxiety since elementary school. Recently I've gotten into a relationship with a wonderful boy (22M) (been going on for a few months), who has (thank god) no experiences with depression, anxiety, or any other mental illness. I've told him about my struggles, how bad they can get, and how he can support me in those moments, but I don't think he understands the gravity of the situation. My depression and anxiety were one of the main reasons why we've broken up with my ex and I am very afraid that they would be the reason for him to leave me once things get complicated. I've tried talking to him about it many times but I am not sure if he really understands what he's getting into...

How do I deal with that fear?

Edit: I am on meds and have been going to therapy

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I relate to your fear, but besides going to therapy and sticking to your treatment(if you have any) there's nothing you can really do about it. You can't just stop being depressed or anxious. Just don't let this fear control you and poison your relationship(like obsessively accusing him that he's going to leave you). If he really loves you, he will stick around.
- That's your depression talking.

My girlfriend goes through the same thing, on my end I personally already walked into this knowing a relationship is a work in progress every step of the way. So im ready to make the necessary moves for the sake of her and the relationship.

If you are worried check in with your boyfriend, if you the reassurance would make you feel better, concurrently i suggest also focusing on working on yourself because he will notice the effort on your end.

- I may be downvoted to oblivion, but to hell with it.

I guess I cannot offer any advice on how to deal with the fear. I myself have issues with self-esteem. However, I'm dating someone who suffers from mental health issues, so I can offer you personal experience from the other side. Maybe you can find a way from my comment to help your boyfriend help you... Or make it easier for him to handle. Tending to my girlfriend has

brought me to total mental breakdown from which I still haven't totally recovered. And it was due to errors that perhaps could have been avoided.

As a TL;DR, my advice would be: Don't sabotage his attempts to help you. And if you doubt something nice he says, if it's doubt related to depression... Better to keep it to yourself and let him prove you wrong.

In terms of "what he's getting into", the anxiety itself is not that big of a deal. My girlfriend randomly feels awful and cries. I can be there for her. She has shivers? I can be there for her. She hates herself and feels like she's the worst trash on Earth? I can show her she's loved and that I need her. Unless I'm emotionally depleted, supporting her is not that difficult. Over time I've learned how to carefully balance various degrees of support so that she makes it out of the attacks just fine. Even sex has become a pretty useful tool to break nasty attacks and give her a peaceful night's sleep protected from nightmares. Me taking care of her takes a substantial amount of time and sometimes completely disrupts our dates. She "likes to think" it's a bother. But it really isn't.

However, it gets problematic when you actively begin to sabotage the efforts. Here's stuff that has happened to us:

My gf would argue with me how she hates herself or how she's useless. She would shoo away objective arguments with "It can't be, because I don't think so"... Which might be okay the first couple of times... But as it happened again and again, it only began to be infuriating.

She would actively try to distance herself from me, because she "didn't want to be a bother". Distancing yourself from someone who's mad worried about you will only make them more worried. She knew it, yet she'd do it again and again.

She would refuse to meet with me, because she'd thought she'd made our dates terrible. That's not a valid reason. If you need some space, okay. But I wouldn't invite you on dates so often if they sucked. I'd choose a different program to employ you in.

It's not as easy for depressed people, so... It's important to not take everything bad that happens personally. And if you do take sth personally, better to gently raise the issue and clear any potential misunderstandings. If you do something, apologize and make up after a while. Similarly if you two have issues, it's important to resolve them. And especially important in these special circumstances.

It's also important to remember that everybody makes mistakes. When a mistake happened, if it was grave enough, she would shut down for hours before finally willing to communicate.

She had 4 stages of dealing with serious problems: Not knowing what the problem was, downplaying the severity of the problem, asking for what to do about it and how and complaining that nobody helps her solve the problems. However, when I gave advice, I was

promptly ignored and when I offered to solve the problem, I was rejected. It was even worse that the problems would often repeat.

Nevertheless, all this is still nothing compared to her worst mistake. And I never recommend anyone to repeat it.

The combo of: Progressively increasing self-hate, progressively more dangerous self-harming tendencies and progressively increasing suicidal tendencies, despite my best efforts, was left untreated. As it got worse, I eventually learned to differentiate when she was "begging for attention" and when she was serious. However, during those serious cases, I got more stressed and more desperate. Eventually I got so desperate that I began to cause harm myself.

Eventually she realized that it needed to be dealt with. But... Our relationship got tried by fire.

P.S You're probably right that he doesn't understand the gravity of the situation. But this is one of those situations that you need to live through to properly understand. Similarly how a seeing person cannot imagine what being blind looks like, it's impossible to imagine that crippling depression really cripples you.

- A piece of advice that may sound very typical: Communicate well.

There's a big difference between telling him what you have, and going over what happens when you get depressed or highly anxious. You should be informing him of the warning signs so he can be aware early on, the typical motions you go through while figuring yourself out, and most importantly, what role, if any, you want him to play in it.

These are important because he may not know what to expect, what to do, or who to call if things are bad. Maybe even in a Google doc or something. If you're lucky, your symptoms won't come back for a long time, but when they do, he'll have a place to regain any knowledge that's lost.

Have him read a book from the perspective of someone going through these things. If he really wants to be involved, have him read help books from his perspective.

Like some people said, you won't be able to avoid it, but if he's prepared for it, he can most likely manage through it with you and help you along the way.

Be prepared though if he does decide to leave. Don't blame him, not everyone can deal with mental health issues (including people with mental health). But many can, and do :)

Title: My boyfriend asked me for a break due to his health deteriorating

Post Text: We (F+M)'ve been together for over a year, I consider him to be the love of my life, he's always there for me and I would trust him with my life.

He's been having some mental and physical health issues, but the gravity of which he and I have only realized recently. Two days ago, when he asked for the break, he told me he's feeling

very overwhelmed because he's working long hours (which I know is true), I've been noticing he's been up at random hours during the night, his energy is very low and he's very worried and scared about his mental and physical health. Due to all of this combined, he said he feels he is being a burden to me and he doesn't show up in his boyfriend title as he would like to, which makes him feel very guilty.

When he asked for the break, he said that he still wants us to be in each other's lives. He just said that he needs to work on himself and if he fails after a few months, at least he won't "drag me with him". We've had similar discussions in the past, but he never mentioned a break before. He also said that he knows I don't owe it to him to wait for him (but I really want to). Since the break, we've talked on the phone at least once a day about random stuff.

I have no doubts about his love and loyalty for me, I'm 100% sure there's no other person involved, but he said he's afraid that if we stick together right now, I'll end up resenting him and the relationship will go past the point of no return (as we almost never go out anymore and he's grown weary to physical affection).

I am trying so so hard to take this time to work on myself (I'm in therapy and I have some hobbies), to have hopes about our relationship as we've overcome every obstacle before, but every time I think about him, my heart sinks a bit. I just want him to be happy and healthy but I also want to be there for him during this process. I have no idea what to do, any words of encouragement would be welcome! Thank you!

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- Does he have other people in his life that he goes to for support? Also has he been to a doctor and/or psychologist? If he's depressed or burned out he will never succeed in fixing that by himself. He needs external support. The first time I got depressed I made the mistake of withdrawing and thinking it was something I could fix myself and it got exponentially worse.

If you want to help him you need to encourage him to have multiple points of contact for support. The more the better. You cannot be the only source of support for him because it will exhaust you, even if you're not together. If he's reluctant to go to a doctor and reach out to friends for support tell him that if he does really care about you and doesn't want to drag you down with him he needs to do that. Many hands make light work. He's not a burden if he spreads the load. He needs to reach out to multiple points of support, even if he feels uncomfortable doing that. The best thing you can do is encourage him to do that.

And again, just to reiterate, if it's his first time being depressed it's a super common mistake for the depressed to withdraw and think the solution is to try and fix everything yourself. This will never ever work. It helps to think of depression as a parasite that can control your mind. It wants to survive and grow, so it tricks you into doing all the behaviours that help it grow (withdrawing, not going outside as much, not exercising, sleeping too much, stopping hobbies you used to enjoy etc). Even going on a break from what sounds like a happy loving relationship sounds like the depression tricking him. He doesn't need to be on a break from you to avoid dragging you

down with him. He can stay with you and just reach out to multiple sources of support so that the burden isn't all on you.

Title: How do I keep my mental health from affecting my relationship?

Post Text: I 20(F) have been dating my boyfriend 23(M) for about six months and he has always been aware of my struggle with mental health. It was pretty bad when we met, but I started medication and being in a new and exciting relationship actually helped me get better. Recently however, I can feel myself having bad thoughts (not suicidal but overly anxious, worried, and loss of interest in literally everything), and I'm not sure how to keep it from affecting my relationship with him. It's very difficult for me to ask for help, or to even talk about it. It's also difficult not to let small things that he does push me into feeling even more upset, anxious, or crabby. It doesn't seem fair to me that when we fight my depression and ptsd from past sexual assaults are always brought into conversation (sometimes by me and sometimes by him).

He tries to be as supportive as possible, but I don't think he could ever understand. Maybe I also don't disclose enough about how I'm feeling to him. Everyone has stuff going on and I don't want to burden him with mine, or make him feel like he isn't doing enough. I am open to posting more details, I just wanted to summarize the jist of it to make it simple and relatable.

TL;DR I don't want my mental health issues to affect my relationship with my boyfriend

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- As someone who also struggles with mental health issues, many similar to what you describe, I can offer you this- your mental health will probably always affect your relationship. But that doesn't always mean it will be in a negative manner. Ultimately the hope is that you'll grow together. That you'll maybe open up to him more and he will offer the support you need. And that just builds a tighter bond. Yes. There will be stressful days ahead, days when it's a negative. But ultimately he needs to figure out if that's something he can handle going forwards. It might not be and it's horrible to lose someone we love because of something that's a part of us and we can't change. But it's also horrible to live with a part of you hidden from the people you care about the most. I've been there. It will way away at you over time, fester, and ultimately make you worse off because of it.

But it's hard. It's so hard. We never want to burden the people that we love. But at the end of the day, the people who truly love us and want to be with us either are able to handle it or they aren't. But keeping some of yourself from them isn't the answer. If you lose them because of your struggles then it wasn't right for one or both of you. And you deserve someone who loves you for all of you, not just the parts that you easily show to the world.

For now, maybe consider asking him to come to therapy with you. He may never truly understand, because everyone has their own unique experience. But it might help him to understand better, to learn how to help you, to ask the therapist questions of his own. They can help you guys have a healthy and on-track conversation about what's going on.

- Be honest with him, for his sake, and yours! my wife wasn't really that honest to start with and it has caused lots of problems, An example (we laugh about now) she has travel anxiety amongst other things, really underplayed it when we met, I booked a surprise trip to a small greek island = massive panic attack on the plane (nearly got rerouted for medical emergency) then barely ate or drank and stayed in the room for a week mostly worrying about getting home, I thought she was going to die!

On a serious note though try to make sure he understands, if he can't cope or doesn't want to (it's hard and there's zero support for partners) he might not be the one for you and might make your condition worse.

On the positive my partner and I have compromises in place and are very happy with 2 kids, and I know lots of people with partners with mental health issues that are also very happy.

- You continually keep your mental health monitored and treat it with the attention it needs. If you came here and asked "how do I keep my cancer from affecting my relationship" the answer would be the same.

The person that loves you will accept you with all your wrinkles, warts, and worries. Just because your wrinkle is a different shape doesn't mean he will love you any less.

I didn't notice you mentioning therapy/counseling which you should absolutely be in if your bad thoughts evolve into suicidal thoughts. Your boyfriend isn't equipped to handle those problems, and at best can be a good listener.

Honestly, why not schedule some time to see a therapist right now? Their advice will be infinitely more helpful to you and your relationship than random internet strangers without education or training in this field in the first place.

Title: My boyfriend told me that he needs space due to his mental state. I don't know what to do and I need someone to talk to

Post Text: Hi all. I have been struggling so much recently with what to do about my situation, and I need advice. I have been dating my boyfriend for about a year. He is a great boyfriend; we get along so well, and I am so happy being in his company. I love him so much, he always tells me how much he loves me, takes me on dates, plans trips together with me, and makes me feel so confident about myself. He is my first boyfriend ever (I am a little bit of a late bloomer).

Over the past couple of weeks, he had been acting very distant towards me. He wouldn't touch me or kiss me as much, and I felt the vibe that he was more tired than usual and that would manifest in him being a little less goofy with me and a little more snippy than usual. There was one particular day, where in the morning when we woke up, he didn't acknowledge me much, turned away from me so his back was facing me, and when I told him I should probably leave, he just said "yeah". That hurt me, I felt like I had done something to upset him. I cried all the way home, and when I got home I texted him asking if we were good, and that I felt hurt by how he had treated me for the past couple of days. He told me that it had nothing to do with our relationship, and that he was going through personal problems that had left him emotionally

exhausted for the past week. It hurt that he didn't feel like he could tell me about these problems; in my mind, that is what a relationship is for. To share your intimate feelings with your partner and let them be there for you, and I was sad that he just wanted to keep it in and let our relationship (and my feelings) suffer the consequences.

We didn't see each other for around a week after that because I was gone on a trip and the days I was in town, he told me that he was not emotionally available to hangout and that he loves me. After I got back from my trip, he asked if he could come over to talk.

Basically, he told me that he is struggling with where he wants to be in life. He hates his job and the town that we live in. His best friend is moving away, and he feels like he is complacent and stuck here. He doesn't know what kind of job he wants to have, if he wants to pursue a higher degree, where he wants to move, or anything he wants to do career-wise. He told me that he had been having extreme anxiety over it, to the point of nearing panic attacks. He cried to me, and I've never seen him cry before. He then told me that he loves me, and part of the reason he stays here is because I'm here, and I told him to not even think about that, that we would make it work long-distance and that I don't want to be a source of his anxiety. He then told me that he needs space to figure some things out about his life, that he just needs to be alone for a week or two. I asked him if he wants to take a break, and he said that he doesn't want to go no contact, and that he still wants to text me, but basically that he doesn't want to hang out for the next 1-2 weeks. In the moment, I told him that I would be okay, and to do whatever he needs.

However, it's been a few days, and he has barely texted me. I feel like we are on a break, but not really on a break because he didn't specify that. He's clearly going through something but I feel like I have no control in this relationship anymore. I'm sitting around waiting for him to reach out when he's done having his own space, and I feel used and taken advantage of. He wants to be my boyfriend but with no expectations. Obviously, I'm heartbroken that he's not happy, but it feels like I'm being strung along. He's been alone for so long that he doesn't know how to share his emotions with another person, so he's shutting me out. In my head, I wonder what he is going to figure out in the next one or two weeks while he's alone. Is he going to keep extending the amount of time that he needs space? And leave me in this limbo of being "on a break" but not really? I want to bring this stuff up to him but I don't want to add to his pain. I feel selfish for even feeling this way. I don't know whether I should just stick it out for the two weeks and call a break if he extends it. I'm mad at him but I don't wanna be, I just want to see him and be with him.

What's more, he's really into hiking and he's going on a hiking trip with 6 of his friends this weekend. Hiking is very very important to him, and an essential part of his life, and I would be worried if he stopped doing it, but part of me wonders why he is able to take a 2.5 day long trip with his buddies but can't even make time to hangout with me or spend a night with me even just once this week. Should I stick it out for the next one or two weeks and wait for him to tell me he is ready or should I call him over and tell him either he lets me in or we're on a break? I don't know what to do, all I know is that I love him so much and I want things to be the way they used to be. Any advice would be appreciated.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- So I was looking for a totally different subreddit and tapped this one by accident but I noticed your post and got interested so my view is an outsider guy view so keep that in mind and throw it away at your discretion.

Obviously I don't know anything about you two such as age, maturity, background, or situation so I'm not going to comment on what you or he may or may not be like or what you two are thinking.

What I can offer is a perspective from the other side. Some years ago when I was fresh out of highschool and for a few years there I was sorta like your boyfriend in how I handled emotional upheaval, I would retreat into myself and basically just become extremely introspective and try to come to terms with things in my way. I grew up in a house with a very drunk father and a mother who was caring but stretched thin and stressed so I never really developed a way to reach out to other people that I was comfortable with and so I never did and still have some issues connected to that.

When I shut down like that to come to terms with myself and situation I would sort of operate on an autopilot and go through the motions. It was like putting on a face in public to keep the status quo while I tried to figure my next move. I don't know if your boyfriend is doing exactly that but I know for me there was one opening that I couldn't keep under my control and that was when I was involved in a relationship. I was in one for a couple of years with college and I was deathly afraid of her when it came to emotional upheaval for that very reason. I didn't have the energy to keep pretending all the time and she was frequently with me at the end of the day and so the exhaustion was very obvious to her.

She would try to get in my head to figure out what was wrong and to get me to tell her, the biggest one was a death of a cousin I dearly loved that coincided with my father's first relapse, and I was never once okay with that. I didn't want to talk to her about it so wanted her to offer a sense of stability and normalcy and not to try and carry my emotional burden with me or to comfort me on it. As a result I became afraid to speak with her because I felt that she would tear apart the sort of method I had made and ruin the status quo that I wanted enforced. She knew so much about me and wanted to know so much more that I began to see her as sort of an enemy to be countered and not a support system. That's where that relationship began to tear apart which of course only made me more afraid of her and more resentful of having her in my life.

I of course realize now in retrospect that I was putting a lot of anxiety and pain onto her and that she was picking up on more than I believed she was, she knew I wanted her gone and couldn't understand why because I communicated nothing to her except that this upsetting event had happened in a very matter of fact way. I hurt her and in the process myself, and in that way I did exactly what I was trying to avoid doing. That was very wrong of me and when I did eventually break up with her I went on a journey of life that has brought me to many outstanding places in the effort to confront myself, my history, and who I want to become.

As for his friends, I would spend time with my friends as well because they upheld that normalcy for me. I felt comfortable because they wouldn't try and break into my psyche. The only one I avoided was my very best friend because I've never in all my life been able to hide what I'm thinking to him. I've done him wrong as well and we're even closer now because I've worked on myself.

I haven't had a single relationship in the five years since I broke up with her, I'm not in a place to have a healthy one. I will be in the future tho, I just have to break the status quo.

Obviously I don't know what carries over to your situation but maybe that offers insight or maybe it doesn't. Make your decision on your best intuition and in the spirit of wisdom. Whatever happens, this too shall pass and life will give you another chance if you get it wrong.

- I've had terrible depression all throughout my life. I even ended a possible great relationship in the past because I was too mentally checked out and sad. But for some reason with my current boyfriend I have never left even when my depression was terrible. He was/is my safe haven. This man doesn't want to be with you and isn't afraid of losing you. I'm sorry to say this. I hope you've left and found better.

- I'm sorry you and your boyfriend are going through this. However, your boyfriend DID eventually do the right thing and tell you what's going on with him. This is a good thing. Some partners never communicate what's going on with them and leave you wondering. He didn't. He was an adult about it and told you what's going on and what he needs.

It sounds like he's going through some depression and needs to figure things out for himself. That's a tough thing for anyone to go through. While people are experiencing these things, they *can* participate in other activities. Just because he doesn't want to hang out with you right now doesn't mean he doesn't want to hang out with other friends, and the physical activity of hiking, getting away from his normal environment, might just be the physical/mental break he needs to heal some of his depression. It's a good thing for him to do, and I think he sees that. I hope you can, too, and be an adult about his needs right now.

If you value him as a person, as a partner, that's what you'll do - respect his needs, respect that he's asked you for space and **GIVE IT TO HIM**. His actions right now aren't about you, but about him and his own healing, at least based on what he's shared with you so far. Give him the time and space to work on that.

In fact, it's what you've told him you're willing to do. So back up your words with adult action and do it. He knows how you feel; you've already communicated it to him. But right now he needs time to work on himself. So allow him that. Give him 2 weeks, 3 weeks to hopefully get a bit more right in his head and heart, to heal the emotional confusion he's feeling about his own life situation.

And then after that time, check in with him. Text him: "Just checking in. How are you feeling? Would you be up to seeing me and maybe talking a little?" See how he responds. If he's open

to it, that's a possible good sign that he's done some healing. Meet with him, see how he is, see what he says.

If he's not ready to see you and says he still needs more time, then it will be time for *you* to come to a decision: to continue supporting him by giving him more space, or let him know that you need to move on.

There's absolutely no shame in moving on from someone with mental and emotional health issues. Those issues weren't apparent, weren't there, at the start of your relationship. You didn't know this personal crisis would develop with him. If that's not what you want in your life, move on. Let him know you'll still be around should he need a friend to talk with, but that's it. That's all the support you can offer. Move on and find someone else to date.

Or you can continue the relationship, continue waiting, continue holding out for him to get better, keeping your distance and giving him the time and space he needs. If you're willing to do that. If that's what you want in your life.

You need to make that decision for yourself. But first, give him the time he's asking for now and see how it goes. Be an adult about it, do the hard thing. Don't text, don't call him until the time is up, and then check in. Sometimes giving people the space they need is part of maintaining the relationship. And sometimes, once you've done those things, moving on from a situation you didn't ask to be part of is also what happens in a relationship. Let him navigate it for now, and when and if the time comes, you can take over, should you choose, and navigate it yourself. - He got emotional enough to cry in front of you. That's a really big thing for anyone to do.

It sounds like he's really struggling with his mental state, and honestly, sometimes a day with some friends where it's not going to be as intimate is helpful in those situations --especially when part of his depression is one of his friends moving away.

Just give him some space and time and gently offer that you're there to talk and make sure he knows you won't judge. Focus on your hobbies and yourself for a bit.

Title: All MAGA candidates can use against their opponents are these disgusting anti-trans ads.

Post Text: I am struggling with the frequency of the bullying of transgender children and the fear mongering being done by MAGA candidates in these awful political ads. It feels abusive and traumatizing to ME (a straight, white, middle-aged man), so I cannot imagine how it feels to kids and families in the LGBTQ+ community. Not that the people who believe these ads care, but here are some facts:

1. HB68 (or House Bill HATE, as I've heard it called and find appropriate) did 3 things, but the biggest and most real consequence was it took away gender affirming healthcare for transgender children. Which includes mental health services. Which those kids already need because of the bullying and the extremely high suicide rate. I read a study recently that shows how much suicide rates have increased in these last couple of years of anti-trans legislation.

Have these people no shame? How can you live with yourself putting out messages that these kids see when they are streaming a show on tv (I know, because my kids have seen it so many times).

2. No one voted to "allow boys to play girls' sports." They use this because if you paid attention to the facts on the other two, you would likely agree with how hateful they are. But saying boys are taking over girls' sports and how unfair it is resonates more (despite it being a mischaracterization of the issue.) And the number of transgender athletes is so small that it isn't even a real issue, especially compared with actual real issues. How about school safety and reducing school shootings? How about fully funding public schools? How about the indoctrination happening in schools because groups like Lifewise have infiltrated (part of project 2025 and already spreading like the virus it is), which started in my own district in Hilliard. It is literally the only thing these hateful MAGA candidates can use to attack.

3. Children do not get "sex change surgeries." Not at school, not at their doctor's office -- it's not happening. And as for puberty blockers and mental healthcare -- that should be between the parents, their child, and their healthcare providers.

Please see these ads for what they are -- hateful, divisive fear mongering used to distract you from the negatives about the candidates putting the ads out. Like Moreno being a billionaire who rips off his workers and sends jobs to China. Or Stephanie Kunze who opposes reproductive freedom, voted for the August special election (which wasted \$18 million taxpayer dollars), who voted for the HB68/HATE bill and voted to override Mike Dewine's veto (yes, Gov. DeWine even agrees HB68 is cruel and harmful to transgender children), and she pretends to care about our public schools but supported and voted for the Voucher expansion costing our schools \$1 billion in taxpayer dollars, meanwhile they are only funded slightly over half of what they are supposed to be. Worse, Kunze pretends to be a moderate while voting for those extreme bills that are right in line with the MAGAs in her party.

I have a mutual friend with Kunze and have been told that she only votes that way because her party bullies her into it. I don't know if that is accurate or not, but to me that is just as bad. Not only does she not have integrity, but she also doesn't have a spine or the courage to do what is right. She should be ashamed.

Aren't we all just so very tired of all this hate? We could end it and all move on if we vote for normal people with solid policies that aren't just pushing culture wars and hateful rhetoric to hold office.

Comments Related to Mental Health:

- I mean the below is pretty straightforward.... Good I see no issue with it.

This bill, known as the Enact Ohio Saving Adolescents from Experimentation (SAFE) Act, proposes several key provisions: 1. It prohibits physicians from performing gender reassignment surgery or prescribing cross-sex hormones or puberty-blocking drugs for the purpose of

assisting minors with gender transition, with limited exceptions. 2. It requires mental health professionals to obtain parental consent before diagnosing or treating a minor for a gender-related condition, and to screen for other potential underlying issues. 3. It prohibits Medicaid coverage for gender transition services for minors, with exceptions. 4. It enacts the Save Women's Sports Act, which requires schools, state institutions of higher education, and private colleges to designate separate single-sex teams and sports for each biological sex, and prohibits individuals of the male sex from participating on female sports teams. The bill aims to protect the health and safety of minors by limiting access to certain gender transition services and procedures, citing concerns around long-term risks and lack of clinical evidence on the benefits. It also seeks to preserve fairness in women's sports by maintaining separate teams based on biological sex.

- The way I see it, a rare group of individuals asked for help and recognition of a problem.

What we have is the result of over zealous glom-ons from politics.

None of these trans issues were the original plan of the founding persons at the beginning. These current "trans" issues are "mental health" issues, not because of bullying, but because of the glom on politics.

People call out bullshit. There's legit transgenderism. What hate you perceive is the calling out of bullshit.

We all find our ways around ramps for the wheelchair bound, we find ways around the woman who also has a prostate.

But we put up a hand and say wait when there are men swimming against women and cross dressers at story time.

- Issues that I have here are in some states as you stated treatment should be between child, parent and doctor if underage. That isn't the current case. CPS in states like Wyoming can come in and take a child if they are told the home is unsafe. Even when there is no proof. This is an issue when it comes to troubled youths who have real mental health issues. Please don't read this as "all of them are crazy" because that's not at all what I'm saying but distinguishing from real mental health issues and a cry for help are very different.

My mother is bipolar type II, has paranoid schizophrenia and multiple personality disorders. She flew under the radar as a kid into a young adult hood. With the typical well she will grow out of it till she didn't. She has made all kinds of accusations that have no actual basis in reality. That being said from that point due to gender affirming care they can start treating said child without the consent of the parents because they are considered a ward of the state.

I have an issue with this there need to be better processes.

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I'd cite the study Harvard did but it's lacking major data points and just repeatedly says it's inconclusive or not enough data was gathered.

I'd also address that with gender affirming care it's very easy to jump right in and get hormone treatment without going through psychological evaluation to make sure there are no underlying stressors. As a personal anecdote. It has been harder for me as an adult male with testosterone problems to get prescribed testosterone. Then it was for my cousin and she is in the process of transitioning, she went to a doctor, said she wanted to transition and was immediately referred to and prescribed blockers and testosterone. I've seen kids and their friends identify with lgbq+ for a year or two and then dip out. Which takes away from children who may really need this treatment. Let's also mention those who transition, realize they were just gay and didn't actually need to transition to themselves. My cousin almost went down that road and has said she would have majorly regretted it.

We don't know the long term affects of long-term puberty blockers for kids who are healthy and not lacking testosterone or estrogen. We know in males for example testosterone even in safe doses this can cause early heart conditions.

I'm not saying treatments shouldn't be available I just think the medical system at this time has too much to gain with the cost of surgeries and medication they bill to the insurers. The medical system at this point is very corrupt and not focused on the health of the individual. Mostly money, drug reps incentivising pharmaceuticals.

Moving to the trans athlete issue. It is a big deal there are women who spend their whole sports career becoming a top athlete and when facing biological males who don't have to be on hormone treatment. Often male athletes rank lower against other men. This affects women driven scholarships where biological women no longer have access. A good example of going through testosterone.

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These are pro athletes. Naturally occurring testosterone is a hell of a drug. And can make biological men outperform women who are professionals in their sport. So I think we could at least make spaces where they can build and create their own teams or let women voluntarily compete against those individuals by their own will. Instead of an organization telling them that it's happening and they don't have a choice. I don't think that's hateful I think that we're seeing a new evolution of sport and we need to accommodate and change things as time changes. Currently the setup doesn't seem to work and it also seems to outrage a lot of people even the general public.

There are some sports where Miss may not have an effect. But there are major ones that will. Either way I think that we still need policy change definitely still needs to be policy change.

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